MIND IT!

THE COMPLETE IDIOT'S GUIDE

From Zero to Quizmaster: Everything You Need to Create, Host and Play Mind It!

Version 1.69 · updated for build 138 · real screenshots of the app

Contents

PART ONE — UNDERSTANDING MIND IT! 10

1. Welcome to Mind It! 10
2. Why Play Mind It!? — All Its Perks 12
3. Equipment and Setup 14

PART TWO — CREATING A QUIZ 34

4. Installing and Opening Mind It! 34
5. Creating Your First Quiz: THE BIG FAT QUIZ 43
6. The Complete Question Database Guide 54

PART THREE — TEAMS AND CONNECTIVITY 64

7. Teams, Players and Quizmaster 64
8. Connecting Player Phones 71
9. Connection Health and Pre-Game Checks ✅ 77

PART FOUR — COMPLETE GAMEPLAY RULES 81

10. Understanding the Game Board 82
11. Complete Scoring Rules 86
12. Every Special Ability — Complete Guide 91
13. Game Modes 107
14. Timers 111

PART FIVE — HOSTING THE GAME 113

15. Every Quizmaster Button Explained 113
16. Audience View 127
17. Complete Example — Host an Entire Game 136
18. Mastermind It! 149
19. Ending a Game 158

PART SIX — ADDITIONAL FEATURES 162

20. Achievements, Statistics and Historic Games 162
21. Themes, Audio and Personalisation 167
22. Backups and Game Recovery 171

🆘 HELP! MY GAME CLOSED IN THE MIDDLE OF A QUIZ! 175

PART SEVEN — TROUBLESHOOTING AND HOSTING TIPS 177

23. Complete Troubleshooting Guide 177
24. Tips for Hosting a Great Quiz 180

PART EIGHT — QUICK REFERENCE AND APPENDICES 182

25. The Printable Quick-Reference Materials 182

Appendix A — Feature status at a glance 183
Appendix B — Things found while writing this guide 185
Appendix C — Keyboard shortcuts (laptop) 186
Appendix D — Glossary 187
Appendix E — Frequently asked questions 189

For Mind It! version 1.69 (updated for build 152 — the Windows app `Mind It!.exe`, the Mac app `Mind It!.app` for Apple Silicon Macs, the Android tablet app and **Mind It! TV** for the Mi Box). Writing the guide changed nothing in the app; build 112 then added the changes the owner approved, and this edition describes them.

New in build 112 (all ✅): the TV shows the phone join QR code before the game · 📶 Devices → **Phone Join QR (for Teams)** · ties are decided by **most correct answers** on the TV too · **Undo** gives chips back · at least **2 teams** · no Phoenix in Phone Buzzer Mode · a **one-player team** takes its player's name and picture · phones say "Thanks For Playing!" after every END GAME · no speed-bonus countdown on a Triple Gamble.

New in builds 113–114 (all ✅): places (1st, 2nd…) on the TV score cards · long team names fit the Now Playing bar · ⚡ speed bonus shown on the Correct button · correct-answer counts on the final podium and the phones' scoreboard · a hand-edited question value is kept · 🚀 "Phoenix Climber" achievement · the Mastermind It! question locks once Mastermind It! starts · Mastermind It! phone answers close 2 seconds after time's up · bigger Setup buttons on the tablet · Replace Round warns about repeated questions · clearer Phone Buzzer Mode on the TV · licences in About · team phones vibrate when they're needed (Android).

New in builds 115–117 (all ✅): in Phone Buzzer Mode, Correct / Wrong wait until a team buzzes — on the laptop and on the tablet · no Phoenix on the browser-only web link (no phone server) · if Mind It! opens on a different network port, your saved game, theme, sound and house rules come with it · accepted alternate answers can still be added during Mastermind It! · in Phone Buzzer Mode the tablet drops the turn-order line and the laptop says who buzzed first (build 117) · a new 2-page **Rehearsal Checklist** for the real devices.

New in build 118 (all ✅, layout only): pop-up messages appear beside the laptop's right-hand panel instead of over its buttons · the board panel shows "questions left" once · one **Begin Game** button on Setup (in the bar at the bottom) · Correct and Wrong are the same size · a slimmer header on Setup.

New in build 119 (all ✅, layout only): on a portrait tablet the quiz name gets the top row and the buttons sit below · chip names show in full on the tablet · on team phones, "Connected" and **Change Team Code** share one line under the scoreboard · the game record page shows each team's score beside its name · the Random Team Generator shows every team count on one row. (The joined-phone screenshot in Chapter 8 is new; some other tablet and phone screenshots were taken before these small changes.)

New in build 120 (all ✅): the **Board & Flow** card sits above the Back / Next buttons of Audio & Presentation · **Export History To Excel** appears once in Backups & Data · the leftover step numbers (1, 4, 5) are gone · the automatic **Speed Bonus Points** show in a normal box. · **Random Team Generator:** tap two players to swap, **+** to move, ↶ **Undo**, ⟲ **Reset to Generated Teams** (Chapter 7.4).

New in build 121 (all ✅, quality fixes — nothing to learn): team phones that check in normally no longer flicker between *Connected* and *Unstable* in Connection Health · the Quizmaster tablet no longer redraws its whole screen every second (numbers you are typing stay put) · on team phones the **BUZZ IN** button is no longer rebuilt several times a second, so every tap counts · the laptop's **Join link & QR code** section stays open · the 📱 phone remote no longer speeds up after each button press · **an unfinished game is no longer lost** if Mind It! is opened and closed again without choosing **Resume saved game** or **Start fresh** — it is offered every time until you choose.

New in build 122 (✅, owner's decision): 👑 **Returning Champion** only when last game's **whole winning team** is on one team tonight (a one-player winner crowns the team that player is on) — split winners mean no crown (12.5).

New in build 123 (✅, owner's decisions): restoring a backup or loading a game file **always asks first** — even with no game running — so a quiz you're still setting up can't be replaced by accident (22.3) · a **Mac version** of the laptop app (4.1b, 🟡 not yet tried on a real Mac).

New in build 124 (✅): 🗑 **Delete a player** from Player Profiles — past games keep their name (7.2b) · the Mac app now comes for **Apple Silicon Macs only** (4.1b).

New in build 125 (✅): 🗑 **Recently Deleted** — restore a deleted player for 30 days (7.2b) · ☑ **Select** several players to archive or delete together (7.2c) · 🛟 **Safety backups** made automatically before anything is replaced or removed (22.3b) · the tablet keeps what you're typing when the laptop changes the scores (11.9) · 🖼 **Results Picture** for any game in Historic Games (20.8).

New in build 126 (✅): 📲 **Mind It! on the home screen** — on an iPhone or iPad, Safari's **Share → Add to Home Screen** now gives a proper **Mind It!** icon that opens full-screen, for team phones and the 📱 Phone Remote (8.6) · the downloads are also on your private GitHub page, as single complete files, plus the **webpage version** (4.1, 4.1c).

New in build 127 (✅): **an iPad or iPhone can be the full Quizmaster remote** — 📲 **Connect Tablet is now Connect Device** and shows a second code, **iPad / iPhone**; scan it with the Camera and Safari opens the same remote the Galaxy Tab uses, with nothing to install (Setup B2) · on an iPhone the remote's board now fits the screen.

New in build 128 (✅ laptop · 🟡 tablet): **trusted devices** — a remote connects once with the PIN and then reconnects by itself · **only one remote controls the quiz**, and a second one waits until you **Allow & Switch**, **Reject** or **Ignore** it · **Connected Devices** shows who's in control, who's waiting and your trusted devices (Setup B4) · **the Galaxy Tab can be the server**: with no laptop, team phones and a phone remote join the tablet (Setup B3).

New in build 136:

- 🌐 **Online Mode replaces Family Night** — for a quiz on a **Teams call**: Speed Bonus on, no Phoenix Chip, 2 rounds + Mastermind It!, Standard answering, and wagers sent to the Quizmaster in a private chat message instead of a QR code on the TV (5.Step 7).
- **Backups about a third smaller:** each question picture is now in a backup file once (it was also stored a second time inside the quiz). Builds 132 and later restore them (22.2).
- **See where your data is:** Backups & Restore → **Right now** shows where the player data is saved (this laptop's file, the tablet's file or this browser), how big it is and when it was last saved, and how many pictures there are (22.3c).
- 🗜 **Make photos smaller** (only when you tap it): makes the older, larger player-photo originals 800 px, like every new photo since build 111, after a safety backup. Players keep their pictures; question pictures don't change (22.3c).

New in build 152:

- 📺 **Mind It! TV — an app for the Mi Box (Android TV).** The box becomes the audience screen: it finds the quiz on your Wi-Fi by itself (laptop or Galaxy Tab), shows it full-screen, keeps the screen on and reconnects on its own. You run it with the TV remote; the game stays on the laptop or the tablet (Setup C2b).
- **Every app updates itself.** The laptop app (**Setup → 6 · Advanced → ⬆ App Update**; on Windows it downloads the new build beside the old one and restarts into it), the Galaxy Tab (it now downloads the update **inside the app** — no browser — and shows Android's install screen) and Mind It! TV (**⬆ App Update** on its start screen) (4.1, 4.2, Setup C2b).
- **Safer keys: End Round Early is Shift+E** (E alone does nothing), and every "are you sure?" box starts on **Cancel**, so a stray Space or Enter can't end the round or undo a score. **T** now **resumes** a paused timer from the seconds left. One set of words for the timer: **Pause · Resume · End** (14.2, Appendix C).
- ⌨ **Keyboard Shortcuts** — the whole list on screen: ⋯ → ⌨ **Keyboard Shortcuts**, or press **?** (Appendix C).
- **Host controls tidied:** the **Timer** card sits under the TV preview, the resets are in their own **Danger zone** row away from Undo, **Mastermind It!** shows *Mark each team* first, **click a team's score** to adjust it, and the Undo pop-up after a score is centred (10.4, 11.9, 15.7, 18).
- ⬇ **Excel ▾** in the Question Database's top row: the blank **Quiz Template**, the **Mastermind It! Template** and the **Whole Question Database** in one place; **More ▾** shows how many groups of 🔁 Duplicates it has found (6.1, 6.9).
- **The Galaxy Tab hosting in portrait:** the TV preview folds away behind 📺 **Show TV preview**, so the clue picker and the teams come first (Setup B3).

New in build 151:

- 🤠 **Rewind It! on the team's own phone** — in **Phone Buzzer Mode** with team phones, the team that picks a Rewind It! square spins the wheel on its phone (**SPIN THE WHEEL**) and stops it (**STOP!**); the result is drawn when they stop, each of 1×–5× equally likely. The laptop and the tablet keep small **Spin For Them / Stop For Them** buttons in case the phone is away. In every other mode the Quizmaster spins, as before (12.1b).
- **New pictures** of the tablet and the phones with the new names (8.3, 12.1, 12.1b, Chapter 18).

New in build 150:

- **The game sounds like the trailer** — each moment uses the trailer's sound at the trailer's balance: a right answer is the ding and then the score "pop", a phone's **BUZZ IN** is the buzz, a new board, the round summary and the standings arrive with a whoosh, the winner gets the impact before the crowd, a change of theme sparkles (21.2).
- **Updated guides** (this one, the Quick Start, the cheat sheet, the rehearsal checklist and the players' guide) with the new names and everything below. The guides are now updated every 5th build.

New in build 149:

- **The Rascala! is a cowboy cat** — brown cowboy hat with goggles, black bandit mask, red bandana and sheriff star — on the TV reveal, the badge in Historic Games and Career Achievements (19.1b).
- **The tie-break always decides The Rascala!** — also when every team finishes level on score (19.1b).
- **The tagline "Enna Rascala....Mind It!"** under the big MIND IT! logo on the TV's loading and intro screens, on The Rascala! reveal and on the Galaxy Tab's Main Menu (16.1).
- **The Mind It! sound pack** — recorded sounds in the style of the Mind It! trailer for right and wrong answers, the question, lock-ins, Blind It!, Mastermind It!, the chips, Rewind It!, The Rascala! and the winner (21.2).
- 📲 **The Galaxy Tab updates itself** — **Settings → App Update → Check For Updates**, or **Update Available** on the Main Menu; no laptop needed (4.2).
- **Fixes you may notice:** on a 4× or 5× Rewind It! the laptop's WRONG ANSWER button shows the real loss (3×); **Undo** also takes the answer out of the night's statistics; after **END GAME** you can choose Blind It! or Rewind It! again; the Blind It! and Mastermind It! wager screens keep clear of the scenery on Comic Book, Christmas, Movies, Summer and Diwali.

New in build 148 — new names and two new moments:

- **Blind It!** is the new name of the **Daily Double** (same rules; the TV shows black sunglasses), **Mastermind It!** of the **Final Round** (with a gold brain), and **Never Mind It!** of the **True Daily Double** (12.1, Chapter 18).
- 🤠 **Rewind It!** — choose it instead of Blind It! for a game: the Quizmaster (in Phone Buzzer Mode since build 151, the team on its phone) spins a cowboy-hat wheel for **1× to 5×** the question's value; a wrong answer loses at most 3×; no chips that game (12.1b).
- 😾 **The Rascala!** — the last-place team gets a TV reveal after the winner, an achievement and a badge in Historic Games (19.1b).

New in build 147:

- **Every theme is now a premium TV game show** — each of the 12 has its own moments for the title, round intros, the question reveal, correct and wrong answers, a team taking the lead, the Blind It! question, back to the board, Mastermind It!, the standings and the winner (21.1).
- **Default Mind It!** gets a navy studio look with gold light and an LED wall; **Comic Book** is redesigned in ink black, crimson, hero gold, paper cream and steel blue (21.1).
- **Deeper colours** for Christmas, Eid, Diwali, Summer, Bollywood, Sports, Gaming and Movies. 🎬 **Motion** Subtle keeps a gentle glow, Off none (21.3).

New in build 146:

- **A premium look on every theme** — glossy tiles, rimmed headers, glowing question and answer, framed pictures, a Blind It! spotlight — in each theme's own colours (21.1).
- 🎨 **Theme ▾ in your top bar:** change the theme in one pick, even in the middle of a question (21.1).
- 🎲 **Fun team names** in Quick Setup and beside each team's name (7.3).
- **A new theme picker** with larger previews (21.1); **Back to the board** after **3 seconds** (21.3); the **Google Drive backup** uploads more lightly and retries patiently (22.6).
- 🎨 **Theme on the tablet remote** (15.12); **No One Answered** closes after **3 seconds** (11.3); a **slow Wi-Fi TV lightens itself** and the laptop says which (21.3); ☁️ **Restore from Drive** (22.6); a 🏆 **Champions card** on the TV and 💾 **Save Champions Picture** (15.10).
- **Easier to read on the TV:** pictures fit their frame, bigger names, turn line ("Next to Pick:") and answer.
- **Phones:** one team card, **Your Turn to Pick!** in words, score and place under the buzzer, a tidier wager pad, and they follow 🎬 **Motion** (8.1, 21.3). Wi-Fi Audience Screens now play the animations too.

New in build 145:

- **Smoother moments everywhere:** on the TV the question grows out of its square, screens fade, **TIME'S UP** stamps onto the card, a wrong answer shakes, a correct one sparkles, the Now Playing light glides, standings arrive 3rd → 2nd → 1st, a spotlight sweeps for the winner and Intermission flips its digits. Phones slide between screens, stamp ✔ **LOCKED IN**, glow when it's your turn to pick and shout **YOU'RE FIRST!** on a buzz. The tablet, laptop and Setup fade and press. New: **Motion — Full / Subtle / Off** in 5 · Audio & Presentation (Full by default; the device's Reduced Motion setting always turns it off) (21.3).

New in build 144:

- ↔ **Move a whole category to another round:** in Review & Edit Clues, ↔ **Move** swaps a category with the one you pick — in another round, or the same round to change its column. The questions take their answers, notes and pictures with them; values and Blind It! squares stay on the board (6.8b).

New in build 143:

- 📲 **The tablet offers its own update:** when the Galaxy Tab finds or connects to a laptop that carries a newer tablet app, it shows **Update Available** — tap **Update**, Chrome opens the laptop's download page, then **Download** and **Update** (4.2). From build 143 on, no code to scan.

New in build 142 — three upgrades:

- 📲 **Update the Galaxy Tab app from the laptop:** the laptop app carries the tablet app of the same build. 📲 **Connect Device → Update the Tablet App** shows a code; scan it with the tablet's camera and the tablet downloads the app straight from the laptop over your Wi-Fi — no GitHub, no internet (4.2).
- **No PIN for your own tablet:** a tablet the laptop already knows now connects from **Connect To Laptop** without the PIN, also after the laptop app has restarted (5.1). Before, the tablet asked for the PIN again every time Mind It! had restarted on the laptop.
- 🛟 **A Safety Backup after every game,** by itself, in Backups & Restore with the others (22.3b).

New in build 141 — nine upgrades:

- ⚑ **Fix Later:** spot a wrong question or answer during the game? Tap ⚑ **Fix Later** (or press **F**, or tap it on the tablet) and carry on. After the game the Question Database lists them (Chapters 15.3 and 6.4).
- **Reveal before anyone has answered asks first**, so a mis-tap can't spoil a question (Chapter 15.3).
- **Pre-show checklist** on Setup: TV, sound, questions, backup and storage, ticked by themselves (Chapter 4, Step 12).
- 📊 **Night Recap** on the TV after the game: the champion, the final table, the night's numbers and its highlights (Chapter 15.10).
- **Your data stays put:** Mind It! asks the browser to keep its data, and Backups & Restore shows whether it agreed (Chapter 22.1).
- Under the hood: big picture quizzes save faster; the release check now saves and reopens a game in the tablet app before every release.

New in build 140 — four new buttons for the end of a round and the end of the game:

- ↩ **Undo pop-up:** after every score, the laptop shows what was scored with an **Undo** button for 8 seconds — one tap undoes it, no question asked (Chapter 15.4).
- ⏱ **One More Question:** tell the game the next question is the last of the round; the TV says so, and the round summary comes up by itself after it (Chapter 15.2).
- ⭐ **Go to the Final:** short of time? End the round, skip the rounds still to come and go to Mastermind It!, after the round summary (Chapter 15.2).
- ⚡ **Sudden-death tiebreaker:** teams level on points for first place at the very end? You can play one question from your Question Database, answered out loud — the first team you mark right wins. Skip it and most correct answers decides, as before (Chapter 18.3).
- On an **upright (portrait) TV** with 6–8 teams, the Mastermind It! reveal shows the answer cards in rows of four, with the standings straight under them.

- **Pictures, videos and music survive a crash:** a quiz with lots of pictures, videos, music or team photos is now also saved complete, so **Resume saved game** brings them back after a crash or restart. If there is ever no room for that copy, a red card says so, with 💾 **Save Backup File** (Chapter 22.1).

New in build 139 — a white "now playing" light, a 45-second Mastermind It!, and many teams:

- The team whose turn it is now has a **white** ring and glow (a "spotlight"), so it can't be mistaken for a team that is 🔥 **On Fire**. A team that is both shows both rings.
- The **Mastermind It! timer is 45 seconds** by default (was 60). You can still set 10–600 seconds in Setup.
- Screens with **7–8 teams and many players** were checked and fixed: the Mastermind It! reveal, the Returning Champion card, "Buzzed In!", the recap and standings pictures, the tablet's Mastermind It! marking and the laptop's team statuses.
- Steadier on the Wi-Fi: one bad message can no longer stop the Windows/Mac app; slow TVs catch up instead of falling behind; after 20 different wrong team codes a phone waits 5 minutes.

New in build 138 — one go per team, and the board comes back by itself:

- Each team gets **one go per question** (a wrong answer or a pass). When every team has had its go, the answer shows with **NO ONE ANSWERED** and the board comes back by itself; **No One Answered** closes a question earlier.
- After every answer the board comes back by itself after **7 seconds** (it was 3½ s after a correct answer); **Stay Here** and **Next Question** still work.

New in build 138 — fixes from a code check (the game plays the same):

- In the Windows and Mac app, **+ New Category, Move To Category, Rename, Delete Category, ⇄ (move a question to another round) and ✎ Edit Answer** now open a small box to type in (they did nothing there before).
- ✎ **Edit Answer** stays when team phones are connected; 📶 **Devices** shows the tablet as ● **Connected**; on the Galaxy Tab, **Wi-Fi TVs** stay connected.
- Accents and emoji survive large saves; the **"now playing" glow** uses far less computer power; phones, TVs and tablets load the page compressed; 20 wrong remote PINs make that device wait 5 minutes.

New in build 137 — Online Mode for Teams calls:

- Picking **Online Mode** also switches on **Teams Presentation Mode** (Audience View + Presentation Check).
- **Mastermind It! answers by private chat:** the TV asks for them, you type each into **Mark Each Team** (with the usual suggestion), and the reveal shows it.
- **Wagers from the chat: All in · Half · 0** buttons; no phone-only boxes; the cursor starts in the first amount box.
- **How to Play** on the TV explains a call; 📋 **Copy picture for the chat** at the end; **Speed Bonus window 15 seconds** in Online Mode (5.Step 7).

New in build 135:

- **Drawn TV backdrops for every holiday and party theme** — Christmas, Halloween, Ramadan / Eid, Diwali, Summer, Comic Book, Gaming and Movies each get an original picture behind the quiz with a few things moving in it, like the Wizard castle in build 134 (Setup → 🎨 Theme; see 21.1).
- **The remote warns too:** a remote, such as the Galaxy Tab controlling a laptop quiz, shows ⚠ **Different Builds** when the device running the quiz is on another build (Setup B4).
- **The tablet app is fixed:** builds 129–134 installed under the name "application" and closed straight away on the Galaxy Tab (a fault in how the app file was packaged). Build 135 fixes it: it is called **Mind It!** and installs over the broken one, keeping the tablet's data (4.2, 23.1).
- **No more false "storage full" on an iPhone:** an iPhone or iPad used as the remote no longer copies the laptop's whole player database (it never used it, and Safari only allows each site about 5 MB). The webpage keeps a large database in the browser's own database instead; the laptop's file is read before anything is written; and every storage message now says what really happened (23.4).
- **New photos are smaller:** on an iPhone a photo is saved as a JPEG (not a large PNG) unless it really has see-through parts.

New in build 134:

- ☕ **Intermission music:** the theme's background loop plays quietly while the Intermission countdown is on, and fades out when you resume.
- **The build number in ★ About & Credits** ("Version 1.69 · Build 134") and in Setup → About, so you can see which build each laptop and tablet runs.
- **Connected Devices warns** when a connected remote, such as the Galaxy Tab, runs another build (Setup B4).
- **The Wizard / Magical School theme** has a new TV backdrop: a castle at night, with owls, a dragon, a phoenix and bats flying past (an original drawing).

New in build 133: a new intro theme — new hard-rock music with a deep cinematic **"MIND IT!"**, then a bigger, booming explosion on its own and a short closing riff; the loading screen plays the new riff. The intro page now stays until that riff has finished (about 13 seconds). The 🎵 Mind It! sting and the winner screen play the same theme. Music and voice were created in collaboration with ElevenLabs (★ About & Credits).

New in build 132 (✅ laptop · 🟡 tablet and TVs): 🔊 **sound on a Wi-Fi TV** — one audience screen can play the quiz's sound through the TV's own speakers (Setup C2) · the intro's first line is easier to hear: the music dips slightly under it · 📋 **Rehearsal Report** — a file to send after a rehearsal (Setup C3) · a **shorter TV address** from the laptop, e.g. `192.168.1.20/tv` (Setup C2) · 🔒 **Lock** on the remote is now a small icon · 📲 **Hand Quiz to the Galaxy Tab** — the laptop hands a running quiz to the Galaxy Tab (Setup B6) · fixed: a Galaxy Tab whose quiz had moved to the laptop can host again, and a tablet hosting with a remote that was switched off no longer drops its other remotes.

New in build 131: a new voice for the intro — your own clip, before the explosion; the music, the loading screen and the explosion are unchanged.

New in build 130 (✅ laptop · 🟡 tablet and TVs): 📡 **Audience Screens over the Wi-Fi** — any TV or computer with a web browser shows the audience screen, no cable, from the laptop or the Galaxy Tab; several at once; rename, test, safe margin, disconnect (Setup C2) · 💻 **Take Over Tablet Quiz** — a quiz running on the Galaxy Tab moves to the laptop with its scores, question, wagers, chips, timer, phones, remotes and TVs, after the tablet approves (Setup B5) · 🧪 **Test Hosting**, a 🔋 **battery warning**, 🔒 **lock the remote**, a ▂▄▆ **signal** for each remote, and the Windows joiner now checks the file's fingerprint.

New in build 129 (✅ laptop · 🟡 tablet and iPhone): **rename your devices** in Connected Devices (Setup B4) · 📱 **Add Phone Remote is always there** on the remote in control, also after it reconnects without the PIN · **the Galaxy Tab keeps hosting** when its screen goes off or you open another app — a notification says *Mind It! is hosting a quiz* · **other Galaxy Tabs find the tablet's game** (*Tablet Game Found*) (Setup B3) · **the webpage works with no internet** once it has been opened (4.1c).

How to Use This Guide

- **Never hosted a quiz?** Read Part One, then follow Chapter 5 (*Creating Your First Quiz*) and Chapter 17 (*Complete Example*) with the app open in front of you.
- **Hosting tonight and in a hurry?** Print the two-page **Quizmaster Cheat Sheet** (`MIND_IT_QUIZMASTER_CHEAT_SHEET.pdf`) and read the **Quick Start** (`MIND_IT_QUICK_START.pdf`). Before your first real quiz night, tick through the **Rehearsal Checklist** (`MIND_IT_REHEARSAL_CHECKLIST.pdf`) on the real devices.
- **A player?** You only need the two-page **Player's Guide** (`MIND_IT_PLAYERS_GUIDE.pdf`).
- **Something broke?** Jump to *HELP! My Game Closed in the Middle of a Quiz!* (end of Chapter 22) or Chapter 23 (*Troubleshooting*).

What the little labels mean

This guide is honest about what was checked and how. You will see these labels:

Label	Meaning
✅ **Verified**	Seen working in Mind It! 1.69 (build 111, or builds 112–114 for their changes) while this guide was written — in the real app on a test computer, with test tablets and phones simulated in a browser — and/or covered by the app's automatic test suites.
🟡 **Not verified on real hardware**	The feature is in the app, but it has not been checked on a real Windows PC, a real Galaxy Tab, a real iPhone/Android phone, a real TV, or with real sound. It *should* work; nobody has watched it work on that device.
🔵 **Approved, unfinished or undecided**	The behaviour is in the app, but the owner has an open question about it. It may change later.
⚪ **Idea only — not in the app**	Discussed at some point, but it does not exist. Don't go looking for it.

About the pictures. Every screenshot marked 📸 is a **real screenshot of Mind It! 1.69** — build 111, or build 112–114 where the caption says so — captured from the actual app (the laptop app on a test computer, with the tablet and phone screens opened in a browser at tablet and phone sizes). The numbered yellow circles were added afterwards to point things out. Nothing is a mock-up. The test computer's network address (`192.0.2.2`) and the quiz content are examples — yours will differ.

About the money sign. Mind It! shows every score and value with the **UAE Dirham sign** (it looks like a "D" with two lines through it). In this guide we simply write numbers: "+200" means "200 points".

PART ONE — UNDERSTANDING MIND IT!

1. Welcome to Mind It!

What is Mind It?

Mind It! is a **TV game-show quiz for a room full of people**. Think of a big board of questions on the TV, teams taking turns to pick them, points flying up and down, secret bets, a few naughty special powers, and a dramatic Mastermind It! — all run by one person, the **Quizmaster**, from a laptop (and, if you like, a tablet in your hand).

Nobody needs to install anything on their phone. Nobody needs the internet. Everything runs over your own Wi-Fi from the laptop.

The cast

Who / what	What it does
The Quizmaster (you)	Runs the show from the laptop's **host panel** — and/or from the **Android tablet** as a remote. Sees the answers. Decides if answers are right.
The laptop (`Mind It!.exe` on Windows, or `Mind It!.app` on a Mac)	The brain. It keeps the scores, saves everything, runs the timer and serves the phones and tablet over Wi-Fi.
The Audience View (the TV or projector)	What the room sees: the board, the question, the scores, the drama. It **never** shows answers before you reveal them, never shows secret wagers, never shows team codes.
The tablet (optional, Android)	A remote control for the Quizmaster: Correct / Wrong / Pass / timer / wagers / End Game, with the answer shown only on the tablet. It can also run a whole game on its own.
Team phones (optional but fun)	Each team's private keypad: secret wagers, special chips, the buzzer (in Buzzer Mode) and typed Mastermind It! answers. **Normal answers are said out loud.**

How a game works — in plain English

1. **Teams.** 2 to 8 teams play. Each team has at least one player.
2. **The board.** Each round has a board of **6 categories × 5 questions**. Questions lower down are harder and worth more (for example 200, 400, 600, 800, 1,000).
3. **Taking turns.** The team whose turn it is picks a category and value ("Pub Grub for 200, please!"). The Quizmaster opens it. The question appears on the TV and the clock starts (45 seconds).
4. **Answering.** The team **says** its answer out loud. - **Right:** they win the question's points (plus maybe a bonus). - **Wrong:** they **lose** the question's points, and the same question goes to the next team with a fresh clock. - **Pass:** they lose nothing, and the question goes to the next team.
5. **Next turn.** The next question always belongs to the team **after** the one that picked the last question — even if someone else answered it.
6. **Surprises.** Hidden **Blind It! questions** let a team bet. Special **chips** (Triple Gamble, Phoenix, Bottoms Up) change the stakes.
7. **Rounds.** Up to 4 board rounds. Each new round is worth more.

8. **Mastermind It!** One last question. Every team that isn't below zero secretly bets any amount from 0 up to its score, then types its answer on its phone. Right = win the bet. Wrong = lose the bet.
9. **The winner** is the team with the most points after Mastermind It! Then come the awards, the stats and the bragging rights.

How do teams win?

Most points at the end. Scores can go **below zero** (wrong answers cost points), so being clever about when to pass matters. If two teams finish level on points, the team that **answered the most questions correctly** wins — on the TV and in the records. Only if that is level too do they share the win (see Chapter 18).

What makes Mind It! different from a normal pub quiz?

- **It's a show, not a worksheet.** The TV does the drama: animations, a heartbeat in the last 10 seconds, "WRONG ANSWER → NEXT TEAM'S TURN" banners, a podium at the end.
- **Wrong answers cost points.** That makes passing a real decision.
- **Secret bets.** Blind It! questions and Mastermind It! are wagered privately on phones. The TV only says "Locked in".
- **Special chips.** Once-per-game powers that can swing a game.
- **Fair turns.** The app keeps the team order, so nobody argues about whose turn it is.
- **It remembers.** Player profiles, history, achievements and leaderboards build up quiz night after quiz night.

A typical game, start to finish (the 60-second version)

> Four teams arrive: **Crime Master Gogo, Tequila Mockingbird, Hungover Achiever and The Groovefather**. The Quizmaster opens Mind It! on the laptop, plugs in the TV, types the quiz name **THE BIG FAT QUIZ**, picks 2 rounds plus Mastermind It!, and adds the players to teams. Teams scan the QR code on the TV with their phones and type their 4-letter team codes.
>
> The Quizmaster presses **Begin Game**. The TV shows *Tonight's Teams*, then the Round 1 board. Crime Master Gogo picks *Pub Grub for 200*, answers quickly and correctly: **+200, plus a speed bonus of +100**. Tequila Mockingbird gets a 400 wrong (**–400**) and Hungover Achiever steals it (**+400**). Someone finds a Blind It! question, someone plays a Triple Gamble, someone's designated player has to finish their drink...
>
> After Round 2 comes **Mastermind It!**: category *SPACE*. Teams bet secretly on their phones, the question appears, teams type their answers, and the Quizmaster reveals them one by one, lowest score first. **Hungover Achiever** — who was in last place, deep below zero, after Round 1 — wins with 3,400. The TV crowns the winner, shows the awards, and the Quizmaster taps **END GAME**. Everything is saved.

That exact game is played out step by step, with every score, in **Chapter 17**.

---

2. Why Play Mind It!? — All Its Perks

Everything in this chapter exists in Mind It! 1.69 today. (Ideas that do *not* exist are listed in Appendix A, so you won't be disappointed.)

Perk	What it does	Why it makes the night better
📺 **Game-show presentation** ✅	A full-screen Audience View with a gold-and-navy board, animated board fill, "Now Playing" banner, score cards, a ring timer, banners for every result, and a podium at the end.	It feels like a TV show, not a quiz sheet. People lean in.
✍️ **Your own questions** ✅	Type questions in, import an Excel/CSV template, or pick from your **Question Database**. Pictures, answer pictures and media links can go with a question.	Your quiz, your jokes, your local trivia.
🗂️ **Categories & multiple rounds** ✅	1–4 board rounds of 6 categories × 5 questions, plus an optional Mastermind It! Values rise every round automatically.	Easy start, big finish.
♟️ **Strategy** ✅	Wrong answers cost points, passing is free, bonuses reward bravery and speed.	Every team has decisions to make, not just facts to remember.
💰 **Blind It! questions** ✅	Hidden on the board (1, 2, 2, 3 per round by default). The finder bets secretly.	Instant tension, and comebacks.
🎲 **Special chips** ✅	**Triple Gamble** (3× points, 6× on a Blind It! question), **Phoenix** (a catch-up power for the team far behind) and **Bottoms Up** (finish your drink and lose nothing).	Big moments everyone remembers.
🤫 **Secret wagers on phones** ✅	Teams bet on their own phones. The TV only says "Locked in".	Real poker-face drama.
📱 **Phones as private keypads** ✅	No app to install: phones open a web page served by your laptop.	Players join in seconds.
🔔 **Phone Buzzer Mode** ✅	An optional fastest-finger mode: phones become buzzers; the first valid buzz (as received by the laptop) wins.	A totally different, frantic game.
📊 **Live scoreboard** ✅	Scores, places and "who's next" are always on the TV. Phones show your score and place too.	No arguing about the score.
🎨 **12 themes** ✅	Default Mind It!, Christmas, Halloween, Ramadan / Eid, Diwali, Summer, Bollywood, Sports, Comic Book, Wizard / Magical School, Gaming, Movies — with optional theme sounds.	Dress the quiz for the occasion.
🧑‍🤝‍🧑 **Player profiles** ✅	Each person has a profile with a picture, nickname and statistics that follow them from game to game.	Rivalries!
🏅 **Achievements & Fun Stats** ✅	59 per-game achievements, 11 career badges, 6 milestones, 10 host achievements, and a "Fun Stats" slideshow after every game.	Even the losers win something.
📚 **Historic Games & leaderboard** ✅	Every finished game is saved as a frozen snapshot. A leaderboard ranks players (All Time / This Season / This Month).	Seasons, champions, legends.
👑 **Returning Champion** ✅	Last game's winning team walks on wearing the crown — if the whole team is back together.	Bragging rights carry over.

Perk	What it does	Why it makes the night better
🛠️ **Quiz customisation** ✅	Presets (Classic, Full Show, Online Mode) or switch each rule on/off. Timers, bonuses, number of Blind It! questions, turn order, wager display.	Make it gentle for family, savage for the regulars.
📴 **Works offline** ✅	No internet needed. Phones and the tablet connect to the laptop over your own Wi-Fi (or the laptop's hotspot).	Works in a basement, a hall, a garden.
💾 **Game recovery** ✅	Autosave after every change, "Resume saved game" after a crash, backup files, hand-over to another device.	A crash is a hiccup, not a disaster.
📶 **Connection Health** ✅	One screen shows whether the laptop, tablet, TV window and every team phone are talking, with a **Test All Connections** button.	Check before the guests arrive.
🎭 **Rehearsal mode** ✅	Play a test game where nothing counts — no history, no stats.	Practise without spoiling the records.
📲 **Tablet remote** ✅ / 🟡	Run the game from an Android tablet anywhere in the room. (Built and tested in the browser; not re-checked on a real Galaxy Tab for this guide.)	Walk among the teams like a real host.

3. Equipment and Setup

What you need

Item	Needed?	Notes
Windows laptop (Windows 10 or 11) **or an Apple Silicon Mac** (M1–M4, macOS 11 or newer, since build 123)	**Yes** (unless you run the whole game on the tablet)	Runs `Mind It!.exe` (no installation; a "portable" program) or `Mind It!.app` on a Mac (4.1b).
TV, projector or second screen	Strongly recommended	Connected by HDMI cable, or wireless display / casting — or, since build 130, **any TV with a web browser** on the same Wi-Fi, no cable (Setup C2). Shows the Audience View.
Wi-Fi network (no internet needed)	Needed for phones and the tablet	All devices must be on the **same** network. Or use the laptop's **mobile hotspot**.
Android tablet	Optional	Install the Mind It! APK. Used as the Quizmaster remote, or to run a game on its own — since build 128 it is then the **server**: team phones and a phone remote join the tablet (Setup B3).
One phone per team	Optional (but you lose secret wagers, chips, buzzers and typed Mastermind It! answers without them)	Any modern phone browser (Chrome, Safari). Nothing to install.
Speakers	Recommended	Sound effects, the "Mind It!" sting, thinking music, the heartbeat.

Setup A — Laptop only

The simplest setup. Good for a first game.

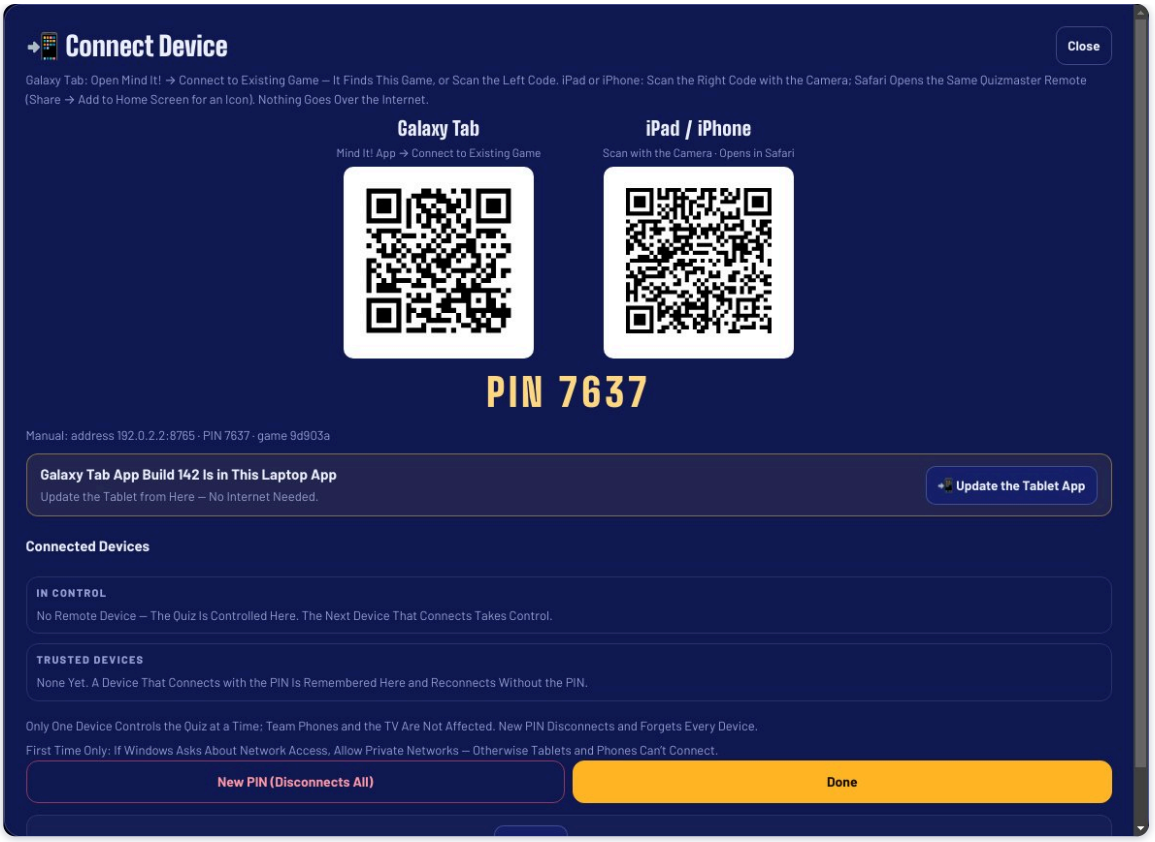
1. Open `Mind It!.exe` on the laptop.
2. Connect the TV (HDMI) and open the **Audience View** (Chapter 16). Drag that window to the TV and make it full screen.
3. Keep the **host panel** (the main window) on the laptop screen. Only you can see it — it shows the answers.
4. Run the game with the mouse or the keyboard shortcuts (C = Correct, W = Wrong, S = Pass… see Appendix C).

Without phones, the Quizmaster types the Blind It! question and Mastermind It! wagers into the host panel (teams can whisper or write them down). Chips are designed for team phones, but the Quizmaster can still switch a chip on for the picking team from the 🎟 **Team Chips** card (Chapter 12).

Setup B — Laptop + Tablet

The laptop stays the brain and drives the TV. The tablet is your remote control.

1. Laptop: **Connect ▾ → Connect Device** (or Setup → 6 · Advanced → Connect Device). Two QR codes and a 4-digit **PIN** appear: **Galaxy Tab** on the left, **iPad / iPhone** on the right (since build 127, Setup B2).
2. Tablet: open Mind It! → **Connect To Laptop**. It finds the laptop game automatically ("LAPTOP GAME FOUND") — tap **Connect** — or scan the code / type the PIN. The PIN is only needed the first time: a tablet the laptop already knows goes straight in (since build 142, also after the laptop app restarted).
3. From now on you can press Correct / Wrong / Pass on the tablet. The answer shows **only** on the tablet when you tap "Tap To Show Answer".



📸 Real screenshot (build 142) — Connect Device on the laptop: the Galaxy Tab code, the iPad / iPhone code, the PIN, and the line to update the tablet app from the laptop.

> **Who is in charge?** The **laptop** is the boss while the tablet is connected. The tablet sends button presses to the laptop, and the laptop confirms them. Only one device controls the game at a time.

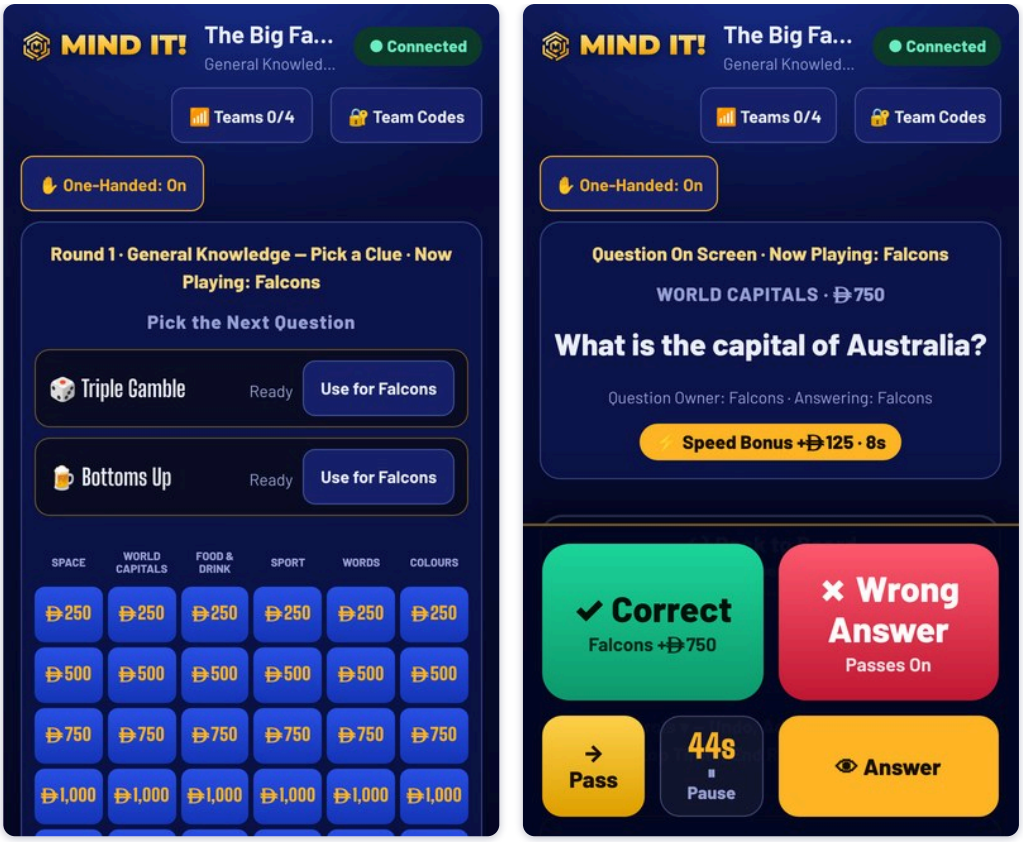
Setup B2 — An iPad or iPhone as the remote (no app needed) 🟡 — since build 127

Any iPad or iPhone can be the **same full Quizmaster remote** as the Galaxy Tab — board, Correct / Wrong / Pass, chips, More Controls, Team Codes — in Safari.

1. Laptop: **Connect ▾ → Connect Device**.
2. iPad or iPhone (on the same Wi-Fi): open the **Camera**, point it at the right-hand code (**iPad / iPhone**) and tap the yellow link. Safari opens the remote and shows **Connected**.
3. Optional: **Share → Add to Home Screen** gives it a **Mind It!** icon that opens full-screen. The icon keeps working after the laptop app is restarted, as long as the laptop is on the same Wi-Fi with the same address and you haven't pressed **New PIN**.

Good to know:

- **Only one device is in charge at a time**, exactly as with the Galaxy Tab. Since build 128 a second remote waits until you allow it on the laptop (Setup B4).
- **On an iPhone** the board's six columns now share the width of the screen (values are smaller, but nothing is cut off). An iPad shows the normal tablet layout.
- **New PIN (Disconnects All)** disconnects iPads and iPhones too; scan the code again afterwards (and add a new home-screen icon).
- The 📱 **Phone Remote** (Connect ▾ → Phone Remote) still exists: a simpler remote with just the big buttons.



📸 Real screenshots (build 127, iPhone-sized browser) — the full remote on an iPhone: the board (left) and a question (right).

🟡 Checked on the build machine with browsers pretending to be an iPhone and an iPad (Chromium), not real Safari. Try it once at home before a quiz night.

Setup B3 — The Galaxy Tab as the server (no laptop) 🟡 — since build 128

When the Galaxy Tab runs a quiz on its own, it does everything the laptop does for the room:

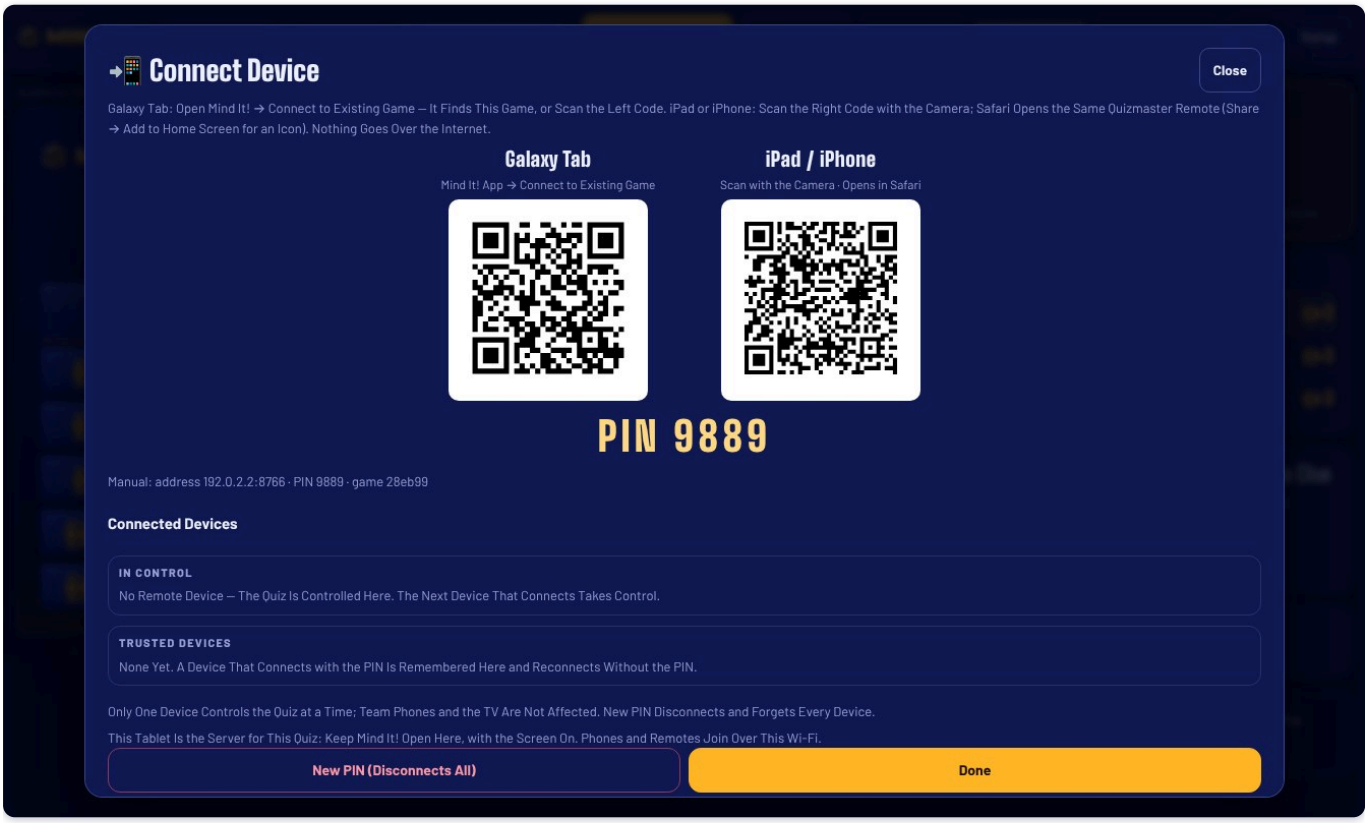
- **Team phones join the tablet** — scan the join code, type the team code; secret wagers, chips, buzzers and typed Mastermind It! answers all work, exactly as with the laptop (Chapter 8).
- **A phone (or iPad / iPhone, or another Android tablet) can be the Quizmaster remote** for the tablet's quiz — 📲 **Connect ▾ → Connect Device** on the tablet shows the codes and the PIN.
- **Phone Remote, Check Connections and the TV join code** work too.

How to start: open Mind It! on the tablet, start or resume a quiz **on the tablet** (not "Connect To Laptop"). The tablet starts its server by itself; nothing goes over the internet. Everyone must be on the same Wi-Fi as the tablet (or the tablet's own hotspot).

Good to know:

- **The tablet keeps hosting in the background (since build 129).** While the tablet hosts, a notification says **Mind It! is hosting a quiz**, and the tablet keeps the Wi-Fi and its server running if the screen goes off or you open another app. Tap the notification to go back to the quiz. The first time, Android 13 or newer asks whether Mind It! may **send notifications** — tap **Allow** (if you don't, hosting still works; you just don't see the notice).
- **Still keep Mind It! on screen while you run the quiz** — that's where you score and move on. The background hosting is the safety net for a dimmed screen or a quick look at another app.
- **In portrait (since build 152)** the tablet's TV preview folds away behind 📺 **Show TV preview** (the tablet remembers your choice), so the **Pick a clue** board and the teams come first. Turn the tablet sideways and the preview is back. The TV itself never changes.
- **To stop hosting**, close Mind It! (swipe it away in Recent apps), or use the tablet as a remote for a laptop instead. The notification goes away.

- 🧪 **Test Hosting** (since build 130): 📲 Connect ▾ → Connect Device → **Run Test** checks, the way phones, remotes and TVs will, that the tablet answers on the Wi-Fi — and that background hosting is on. Run it at the venue before the guests arrive.
- **Remotes that are switched off (fixed in build 132).** In builds 130–131, while the tablet hosted, a trusted remote that wasn't connected (an iPad put away, say) made the tablet cut off the next remote that connected and its own remote link, again and again. Fixed; the laptop was never affected.
- 🔋 **Battery** (since build 130): while the tablet hosts, a battery chip appears at the top of the Quizmaster screen below 20% (red below 10%) when it isn't charging. Never on the TV. Plug the tablet in for a long quiz.
- **Other tablets find the game.** On another Galaxy Tab on the same Wi-Fi, Mind It!'s start screen shows **Tablet Game Found** with a **Connect** button — tap it to use that tablet as the remote (the hosting tablet approves it, Setup B4). A laptop's game still shows as **Laptop Game Found**.
- **The tablet is the boss of its own quiz**: it approves remotes, exactly as the laptop does (Setup B4).
- **A laptop appearing doesn't take over by itself.** A quiz running on the tablet stays on the tablet until you move it with 💻 **Take Over Tablet Quiz** on the laptop (Setup B5) — or with a backup file (Chapter 22). The other way round: 📲 **Hand Quiz to the Galaxy Tab** (Setup B6).
- **A tablet whose quiz moved to the laptop hosts again (fixed in build 132).** In builds 130–131 such a tablet kept sending every phone to the laptop and turned any later quiz page into the laptop's remote. Now it hosts again as soon as you start a quiz on it, or when a set-up quiz is open on it more than 6 hours after the move (the next quiz night). Until then, late phones from the quiz that moved are still sent to the laptop.
- When the tablet is used as a **remote for a laptop**, it doesn't run a server of its own — the laptop's quiz is the only one.



📸 *Real screenshot (build 128) — Connect Device on a tablet hosting its own quiz.*

🟡 The tablet's server was tested on the build machine (the same Java code, with the quiz page as the tablet app opens it, and phone-sized browsers joining over the network) — **not on a real Galaxy Tab**. The background hosting (the notification) and *Tablet Game Found* need a real tablet and were **not tested at all**; the app was checked to be built correctly for Android 14 and 15. Do a full rehearsal at home first: start a quiz on the tablet, join with a phone, turn the tablet's screen off for a minute, and check the phone still works.

Setup B4 — Remotes: trusted devices, one controller, your approval ✅ — since build 128

Who's in charge — Laptop > Tablet > Phone. The device hosting the quiz holds it: the **laptop**, or the **Galaxy Tab** when there's no laptop. Everything else is a remote for that quiz, and **only one remote controls it at a time** — the Galaxy Tab, an iPad or iPhone, or the 📱 Phone Remote. There is only ever one quiz: a tablet connected to a laptop never starts its own.

Devices	Who hosts	Remote
Laptop + tablet + phone	Laptop	The tablet **or** a phone — one at a time. In the remote in control, 📱 **Add Phone Remote** shows a code that sends the phone **straight to the laptop** (the laptop approves it). Since build 129 the button is always there, also after the remote reconnected without the PIN.
Laptop + phone	Laptop	The phone (as before)
Tablet + phone	Tablet	The phone (Setup B3)
Tablet only	Tablet	—

First time: the PIN. After that: no PIN. A remote that connects with the PIN is remembered as a **trusted device** and gets its own private key. Next time — after a Wi-Fi drop, a phone restart or a laptop restart — it reconnects by itself, without the PIN. **Since build 142** that includes the tablet's **Connect To Laptop** button: before, the tablet's Main Menu asked for the PIN again whenever Mind It! had restarted on the laptop.

A second device never just takes over. If one remote is in control and another connects, the second one shows **Waiting For the Quizmaster** and the laptop shows a small card at the top of the right-hand panel:

📸 Real screenshot (build 128) — a request on the laptop.

- **Allow & Switch** — the new device takes control; the old one shows *Control Moved*. The quiz carries on exactly where it was (question, scores, wagers, timer, chips).
- **Reject** — the new device is told *Not Allowed*; nothing changes for the device in control.

- **Ignore** — the card goes away; the request waits **2 minutes** and then expires (*No Answer Yet*). The waiting device can tap **Ask For Control** again.

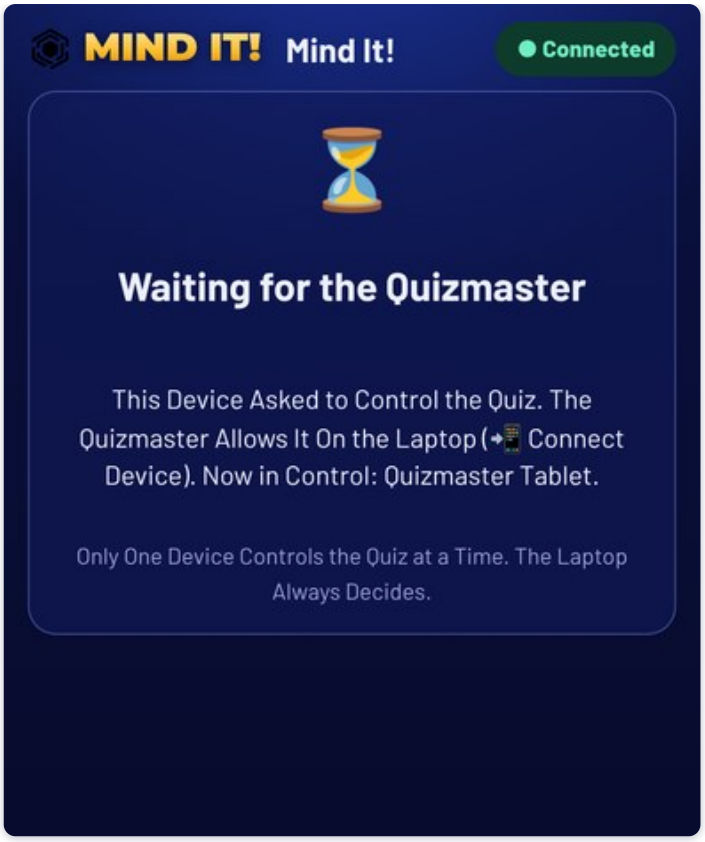
The card is only on the host's screen — never on the TV, and not while **Present On This Screen** is on (it appears when you leave Present mode).

Connected Devices (📲 Connect ▾ → Connect Device): who is **in control**, who is **waiting for you**, and your **trusted devices** with when each last connected. **Since build 134** a yellow **⚠ Different Builds** note appears at the top when a connected remote runs another build (for example the Galaxy Tab still on 133 while the laptop is on 134). Update that device from the download page so both behave the same. ★ About & Credits on each device shows its build. **Since build 135** the remote shows the same warning on its own screen ("This device runs build 135 — the laptop runs build 134").

📸 *Real screenshot (build 129) — Connected Devices, after renaming the iPad "Quiz Desk" and the iPhone "Backstage phone".*

- **Rename** (since build 129) — give a device a name you'll recognise, such as *Quiz Desk* or *Backstage phone*. Type it and tap **Save** (or press Enter); **Cancel** keeps the old name; save an empty name to go back to the device's own name. The name is used everywhere — the request card, *Currently in control*, the waiting remote's screen — and is kept after reconnects and restarts. It stays on the host (laptop or tablet), not on the device.
- **Signal** (since build 130) — each connected device shows ▂▄▆ **Good**, ▂▄ **Slow** or ▂ **Poor / Dropping**, with its round-trip time. A remote that keeps showing Poor needs to be nearer the Wi-Fi router.
- **Give Control** — switch to another connected trusted device.
- **Disconnect** — the device in control is disconnected and doesn't come back by itself; if it reconnects it asks first. The quiz is then controlled on the laptop.
- **Forget** — the device must use the PIN again.
- **New PIN (Disconnects All)** — disconnects and forgets **every** device.

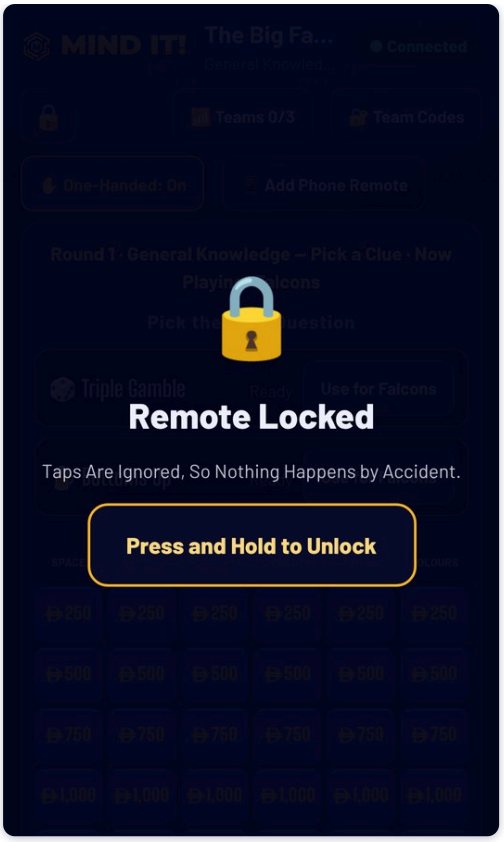
If the device in control drops (Wi-Fi, battery, the screen locked), it reconnects by itself and takes control back — unless you gave control to another device in the meantime; then it asks.



📸 *Real screenshot (build 128) — a second remote waiting for the Quizmaster.*

Not affected: team phones (wagers, chips, buzzers, Mastermind It! answers) and the Audience View — they never count as remotes.

🔒 **Lock the remote** (since build 130): on the remote in control (Galaxy Tab, iPad, iPhone or the 📱 Phone Remote), the small 🔒 button at the top makes it ignore taps — handy when you put it down or in a pocket. To unlock, **press and hold** the button on the screen for a second. (Since build 132 it's a small icon instead of a 🔒 **Lock** button, so the top bar takes less room — on an iPhone the quiz name no longer wraps onto extra lines.)

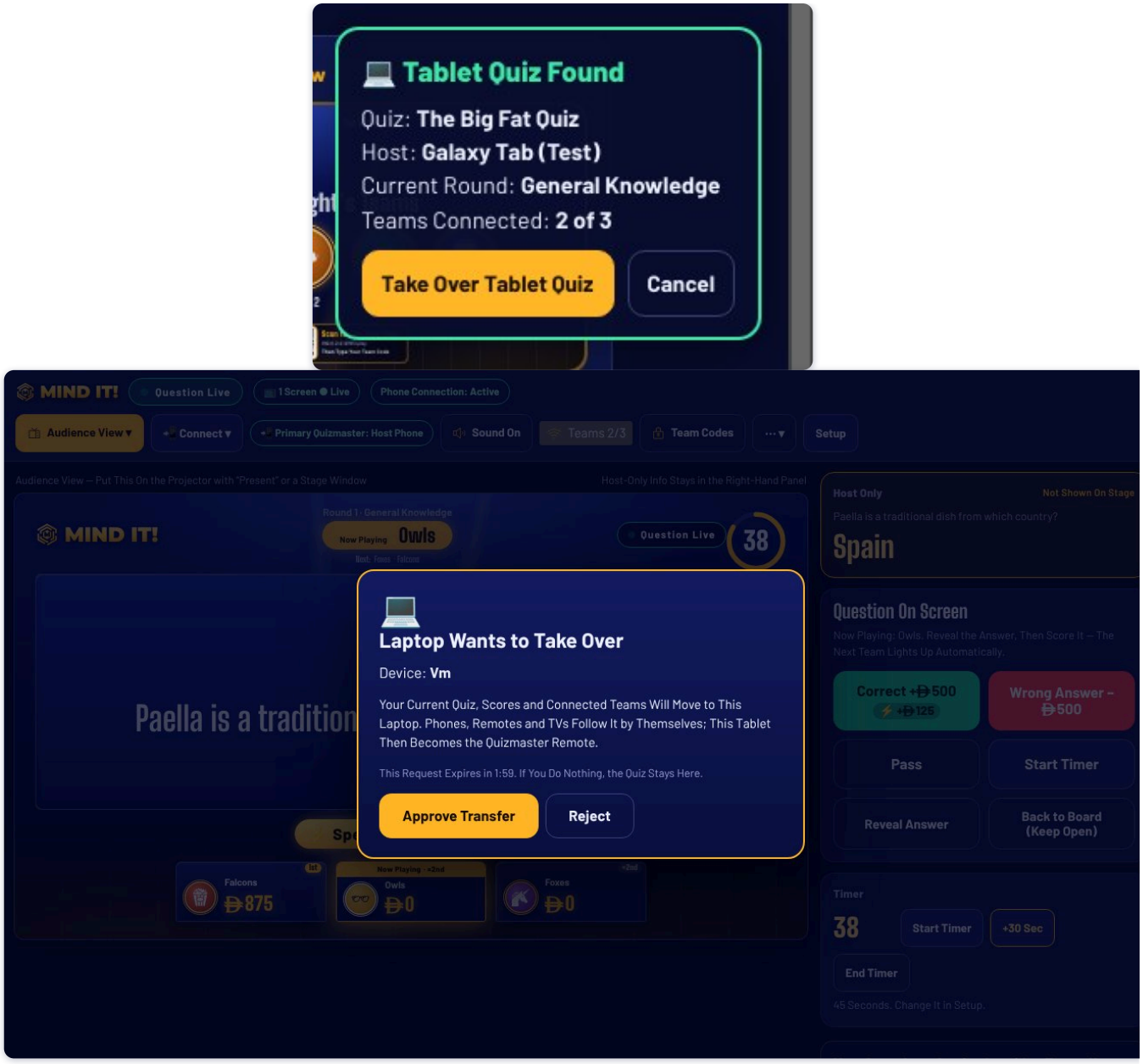


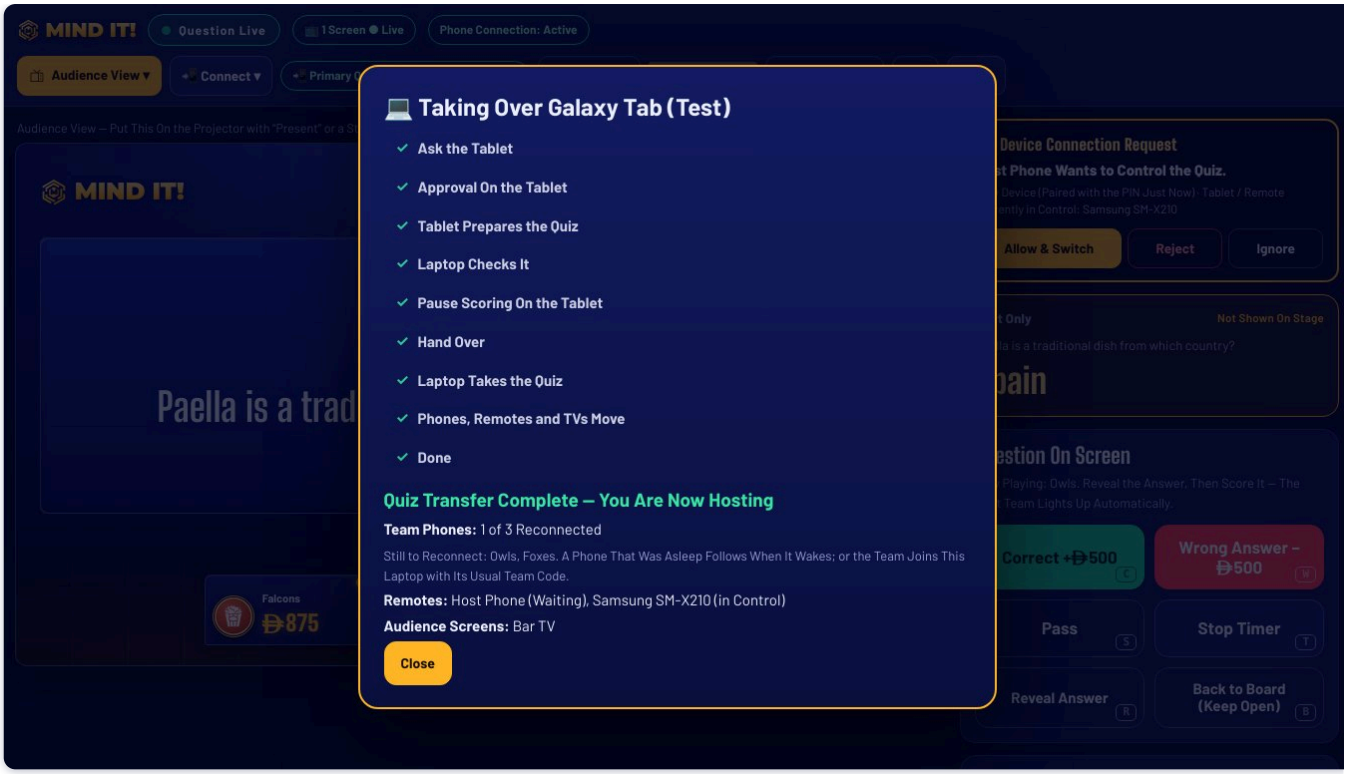
📸 Real screenshot (build 132) — a locked iPhone remote, with the small 🔒 icon at the top left of the buttons (phone-sized browser on the build machine).

Setup B5 — Moving a tablet quiz to the laptop (💻 Take Over Tablet Quiz) 🟡 — since build 130

Started the quiz on the Galaxy Tab and then the laptop arrives? The laptop can take the quiz over **while it is running** — scores, the question on screen, Blind It! questions and wagers, chips, the countdown, Mastermind It! with any wagers and answers already typed, and the connected phones, remotes and TVs. No backup file needed. It never happens by itself: the tablet's Quizmaster has to approve it.

1. Put the laptop on the **same Wi-Fi** as the tablet and open Mind It! on it.
2. Within a few seconds the laptop shows 💻 **Tablet Quiz Found** with the quiz, the tablet's name, the current round and how many teams are connected. Press **Take Over Tablet Quiz**. (Not listed? 📲 **Connect ▾ → Take Over Tablet Quiz** lets you type the tablet's address — it's shown on the tablet in 📲 Connect ▾ → Connect Device, e.g. `192.168.1.23:8765`.)
3. The tablet asks **Laptop Wants to Take Over** with the laptop's name. Tap **Approve Transfer** (or **Reject**). The request disappears after 2 minutes if nobody answers; until then the quiz carries on as normal.
4. For a few seconds the tablet shows ⏳ **Transferring host… scoring is paused** — its buttons wait and the countdown pauses. The laptop shows each step.
5. The laptop says **Quiz Transfer Complete — You Are Now Hosting** and lists the team phones, remotes and TVs that have followed. The countdown carries on with the time that was left.
6. Team phones move to the laptop **by themselves and keep their team** — nobody types a code again. Remotes and TVs follow too. The **tablet becomes the Quizmaster remote** (in control); another remote waits until you allow it (Setup B4).


Tablet Quiz Found
Quiz: The Big Fat Quiz
Host: Galaxy Tab (Test)
Current Round: General Knowledge
Teams Connected: 2 of 3
Take Over Tablet Quiz
Cancel
MIND IT!
Question Live
1 Screen Live
Phone Connection: Active
Audience View
Connect
Primary Quizmaster: Host Phone
Sound On
Teams 2/3
Team Codes
Setup
Audience View — Put This On the Projector with "Present" or a Stage Window
Host-Only Info Stays in the Right-Hand Panel
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Now Playing
Owls
38
Paella is a tradition
Laptop Wants to Take Over
Device: Vm
Your Current Quiz, Scores and Connected Teams Will Move to This Laptop. Phones, Remotes and TVs Follow It by Themselves; This Tablet Then Becomes the Quizmaster Remote.
This Request Expires in 1:59. If You Do Nothing, the Quiz Stays Here.
Approve Transfer
Reject
Falcons
875
Owls
0
Foxes
0
Host Only
Not Shown On Stage
Paella is a traditional dish from which country?
Spain
Question On Screen
Now Playing: Owls. Reveal the Answer, Then Score It — The Next Team Lights Up Automatically.
Correct +500
+125
Wrong Answer −500
Pass
Start Timer
Reveal Answer
Back to Board (Keep Open)
Timer
38
Start Timer
+30 Sec
End Timer
45 Seconds. Change It in Setup.



📸 *Real screenshots (build 130) — the laptop finds the tablet's quiz; the tablet asks; the laptop has taken over. The tablet was simulated on the build machine (its own server code with the quiz page), and the laptop's name there is "Vm".*

What keeps it safe

- **Only one host, ever.** The tablet pauses scoring, hands over a final copy, records that it has handed over, and only then does the laptop take the quiz. After that the tablet refuses scores, wagers and buzzes and sends late phones on to the laptop.
- **Nothing counts twice.** A wager, answer, chip or button press that reached the tablet comes along exactly once; anything sent while it was paused is refused and can simply be sent again on the laptop.
- **Your laptop's own players and history are kept.** If the laptop had a quiz open, it is saved as a **Safety Backup** first. Players from the tablet are added; players already on the laptop are never overwritten.
- **If something goes wrong before the hand-over** (Wi-Fi drops, the laptop or tablet app stops, nobody approves), the tablet simply keeps hosting — its pause lasts at most 30 seconds.
- **If something goes wrong after the hand-over**, the laptop finishes the move when it can (also after a restart). The tablet never takes the quiz back by itself. If the laptop can't tell whether the tablet handed over, it asks you to look at the tablet and choose **Host It Here** or **Discard**. If the laptop never finishes, the tablet offers **The laptop isn't taking over? → Take The Quiz Back** after a minute — only use it if the laptop is switched off.
- Both devices must run the **same Mind It! build**; otherwise the tablet politely refuses.

Good to know: a phone that was asleep during the move follows when it wakes (if the tablet is still on); otherwise the team joins the laptop with its usual team code. An iPhone **home-screen icon** saved for the tablet's address keeps pointing at the tablet — add the laptop's address afterwards. To move the quiz from the laptop to the tablet, see Setup B6.

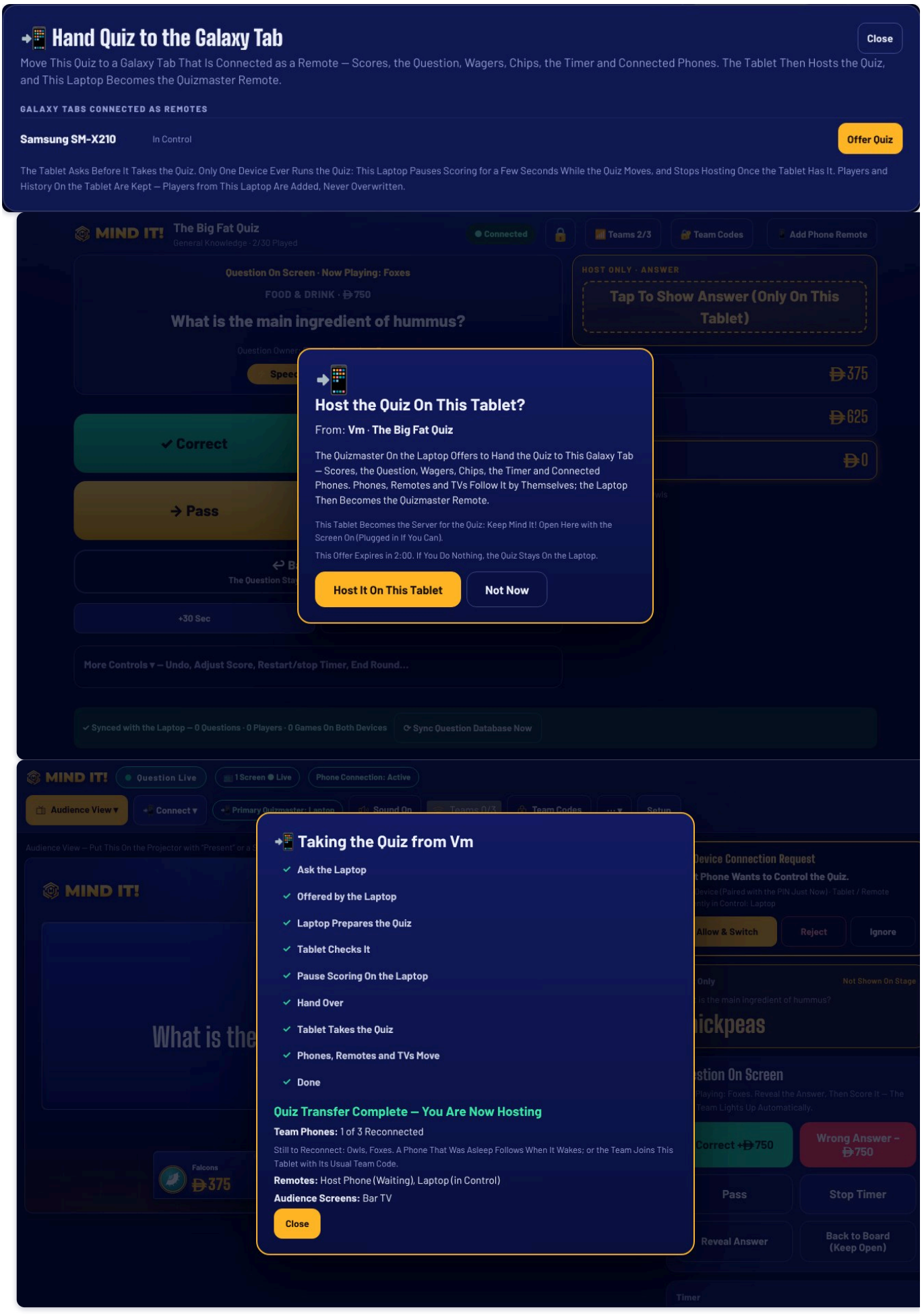
🟡 Tested on the build machine with the real laptop app and a simulated Galaxy Tab (its server code on the build machine, its page in a browser, phones and remotes as browsers), including Wi-Fi loss before and after the hand-over, each app stopping in the middle, and a request nobody answers. **Not yet tried with a real Galaxy Tab** — rehearse it once at home.

Setup B6 — Handing the quiz to the Galaxy Tab (📲 Hand Quiz to the Galaxy Tab) 🟡 — since build 132

The other way round from Setup B5: the quiz runs on the **laptop**, and the **Galaxy Tab** should host it — say the laptop has to leave early, or you started on the laptop and want to finish with just the tablet. The same things move: scores, the question

on screen, Blind It! questions and wagers, chips, the countdown, Mastermind It! with anything already typed, and the connected phones, remotes and TVs. It never happens by itself: you offer it on the laptop and accept it on the tablet.

1. The Galaxy Tab must be connected to the laptop **as a remote in the Mind It! app** (Connect To Laptop — Setup B2). A tablet's web browser can't host a quiz; it needs the app.
2. On the laptop: 📲 **Connect ▾ →** 📲 **Hand Quiz to the Galaxy Tab**. It lists the Galaxy Tabs connected as remotes. Press **Offer Quiz** next to the tablet. The laptop shows *Waiting for … to accept* with a 2-minute countdown and a **Cancel** button; the quiz carries on as normal meanwhile.
3. The tablet asks **Host the Quiz on This Tablet?** with the laptop's name and the quiz. Tap **Host It on This Tablet** — or **Not Now** (the laptop says so and keeps the quiz). If nobody answers, the offer runs out after 2 minutes.
4. The tablet opens its own quiz and shows 📲 **Taking the Quiz from …** with each step ticked off. The laptop doesn't ask again — your offer was the approval — and for a few seconds shows ⏳ **Transferring host… scoring is paused**.
5. The tablet says **Quiz Transfer Complete — You Are Now Hosting** and lists the team phones, remotes and TVs that have followed. The countdown carries on with the time that was left.
6. Team phones move to the tablet **by themselves and keep their team**; remotes and TVs follow; TV names come along. The **laptop becomes the Quizmaster remote** (in control, listed as *Laptop*); another remote waits until you allow it (Setup B4).


Hand Quiz to the Galaxy Tab
Close
Move This Quiz to a Galaxy Tab That Is Connected as a Remote — Scores, the Question, Wagers, Chips, the Timer and Connected Phones. The Tablet Then Hosts the Quiz, and This Laptop Becomes the Quizmaster Remote.
GALAXY TABS CONNECTED AS REMOTES
Samsung SM-X210
In Control
Offer Quiz
The Tablet Asks Before It Takes the Quiz. Only One Device Ever Runs the Quiz: This Laptop Pauses Scoring for a Few Seconds While the Quiz Moves, and Stops Hosting Once the Tablet Has It. Players and History On the Tablet Are Kept — Players from This Laptop Are Added, Never Overwritten.
MIND IT!
The Big Fat Quiz
General Knowledge · 2/30 Played
Connected
Teams 2/3
Team Codes
Add Phone Remote
Question On Screen · Now Playing: Foxes
FOOD & DRINK · ฿750
What is the main ingredient of hummus?
HOST ONLY · ANSWER
Tap To Show Answer (Only On This Tablet)
Host the Quiz On This Tablet?
From: Vm · The Big Fat Quiz
The Quizmaster On the Laptop Offers to Hand the Quiz to This Galaxy Tab — Scores, the Question, Wagers, Chips, the Timer and Connected Phones. Phones, Remotes and TVs Follow It by Themselves; the Laptop Then Becomes the Quizmaster Remote.
This Tablet Becomes the Server for the Quiz: Keep Mind It! Open Here with the Screen On (Plugged in If You Can).
This Offer Expires in 2:00. If You Do Nothing, the Quiz Stays On the Laptop.
Host It On This Tablet
Not Now
✔ Correct
→ Pass
+30 Sec
More Controls ▾ — Undo, Adjust Score, Restart/stop Timer, End Round…
✓ Synced with the Laptop — 0 Questions · 0 Players · 0 Games On Both Devices
⟳ Sync Question Database Now
MIND IT!
Question Live
1 Screen Live
Phone Connection: Active
Audience View ▾
Connect ▾
Taking the Quiz from Vm
Ask the Laptop
Offered by the Laptop
Laptop Prepares the Quiz
Tablet Checks It
Pause Scoring On the Laptop
Hand Over
Tablet Takes the Quiz
Phones, Remotes and TVs Move
Done
Quiz Transfer Complete — You Are Now Hosting
Team Phones: 1 of 3 Reconnected
Still to Reconnect: Owls, Foxes. A Phone That Was Asleep Follows When It Wakes; or the Team Joins This Tablet with Its Usual Team Code.
Remotes: Host Phone (Waiting), Laptop (in Control)
Audience Screens: Bar TV
Close
Allow & Switch
Reject
Ignore
Pass
Stop Timer
Reveal Answer
Back to Board (Keep Open)

📸 *Real screenshots (build 132) — the laptop offering the quiz; the tablet asking; the tablet hosting. The tablet was simulated on the build machine (its own server code with the quiz page), and the laptop's name there is "Vm".*

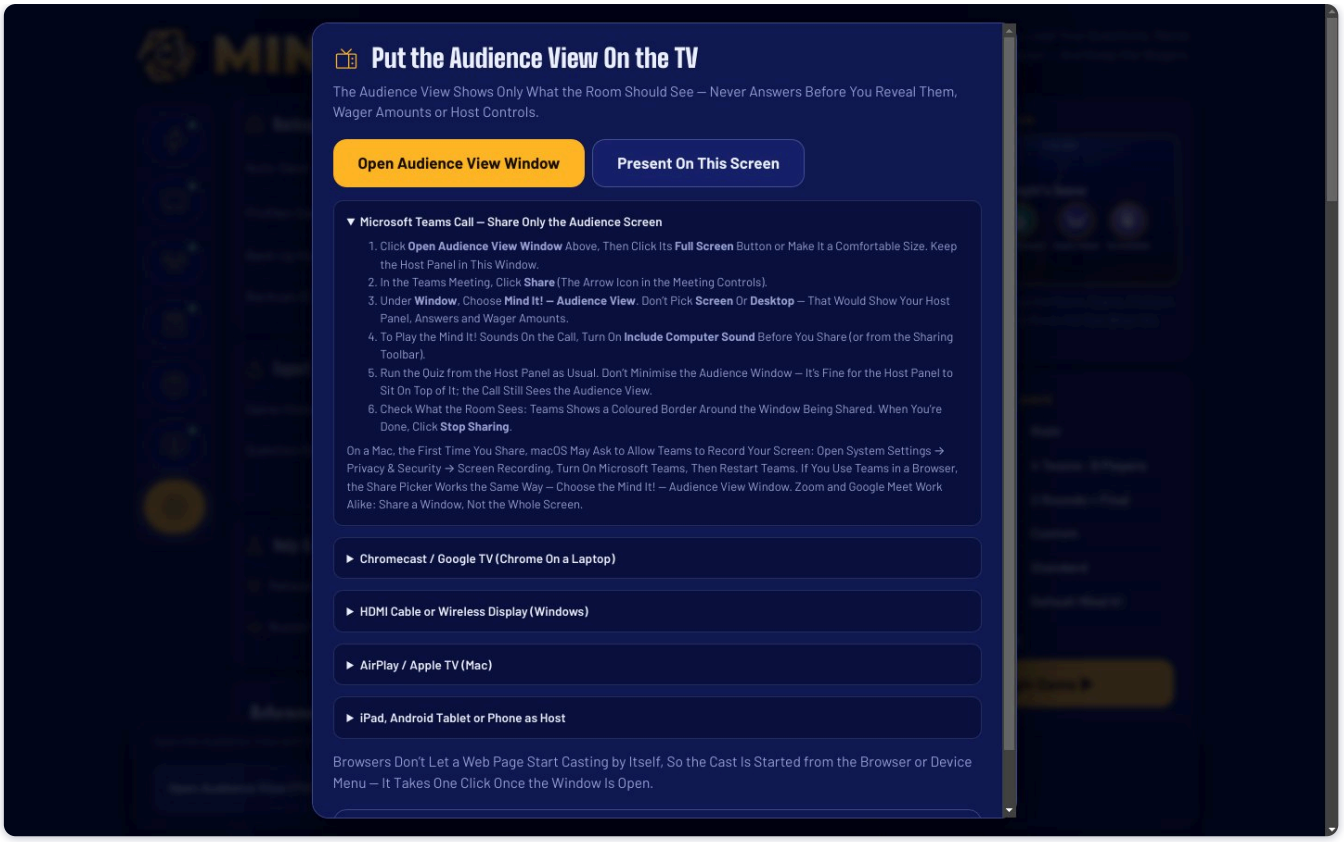
What keeps it safe — the same rules as Setup B5, the other way round:

- **Only one host, ever.** The laptop pauses scoring, hands over a final copy, records that it has handed over, and only then does the tablet take the quiz. After that the laptop refuses scores, wagers and buzzes and sends late phones on to the tablet.
- **Nothing counts twice**, and the tablet's own players and history are kept (players from the laptop are added, never overwritten). An unfinished quiz that was saved on the tablet is put in **Safety Backups** first.
- **If something goes wrong before the hand-over** (the quiz can't be opened on the tablet, the Wi-Fi drops, nobody accepts), the laptop simply keeps hosting, and the tablet offers **Back to the Laptop's Remote** — one tap and it's the laptop's remote again.
- **If something goes wrong after the hand-over** — say the tablet app stops — the tablet finishes the move when it starts again. If it can't tell whether the laptop handed over, it asks you to look at the laptop and choose **Host It Here** or **Discard**.
- **Afterwards the laptop's start screen** says where its last quiz went, with **Connect to the tablet**. Start a new quiz on the laptop and it hosts again as normal.

🟡 Tested on the build machine with the real laptop app and a simulated Galaxy Tab (its server code on the build machine, its page in a browser, phones, an iPhone remote and a TV as browsers): the full move there and back, *Not Now*, the laptop cancelling its offer, a quiz the tablet can't open, and the tablet app stopping just after the hand-over. **Not yet tried with a real Galaxy Tab** — rehearse it once at home.

Setup C — The Audience Display (TV / projector)

- **HDMI cable** (easiest): plug the laptop into the TV, set Windows to *Extend* the display (Windows key + P → Extend), open the Audience View window and move it to the TV, then press its **Full Screen** button.
- **Wireless display / Chromecast / AirPlay / a Microsoft Teams call**: the app has a built-in guide: Setup → 5 · Audio & Presentation → 📺 **TV Display Guide**. It explains each method step by step. (**Audience View ▾ → TV Display Settings** is where you adjust screen size and safe margins and check the TV.) 🟡 Casting was not tested with real TVs for this guide.
- 📡 **Over the Wi-Fi, no cable (since build 130):** any TV with a web browser can show the Audience View — see Setup C2.
- **One screen only?** Use **Present On This Screen** (full-screen Audience View on the laptop itself; Esc to exit). In Present Mode a tap or mouse move shows the controls.



📸 *Real screenshot — the built-in TV Display Guide.*

Setup C2 — Audience Screens over the Wi-Fi (no cable) ✅ laptop · 🟡 tablet — since build 130

Any TV, projector or computer with a **web browser** on the same Wi-Fi can show the audience screen — a smart TV's own browser (Samsung Internet, LG Web Browser), a browser app on an Android TV, Google TV or Fire TV stick, or a second laptop. Nothing to install, no cable, no casting, free. It works from the laptop app and from the Galaxy Tab when it hosts.

1. 📺 **Audience View ▾ →** 📡 **Connect Audience Screen** (also on the setup screen, and in 📲 Connect ▾). The panel shows this device's address. **Since build 132 the laptop's address is short**, for example `192.168.1.20/tv` — no `http://` and no `:8765` to type. Underneath, the longer form (`192.168.1.20:8765/tv`) always works too: use it if a TV can't open the short one (another program on the laptop may already use the short form's door; then only the long form is shown). On the Galaxy Tab the address keeps its number, e.g. `192.168.1.23:8765/tv` — Android doesn't let apps use the short form.
2. On the TV: open its web browser and type the address exactly.
3. Press ⛶ **Full Screen** on the TV with its remote (OK / Enter). If there's no such button, use the browser's own full-screen option.
4. The TV appears in the **Screens** list within a few seconds. Press 🧪 **Test Audience Screen**: each TV shows a test card for a few seconds and the list says ✔ **Test passed (5/5 updates)**. The quiz isn't touched.

📸 Real screenshots — the 📡 Connect Audience Screen panel on the laptop (build 132, with the short address and 🔊 Sound On This TV), and a TV showing a question (build 130). TVs are simulated by browsers on the build machine, and 192.0.2.2 is the build machine's address — yours looks like 192.168.1.20.

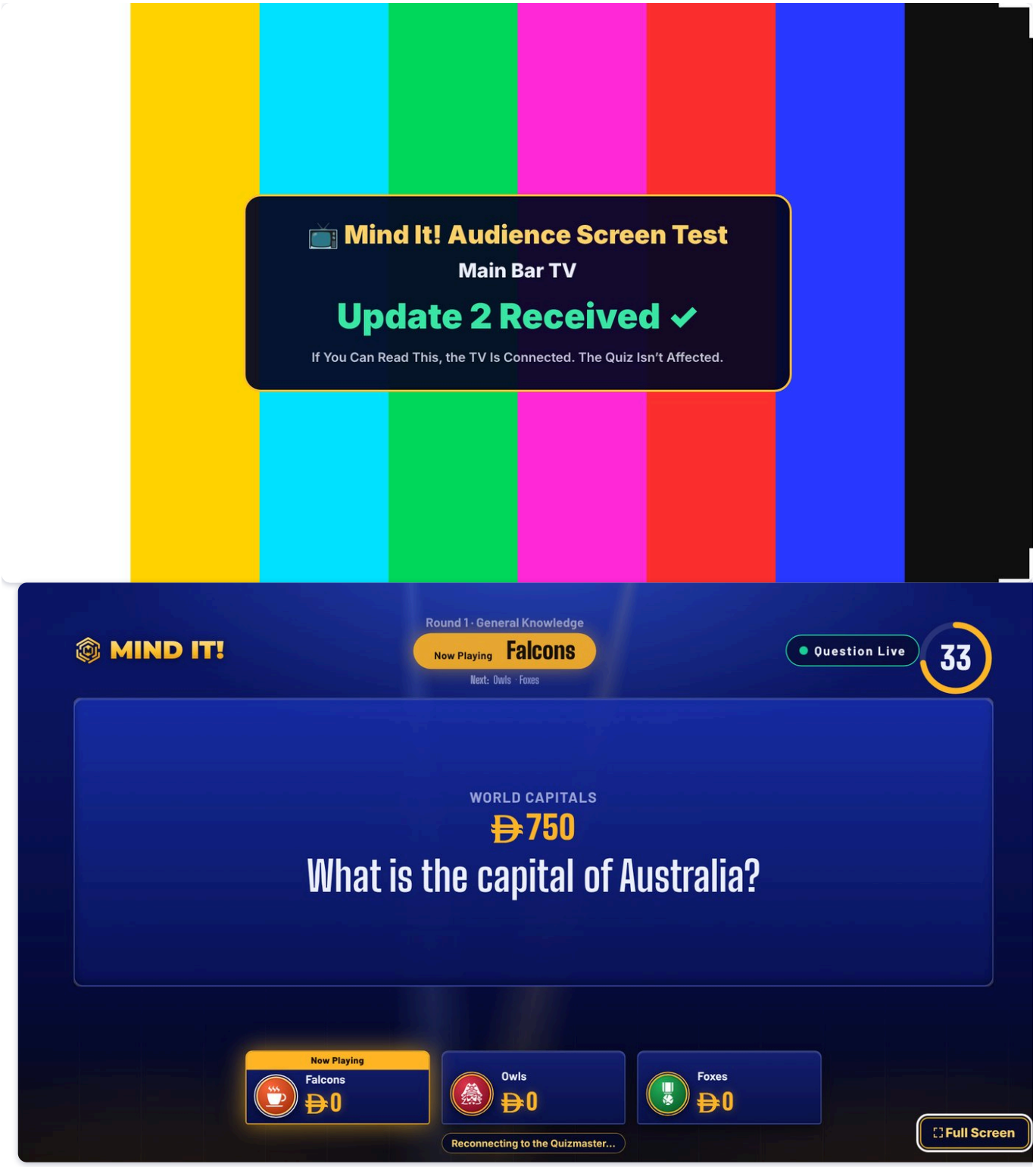
What the TV shows: exactly what the Audience View window shows — board, teams and scores, the question, timer, animations, Mastermind It! and the winner, in your theme. **Never** your controls, answers before they're revealed, sealed wagers, team codes, PINs, players or backups: only the finished audience picture leaves your device, and a TV can't send anything back to the quiz.

Managing screens (in the same panel), for each screen: its name and size, ● Connected / ○ Not connected, the connection (▂▄▆ Good, Slow or Poor with the round-trip time), and when it last updated.

- **Rename** (e.g. *Main TV*, *Bar TV*) — remembered on this device.
- **Margin** — None / Small / Large: shrinks the picture for TVs that cut off the edges (overscan).
- **Refresh** — reloads that TV's page (also ↻ **Refresh All Screens**).
- **Disconnect** — that TV stops showing the quiz and stays off, even if someone reopens the address, until you press **Reconnect**. **Forget** removes a screen that is switched off.

Several screens at once — main TV, a projector, a TV in the bar: open the address on each. They all show the same picture from the one quiz; screens never become remotes or hosts.

If the Wi-Fi drops, a small line at the bottom of the TV says *Reconnecting to the Quizmaster…* while the last picture stays up. It reconnects by itself and jumps to the current screen; the quiz is never restarted. 📶 **Check Connections** lists every audience screen too.



📸 *Real screenshots (build 130) — the test card, and the small reconnecting line.*

Good to know:

- 🔊 **Sound On This TV** (since build 132) — in the **Screens** list, press 🔊 **Sound On This TV** on one screen. The TV shows 🔊 *Press OK on the remote (or click) to turn on the sound*: press **OK** on the TV remote once (TV browsers only play sound after a button press), and the panel says *Sound plays on this TV*. From then on the TV plays all the quiz's sounds, the intro and any theme music through its own speakers, about a quarter of a second behind — in step with its picture, which also comes over the Wi-Fi — and the laptop or tablet goes quiet, so there's no echo. Videos in questions play with their sound on that TV. 🔊 **Sound Back Here** returns it. One screen at a time has the sound. If that TV drops off the Wi-Fi, the sound comes back to the laptop or tablet within about a second (a note says so); when the TV reconnects, press OK on it again.

- **Without it**, sound plays from the laptop or tablet (or a speaker plugged into it), and videos on the TVs are silent — as before.
- **Anyone on the same Wi-Fi** who opens the address sees the audience screen (the same picture as the TV). Disconnect any screen you don't want.
- **Venue / guest Wi-Fi** often stops devices seeing each other — then the TV can't open the address (nor can team phones). Use the laptop's or tablet's **hotspot** and put the TV on it.
- Some **old TV browsers** can't open local addresses or run Mind It!. Then use a streaming stick with a browser, a laptop, or HDMI.
- **Host Cam** doesn't appear on these screens (use HDMI for it).
- **Google Cast / Chromecast "casting" is not used:** a Mind It! cast screen would need a paid Google registration and an internet-hosted secure page, which doesn't fit a free, offline quiz. A Chromecast with Google TV, Android TV or Fire TV can install a free browser and use the address instead — or, on an Android TV box such as the **Mi Box**, use the **Mind It! TV** app (Setup C2b).
- **HDMI still works** and can run alongside: open the Audience View window, drag it to the TV — your controls stay on the laptop screen. The Wi-Fi screens then show that window's picture.

🟡 Tested on the build machine with TV-sized browsers (720p, 1080p, 4K, a slow one) — **not with real TV browsers**. The TV sound was measured there (the level reaching the TV page's speakers, the laptop going quiet, the sound coming back when the TV drops), **not listened to on a real TV** — some TV browsers may play it late, choppy or not at all. Open the address on your TV once at home before the quiz, press 🔊 **Sound On This TV** and listen.

Setup C2b — 📺 Mind It! TV on a Mi Box (Android TV) 🟡 — since build 152

Mind It! TV is a small app for the **Mi Box S** (or any Android TV box) that turns the TV into the audience screen — no browser, no typing an address. It's the same audience screen as Setup C2 (it appears in the **Screens** list, and Rename, Margin, 🔊 Sound On This TV and Disconnect all work). The TV only shows the quiz; you run the game from the laptop or the Galaxy Tab as always. The file is **Mind-It-Android-TV.apk** (about 0.2 MB) on the download page.

Install it once (the Mi Box doesn't get it from Google Play):

1. Copy `Mind-It-Android-TV.apk` onto a USB stick.
2. On the Mi Box, install a file manager from Google Play if it has none (for example **File Commander** or **X-plore**).
3. **Settings → Device Preferences → Security & restrictions → Unknown sources** → allow the file manager.
4. Plug in the stick, open the file in the file manager, press **OK → Install**. (No stick? **Send Files to TV** on the box and on a phone sends it over the Wi-Fi.)

Use it: start the quiz on the laptop (or the tablet), on the **same Wi-Fi** as the Mi Box. Open **Mind It! TV** (the gold **MIND IT! TV** banner in the apps row; add it to Favourites). After a few seconds the quiz is listed — 📺 **Laptop · …** or 📺 **Galaxy Tab · …** — press **OK**. Next time it opens the same quiz by itself, even if the laptop got a new address. **Back** on the remote returns to the list; ⌨ **Type the address** is there if the quiz isn't listed (the address under 📺 **Audience Screen**, e.g. `192.168.1.20:8080`).

Updates: ⬆ **App Update** at the bottom of the start screen checks the Mind It! download page; ⬆ **Install build N**, then **Install** on the TV's own screen. It also checks quietly once a day — only on the start screen, never over the quiz, and it never installs without you pressing the button. The first time, Android asks you to allow Mind It! TV to install apps. It checks the file's fingerprint and that it's signed with your Mind It! key before Android sees it. Updates need the internet; the quiz only needs your Wi-Fi.

Good to know: the picture needs **Android System WebView 105 or newer** — a Mi Box S normally has it; if Mind It! TV shows a red notice, update **Android System WebView** in Google Play on the box.

🟡 Built and checked on the build machine (the app file, its signature with your key, finding a quiz, the update checks, the audience page driven only by remote-control keys) — **not on a real Mi Box**. Try it at home before a quiz night.

Setup C3 — 📋 Rehearsal Report ✅ laptop · 🟡 tablet — since build 132

After a rehearsal — or whenever something didn't look right — 📲 **Connect ▾ → 📋 Rehearsal Report** (also a button in 🧪 Test Hosting) puts together a report of how the devices did. Press 💾 **Save Report File**: it's saved the same way as a backup file, named like `MindIt_Rehearsal_Report_2026-10-17_2015_laptop.html` (or `…_tablet.html`). Send that file to whoever helps you with Mind It! — it opens in any web browser.

What's in it: this device and its browser engine; on the laptop, the app file's **fingerprint** (SHA-256 — it shows a damaged download) and whether the short TV address works; the 🧪 **Test Hosting** results; each **audience screen** — its browser, size, connection quality, drops, its own errors and its sound; the **remotes** and which one is in control; how many **team phones** each team has; **sound** (volume, the sound engine, which TV has the sound, the last intro's timing); **finding the tablet** on the Wi-Fi; any transfer under way; and the errors recorded on this device. On the tablet: the background hosting, the Wi-Fi announcement, the tablet model, Android version and app build.

What's **never** in it: team codes, the remote PIN, device keys, passwords, backups, players or folder names — only the file name of the app.

🟡 On the laptop it was checked on the build machine (with a TV and an iPhone remote simulated by browsers). On the Galaxy Tab the report reads the tablet app's own status, which was only simulated.

Setup D — Player phones

Phones open a web page served by the laptop (the address looks like `http://192.168.x.x:8765/play`). Teams scan the QR code shown on the TV before the game, type their 4-letter **team code**, and they're in. Full steps in Chapter 8.

Phones are used for **private** things only: secret wagers, chips, the buzzer (Buzzer Mode) and typing the Mastermind It! answer. **They never see questions or answers.**

Wi-Fi and the internet — what's the difference?

- **Internet** = getting out to the world (websites, Google). **Mind It! does not need it.** The only optional online feature is the Google Drive backup.
- **Local network** = devices in the same room talking to each other through the same Wi-Fi router (or the laptop's hotspot). **Mind It! needs this** for phones and the tablet.

So a Wi-Fi that "has no internet" is fine. But a Wi-Fi that stops devices talking to each other (common on **guest**, **hotel**, **office** and **café** networks — called *client isolation*) is not. The fix is easy: turn on the **laptop's mobile hotspot** and have everyone join that instead (Chapter 9).

✅ Before You Start — checklist

Tick these off 20 minutes before the guests sit down:

- [ ] Laptop plugged into power (don't run a quiz on battery) and **sleep turned off** (or at least set to "never" while plugged in).
- [ ] `Mind It!.exe` open; the quiz loaded (Setup shows "✓ Ready to Start").
- [ ] TV connected; **Audience View** open on the TV, full screen — or the TV's browser on the **/tv** address (Setup C2) and 🧪 **Test Audience Screen** passed.
- [ ] 🧪 **Test Hosting** (📲 Connect ▾ → Connect Device → Run Test) says **Ready to host**.
- [ ] Sound on: press **Test Sound** (Setup → 5 · Audio & Presentation). Sound through a Wi-Fi TV? 🔊 **Sound On This TV** and **OK** pressed on the TV (Setup C2).
- [ ] Wi-Fi: the laptop, the tablet and the phones on the **same** network (or the laptop's hotspot).
- [ ] Tablet connected (**Connected** shows in green at the top of the tablet).
- [ ] One phone per team joined with its team code.
- [ ] 📶 **Check Connections → TEST ALL CONNECTIONS** says "All set".
- [ ] After a rehearsal where something looked wrong: 📋 **Rehearsal Report → Save Report File**, and send it (Setup C3).

- [ ] Every team has at least one player, and a Quizmaster is chosen.
- [ ] Questions checked (Setup → 4 · Rounds & Questions → *Template Check: No problems found*).
- [ ] A backup file saved (**⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore → Back Up Now**).
- [ ] Optional: a 2-minute 🎭 **Rehearsal** to test the TV, sound and phones.

PART TWO — CREATING A QUIZ

4. Installing and Opening Mind It!

4.1 Windows (the laptop app) 🟡

Mind It! for Windows is one **portable** program: `Mind It!.exe`. There is no installer and nothing to uninstall. Because the file is big (about 66 MB), it is delivered in **three parts plus a small "joiner"**:

- `Mind It!.exe.part1`, `Mind It!.exe.part2`, `Mind It!.exe.part3`
- `Join Mind It - build 140.bat` (the joiner)

Step by step

1. Download all four files into the **same folder** (your *Downloads* folder is fine).
2. Double-click `Join Mind It - build 140.bat`. A black window opens, finds the three parts (it recognises them by their exact size, even if your browser renamed them, and it also looks in *Downloads*), joins them and checks the final size — and, since build 130, the file's **fingerprint** (SHA-256), so even one damaged byte is caught (it says *Fingerprint checked*; if Windows' certutil tool is missing it says the check was skipped). If a part is damaged it says so and deletes the bad file — download the parts again.
3. When it says **"Done - Mind It!.exe is ready in this folder"**, press any key. You can delete the three part files.
4. Double-click `Mind It!.exe`. - If Windows shows **"Windows protected your PC"** (SmartScreen), click **More info → Run anyway**. This happens because the app isn't code-signed. - The first time, Windows may ask whether Mind It! may use the network. **Tick "Private networks" and allow it.** Without this, the tablet and phones can't connect.
5. Mind It! opens straight into **Setup** — that is the laptop's "main menu".

> **It updates itself (since build 152): Setup → 6 · Advanced → ⬆ App Update** (Mind It! also checks quietly about once a day and shows a small note). Press **⬇ Download build N**: the new build is saved **beside** the one you're running as `Mind It! (build N).exe`, and its fingerprint is checked against the download page's list (a damaged file is deleted). Then **Restart into build N** — never during a game (it says *after tonight's game*). Your players, history and settings stay. After the first update Mind It! runs from the new file, so a desktop shortcut to the old `Mind It!.exe` stops working — make a new one (Mind It! reminds you once). Build 151 and older still have to be replaced by hand once.
>
> **Updating by hand:** run the new joiner in the same folder. It replaces the old `Mind It!.exe` (close Mind It! first — the joiner refuses to replace a running app). Your players, history, questions and saved game are **not** stored inside the .exe, so they are kept. Still, save a backup file first (Chapter 22) — it costs ten seconds.

🟡 The joiner was tested on a non-Windows test system, not on a real Windows PC, for this guide.

> **The GitHub download page (since build 126; as Releases since build 132):** the **MindIt-Downloads** page on GitHub starts with **Download Mind It! — Latest Version**: one link each for Windows, the Galaxy Tab, the Mac and the web version, always the newest published build, as **single complete files** — no parts to join. **View All Previous Versions** lists every earlier build (back to build 125) with its own files. The Windows file from GitHub (`Mind-It-Windows.exe`) needs no joiner: use it in place of your old `Mind It!.exe` (your data stays). Each release lists every file's SHA-256 fingerprint.

4.1b Mac (the laptop app on a Mac) 🟡 — since build 123

The same laptop app also comes for a Mac with **Apple Silicon** (M1, M2, M3, M4 — macOS 11 Big Sur or newer). It does everything the Windows app does — TV window, phones, tablet, saving — and keeps its own players, history and Question Database on that Mac. (Older **Intel** Macs aren't supported from build 124 on.)

Is my Mac Apple Silicon? Apple menu → About This Mac. It should say **Chip: Apple M1/M2/M3/M4...**.

The app comes in parts (about 100 MB): `Mind It! for Mac (Apple Silicon).zip.part1` … `.part5`.

Step by step

1. Download all the parts into your **Downloads** folder (delete any older Mind It! parts there first, so only the new ones get joined).
2. Open **Terminal** (press ⌘-Space, type *Terminal*, press Return), paste this line and press Return: `cd ~/Downloads && cat "Mind It! for Mac (Apple Silicon).zip.part"* > "Mind It! for Mac (Apple Silicon).zip" && open "Mind It! for Mac (Apple Silicon).zip"`
3. The Mac unzips it into `Mind It!.app`. Drag it into **Applications**. You can delete the parts and the .zip.
4. Open it. The first time, macOS says it can't check the app for malicious software (it isn't signed with an Apple developer certificate). Click **Done**, then go to the **Apple menu → System Settings → Privacy & Security**, scroll down to *"Mind It! was blocked..."* and click **Open Anyway** (enter your password). On macOS 14 or older you can instead **Control-click the app → Open → Open**. You only do this once.
5. When the Mac asks, **Allow** Mind It! to **find devices on your local network** and to **accept incoming network connections** — without this the tablet and phones can't connect. The camera is only used for the optional Host Cam.

> **Moving from the Windows laptop?** Make a backup file on Windows (Chapter 22) and restore it on the Mac. **Updating:** quit Mind It! (⌘Q), replace `Mind It!.app` in Applications with the new one; your data stays. Since build 152, **Setup → 6 · Advanced → ⬆ App Update** tells you when there's a newer build and opens the download page.

🟡 The Mac app was built and checked on the build machine (app contents, the tested quiz page inside, Apple's own "ad-hoc" signature) but **has not been run on a real Mac**. Try it at home before a quiz night.

> **Mac from GitHub (since build 126):** the GitHub download page has the Mac app as **one zip** — download it, double-click it, then carry on from step 3. No Terminal needed.

4.1c The webpage version (`mindit.html`) 🟡 — since build 126 on GitHub

The whole of Mind It! also comes as **one webpage file**, `mindit.html` (also on the GitHub download page). It is the same quiz as the laptop app, with nothing to install: **double-click it on any computer** and it opens in Chrome, Edge or Safari.

What's different from the laptop app:

- **No phones and no tablet.** A webpage can't be a "server", so team phones, the tablet remote, the 📱 Phone Remote and Phone Buzzer Mode don't work, and the Phoenix chip isn't handed out. Play it like a board game, with the Quizmaster scoring on the computer.
- **Its own data.** Players, history and the Question Database are kept by that browser on that computer, separately from the laptop app. To move them, make a backup file in one (Chapter 22) and restore it in the other. Clearing the browser's history and site data deletes them, so make backups.
- **The TV:** use the 📺 **Audience View** button as usual — it opens a second browser window you drag to the TV (allow pop-ups if the browser asks).
- **iPhone and iPad:** a downloaded webpage file opens in the Files preview, which doesn't run Mind It! properly. Use the **hosted webpage** instead (below).

The hosted webpage — for an iPhone or iPad. The same page is online at **https://coolrishi20.github.io/MindIt-Web/**. Open it in Safari, then **Share → Add to Home Screen → Add**: you get the gold **M** icon named **Mind It!**, which opens full-

screen. It is the whole quiz on that one device, with the same limits as above (no team phones or remotes), and it keeps its own players and history.

No internet? It still opens (since build 129). Once the page has been opened with internet, the phone keeps a copy. With no internet — or Wi-Fi with no internet, such as a laptop's hotspot — it opens from that copy, with your players and history. With internet it always fetches the newest build first, so updates arrive by themselves; open it once with internet after each new build. Clearing Safari's website data removes the copy (and the players), so keep backups. Use the **home-screen icon** rather than a Safari tab: in Safari itself, iOS may remove a site's saved data after 7 days without a visit.

🟡 The webpage is the exact page tested inside the laptop app. Opened as a downloaded file it was checked on the build machine in Chrome's engine (it starts, keeps a saved game and players after closing and reopening, and the Audience View opens), not on a real PC or Mac. The hosted webpage working with no internet was checked the same way, with a phone-sized browser and the site switched off — not on a real iPhone.

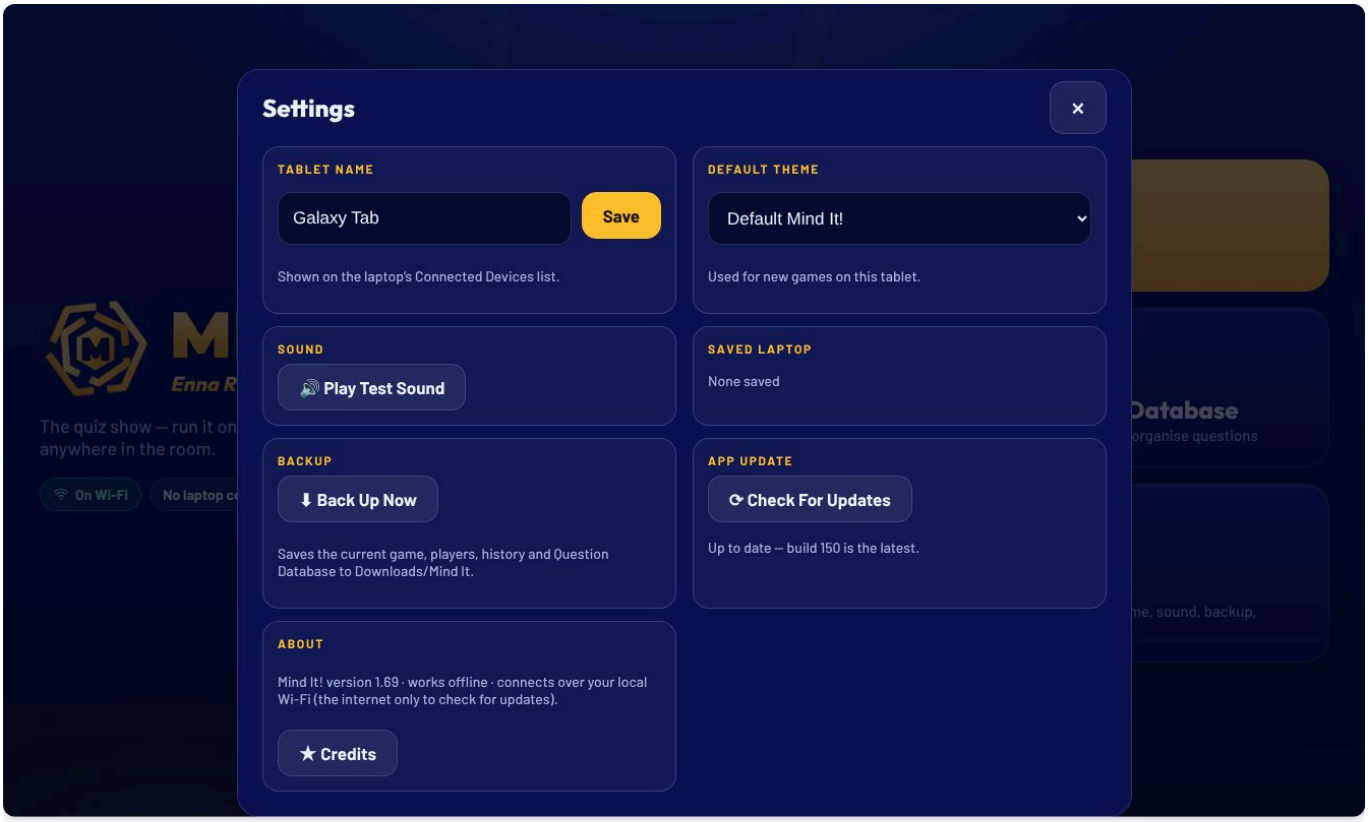
4.2 Android (the tablet app) 🟡

The tablet app is the file `Mind It! for Android (Galaxy Tab).apk`.

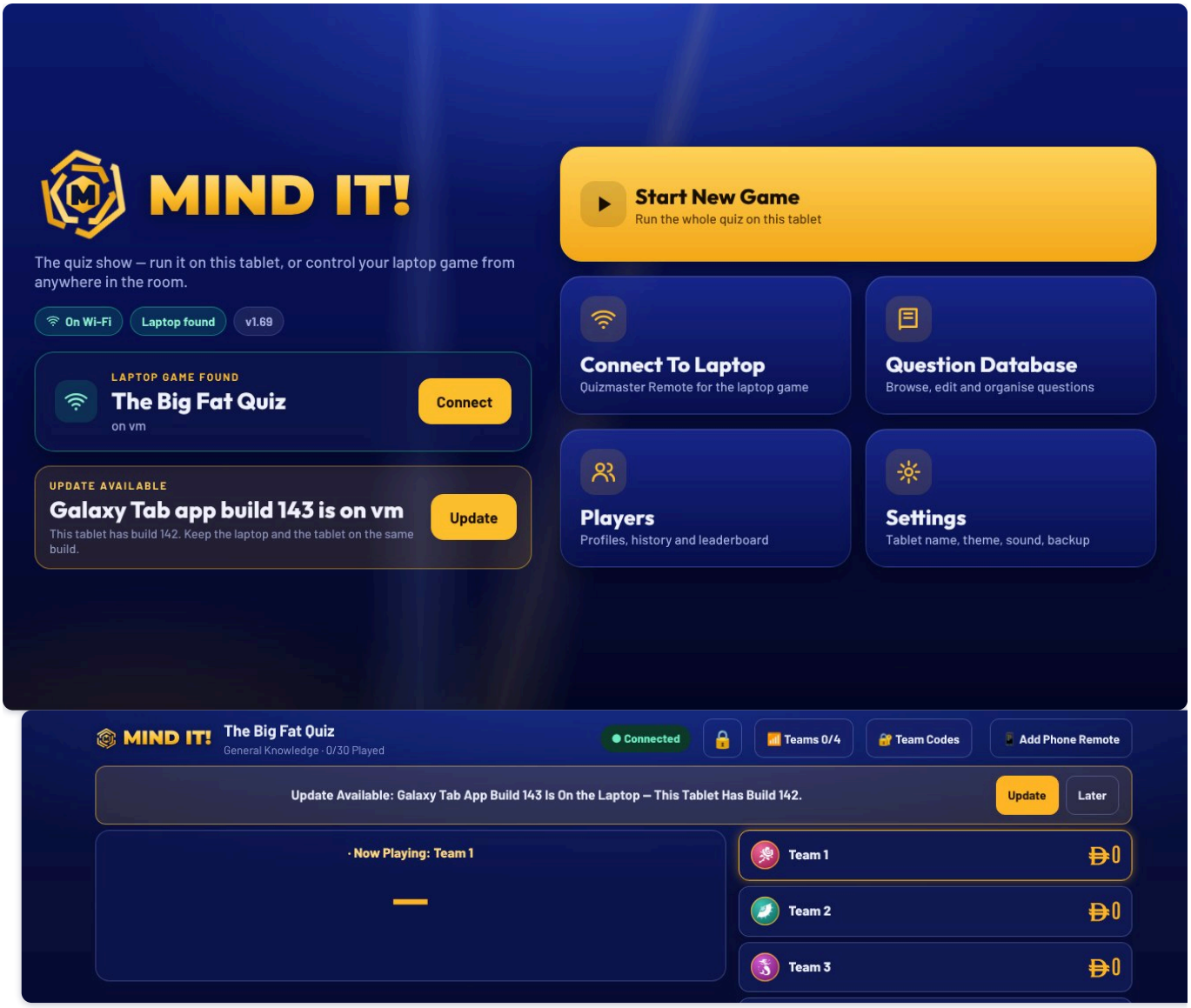
1. Copy or download the APK onto the tablet. **Easiest (since build 142):** on the laptop app, 📲 **Connect Device →** 📲 **Update the Tablet App**, and scan the code with the tablet's camera — the tablet downloads the app from the laptop over your Wi-Fi (no internet). If Chrome warns that the file might be harmful, tap **Download anyway**.
2. Tap it. Android asks to allow installing apps from this source (*Install unknown apps*) — allow it for your file manager or browser.
3. Tap **Install** (or **Update** if an older Mind It! is already installed — updates install over the old app because they are signed with the same key, so the tablet's data stays).
4. Open **Mind It!**. You land on the tablet's **Main Menu**.

Even easier (since build 143): the tablet offers the update itself. When it finds a laptop that carries a newer tablet app, the Main Menu shows **Update Available** under the laptop (and, once connected, a banner with **Update** and **Later**). Tap **Update**: since build 152 the tablet downloads it from the laptop **itself** and shows Android's install screen (before 152, Chrome opened the laptop's download page — tap **Download**, open the file, **Update**). **Later** hides it until the tablet app is opened again. (The tablet must already be on build 143 for this; from 142, use the code once.)

On its own, from the internet (since build 149) — no laptop needed: on the tablet, **Settings → App Update → Check For Updates** asks the Mind It! download page whether there is a newer tablet app. If there is, it shows the build and an **Update** button. **Since build 152** Mind It! downloads the update **itself** — the card shows *Downloading… 1.2 / 2.6 MB* — checks it is genuine (its fingerprint, and signed with your Mind It! key), then opens Android's install screen: tap **Install** (or **Update**). Mind It! closes while it updates; open it again — every game, player and setting stays. The first time, Android asks you to allow Mind It! to install apps: tap **Allow**, switch on **Allow from this source**, come back, and it carries on by itself. If something goes wrong the card says what happened, with **Try Again** and **Open in browser instead**. *(Up to build 151 the browser downloaded it, and could sit at 2.65 MB / 2.65 MB — then open the file from **My Files → Downloads**. That's also how you install build 152 the first time.)* The Main Menu also checks by itself (at most once a day, and only when the tablet is online) and shows **Update Available** with **Update**. The first time, Android may ask you to allow installs from the browser (*Install unknown apps*). If the tablet already has the newest app, or there's no internet, it just says so.



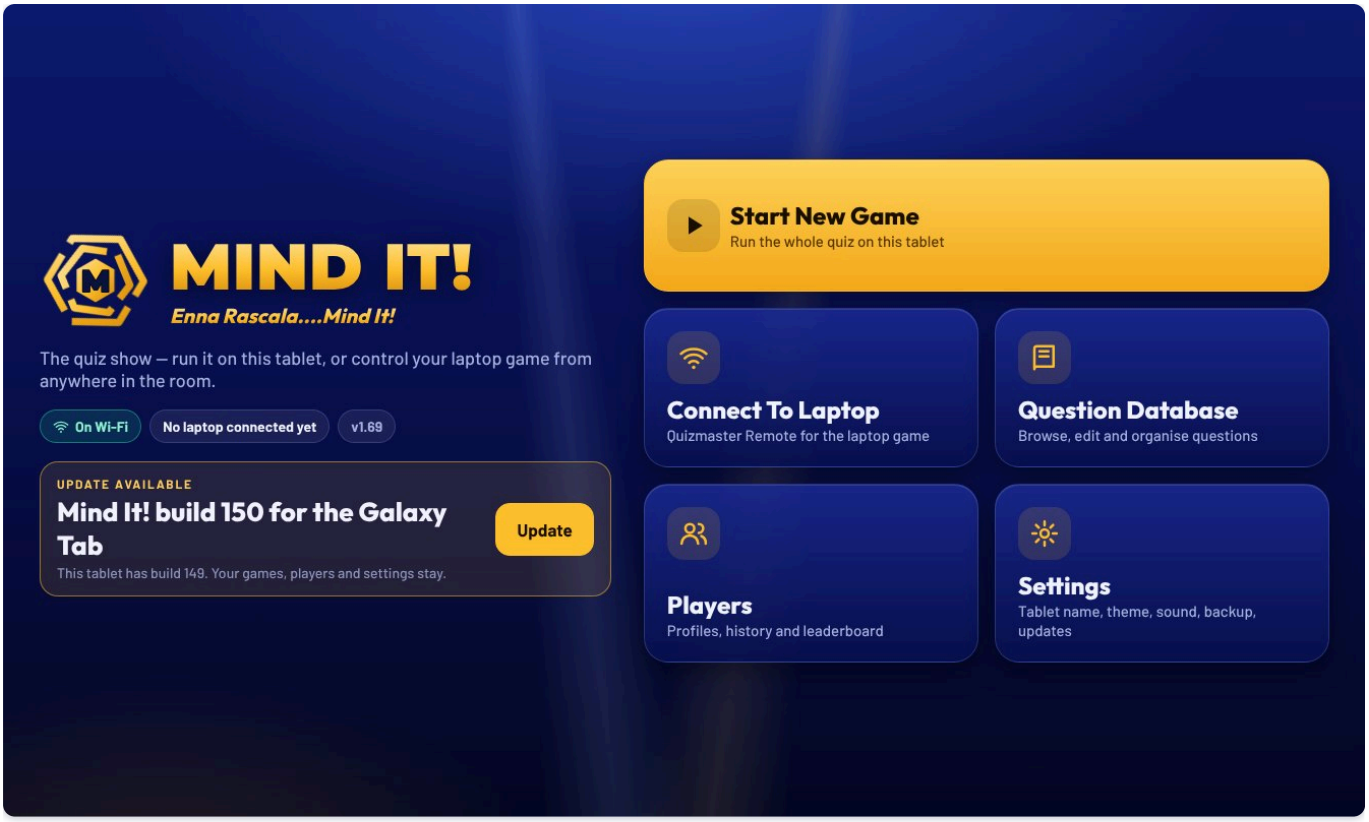
📸 Real screenshot (build 150) — Settings → App Update on the tablet.



📸 *Real screenshots (build 143) — the offer on the tablet's Main Menu and on the remote.*

📸 *Real screenshots (build 142) — the code on the laptop, and the page the tablet opens.*

Builds 129–134 on the tablet: they installed under the name **"application"** and closed at once ("application closed because this app has a bug"). That was a fault in how the app file was packaged, not in your data. Install **build 135** (or newer) over it with **Update** — the fault is fixed there: it is called **Mind It!**, and the tablet keeps its players, history and questions. Don't clear the app's cache or data.



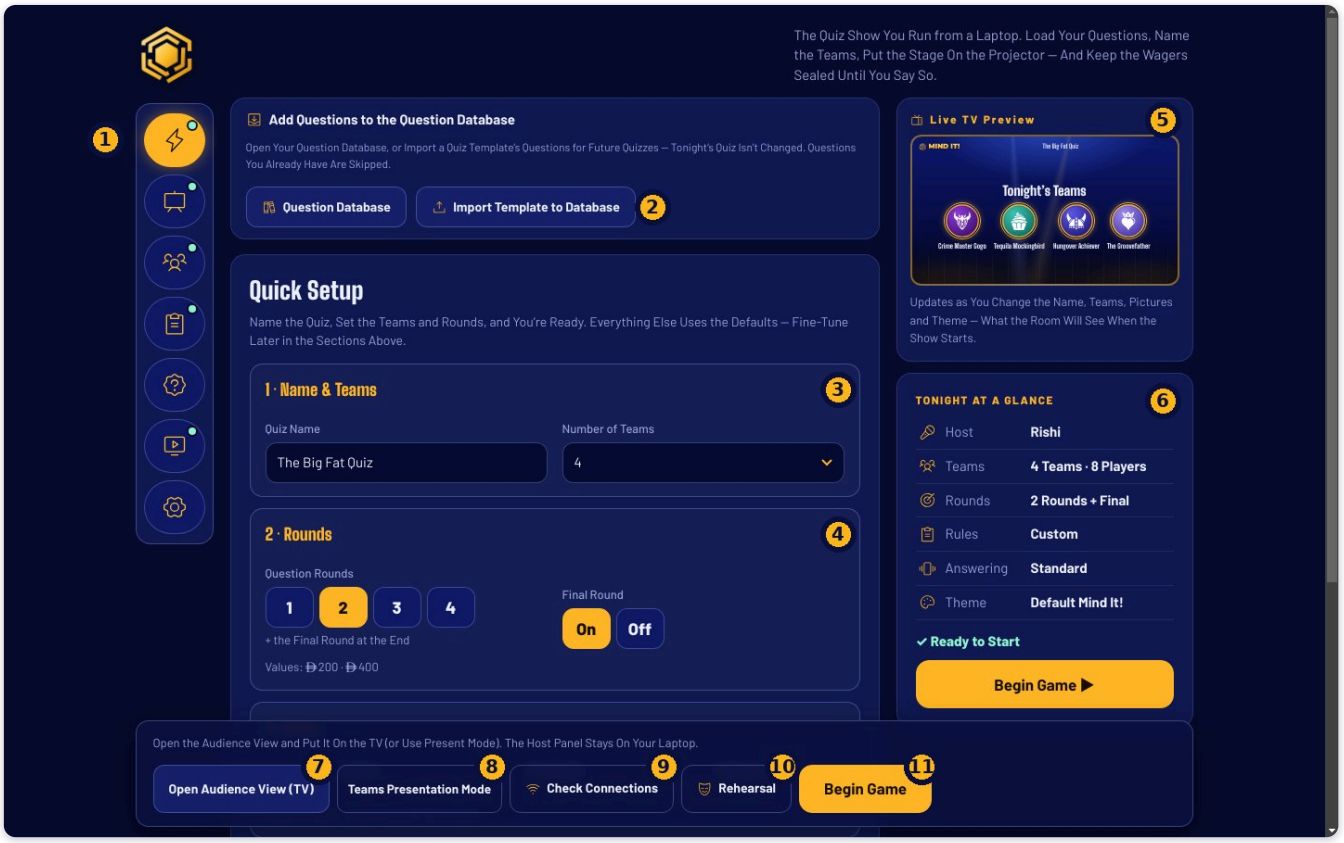
📸 *Real screenshot (build 150) — the tablet Main Menu (start screen), with the tagline under the logo; here the download page has a newer tablet app, so it shows **Update Available**.*

Button	What it does
Start New Game	Run the **whole quiz on the tablet** (no laptop).
Connect To Laptop	Become the Quizmaster remote for the laptop game. When the tablet sees a laptop game on the Wi-Fi it shows a **LAPTOP GAME FOUND** card with a **Connect** button.
Question Database	Browse and edit the questions stored on the tablet.
Players	Player profiles, history and the leaderboard.
Settings	Tablet name, theme, sound, backup, **App Update** (since build 149).

Under the logo is the tagline “Enna Rascala....Mind It!” (since build 149). The little chips under it show the **Network** state, whether a **Laptop** was **found**, and the version (**v1.69**).

🟡 Installing over the old app, network discovery and camera QR scanning were not re-checked on a real Galaxy Tab for this guide.

4.3 Finding your way around the laptop



📸 Real screenshot — Setup, the first screen of the laptop app (Quick Setup).

1. **Setup sections rail.** The round buttons on the left are the setup sections, top to bottom: ⚡ **Quick Setup**, **1 · Game**, **2 · Teams & Players**, **3 · Gameplay & Rules**, **4 · Rounds & Questions**, **5 · Audio & Presentation**, **6 · Advanced**. Hover over (or long-press) a button to see its name; a small dot marks a section that has a status note.
2. **Question Database / Import Template to Database.** Add questions for future quizzes. *Tonight's quiz isn't changed.*
3. **Name & Teams.** The quiz name (shown under the logo on the TV) and the number of teams (2–8).
4. **Rounds.** The **Special Question** (Blind It! or Rewind It!, 12.1b), 1–4 question rounds, Mastermind It! On/Off, and the automatic values.
5. **Live TV Preview.** What the TV will show when the show starts.
6. **Tonight at a Glance.** Host, teams, rounds, rules, answering mode and theme in one box, plus ✔ **Ready to Start** (or what's missing).
7. **Open Audience View (TV).**
8. **Teams Presentation Mode** (for sharing the Audience View in a Microsoft Teams call).
9. 📶 **Check Connections** (Chapter 9).
10. 🎭 **Rehearsal** — a practice game where nothing counts.
11. **Begin Game** — start the show.

The top bar during a game (Chapter 15 explains every button): 📺 **Audience View ▾**, 📲 **Connect ▾**, the tablet status, 🔊 **Sound**, 📶 **Teams x/y** (connected team phones — tap it for Connection Health), 🔐 **Team Codes**, ⋯ **▾** (Intermission, Mind It! Sting, About & Credits, Backups & Restore) and **Setup**.

4.4 Loading, resuming and "going back to the main menu"

- **Mind It! saves the game automatically after every change.** If the app or the computer closes during a game, open Mind It! again: Setup offers **Resume saved game** or **Start fresh**. Choose **Resume saved game** (Chapter 22).
- **Pressing Setup during a game pauses it.** Setup then offers **Return to game** or **Start a new game**.

- **The laptop's "main menu" is Setup.** At the end of a game, **END GAME** (on the tablet) or **Back to Setup** (on the laptop's final screens) saves the results and returns to Setup.
- **The tablet's main menu** is the start screen above. After END GAME the tablet shows "THANKS FOR PLAYING!" and returns there.
- **Loading a quiz from a file:** Setup → 4 · Rounds & Questions → **Upload Your Question Template** accepts Excel (.xlsx), CSV or a saved Mind It! game (.json).

4.5 What is "Quizmaster Mode"?

You may see a button called **QUIZMASTER MODE** on a phone. It belongs to the **browser-only "web link" version** of Mind It! (used without the laptop app): it opens the host controls on that device after you type the Quizmaster password. **You don't need it with the laptop app and tablet**, which this guide covers. The password is known to the owner and is deliberately not printed anywhere in this guide. 🟡 The web-link version was republished with build 114 (11 Oct 2026); it hasn't been checked on real devices.

---

5. Creating Your First Quiz: THE BIG FAT QUIZ

We'll build a real quiz called **THE BIG FAT QUIZ** with 4 teams, 2 rounds and Mastermind It! Follow along on the laptop.

Step 1 — Create a new game

Open Mind It!. If you see an old quiz you don't want, go to **6 · Advanced → Reset → New Quiz (Reset to Defaults)**. This resets the quiz name, teams, settings and questions to the defaults. **Player profiles and their history are never touched.**

> 💡 You don't have to reset. If your Question Database has 10 or more questions, a brand-new game is filled automatically with random questions from it (newest questions first).

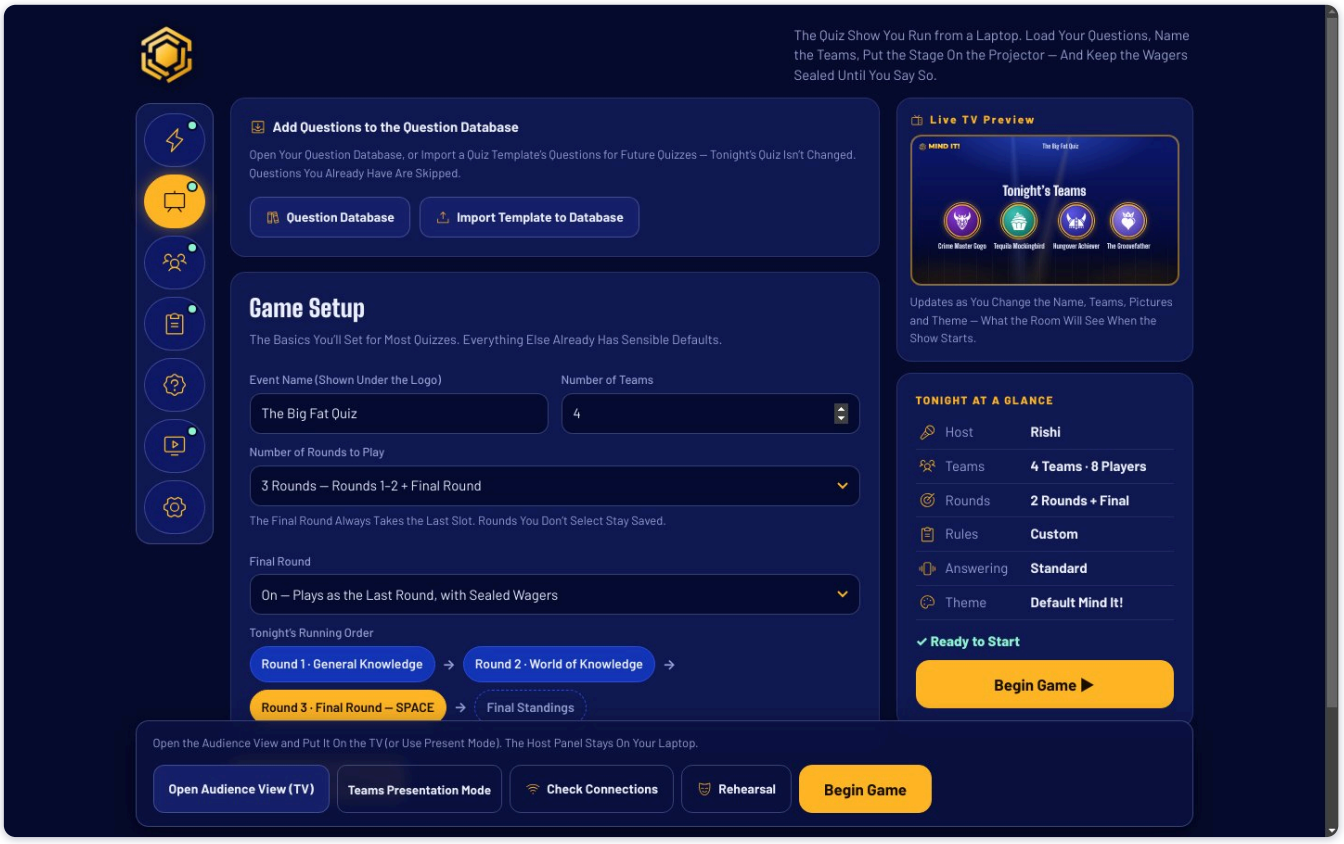
Step 2 — Enter the quiz name

⚡ **Quick Setup → 1 · Name & Teams → Quiz Name:** type `The Big Fat Quiz`. It appears under the logo on the TV ("Event Name").

Step 3 — Choose the number of rounds

⚡ **Quick Setup → 2 · Rounds → Question Rounds:** tap **2**. Leave **Mastermind It!: On**. The box shows the values: *Values: 200 · 400* (the first-row value of each round).

The same choice in more detail is in **1 · Game → Number of Rounds to Play**: "1 Round — Round 1 only", "2 Rounds — Round 1 + Mastermind It!", "3 Rounds — Rounds 1–2 + Mastermind It!", "4 Rounds — Rounds 1–3 + Mastermind It!", "5 Rounds — Rounds 1–4 + Mastermind It!". *(In that list, "rounds" counts Mastermind It! too.)* Rounds you don't use stay saved but never appear in the game.



📸 *Real screenshot — 1 · Game: event name, number of rounds, Mastermind It!, and tonight's running order.*

Step 4 — Select the game mode

3 · Gameplay & Rules → Answering Mode:

- ● **Standard Mode** — "Teams answer out loud in turn — the normal game." **Choose this for your first game.**
- ○ **Phone Buzzer Mode** — "Teams buzz in from their phones; the first buzz answers." (Chapter 13.)

Also on this page, pick a **rules preset** (Step 7 below explains them): **Classic**, **Full Show**, **Online Mode** or **Custom**.

Step 5 — Select question categories

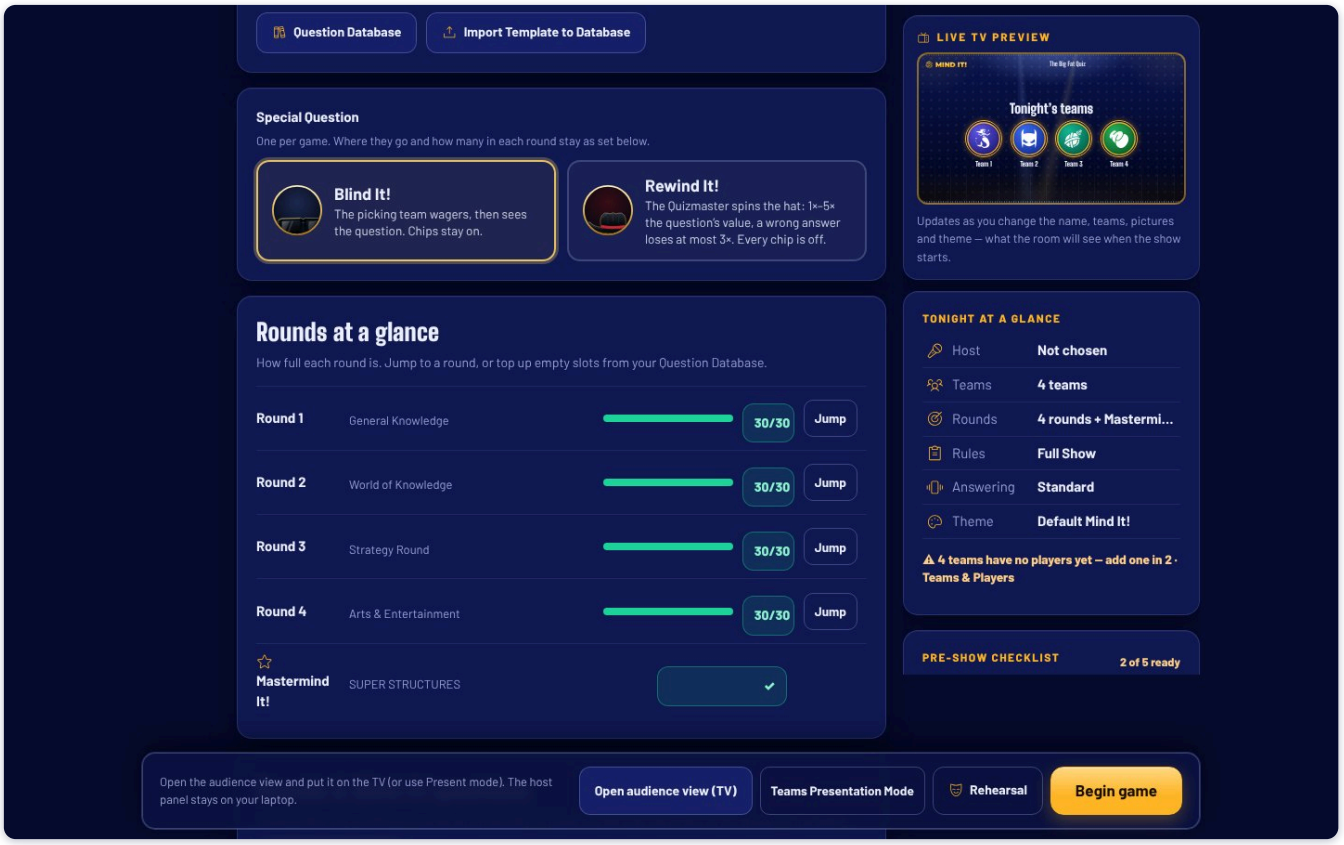
Each round needs 6 categories of 5 questions. You have three easy options:

1. **Use what's already there.** New games are filled automatically from your Question Database.
2. 🎲 **Randomize Rounds** (4 · Rounds & Questions) — refills the rounds with random database questions (it asks first). The newest questions and categories get priority; each column gets a different category; nothing repeats.
3. 🔄 **Replace a round or a single category** with one you choose from the database (Chapter 6.6).

Or load a whole quiz from a spreadsheet: **4 · Rounds & Questions → Upload Your Question Template** (download the **Starter Template (.xlsx)** first — it's a complete sample quiz with a Quizmaster guide; replace the yellow cells with your questions).

Step 6 — Choose (and check) the questions

In **4 · Rounds & Questions → Review & Edit Clues** every round is listed with its categories and questions. Each category has 🔄 **Replace**, ↕ **Reorder** and ↔ **Move** buttons; each question shows a status (✔ **Ready**) and a ⋯ menu. 👁 **Preview Questions** shows a question exactly as the TV will — on a private copy, so nothing counts and nothing is marked as used.



📸 *Real screenshot (build 150) — 4 · Rounds & Questions: the **Special Question** (Blind It! or Rewind It!), then how full each round is ("30/30"); further down, the values and Blind It! questions of each round.*

Step 7 — Configure question values (and the rules)

Values are automatic. You don't have to type a single number:

Question rounds in play	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Round 4
1, 2 or 3 rounds	200 · 400 · 600 · 800 · 1,000	400 · 800 · 1,200 · 1,600 · 2,000	600 · 1,200 · 1,800 · 2,400 · 3,000	—
4 rounds	250 · 500 · 750 · 1,000 · 1,250	500 · 1,000 · 1,500 · 2,000 · 2,500	750 · 1,500 · 2,250 · 3,000 · 3,750	1,000 · 2,000 · 3,000 · 4,000 · 5,000

How it works: each round has a **starting value** (the top row): 200 / 400 / 600 for 1–3 rounds, or 250 / 500 / 750 / 1,000 for 4 rounds. **Row k is worth starting value × k.** So THE BIG FAT QUIZ (2 rounds) has Round 1 = 200–1,000 and Round 2 = 400–2,000. Mastermind It! has no board value — it is played with wagers. ✅ *Verified: the replayed game in Chapter 17 used exactly 200…1,000 and 400…2,000.*

Want your own values? Change a round's **Starting Value (Q1)** in 4 · Rounds & Questions — that switches automatic values off for your quiz. Editing **one single question's** value by hand (in Review & Edit Clues) also switches to your own values, so **Begin Game keeps it** (build 113). **Use Automatic Values** turns them back on.

Rules presets (3 · Gameplay & Rules → 📋 Game Rules):

Rule	Classic	(default)	Online Mode
⚡ Speed Bonus	off	on	**on**
🎁 Pass-On Bonus	off	on	on
🏆 Mastermind It!	on	on	on
🔐 Sealed Blind It! Wagers	on	on	off
🎲 Triple Gamble Chips	off	on	off
🔥 Phoenix Chip	off	on	**off — and hidden**
🍺 Bottoms Up Chip	off	on	off
👑 Returning Champion	off	on	on
🔥 Never Mind It! Moment	on	on	on
🔥 Streak Flames	off	on	on
📳 Early-Buzz Lockout	on	on	off
🎬 Board Fill Animation	on	on	on

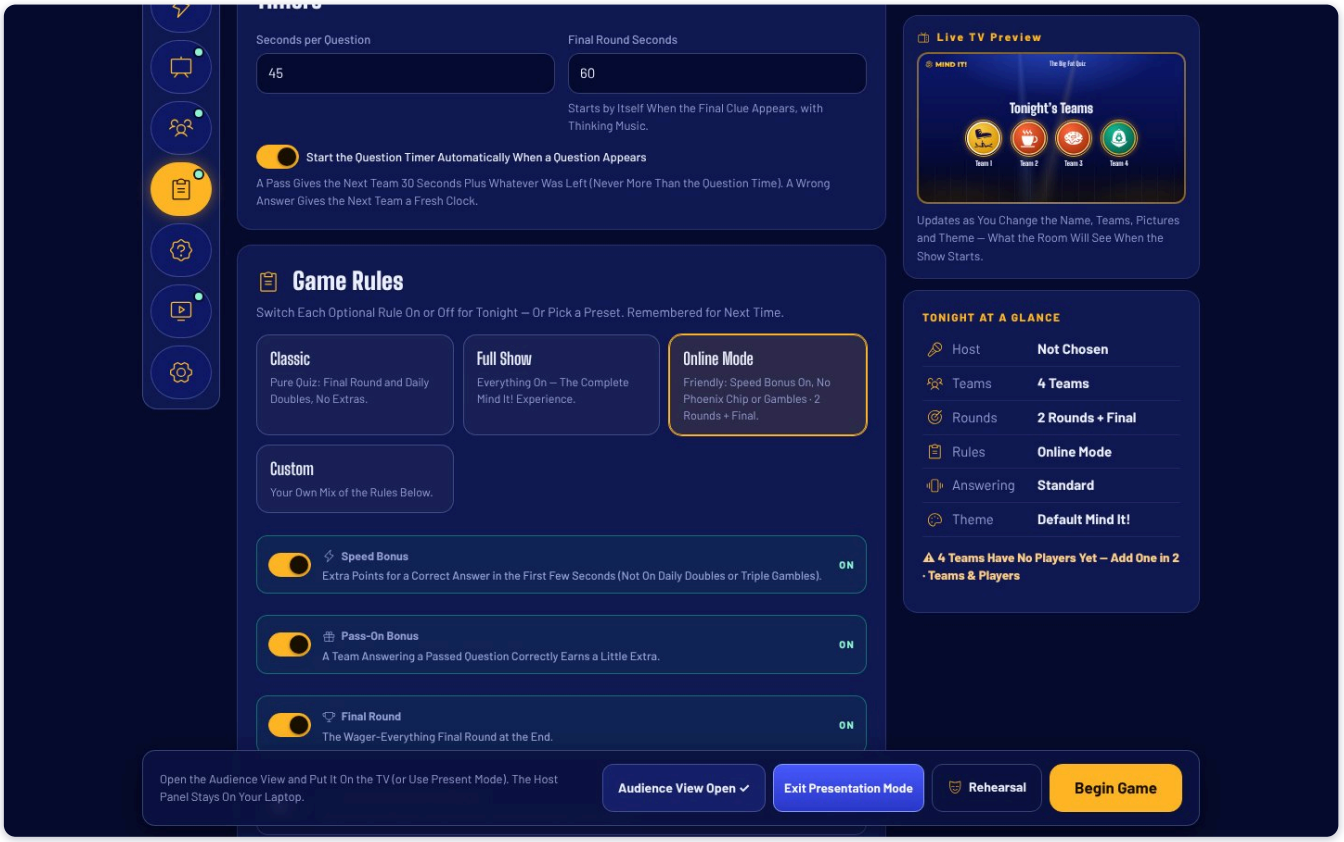
Change any single switch and Classic or Full Show shows **Custom**. Your choices are remembered on this device for next time. Changing a rule during a game asks first and applies from the next question.

🌐 **Online Mode** (since build 136; it replaces Family Night) is for a quiz on a **Teams call** — the players are at home, not on the laptop's Wi-Fi, so team phones can't connect:

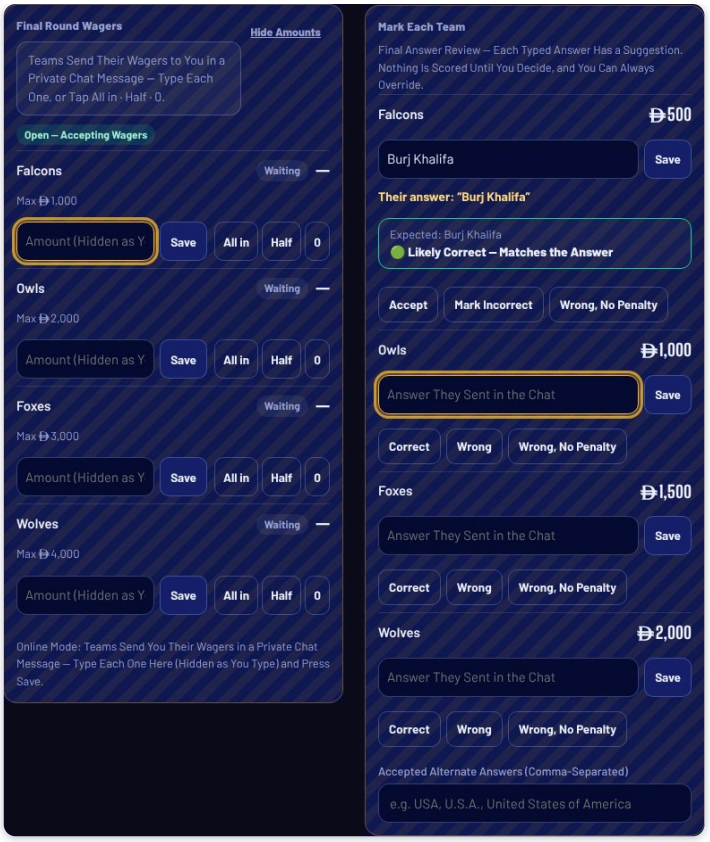
- **Rules:** Speed Bonus, Pass-On Bonus (25%), Streak Flames, Returning Champion, Board Fill Animation and Mastermind It! **on**; the **Phoenix Chip off** — its switch is hidden while Online Mode is selected, so it can't be switched on by accident. Everything else is as Family Night had it: no Triple Gamble, no Bottoms Up, no early-buzz lockout, Blind It! wagers shown.
- **Rounds:** picking it sets **2 question rounds + Mastermind It!** (Round 1 200–1,000, Round 2 400–2,000) and **Standard** answering. You can still change the number of rounds and any other setting afterwards — it stays Online Mode.
- **Teams Presentation Mode switches on** when you pick it (build 137): the Audience View window opens and the **Presentation Check** shows. In Teams: **Share → Window → "Mind It! — Audience View"** and tick **Include computer**

sound, so everyone sees the TV and hears the music. Picked during a game, this happens once you tap **Apply**. **Exit Presentation Mode** switches it off. (Not in the Galaxy Tab app — it has no second window, so host Teams calls from the laptop.)

- **Speed Bonus window: 15 seconds** (build 137; 10 in the other presets) — an answer takes a moment longer to reach you on a call. *Answer Within (Seconds)* still changes it; picking another preset puts 10 back, unless you changed it yourself.
- **How to Play** on the TV explains a call: unmute and answer out loud; Mastermind It! wagers and answers go to the Quizmaster in a private chat message. *(Build 137 — build 136's Mastermind It! card still said "answers on their phone".)*
- **Wagers by private chat:** the TV shows 📩 **Send your wager to the Quizmaster · private chat message** instead of a QR code (Mastermind It!), and the Blind It! screen asks the team to tell you their wager. On the laptop each team has one wager box and the cursor starts in the first: type the wager (hidden as you type) and press **Save** — or tap **All in · Half · 0** (a Blind It! question: **Minimum · Half · Maximum**). The sealed-code boxes, the wager key and the private booth aren't shown (build 137).
- **Mastermind It! answers by private chat** (build 137): the TV's Mastermind It! question says 📩 **Send your answer to the Quizmaster in a private chat message**. When the time is up, the **Mark Each Team** card has a box for each team: type the answer they sent and press **Enter** — the cursor moves to the next team. Each answer gets the usual suggestion (🟢 Likely Correct · 🟡 Review · 🔴 Likely Incorrect); you decide. The reveal on the TV shows the answer, then Correct or Wrong. Changing an answer after marking it clears the mark, so you mark it again.
- 📋 **Copy picture for the chat** (build 137): at the end of the game, next to **Save picture**. The results picture goes on the clipboard — click the Teams message box and press **Ctrl+V** (⌘V on a Mac). A browser or tablet that can't copy saves it as a file instead.
- Choosing **Classic** or **Full Show** leaves Online Mode (the Phoenix switch comes back; Teams Presentation Mode stays on until you exit it).



📸 Real screenshot (build 137) — 3 · Gameplay & Rules with Online Mode chosen, after the Presentation Check: the bottom bar shows "Audience View Open ✓" and "Exit Presentation Mode"; Tonight at a glance shows 2 Rounds + Mastermind It!, Online Mode, Standard.



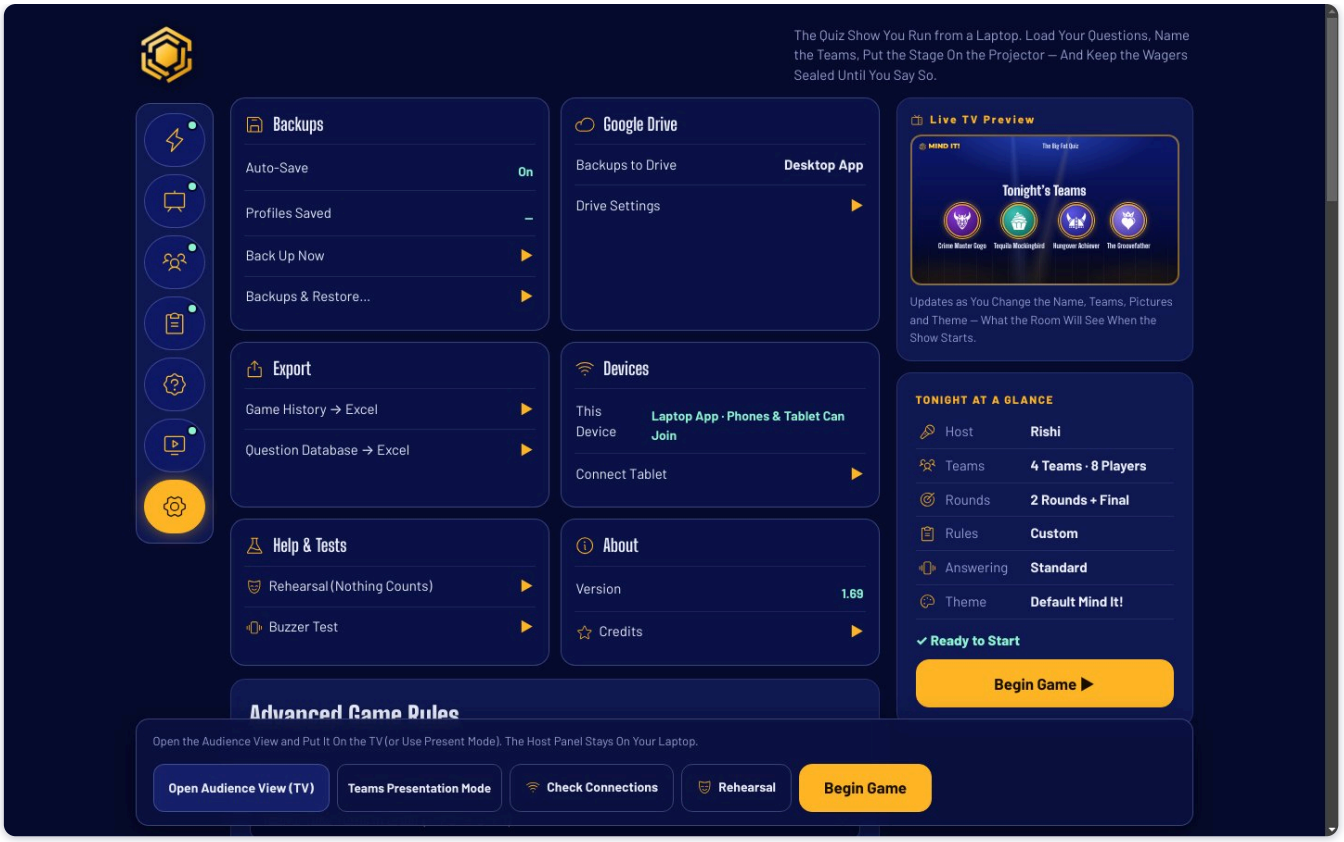
📸 *Real screenshot (build 137) — Online Mode on the laptop: the Mastermind It! wagers (one box per team with All in · Half · 0, the cursor in the first) and Mark Each Team with the first answer from the chat, its suggestion, and the cursor in the next team's box.*

Other settings on 3 · Gameplay & Rules (defaults in bold):

- **Seconds per Question: 45** · **Mastermind It! Seconds: 60** · **Start the Question Timer Automatically: on**.
- **Pass-On Bonus: On — % of the question's value per pass (25%)** · or a fixed number of points per pass (100) · or Off.
- **Speed Bonus: On** — automatic, **50%** of the lowest question value in each round (Round 1: 100 · Round 2: 200 for THE BIG FAT QUIZ) · **Answer Within: 10 seconds**.
- **Blind It! questions per round: 1 · 2 · 2 · 3** (4 · Rounds & Questions), placed **at random on the top two questions of a category** (or "I'll pick them before the round", or "Use the clues marked DD").

6 · Advanced → Advanced Game Rules:

- **Turn Order: Teams take turns in order (1 → 2 → 3 → 1)** or *Classic — whoever answers correctly picks next*.
- **Blind It! Wager On Screen: Sealed until the answer is scored** or *Shown before the clue*.
- **Blind It! Cap for Low Scores: 1,000** — a team may wager up to its score, or up to this amount if its score is lower.

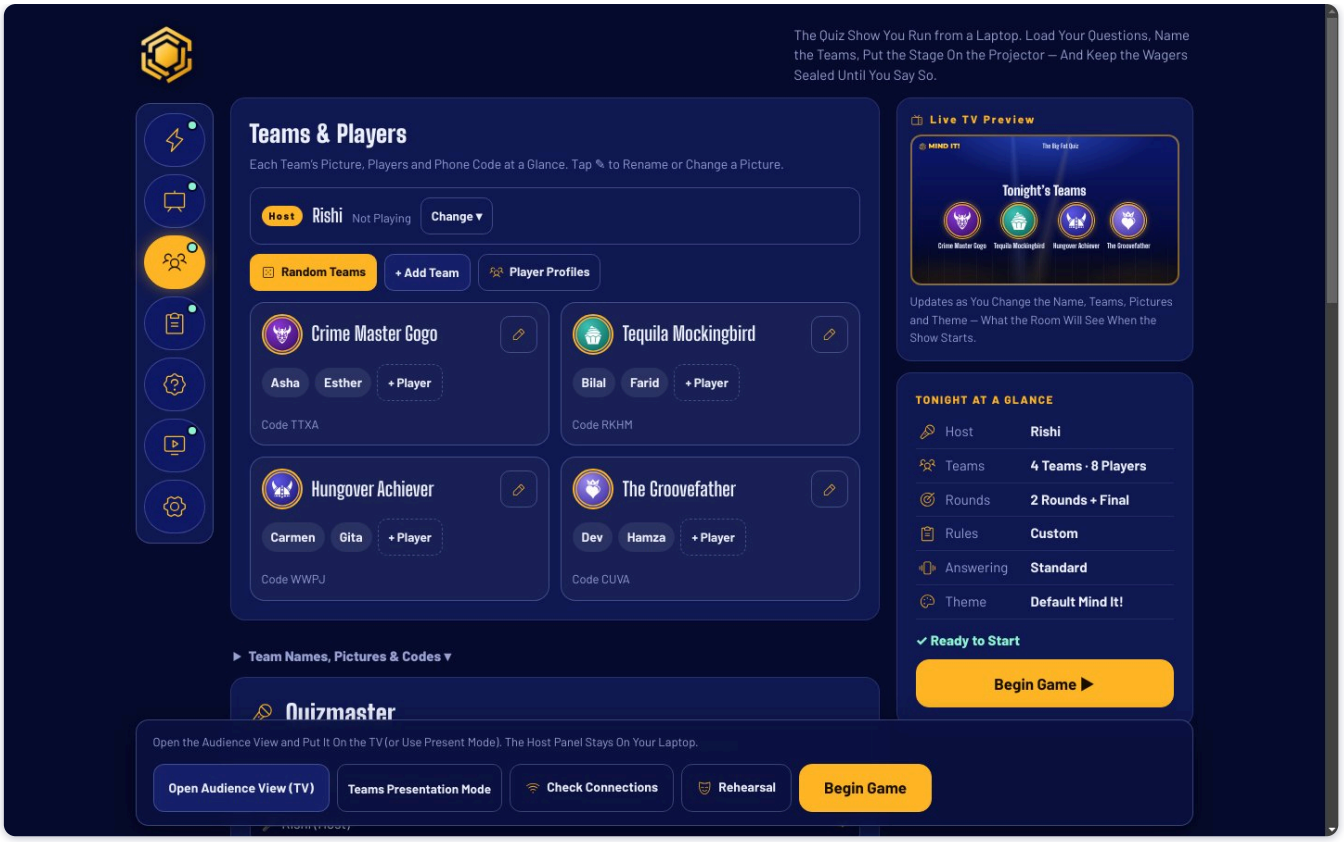


📸 *Real screenshot — 6 · Advanced (backups, Google Drive, export, devices, help & tests, about).*

Step 8 — Create the teams

2 · Teams & Players. Each team card shows its picture, its players, **+ Player**, and its **4-letter code** (e.g. *Code TRYT*). Tap ✎ to rename a team or change its picture. **+ Add Team** adds one (up to 8). Mind It! needs **at least 2 teams** — the number of teams can't be set below 2. 🎲 **Random Teams** shuffles your players into teams for you.

Name ours: **Crime Master Gogo**, **Tequila Mockingbird**, **Hungover Achiever**, **The Groovefather**.

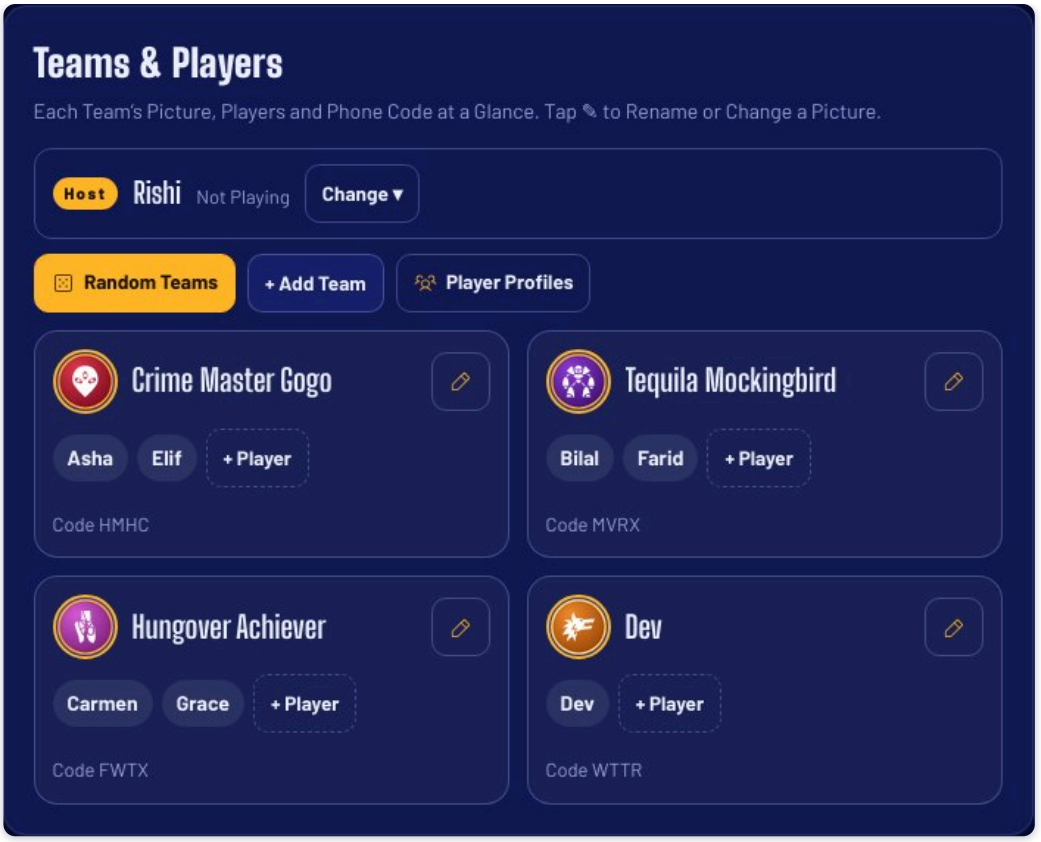


📸 *Real screenshot — 2 · Teams & Players.*

Step 9 — Assign the players

Tap **+ Player** on each team and pick people from your Player Database (or create a new person on the spot). **Every team needs at least one player** before Begin Game (a Rehearsal is exempt). A person can't be in two teams.

A team with only one player *is* that player. It automatically takes the player's **name** and **picture** — on the TV, the phones, the scores and the records. Its name box is then locked (hover over it: "One-player team: it uses Dev's name and picture. Add a second player to give the team its own name."). Add a second player and the team gets back the name it had before. ✅ *(New in build 112.)*



📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — 2 · Teams & Players: the fourth team has one player, Dev, so the team is called "Dev".*

Step 10 — Select the Quizmaster

2 · Teams & Players → 🎤 Quizmaster → Host. One Quizmaster per game; the Quizmaster **can't** also play. New games pick the player named **Rishi** as Quizmaster when that profile exists (otherwise the last Quizmaster). If Rishi wants to play tonight, press 🎮 **Rishi Wants to Play** and choose who hosts instead (Chapter 7.6).

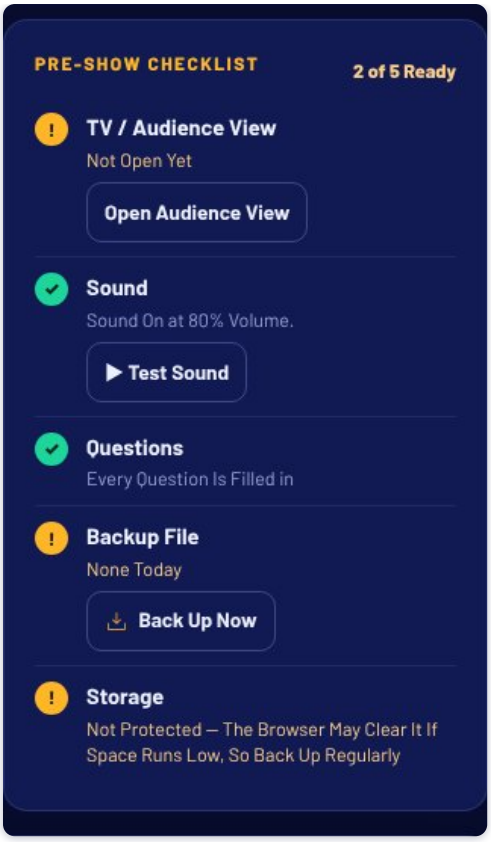
Step 11 — Choose the theme

5 · Audio & Presentation → Theme. Tap one of the 12 themes (each has a ▶ **Sounds** preview). **Theme Intensity** (Subtle · Standard · **Full**) only changes decorations and animations, never the layout. Details in Chapter 21.

Step 12 — Review the setup

Look at **Tonight at a Glance** on the right: *Host · Teams (4 Teams · 8 Players) · Rounds (2 Rounds + Mastermind It!) · Rules · Answering · Theme*. When everything is fine it says ✔ **Ready to Start**. If something is missing (for example a team without a player), it says what — and **Begin Game** explains it too.

Pre-show checklist (since build 141), under Tonight at a Glance: what's ready for the show, ticked by itself as things connect — **TV / Audience View** (with **Open Audience View**), **Team phones** and **Tablet remote** (laptop app; optional unless you use phone buzzers), **Sound** (▶ **Test Sound**), **Questions** (every question filled in, and Mastermind It!), **Backup file** made today (⬇ **Back Up Now**) and **Storage** (Chapter 22.1). The count at the top says how many of the must-haves are ready.



📸 *Real screenshot (build 141) — the Pre-show checklist on Setup.*

Step 13 — Save the quiz

The quiz is **saved automatically** on this computer. To keep a copy:

- **Save Quiz to Question Database** (4 · Rounds & Questions, or inside the Question Database) — adds tonight's questions to your database for future quizzes. (A finished game also adds all its questions automatically.)
- **Save Everything (.json)** — the whole quiz in one file you can load later.
- **Export Questions (.xlsx)** — tonight's questions as an editable spreadsheet.
- **⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore → Back Up Now** — a full backup (game, players, history and Question Database).

Step 14 — Start the game

1. Open the Audience View on the TV (**Open Audience View (TV)**). Before the game, the TV shows a **"Scan to Join Your Team"** QR code with the phone link — teams scan it and type their team code (Chapter 8). It stays up on *Tonight's Teams* and disappears when Round 1 starts.
2. Press 📶 **Check Connections** if you use phones or a tablet (Chapter 9).
3. Press **Begin Game ▶**.

📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — the TV before the game, with the phone join QR code at the bottom.*

Don't want the code on the TV (for example, nobody is using phones)? Switch off **5 · Audio & Presentation → Audience View & Presentation → Show the Phone Join QR Code On the TV Before the Game** (it's on by default).

📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — the switch, just under "Show a How to Play slide".*

The TV shows **Tonight's Teams**, then the Round 1 categories, then the board. The first team lights up as **Now Playing**. You're live! 🎉

> **Common mistakes on setup day** - Pressing Begin Game with the Audience View closed — no problem, just open it; the show waits for you. - A team with no players — Begin Game stops and tells you which team. - The Quizmaster still listed in a team — Begin Game offers **Remove & Start**. - Forgetting that "Number of Rounds to Play" on *1 · Game* counts Mastermind It! Quick Setup's "Question Rounds" doesn't.

How the Mastermind It! question is selected

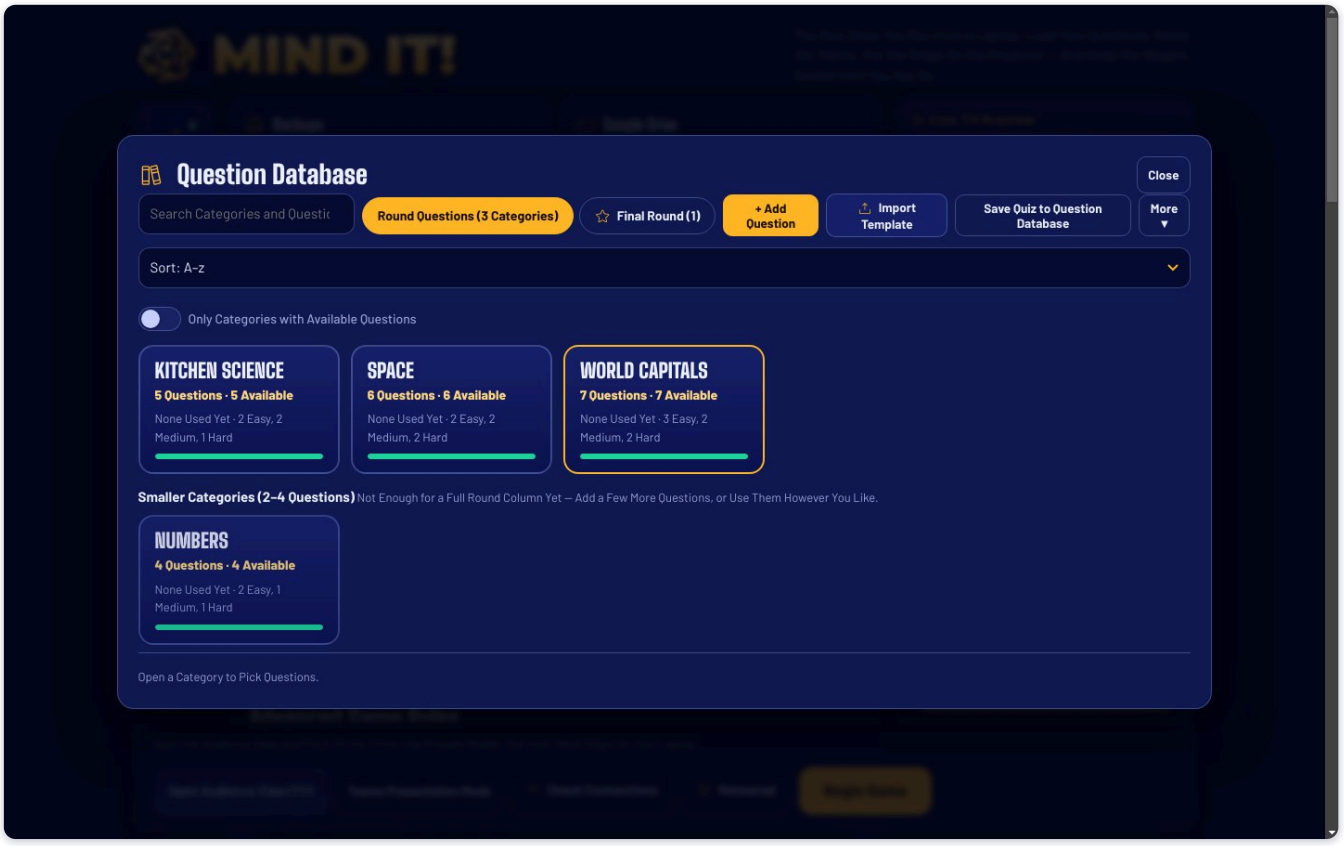
- Every quiz has **one Mastermind It! question** (category + question + answer + accepted alternate answers).
- When rounds are filled from the database, questions marked ⭐ **Mastermind It! Question** (and single-question categories) are kept for Mastermind It!; the **newest** Mastermind It! candidate becomes the Mastermind It! question.

- To choose a different one: **4 · Rounds & Questions → ⭐ Mastermind It! Question → ⇄ Switch Mastermind It! Question** (or the Question Database's ⭐ Mastermind It! tab). It warns if that question is already used in a round.
- **Once Mastermind It! has started, its question is locked** until the game ends (build 114): Switch Mastermind It! Question and "Use as Mastermind It!" say *Mastermind It! Question Locked*, and the Mastermind It! editor is greyed out (you can still change your host note and add accepted alternate answers).
- **Accepted Alternate Answers (comma-separated)** help the automatic answer checker (Chapter 18).
- Turn Mastermind It! off with **Mastermind It!: Off** — the game then ends after the last board round with "FINAL STANDINGS".

---

6. The Complete Question Database Guide

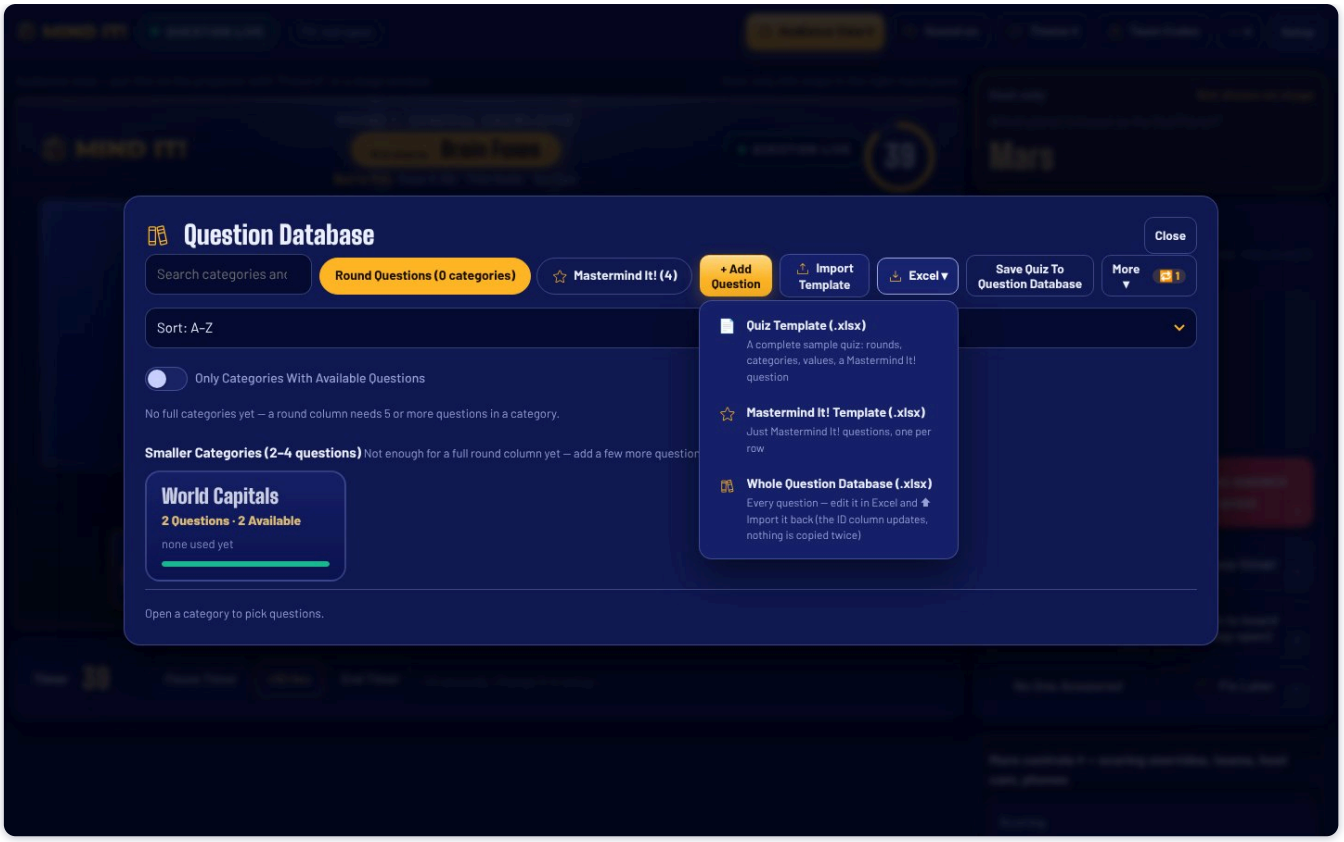
The **Question Database** is your library of questions, kept on the device and included in backups. Open it from 📚 **Question Database** (top of Setup) or 4 · Rounds & Questions.



📸 Real screenshot — the Question Database. Categories are shown as cards with counts.

6.1 Finding your way around

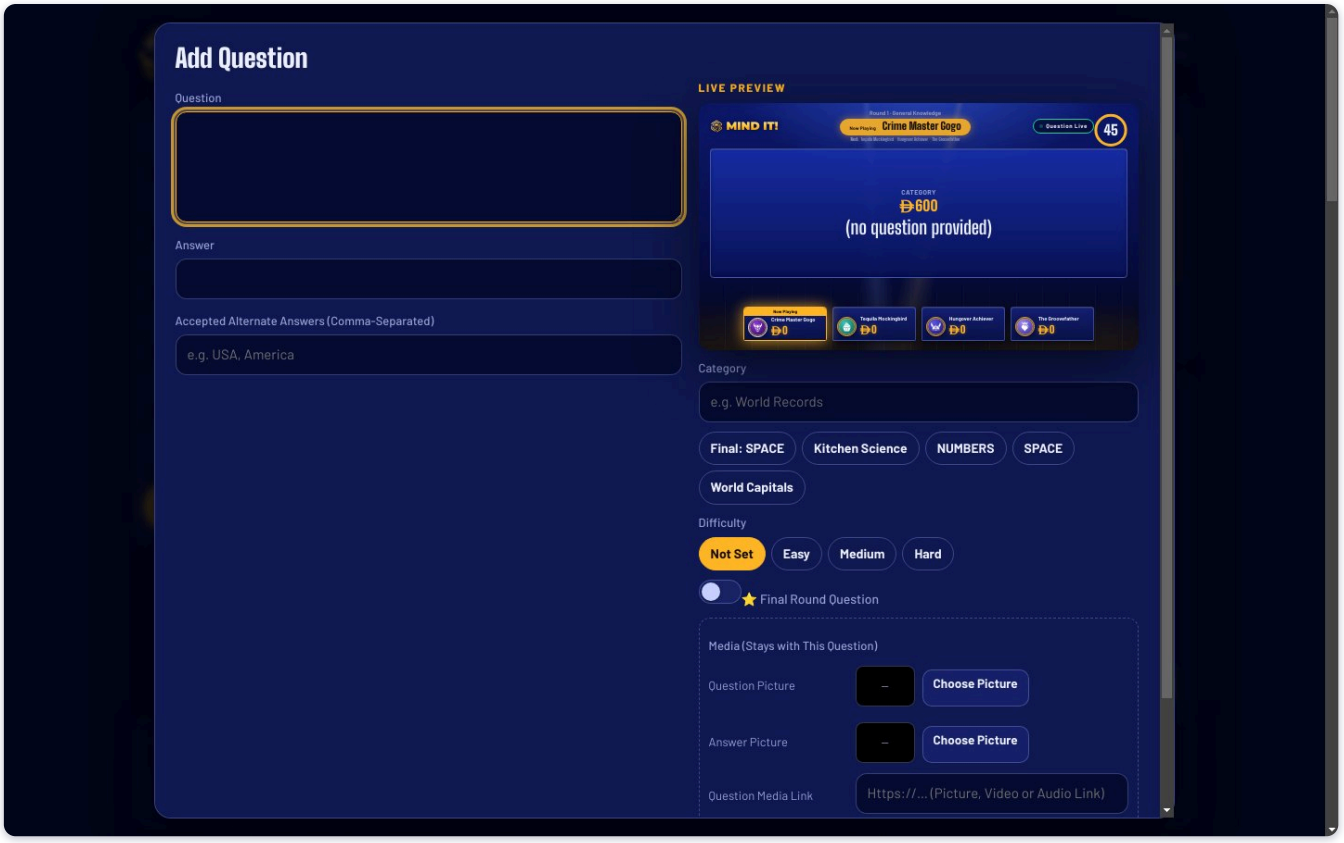
- **Round Questions (N Categories)** and ⭐ **Mastermind It! (N)** — two tabs.
- **+ Add Question**, ⬆ **Import Template**, ⬇ **Excel ▾** (since build 152: the blank **Quiz Template**, the **Mastermind It! Template** and the **Whole Question Database** — edit that one in Excel and ⬆ Import it back: the ID column updates questions instead of adding copies), **Save Quiz to Question Database**, **More ▾** (All Questions, Recently Added, 🔁 Duplicates, Export To Excel — since build 152 More ▾ shows a small 🔁 **N** when it has found duplicates).
- **Sort:** A–Z · Most Questions · Most Available. **Only Categories with Available Questions** hides used-up ones.
- Each **category card** says how many questions it has, how many are **available** (not used yet), and the mix of difficulties ("2 Easy, 2 Medium, 1 Hard").
- **Smaller categories (2–4 questions)** are listed separately — not enough for a full column of 5 yet.
- **Open a category** to see and select its questions.



📸 *Real screenshot (build 152) — ⬇ Excel ▾ in the top row, open.*

6.2 Adding a question

+ Add Question opens a form with a **Live Preview** of how it will look on the TV.

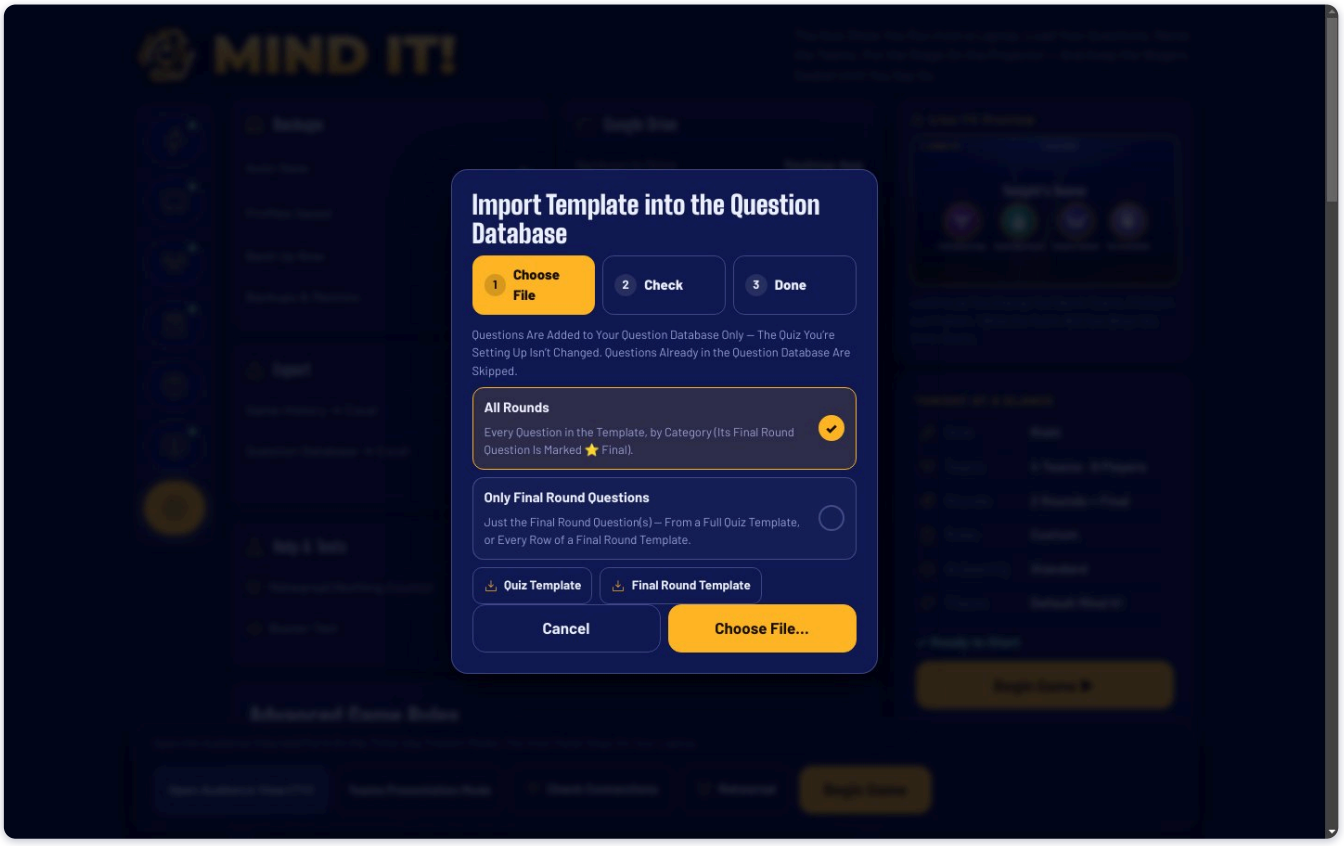


📸 *Real screenshot — Add Question.*

Fill in: **Question**, **Answer**, **Accepted Alternate Answers** (comma-separated), **Category** (pick one or type a new name — that *creates* the category), **Difficulty** (Not Set / Easy / Medium / Hard), ⭐ **Mastermind It! Question** (tick for Mastermind It! questions), and optional **media**: a Question Picture, an Answer Picture, a Question Media Link and an Answer Media Link. Then **Save**, or **Save & Add Another**.

6.3 Importing many questions at once

⬆ **Import Template** → **1 Choose File** → **2 Check** → **3 Done**. Choose **All Rounds** (every question, by category; its Mastermind It! question is marked ⭐) or **Only Mastermind It! Questions**. Download a blank ⬇ **Quiz Template** or ⬇ **Mastermind It! Template** from the same screen (or from ⬇ **Excel** ▾ in the top row, since build 152). Questions already in your database are **skipped** — no duplicates. *Questions are added to the Question Database only — the quiz you're setting up isn't changed.*



📸 *Real screenshot — Import Template into the Question Database.*

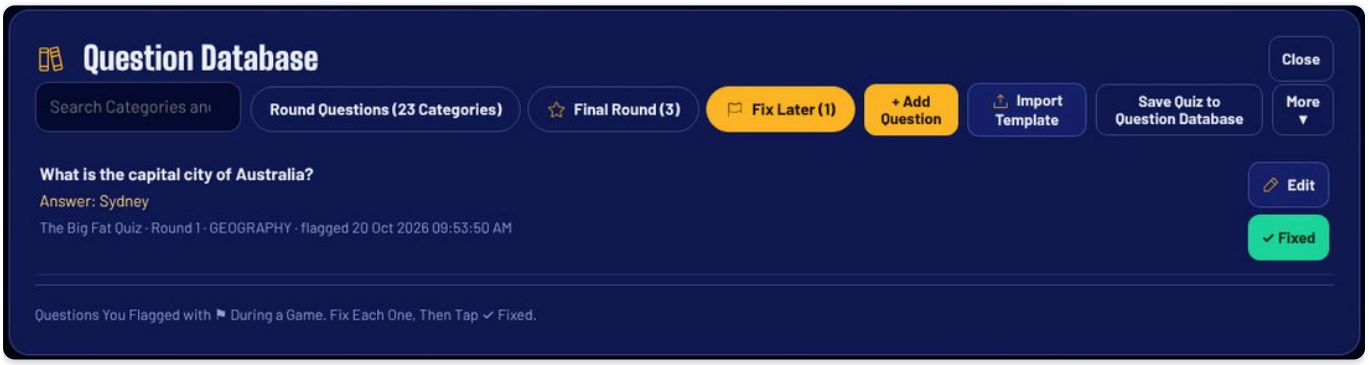
6.4 Editing, moving and deleting

Inside a category you can tick questions (**Select All**, **Select All Available**, **Select Unplayed**) and then:

- ✎ **Edit** a question (text, answer, alternates, difficulty, pictures). Edits flow into tonight's rounds and Mastermind It! by question ID — but **never** into questions already played, and **never** into Historic Games (those are frozen snapshots).
- **Move To Category** — move selected questions to another category.
- **Rename** — rename the category. (That's how you "edit a category".)
- **Delete From Question Database** / **Delete Category** — permanent; the app asks first. Save a backup before big clean-ups.
- ➕ **Add To Round** — put selected questions into the round you're editing (it skips duplicates within a round unless you tick "Allow the same question twice in one round").
- **Export As Quiz Template (.xlsx)**.

⚑ **Fix Later tab** (since build 141): every question you flagged with ⚑ **Fix Later** during a game is listed here, with its answer, the quiz, the round and the category. ✎ **Edit** opens it in the Question Database; a question that isn't in the database yet has

➕ **Add To Question Database** (it's added and opened for editing). When it's right, tap ✔ **Fixed** to take it off the list. The tab only appears while something is flagged; the list is kept with your players and history.



📸 *Real screenshot (build 141) — the ⚑ Fix Later tab.*

Moving questions, Rename, Delete Category (when it has questions), **+ New Category** and ⇄ (move a question to another round) open a small box: type, then **Enter** or **OK**; **Escape** or **Cancel** changes nothing. (Build 138 — before that these did nothing in the Windows and Mac app.)

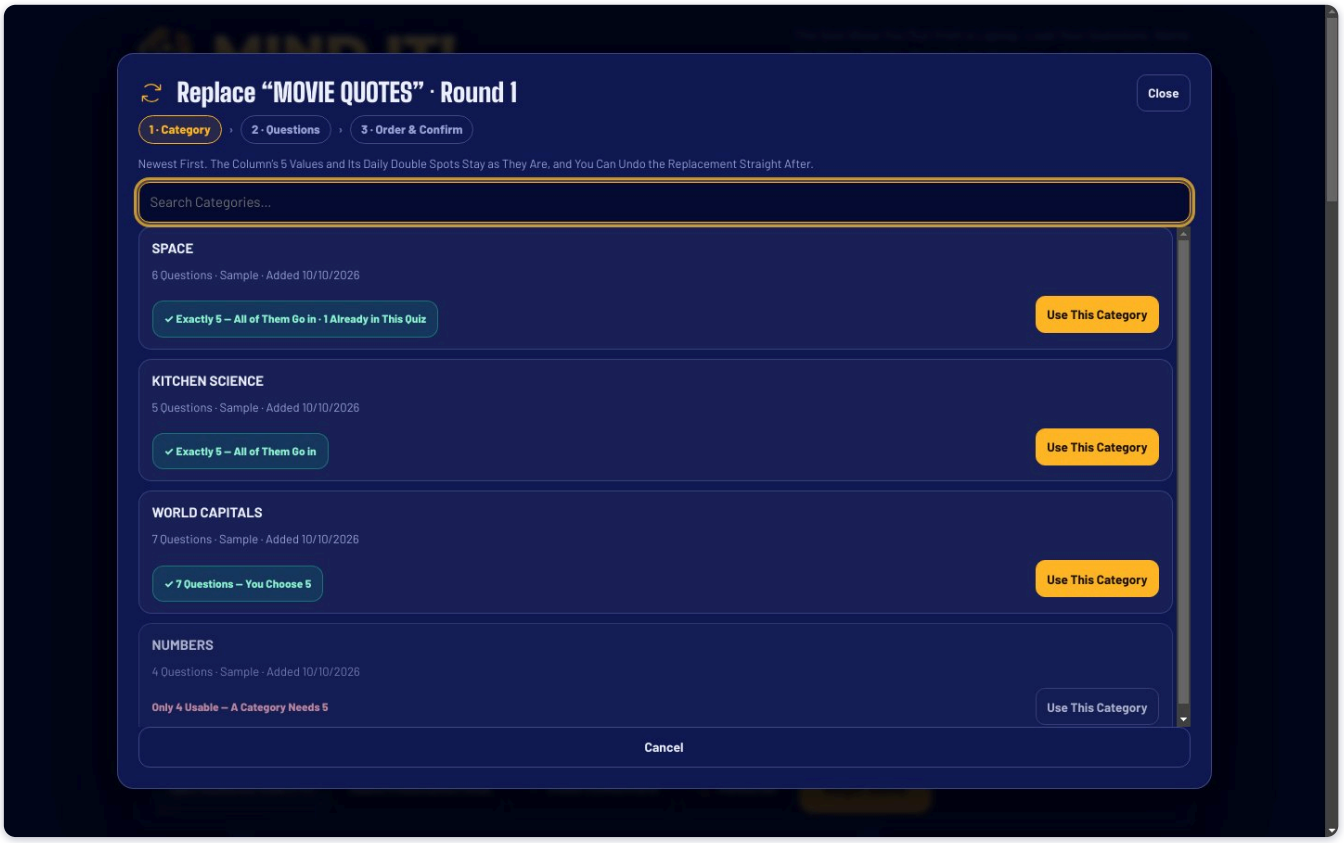
6.5 Searching, filtering, difficulty, preview

- **Search** boxes appear in the category list and inside the replace/choose screens (they search questions *and* answers).
- **Difficulty filter** chips: All · Easy · Medium · Hard · Not Set.
- 👁 **Preview** shows any question as the TV would, on a private copy. It never touches the timer, scores, wagers, the "used" flags, Historic Games, the TV, the tablet or the phones.

6.6 Replacing a category — choosing exactly five ✅

In **4 · Rounds & Questions**, every category has 🔄 **Replace**. Three steps: **1 Category › 2 Questions › 3 Order & Confirm**.

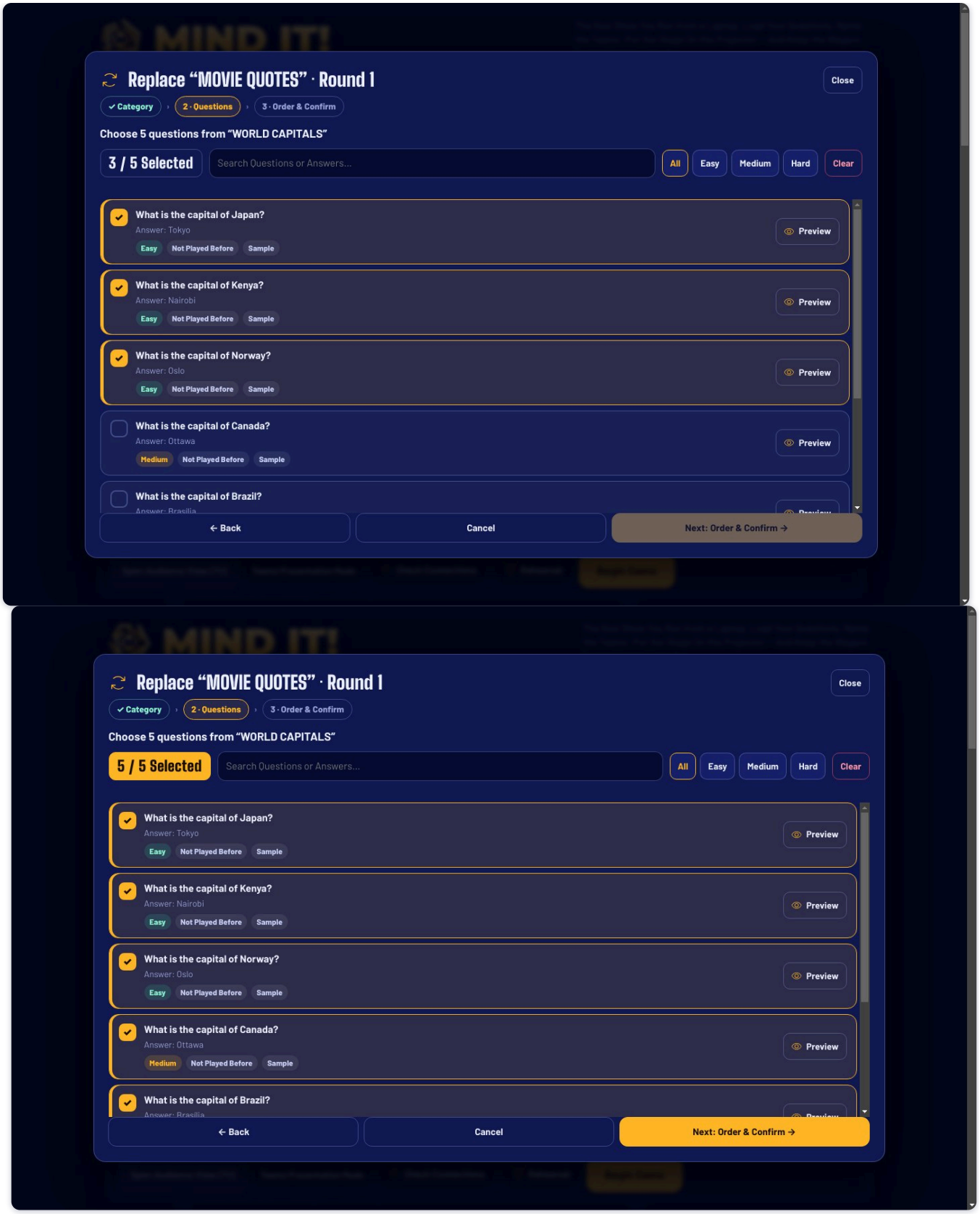
Step 1 — Category. Categories are listed newest first with a search box. Each shows how many usable questions it has:



📸 *Real screenshot — Replace "MOVIE QUOTES" · Round 1: choosing a category.*

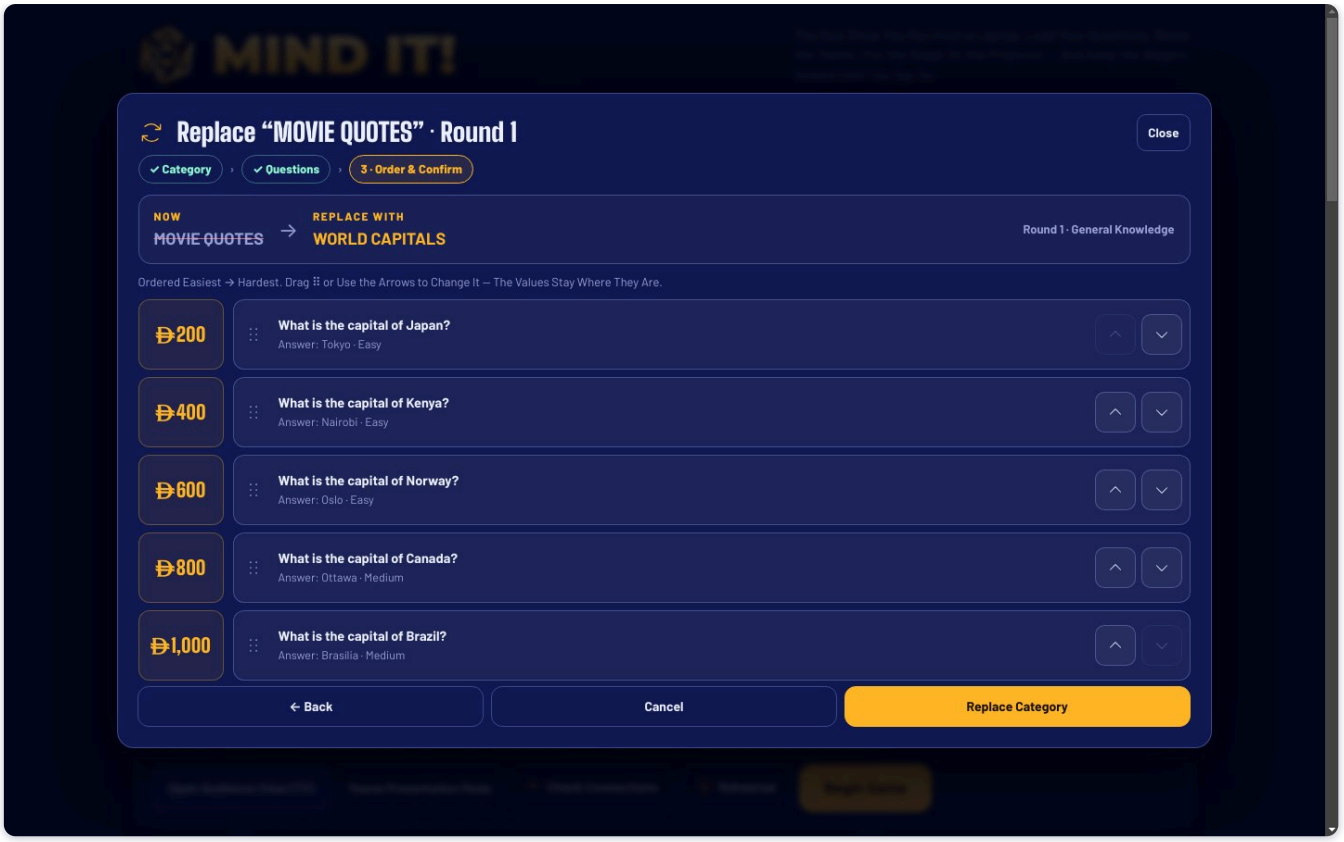
- **Exactly 5 usable** ("✓ Exactly 5 — all of them go in"): all five go in, no picking.
- **More than 5** ("✓ 7 questions — you choose 5"): you pick **exactly five** in step 2.
- **Fewer than 5** ("Only 4 usable — a category needs 5"): **blocked** — "Nothing has been changed" and **← Choose Another Category**.
- Questions already used elsewhere in this quiz (a round or Mastermind It!) are **never offered**.

Step 2 — Questions. The counter reads **"0 / 5 Selected"** and **Next: Order & Confirm →** stays greyed out until you have exactly 5. Use the search box, the difficulty chips and **👁 Preview**. Each question shows its difficulty and whether it was **played before**.



📸 *Real screenshots — choosing 5 of the 7 "WORLD CAPITALS" questions: 3 / 5 selected (Next is still greyed), then 5 / 5 (Next lights up).*

Step 3 — Order & Confirm. The five are ordered **easiest → hardest** by default. Drag them, or use the ▲▼ arrows. The values stay with the rows (200, 400, 600…), and **Blind It! spots stay where they were**. Press **Replace Category**.



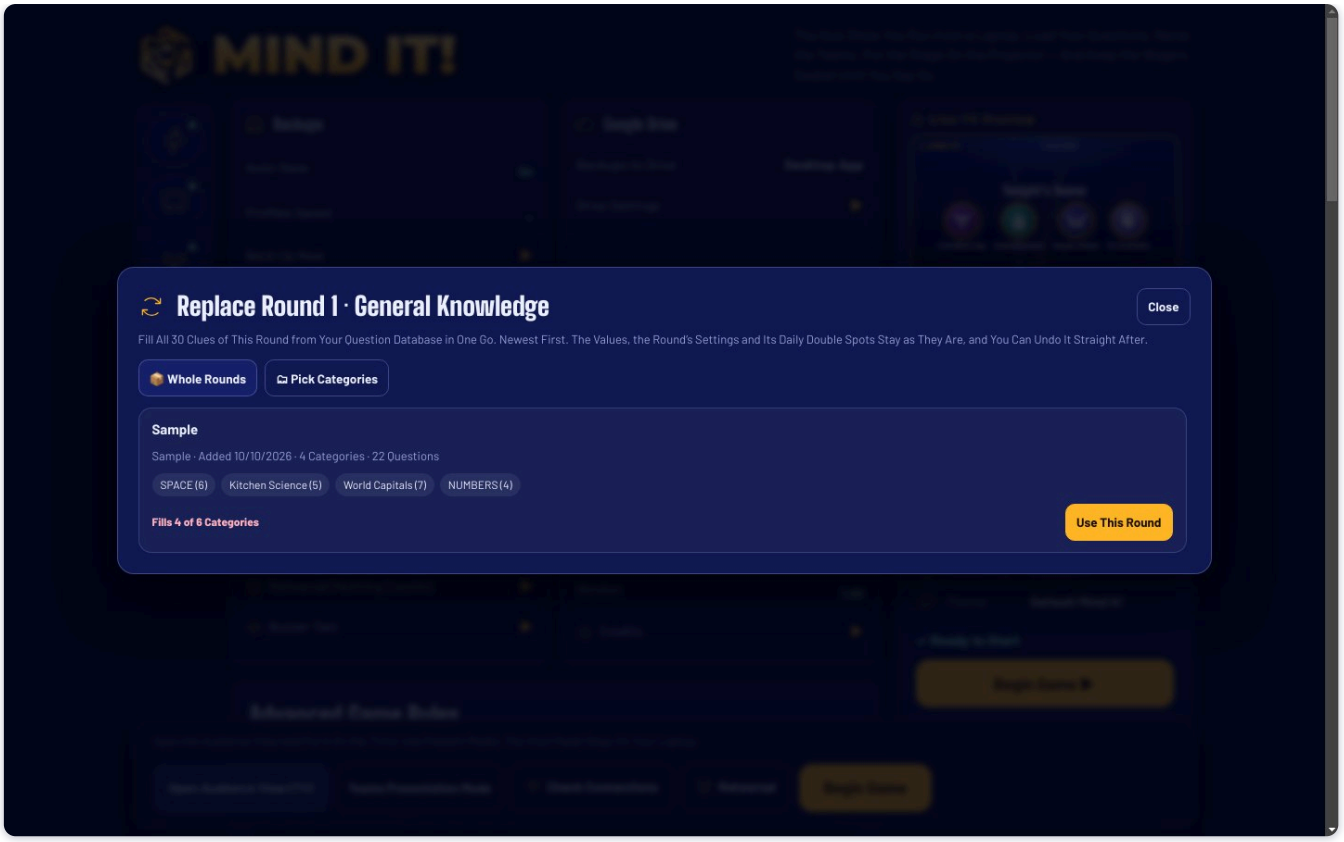
📸 Real screenshot — Order & Confirm: "Now MOVIE QUOTES → Replace with WORLD CAPITALS".

After replacing:

- It's **all-or-nothing** and you can **↩ Undo replace** straight after.
- Accepted alternate answers are copied; the Question Database itself is not changed.
- The editor **stays on the same round** you were editing, so you can carry on with the next category. (The open round tab — even the Mastermind It! tab — is remembered.)
- It is refused if a paused game has a question from that category open.

6.7 Replacing a whole round

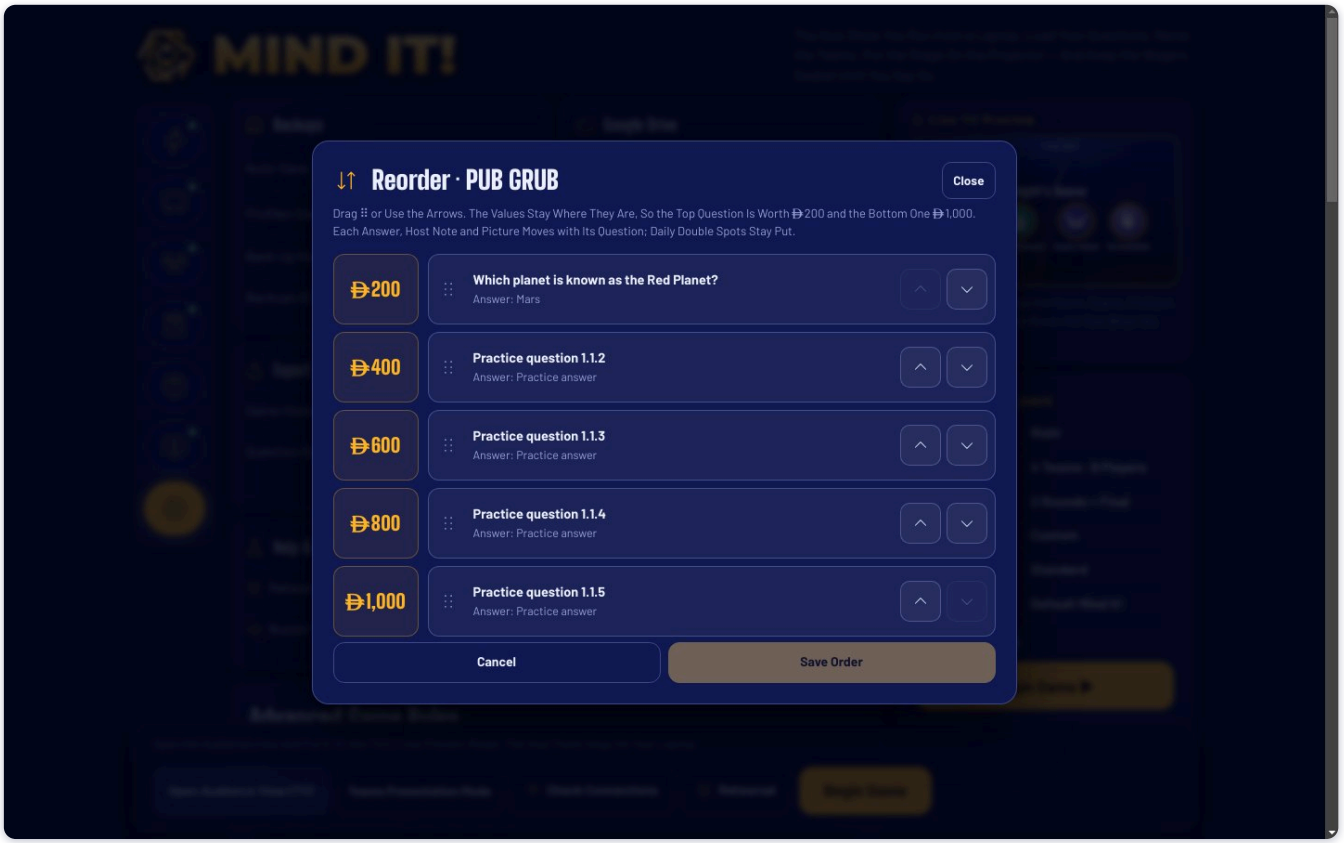
🔄 **Replace Round from Database** offers 📦 **Whole Rounds** (complete rounds, newest first, "✓ Fills the whole round") or 🗂 **Pick Categories** (tick up to 6, in board order). Values, round settings and Blind It! spots are kept, and there is **↩ Undo replace**. If any of the round's questions are **already in tonight's quiz** (another round or Mastermind It!), the list marks it (**⚠ 30 Already in Tonight's Quiz**) and the confirmation says how many and where, with **Replace Anyway** (build 114).



📸 Real screenshot — Replace Round 1.

6.8 Reordering questions in a category

↕ **Reorder** — drag a question up or down, or use the arrows. The **values stay with the row positions**, and **Blind It! spots stay in place** (by position). Played questions can't move while a game is paused. This is deliberate: the owner decided Blind It! spots stay where they are (October 2026).



📸 Real screenshot — Reorder · PUB GRUB.

6.8b Moving a whole category to another round (build 144)

↔ **Move** (under 🔄 Replace and ↕ Reorder) moves a whole category to another round. Every round is a fixed grid, so the category **swaps places** with the one you pick: tap a category in another round, or one in the same round to change its column, then **Swap**. Each question moves with its answer, alternates, host note, pictures and its Question Database link. The **values and Blind It! squares stay on their board** (the owner's rule), so a question moved into Round 2 is worth Round 2's value there. Greyed-out cards can't be picked: the category itself, one with a different number of questions, or (in a paused game) one with a played question. ↩ **Undo Move** at the top of the list puts both back straight after.

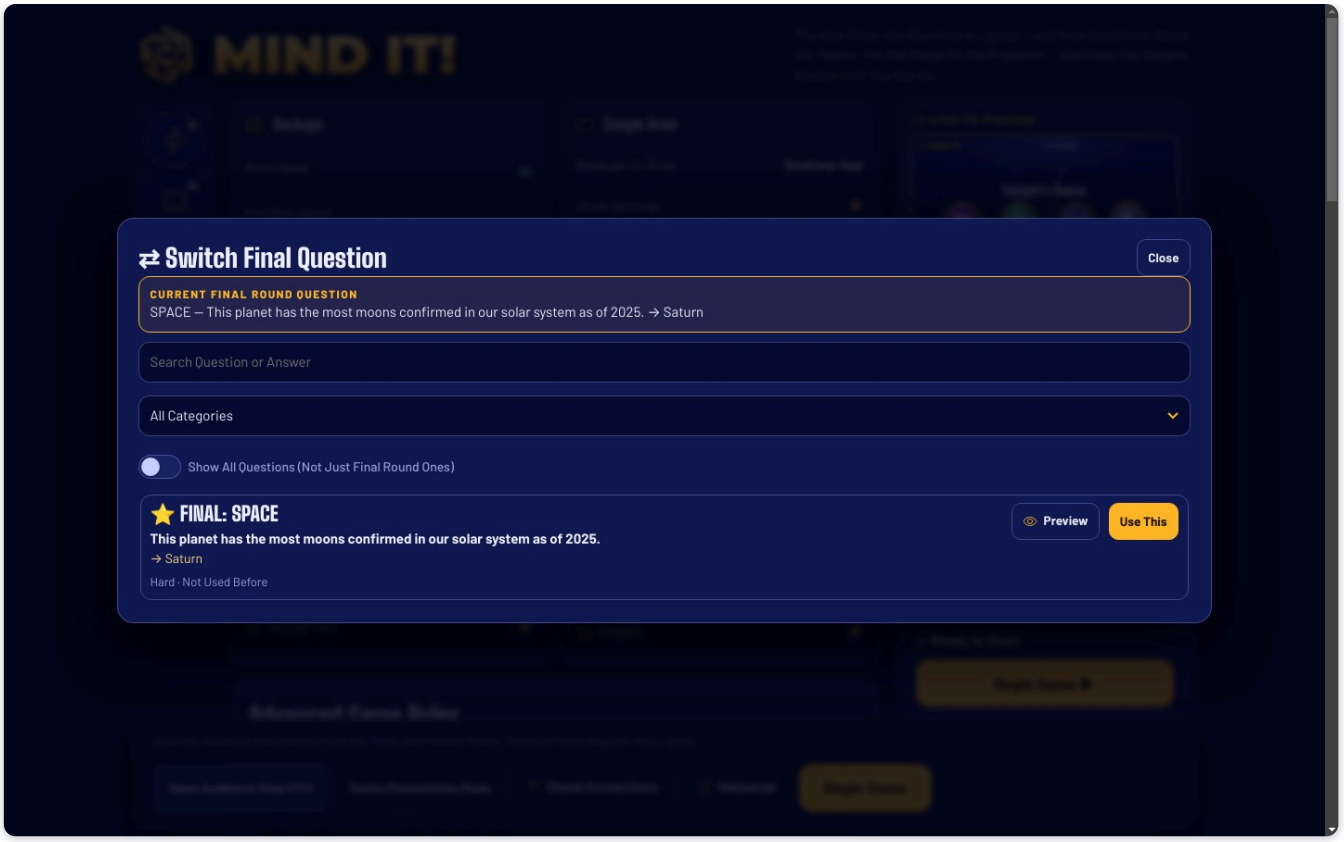
📸 *Real screenshot (build 144) — Move · SCIENCE.*

6.9 Reuse, duplicates and "used" questions

- **Used questions.** A finished game marks its questions as used ("Played 1× before"). Category cards count what is still **available**.
- **Reuse avoidance.** When rounds are filled automatically, questions that tonight's players saw in their **last 3 games** are avoided — as long as at least 80% of the needed questions can be fresh (gaps are never left). 🎲 **Play Again (New Questions)** also skips the last game's questions when at least 60 others exist.
- **Duplicates.** Importing skips questions you already have. Adding a duplicate to a round is refused unless you allow it. **More ▾ → 🔁 Duplicates** lists questions that look the same (merge them, or **Not Duplicates — Keep All**); since build 152 More ▾ shows how many groups it found.
- **Auto-add.** A finished game adds **all** its quiz questions to the database (not just the ones played). Loading a template does the same. Rehearsals never add anything.

6.10 Switching the Mastermind It! question

⇄ **Switch Mastermind It! Question** lists Mastermind It! questions (tick **Show All Questions** to see every question). Each has 👁 **Preview** and **Use This**. It warns if the question is already in a round. Once Mastermind It! has started, the Mastermind It! question is **locked** (build 114) — Switch Mastermind It! Question just says so.



📸 *Real screenshot — Switch Mastermind It! Question.*

6.11 Writing great questions (tips from experienced Quizmasters)

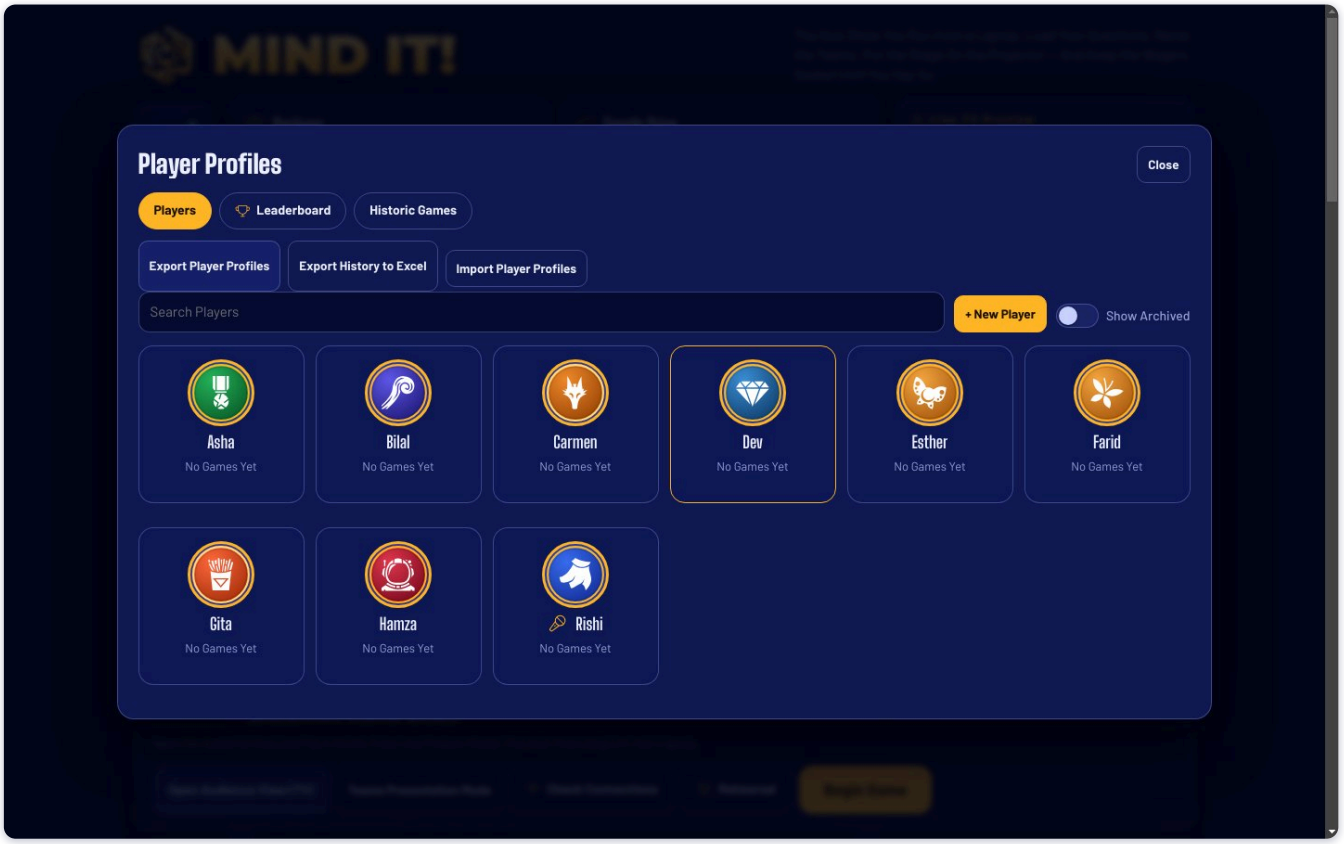
- **One clear answer.** "Which planet is known as the Red Planet?" — good. "Name a red thing in space" — argument guaranteed.
- **Add accepted alternates** for spellings and short forms (*Brasília, Brasilia*). Mastermind It!'s checker uses them.
- **Difficulty = how many teams would know it.** Easy: most of the room. Medium: about half. Hard: one team, if you're lucky. Put easy at 200, hard at 1,000.
- **Mix topics** across the six categories: something for the sports fan, the film buff, the foodie, the geek.
- **Balance rounds:** don't put all the hard questions in Round 1. Order each column easiest → hardest (Replace Category does this by default; ↕ **Reorder** lets you drag questions yourself).
- **Short questions read better on the TV.** Long ones aren't errors — they shrink to fit and show "ℹ Long — shown smaller on TV" — but they slow the game.
- **A strong Mastermind It! question** is answerable by everyone in one or two words, has a single correct answer, and sounds harder than it is. Avoid "as of" facts that may change — or say the date in the question, as in our example ("...as of 2025").
- **Check facts twice.** You'll be the one explaining it to a table of Tequila Mockingbirds.

PART THREE — TEAMS AND CONNECTIVITY

7. Teams, Players and Quizmaster

7.1 Players live in the Player Database

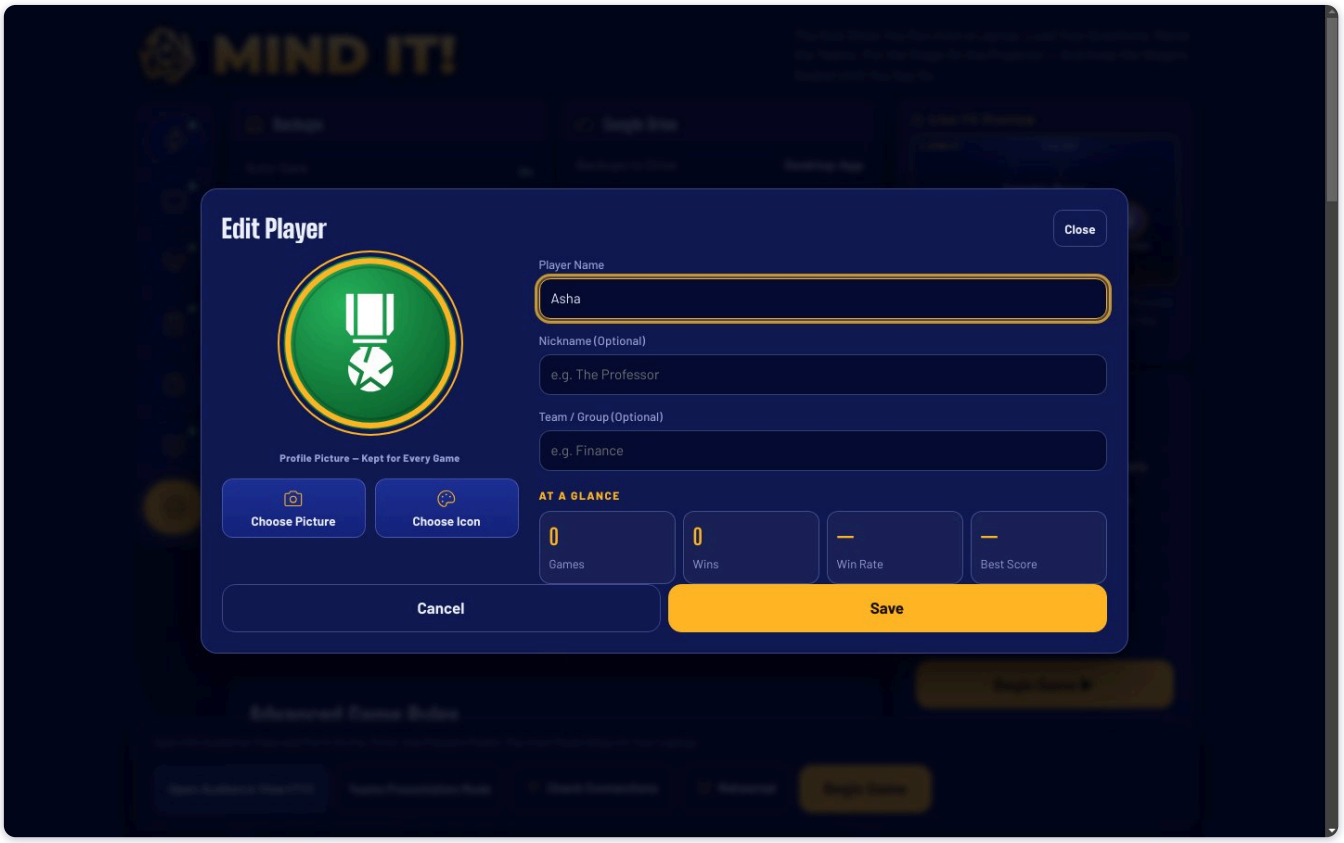
Mind It! remembers **people**, not just team names. Each person is created once in the **Player Database**, and their picture and statistics follow them from game to game. Open it from **2 · Teams & Players → 👥 Player Profiles** (or 6 · Advanced → 👥 All Players & Historic Games).



📸 Real screenshot — Player Profiles (tabs: Players · 🏆 Leaderboard · Historic Games).

- **+ New Player** — create a person.
- **Show Archived** — show people you archived (archiving hides someone without deleting their history).
- 🗑 **Delete** (on a player's own page, since build 124) — remove someone (7.2b); 🗑 **Recently Deleted** brings them back for 30 days (since build 125).
- ☑ **Select** (since build 125) — tick several players, then **Archive** or 🗑 **Delete** them together (7.2c).
- **Export Player Profiles / Import Player Profiles** — move all players, pictures and game records to another device. Import **merges**: nothing already there is lost, and the current game isn't changed.
- **Export History to Excel** — every Historic Game as a spreadsheet.

7.2 Creating and editing a player

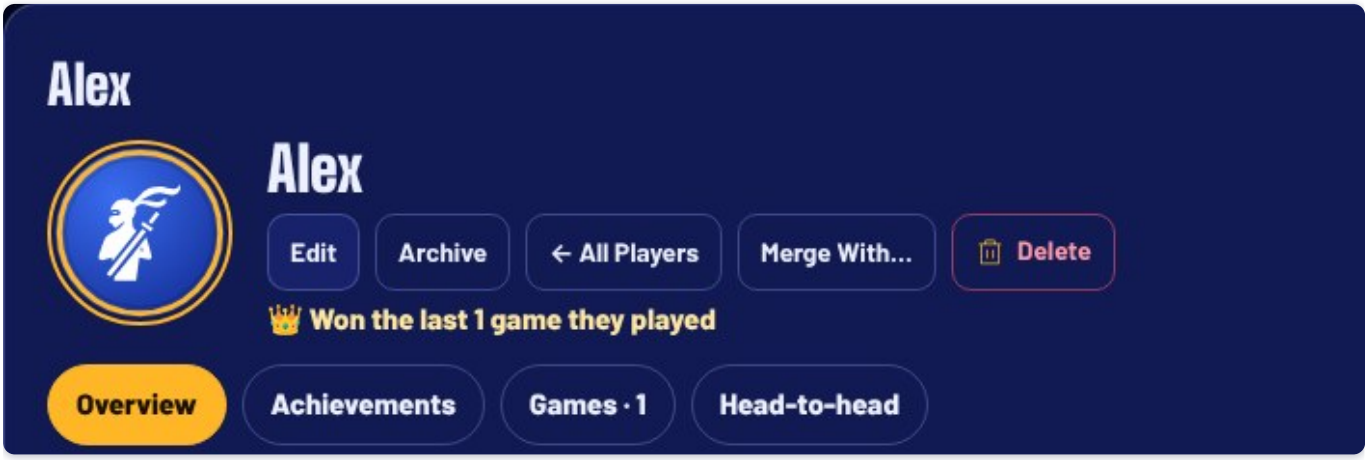


📸 *Real screenshot — Edit Player.*

Fields: **Player Name**, **Nickname (optional)**, **Team / Group (optional)**, and a **profile picture** — **Choose Picture** (a photo; iPhone HEIC photos are supported and can be cropped) or **Choose Icon** (one of the built-in badges). **At a Glance** shows games, wins, win % and best score. Names, nicknames and groups can be up to 40 characters. Press **Save**.

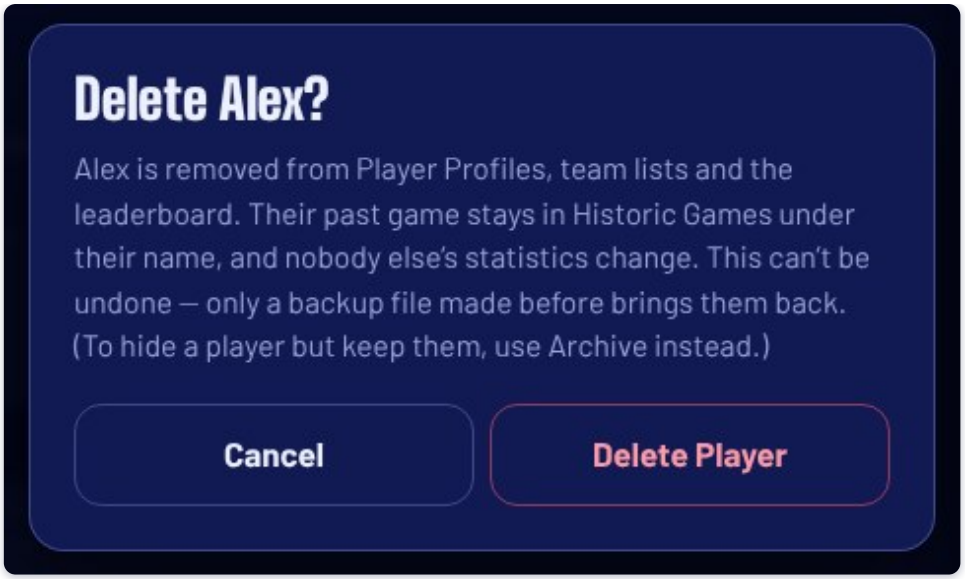
7.2b Deleting a player (since build 124)

Open the player (**Player Profiles → tap their name**) and press 🗑 **Delete** — the red button at the end of the row *Edit · Archive · ← All Players · Merge With…*.



📸 *Real screenshot — a player's page with 🗑 Delete (build 124).*

Mind It! asks first:



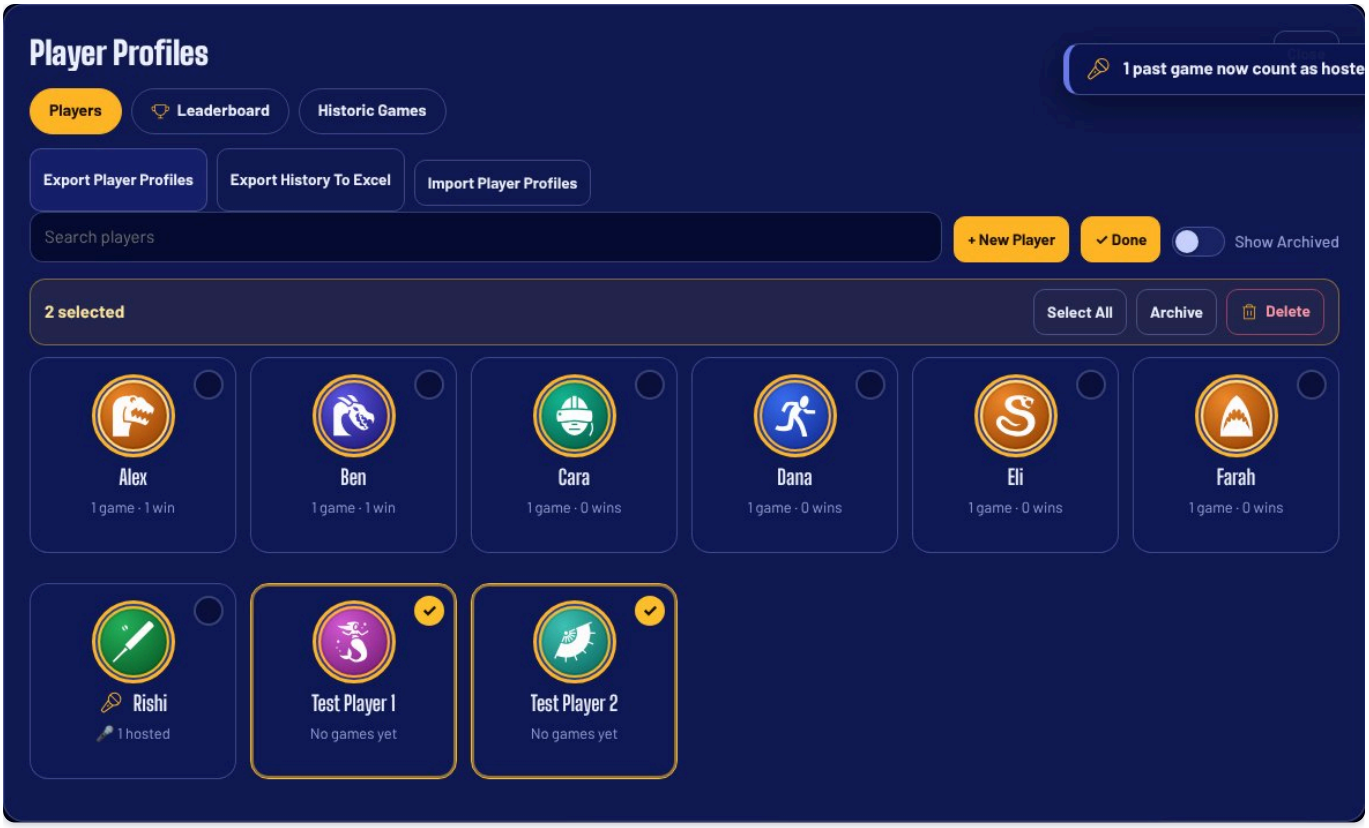
📸 *Real screenshot — the question before deleting.*

- **Delete Player** removes them from Player Profiles, the team lists, the Random Team Generator, the Quizmaster list and the leaderboard.
- **Their past games stay.** Historic Games still shows their name in the games they played, and **nobody else's statistics change**.
- **On Setup** they are taken off their team (and off Quizmaster) automatically. **During a game** you can't delete someone who is playing — finish or end the game first.
- **The tablet and the laptop** get the deletion the next time they sync, and a sync never brings the player back.
- **Changed your mind?** Since build 125: **Player Profiles → 🗑 Recently Deleted → ↻ Restore** brings them back — profile, picture and statistics — for **30 days**. After that only their name stays (in Historic Games). A **safety backup** is also made just before every deletion (22.3b). To hide someone but keep them, **Archive** is still there.

📸 *Real screenshot — 🗑 Recently Deleted (build 125).*

7.2c Selecting several players (since build 125)

Player Profiles → ☑ Select. Tap players to tick them (tap again to untick; **Select All** ticks everyone shown). Then **Archive** or **🗑 Delete** — one question for all of them. Players who are in the game being played are left out. **✔ Done** leaves Select mode.

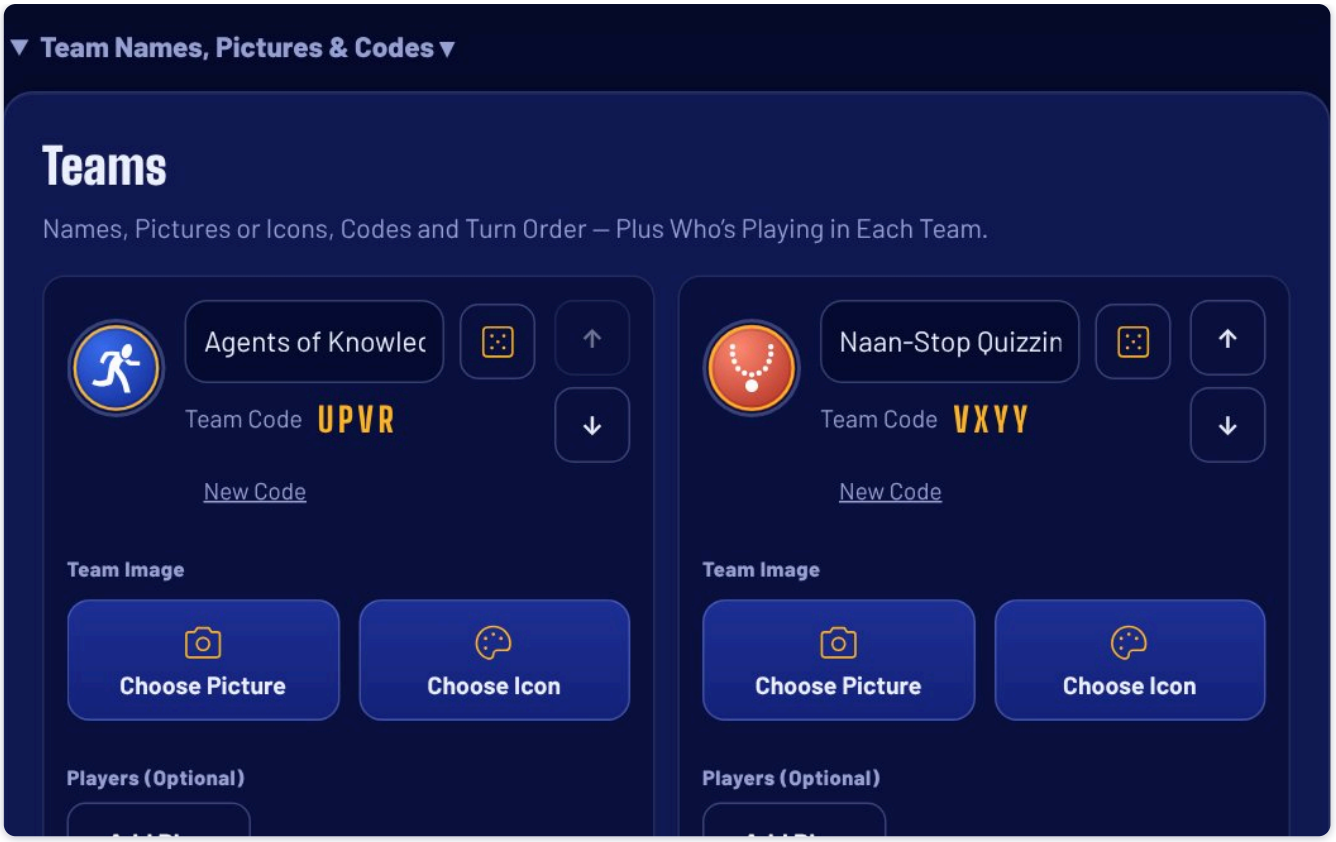


📸 *Real screenshot — Select mode with two players ticked.*

7.3 Teams

On **2 · Teams & Players**:

- **Number of teams:** 2–8 (default 4, named "Team 1–4" until you rename them). Mind It! needs at least 2 teams.
- ✎ on a team card: rename it, choose its **picture** or one of the built-in team icons.
- 🎲 **Fun names (since build 146):** the 🎲 beside a team's name box gives that team a fun quiz-team name no other team has ("Question Tarantino", "Quiztiano Ronaldo", "The Quiztice League"…); tap again for another. ⚡ **Quick Setup** → 🎲 **Fun Names** names every team at once. You can still type over any name.
- **+ Player** — add a person from the Player Database (or create one there and then).
- **Code XXXX** — the team's **4-letter phone code** (letters only, never shown on the TV). Codes are regenerated when a new game starts after one was played. A "New code" option exists if a code leaks (the old one then stops working).
- **A one-player team is that player:** it automatically uses the player's **name** and profile **picture**, and its name box is locked until a second player joins (then the team gets its old name back). A team with several players uses its own name and its own picture or icon. Every team always has a picture.
- **Rules Begin Game checks:** every team needs at least one player; nobody may be in two teams; a player who no longer exists can't be in a team; the Quizmaster can't be in a team.



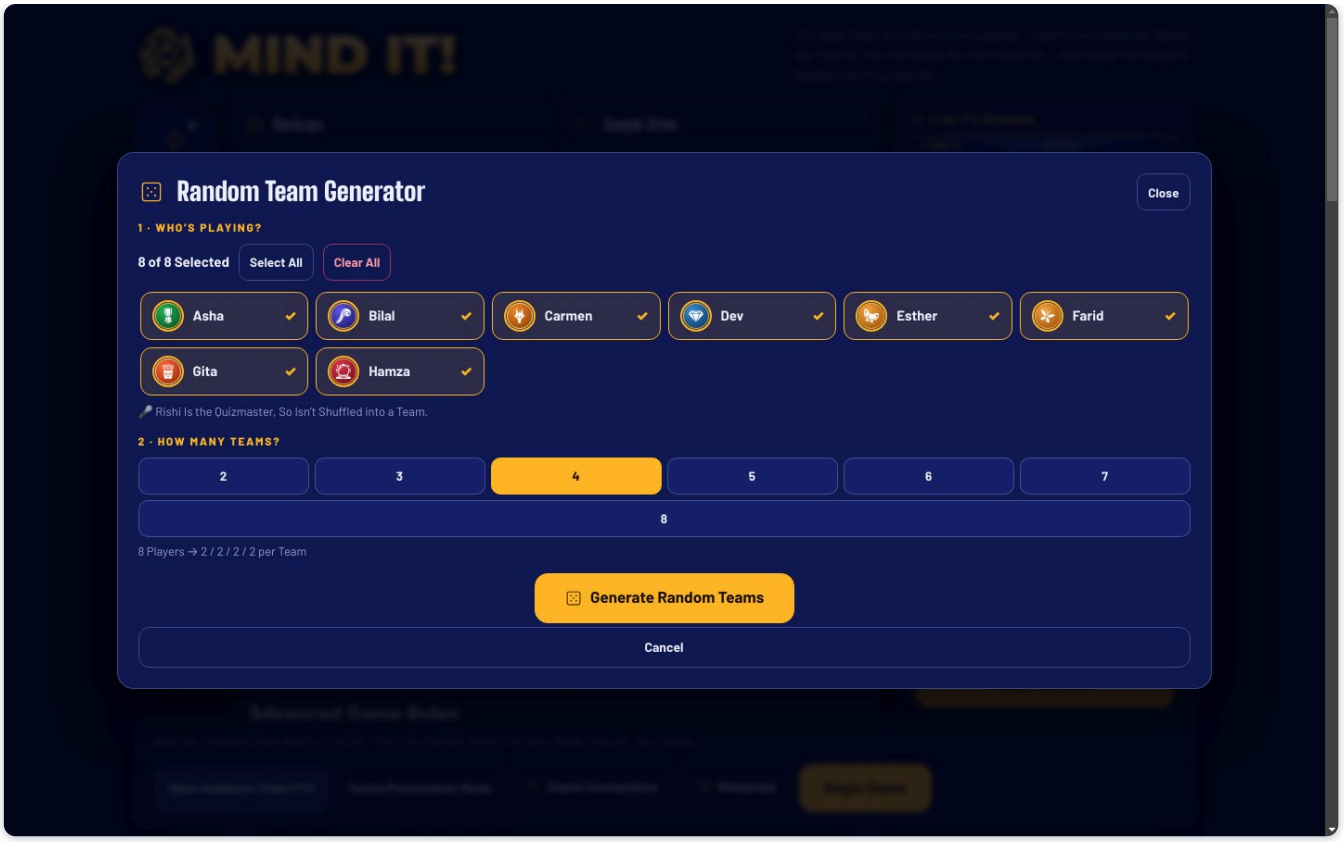
📸 *Real screenshot (build 146) — 2 · Teams & Players: the 🎲 beside each team's name.*

7.4 Random teams

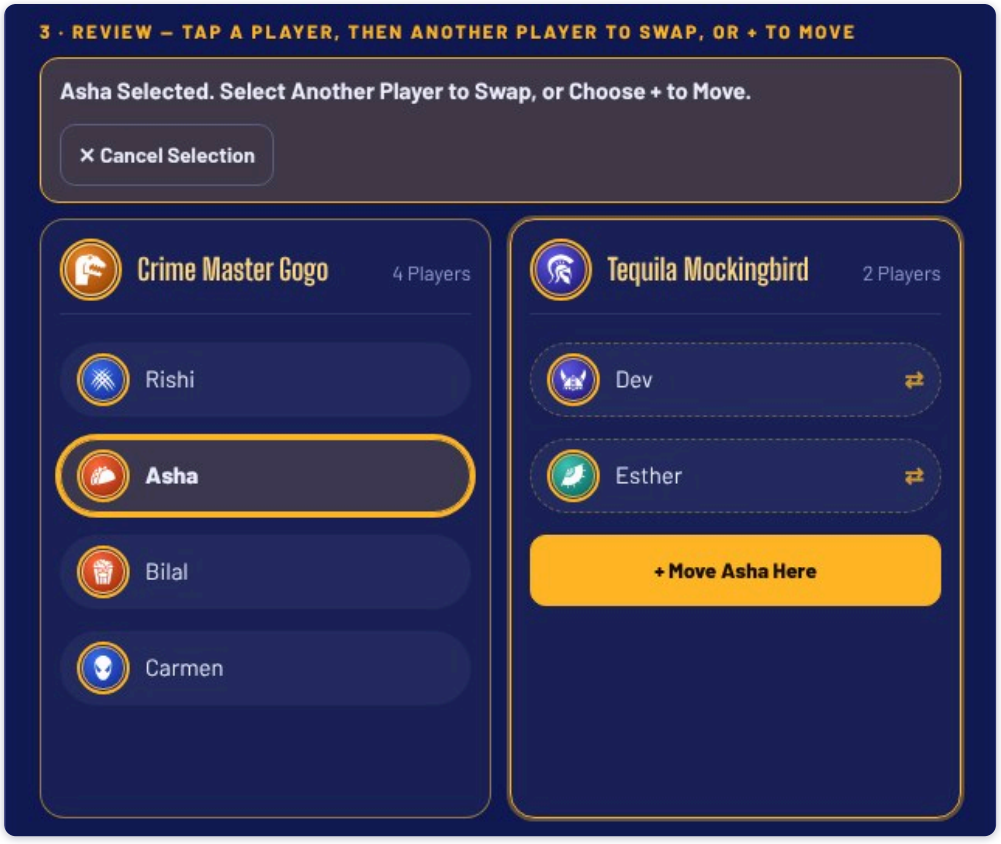
🎲 **Random Teams** opens the **Random Team Generator**: tick **who's playing**, choose **how many teams** (2–8, never more teams than players), and press 🎲 **Generate Random Teams**. Teams are split as evenly as possible (e.g. 11 players into 4 teams = 2/3/3/3). The Quizmaster is never shuffled into a team.

Balancing the teams by hand (build 120) — nothing is regenerated and nothing needs confirming until you're happy:

- **Swap:** tap a player (they light up), then tap a player on **another** team — the two change places. Tapping the same player again, or ✕ **Cancel Selection**, cancels; tapping someone else on the **same** team just selects them instead.
- **Move:** tap a player, then **+ Move <name> here** on another team. The **+** glows on teams with fewer players. A team's only player can't be moved out (every team needs at least one) — swap instead.
- ↶ **Undo Last Change** steps back through your swaps and moves; ⟲ **Reset to Generated Teams** (asks first) puts the shuffle back.
- ✓ **Confirm Teams** saves the teams exactly as they are on screen.



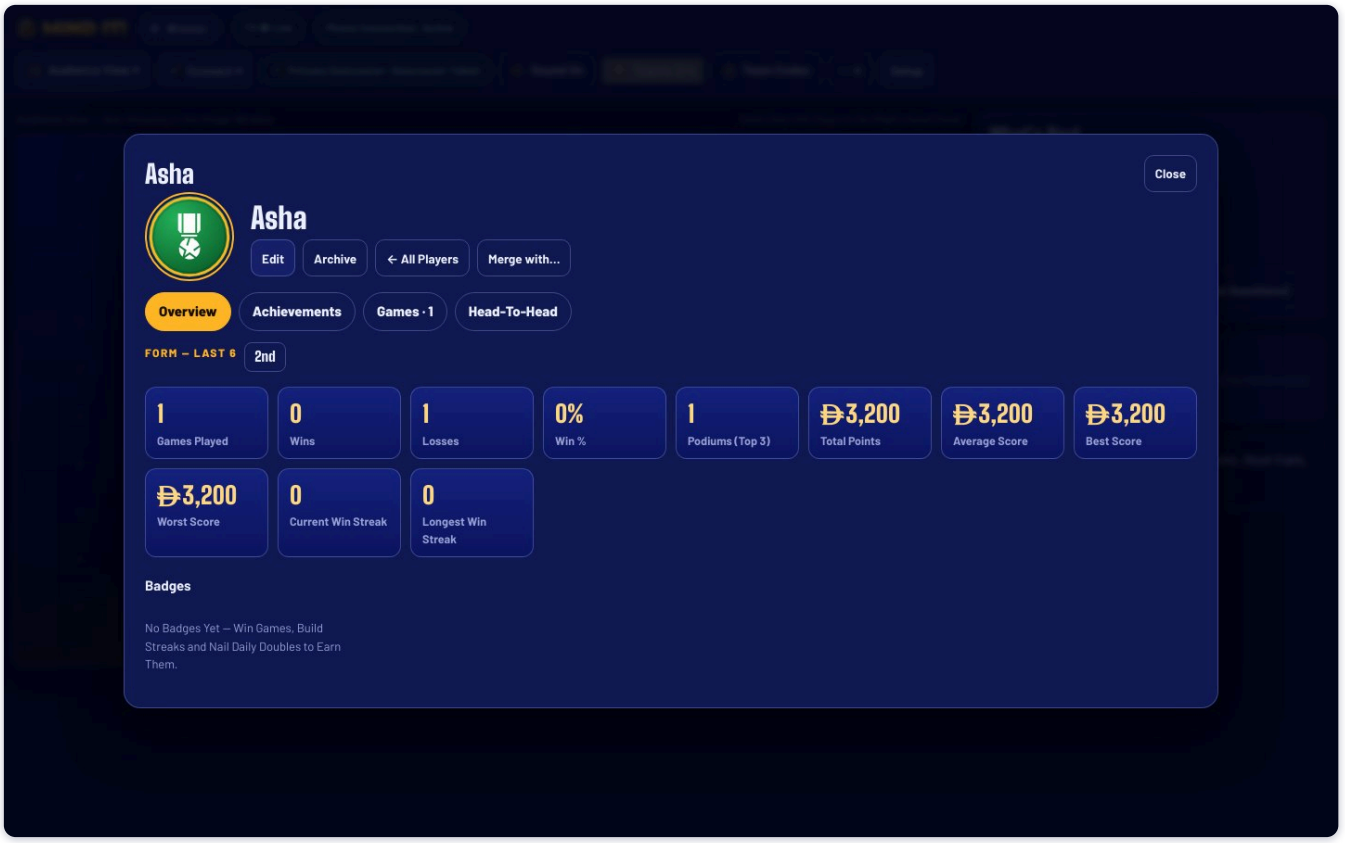
📸 *Real screenshot — Random Team Generator: 8 players → 2 / 2 / 2 / 2 per team.*



📸 *Real screenshot (build 135) — Asha selected: ⇄ marks the players she can swap with, and "+ Move Asha Here" glows on the smaller team.*

7.5 Player statistics and host statistics

Tap a player (or **Stats & History** on their card) to open their page: **Overview · Achievements · Games · Head-to-Head**, plus host statistics if they have hosted. Statistics are worked out from the saved game records, so they are always consistent with history.



📸 *Real screenshot — a player's page after one game.*

Player stats (🎮) and **host stats (🎤)** are kept separately. A game counts as *hosted* or *played* for a person — never both.

7.6 The Quizmaster rule — one person, one role

- **Exactly one Quizmaster per game**, chosen in **2 · Teams & Players → 🎤 Quizmaster → Host**.
- **The Quizmaster can't play in a team in the same game.** The Host list shows who is already playing ("Asha — Playing in Crime Master Gogo"), and says "The Quizmaster can't also play in a team."
- **Default Quizmaster:** every new game picks the (non-archived) player named **Rishi** when that profile exists; otherwise the last Quizmaster.
- **If Rishi wants to play:** press 🎮 **Rishi Wants to Play** (the button uses the current Quizmaster's name). You must **choose** a replacement Quizmaster — someone who isn't playing, or "+ New Person To Host". Nothing is swapped automatically.
- **If you pick someone who is playing** as Quizmaster, the app asks first, then removes them from their team.
- **If the Quizmaster is still in a team at Begin Game**, the game won't start; it offers a one-tap **Remove & Start**.
- Rishi's own profile is never deleted or changed by any of this.

✅ *Verified in the app's automated tests and in the setup screens shown above.*

---

8. Connecting Player Phones

Phones don't install anything. They open a web page served **by the laptop** over your Wi-Fi.

8.1 Step by step

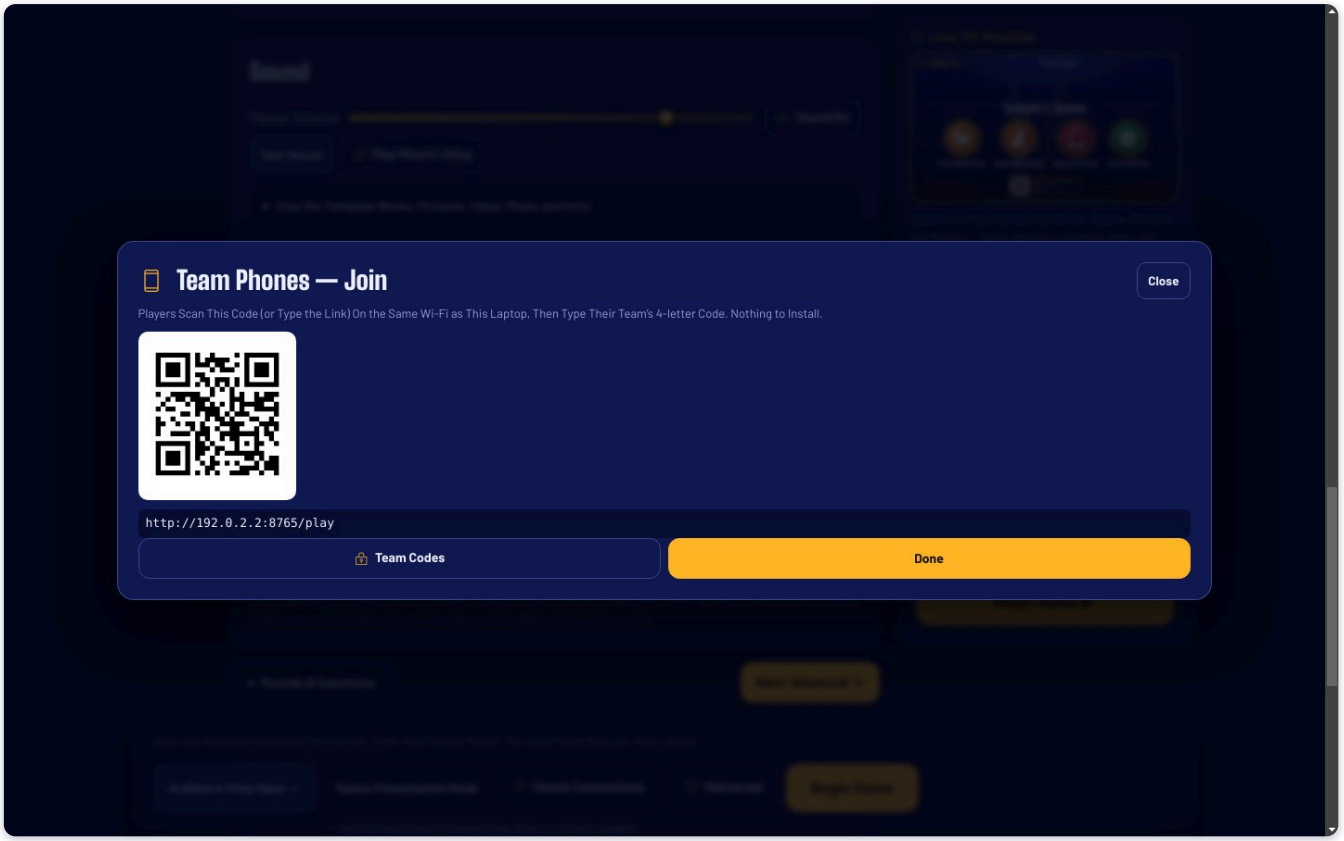
1. **Show the QR code.** The easiest way: **the TV shows it** ("Scan to Join Your Team", with the link and "Then Type Your Team Code") from the moment the Audience View opens until Round 1 starts — at the bottom of the welcome screen, and in the top-right corner of *Tonight's Teams* so it never covers a team. (Switch: 5 · Audio & Presentation → *Show the Phone Join QR Code On the TV Before the Game*.) The same code is also in: - 📲 **Connect ▾ → 📶 Devices → Phone Join QR (for Teams)** — opens 📱 **Team Phones — Join** with the code, the link and a 🔐 **Team Codes** button; - **Setup → 6 · Advanced → 5 · Phones & Live Wagers** (the join QR code and the **Join Link**, e.g. `http://192.168.1.20:8765/play`); - **More controls → Phones → Join Link & QR Code** during a game.

The TV also shows a QR code automatically whenever wagers are open ("Scan to enter your wager").

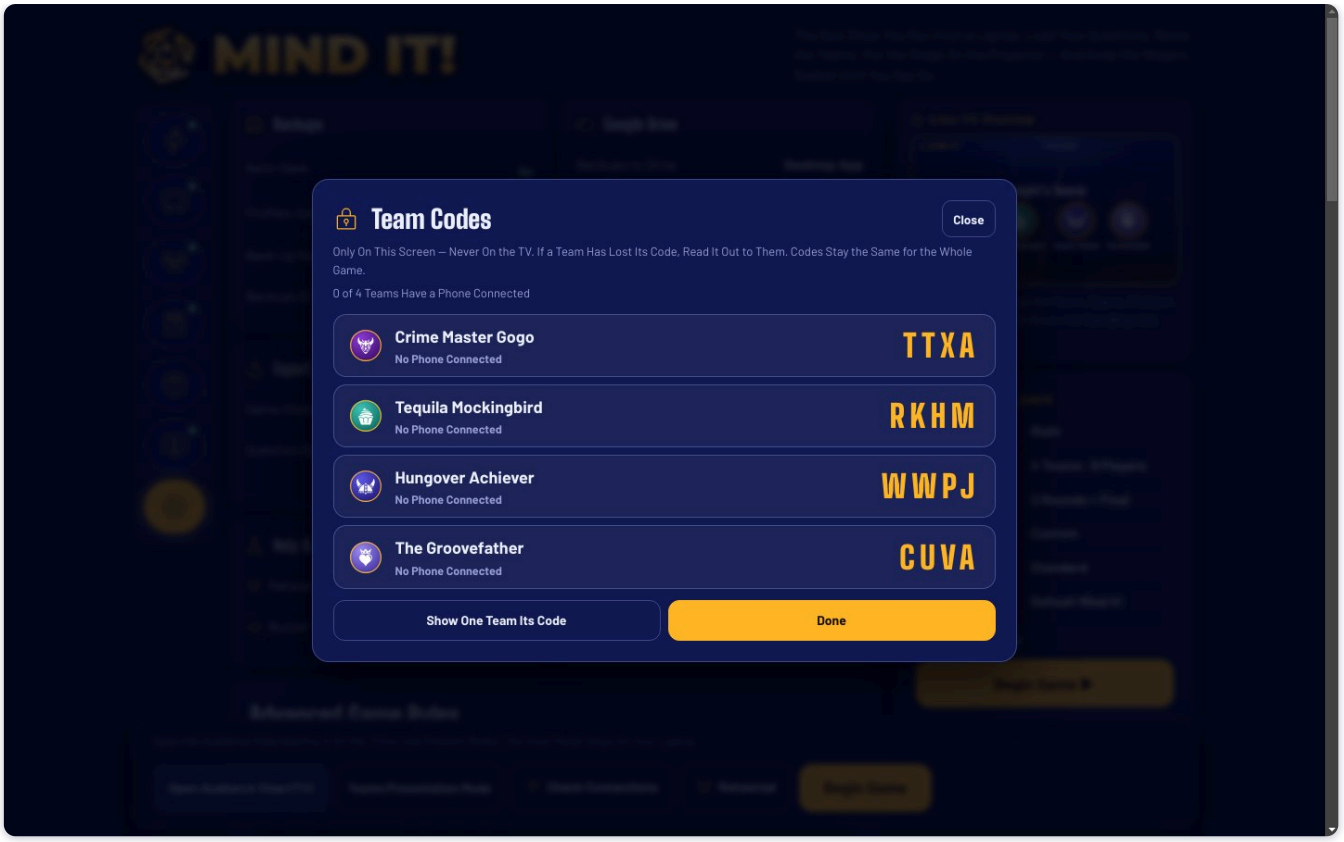
📸 *Real screenshot — the join QR code and link in Setup (6 · Advanced).*

2. **Scan it.** iPhone: open the **Camera** and point it at the code, then tap the yellow link. Android: use the camera or Google Lens. (Or type the link into the browser.)
3. **The player page opens:** "Enter Your Team Code".
4. **Type the team's 4-letter code** and tap **Continue**. The Quizmaster reads codes from 🔐 **Team Codes** (top bar) — only on the host screen, never on the TV. **Show One Team Its Code** shows one team's code big enough to show them privately.
5. **You're in.** The phone shows the team name, its score and place ("=1st of 4"), and **Eyes On the TV**.
6. **Check it worked.** On the laptop, the top bar shows 📶 **Teams x/y** (connected teams) and 🔐 Team Codes shows "✓ Phone Connected" per team. Several phones per team are fine — the first phone to submit a wager "owns" it.

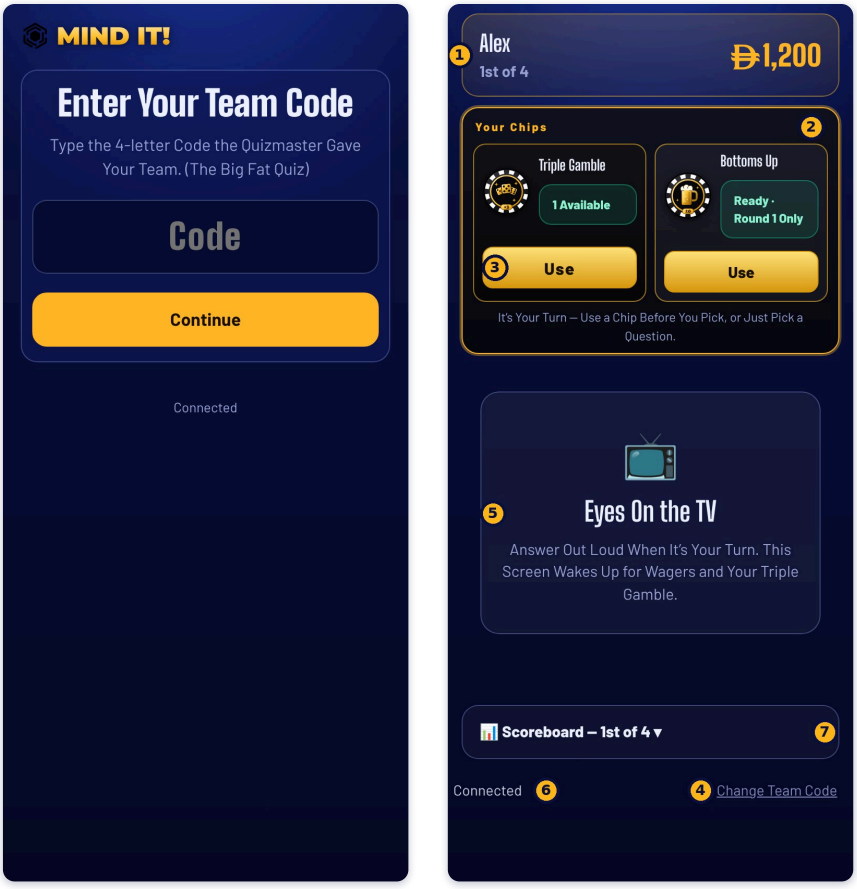
📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — the TV on Tonight's Teams: the join code sits in the top-right corner so it never covers a team.*



📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — 📲 Connect ▾ → 📶 Devices → Phone Join QR (for Teams).*



📸 *Real screenshot — 🔐 Team Codes (host only).*



📸 *Real screenshots — joining (left) and a joined phone between questions (right).*

The joined phone, explained:

1. **Your team card** — the team's initial, name, place ("1st of 4") and score; the countdown shows here while a question runs. Since build 146, **Your Turn to Pick!** appears under it when it's your team's turn to choose a category and value.
2. **Your Chips** — the special chips the team still holds (Chapter 12).
3. **Use** — switch a chip on, *before* picking a question, on your own turn.
4. **Change Team Code** — signed into the wrong team? Tap this and type the right code. Since build 119 it sits at the bottom, beside the connection status.
5. **Eyes On the TV** — "Answer out loud when it's your turn. This screen wakes up for wagers and your Triple Gamble."
6. Connection status (see 8.4).
7. 📊 **Scoreboard** — tap to see all scores, with each team's correct answers (✓ 3) since build 113.

> ✅ **Fixed in build 112:** in build 111 the Devices button (then called *Phone Join Link / QR*) wrongly opened the Quizmaster's 📱 Phone Remote. It is now **Phone Join QR (for Teams)** and shows the players' join code. If you ever showed the old Phone Remote code to a room, open **Connect ▾ → Phone Remote** and press **New PIN (Disconnects Remotes)** or **Turn Remote Off**.

8.2 What phones are used for

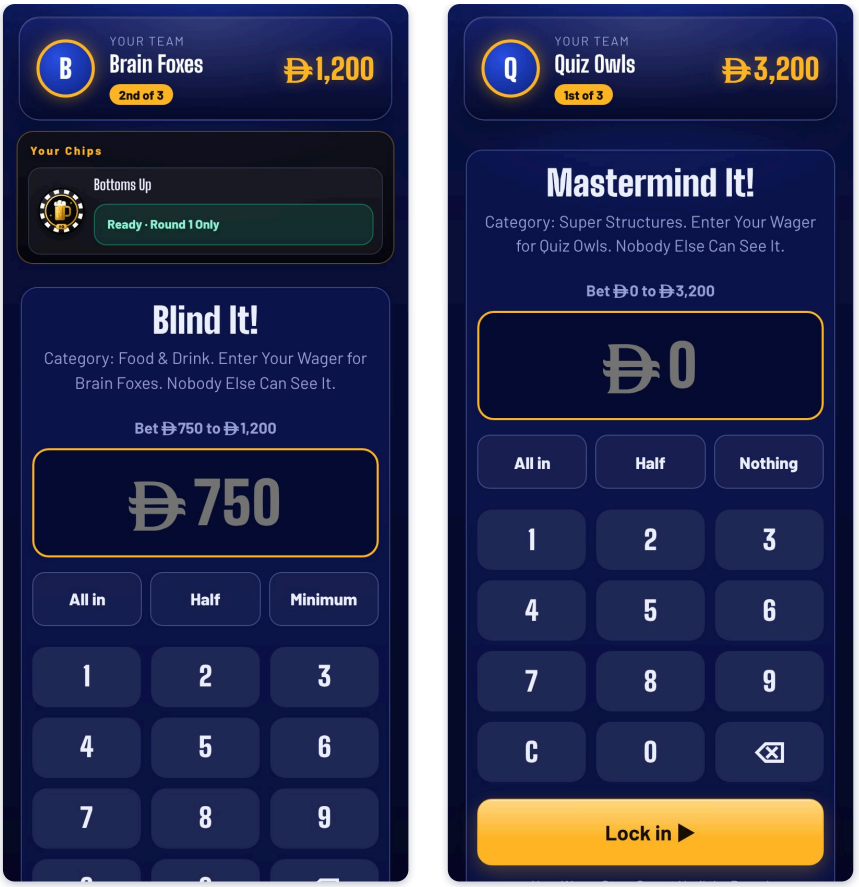
Phone job	When
Secret wagers	Blind It! question (the team that found it) and Mastermind It! (every eligible team).
Special chips	Triple Gamble, Phoenix, Bottoms Up — on the team's own turn, before picking.
Buzzer	Only in **Phone Buzzer Mode**.
Mastermind It! answer	Each team types and locks one answer in Mastermind It! — before time runs out (answers close 2 seconds after time's up, build 114).
Scores	Always — the team's score, place and the scoreboard.

Normal answers are spoken out loud. In Standard Mode the phone never shows the question or the answer.

📳 **Phones vibrate when they're needed** (build 114): when it becomes the team's turn to pick, and when its Blind It! question or Mastermind It! wager opens. 🟡 Android phones only — iPhones don't let web pages vibrate — and not tested on real phones.

8.3 Submitting a wager (the short version)

When it's time, the phone wakes up with a keypad: type the amount (or tap **All in / Half / Minimum** — in Mastermind It!: **All in / Half / Nothing**) and press **Lock in ▶**. It says **Wager Submitted ✓**. A locked wager can't be changed by the team — only the Quizmaster can change it (Chapter 18).



📸 *Real screenshots (build 151) — a Blind It! wager (left) and a Mastermind It! wager (right).*

8.4 Disconnections and reconnecting

- **Phones stay signed in.** If a phone locks, a player switches apps, or the laptop restarts, the phone reconnects by itself when it can. Nobody needs to re-type the code.
- When a phone is locked or in the background it tells the laptop and checks in less often (it saves battery); Connection Health shows it as **Asleep / In Background**. It wakes up when unlocked.
- A small status line appears only when there's a problem: **Connection Unstable** (amber), **Reconnecting to Host…** (amber), **Connection Lost — Retrying…** (red), then a brief green **Connected** when it's back. It never covers the screen once the phone has joined.
- **Wrong team?** Tap **Change Team Code**.

8.5 Phone troubleshooting

Problem	Android	iPhone
The QR code opens nothing	Use the camera app or Google Lens; or type the link into Chrome.	Use the Camera app (not a QR app with adverts); tap the yellow banner. Or type the link into Safari.
"This site can't be reached" / spins forever	Turn **mobile data off** and make sure the phone is on **the same Wi-Fi** as the laptop. Some phones switch to mobile data when the Wi-Fi "has no internet" — tap "Stay connected" / "Keep Wi-Fi".	Same Wi-Fi as the laptop; turn off **Private Relay** or any VPN; check *Settings → Wi-Fi → (network) → Limit IP Address Tracking* is off if it misbehaves.
Works for some phones, not others	Guest/hotel/office Wi-Fi often blocks devices from seeing each other. Turn on the **laptop's mobile hotspot** and have everyone join it.	Same.

Problem	Android	iPhone
"Team code rejected"	Check the code in 🔐 **Team Codes** (letters only, no zero/O confusion — codes only use the letters A C D E F H J K M N P R T U V W X Y).	Same.
The phone shows an old game	Pull down to refresh the page.	Pull down to refresh in Safari. Opened from a **home-screen icon** (8.6)? There's no refresh: swipe up to the app switcher, swipe Mind It! away, and tap the icon again.

🟡 Real iPhones and Android phones were not tested for this guide (they were simulated in a browser at phone size).

8.6 Mind It! on the home screen (iPhone and iPad) 🟡 — since build 126

A team phone, or the Quizmaster's 📱 Phone Remote, can have its own **Mind It! icon** on the home screen, so it opens like an app — full-screen, with no Safari address bar.

1. Start Mind It! on the laptop and join as usual (8.1): scan the QR code, so Safari opens the player page. For the Quizmaster: scan the 📱 **Phone Remote** code (Connect ▾ → Phone Remote).
2. In Safari tap **Share** (the square with an arrow) → **Add to Home Screen** (on newer iPhones it may be under ⋯ → **Share**). Leave **Open as Web App** on if it's offered.
3. The name is already **Mind It!** and the icon is the gold **M** logo. Tap **Add**.
4. Next time, tap the icon instead of scanning. The laptop must be running Mind It!, and the phone on the same Wi-Fi.

Good to know:

- **The first time you open the icon, type the team code again.** A home-screen app keeps its own sign-in, separate from Safari's.
- **The icon remembers the laptop's address.** On a different Wi-Fi (another house, the laptop's hotspot) the laptop usually gets a new address, so the icon won't connect. Scan the code again and add a new icon (delete the old one).
- **Phone Remote:** the icon also remembers the remote's PIN. After **New PIN (Disconnects Remotes)**, scan the new code and add the icon again.
- **No refresh button.** If it ever looks stuck, swipe it away in the app switcher and tap the icon again.
- **The screen locking pauses it.** It reconnects by itself when unlocked (8.4), but keep the phone awake during wagers and Mastermind It!
- **Android phones:** Chrome's ⋮ → **Add to Home screen** gives the same icon. Because the laptop's address is a plain `http://` address, Chrome opens it as a normal tab, not full-screen.
- The webpage *file* (4.1c) can't do this, so for a team phone or remote the icon must come from the laptop app's join or remote link. (The **hosted webpage**, 4.1c, can be put on the home screen too — but as a quiz on its own, not as a team phone.)
- **The full Quizmaster remote** (since build 127) works the same way: scan the **iPad / iPhone** code in 📲 Connect Device, then Add to Home Screen (Setup B2).

🟡 Checked on the build machine with a phone-sized browser pretending to be an iPhone, not on a real iPhone or iPad. Try it once at home before a quiz night.

---

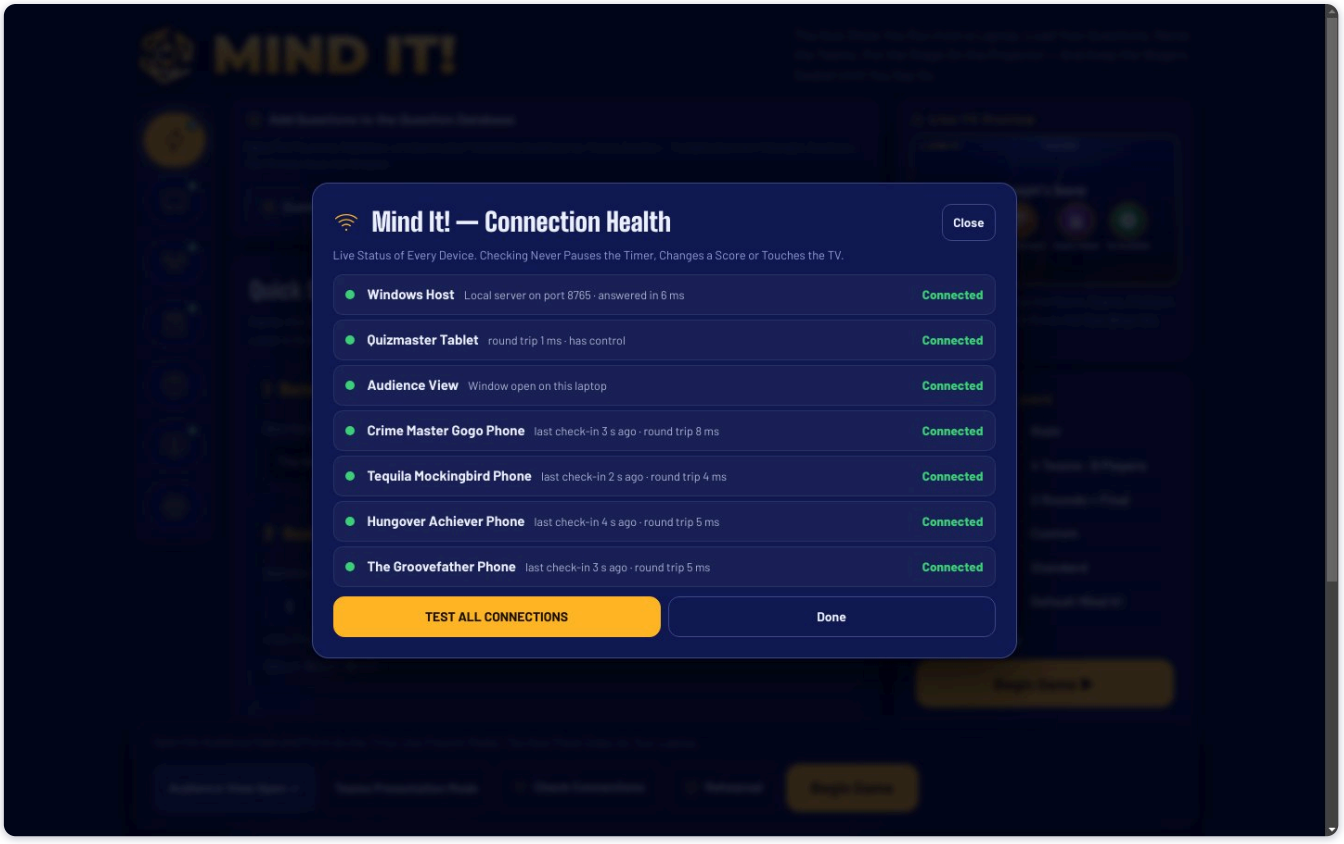
9. Connection Health and Pre-Game Checks ✅

9.1 Opening it

- In Setup: 📶 **Check Connections** (bottom bar).
- During a game: tap the 📶 **Teams x/y** chip in the top bar.
- On the tablet: its own connection sheet (tap the status at the top).

The window is called 📶 **Mind It! — Connection Health**. *Checking never pauses the timer, changes a score or touches the TV.*

9.2 What each line means



📸 *Real screenshot — everything connected (tablet, TV window and four phones).*

Line	What it checks	Typical detail
Windows Host	The laptop's own local server (port 8765).	"Local server on port 8765 · answered in 6 ms"
Quizmaster Tablet	The tablet's live link.	"round trip under 1 ms · has control"
Audience View	Whether the TV window is open on this laptop.	"Window open on this laptop" / "Not open"
<Team> Phone (one per team)	When that team's phone last checked in, and how fast.	"last check-in 2 s ago · round trip 8 ms"

Status words and colours:

Status	Colour	Meaning (phones)
Connected	🟢 green	Checked in within the last 4 seconds.

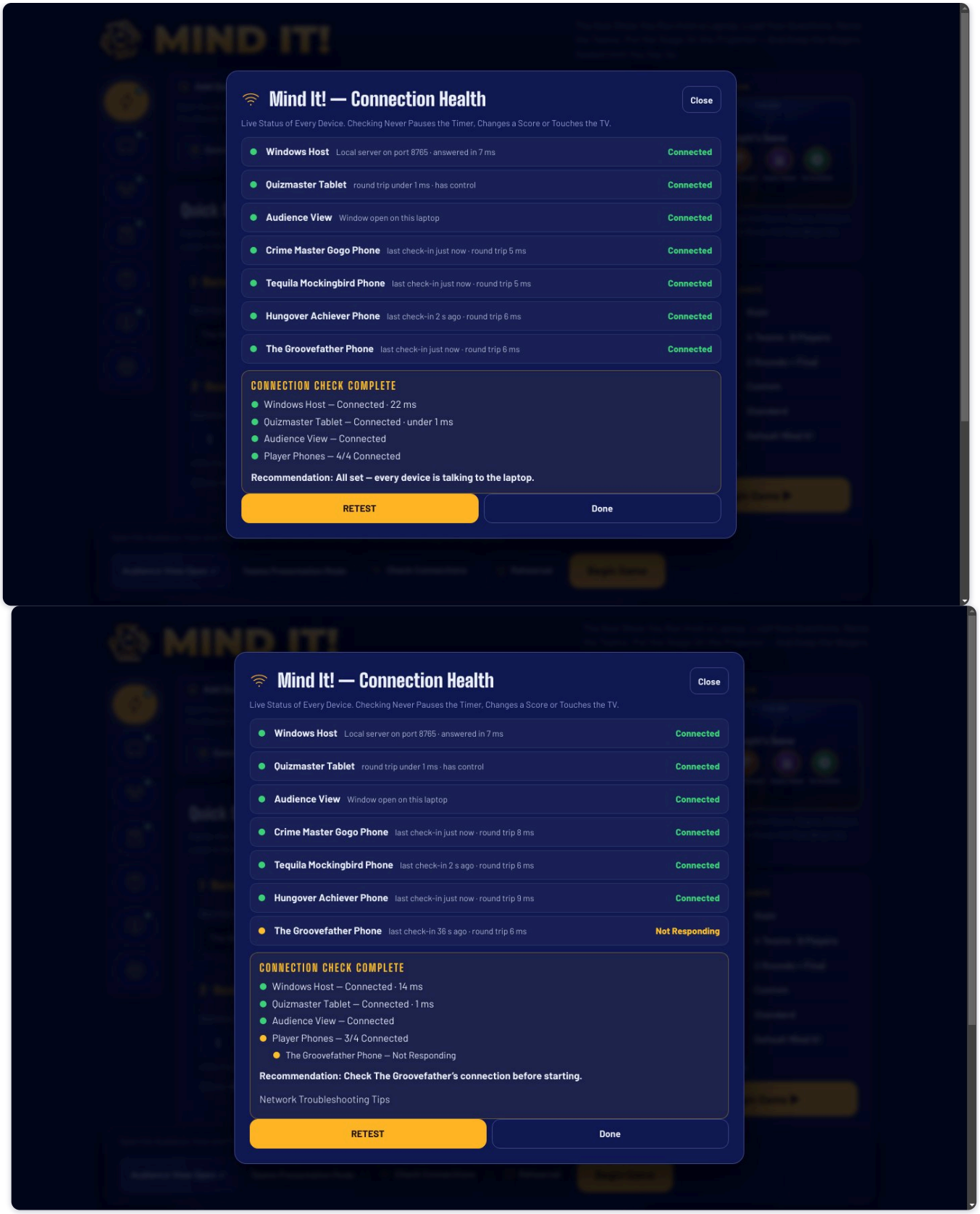
Status	Colour	Meaning (phones)
Unstable	🟠 amber	Last check-in 4–15 seconds ago.
Not Responding	🟠 amber	15–90 seconds ago.
Disconnected	🔴 red	More than 90 seconds ago (or the laptop's server isn't answering).
Asleep / In Background	grey	The phone is locked or the browser is in the background.
Not Yet Connected	grey	No phone has joined for this team.
Not Open / **Not Used**	grey	The TV window isn't open / phones and tablet need the laptop app.

The **round trip** in milliseconds is the latency (how long a message takes to go there and back). Under 100 ms is great; a few hundred is fine; seconds means a weak signal.

On the tablet the same list is a little simpler, so the tablet isn't redrawn every second just because a number changed: round trips are shown in bands (**under 100 ms**, **100–300 ms**, **300 ms – 1 s**, **over 1 s**), a connected phone says **last check-in just now**, and a phone that has dropped out says **less than a minute ago** (then minutes). The laptop's own Connection Health card shows the exact numbers.

9.3 TEST ALL CONNECTIONS

Press **TEST ALL CONNECTIONS**. For up to about 5 seconds every device is pinged ("the game carries on"). Then **CONNECTION CHECK COMPLETE** lists each device, and a **Recommendation**:



📸 *Real screenshots — all set (left: "Recommendation: All set — every device is talking to the laptop.") and a problem (right: one phone switched off — "Check The Groovefather's connection before starting.").*

Open **Network Troubleshooting Tips** for the built-in advice, then **RETEST**.

9.4 Fixing what it finds

- **Different Wi-Fi networks.** Every device must be on the *same* network as the laptop — not "Guest" on one and "Main" on another, and not the 5 GHz "-Ext" repeater of a different router.

- **Guest Wi-Fi / client isolation.** Many guest, hotel, office and café networks stop devices from talking to each other. Symptom: the laptop is fine, every phone fails. **Fix: turn on the laptop's mobile hotspot** (Windows Settings → Network & internet → Mobile hotspot) and join everything to it. The hotspot doesn't need internet.
- **VPN interference.** Turn off VPNs on the laptop, tablet and phones (including iPhone Private Relay).
- **Windows Firewall.** Mind It! must be allowed on **Private networks**. If you clicked "Cancel" on the first-run prompt: Windows Security → Firewall & network protection → Allow an app through firewall → tick *Mind It!* for Private. Also make sure your Wi-Fi is set to **Private**, not Public, in Windows.
- **Poor reception.** Keep the laptop and tablet near the router. Big halls: put the router (or the hotspot laptop) in the middle.
- **Laptop sleep.** Plug the laptop in. Mind It! keeps the screen awake during a game, but set Windows sleep to "Never" when plugged in to be safe.
- **Unresponsive phones.** Unlock it, bring the browser to the front, pull to refresh. Still dead? Close the tab and scan again — the team code is remembered.
- **Nothing connects at all?** Restart Mind It! on the laptop so its local server starts again (your game is autosaved — choose **Resume saved game**).

9.5 Internet vs local network — how to tell

Test	Result	What it means
The phone can open google.com but not the join link	Internet works, **local network doesn't**	Wrong network, guest isolation, VPN or firewall.
The phone can open the join link but not google.com	**Local network works**, no internet	Perfect for Mind It!. Nothing to fix.
Neither	The phone isn't really on that Wi-Fi	Reconnect the phone to the Wi-Fi (or the hotspot).

9.6 Reconnection warnings you might see

- **On the TV window:** an amber pill **"Reconnecting to Host..."** after 5 seconds without news from the host panel, a red **"Connection Lost — Retrying..."** after 20 seconds (or if the host window was closed), then a green **"Connected"** for 3 seconds. The board stays visible underneath. (Build 110 fixed the cause of most false "Reconnecting" messages: the host window is never slowed down by Windows any more.)
- **On the tablet:** "Connection Unstable", "Reconnecting to Host...", "Connection Lost — Retrying..." or "Laptop Not Responding — Retrying...". It retries by itself, quickly at first and then every few seconds. Buttons you press while it is offline are not lost silently — End Game, for example, is sent as soon as the connection is back.
- **On phones:** see 8.4.

PART FOUR — COMPLETE GAMEPLAY RULES

All rules in this part were read from the Mind It! 1.69 source code (build 112) and checked against the app's automated tests and the replayed example game in Chapter 17. Where the code and the project documents disagree, or the owner still has an open question, it says so (🔵).

10. Understanding the Game Board

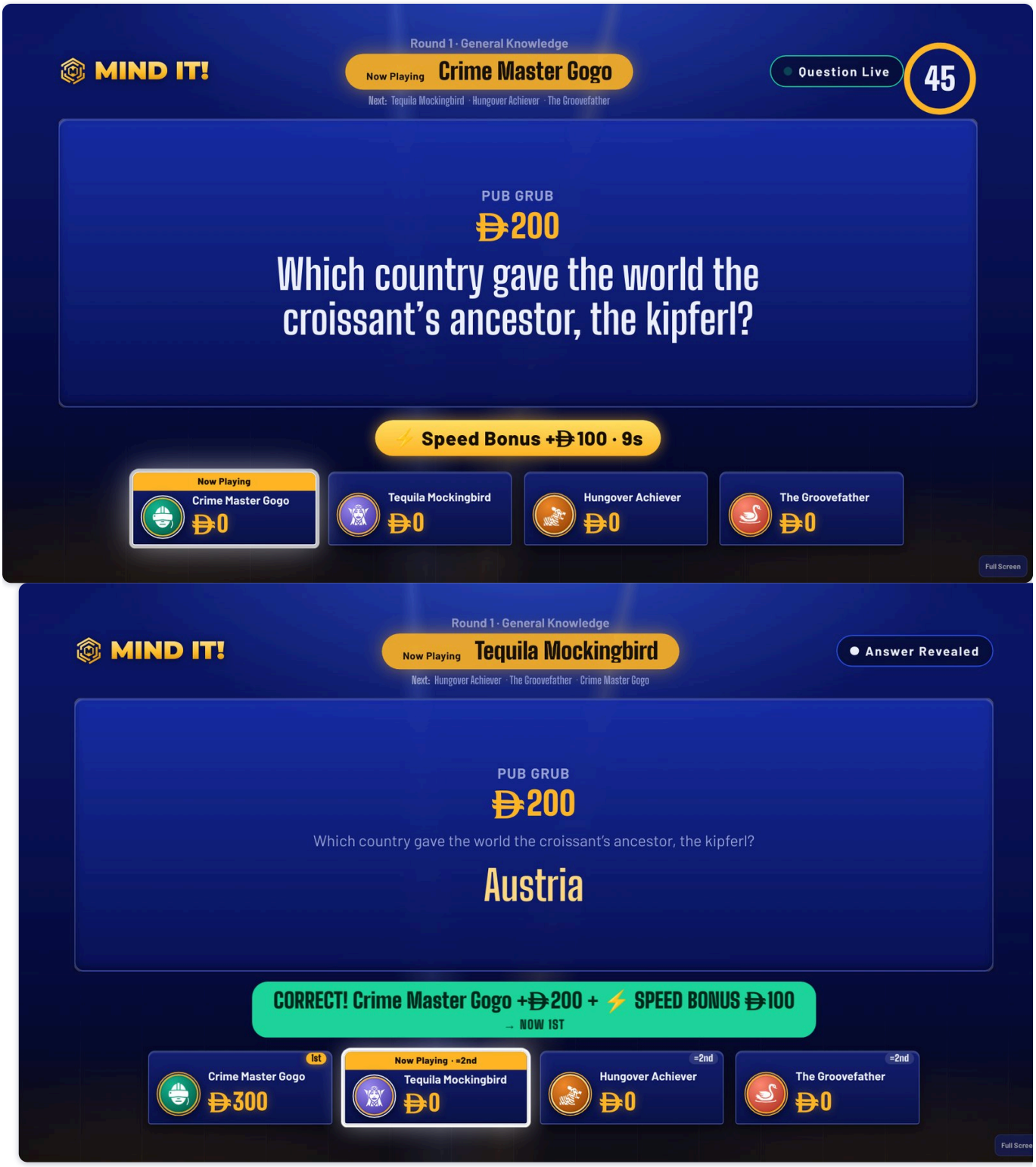
10.1 The board on the TV (Audience View)

📸 *Real screenshot — the Round 1 board on the Audience View (1920 × 1080).*

1. **The Mind It! logo** (with the quiz name underneath when it's set).
2. **Round name and "Now Playing" banner** — whose turn it is, with **Next:** the teams after them, in order.
3. **Team score cards** — picture, name, score. The team whose turn it is has the gold **Now Playing** tab. Special-event marks appear here too: 🔥 streak flames, the Phoenix ember, the 👑 champion crown.
4. **Category headers** — six categories per round.
5. **Question values** — top row is easiest/cheapest, bottom row hardest/most valuable. A question that has been played disappears (the tile goes blank). Blind It! questions are hidden — they look like any other tile.
6. **Full Screen** button (the Audience View window's own button; it hides itself in full screen).

With 7–8 teams, the scores can move to a column on the right (setting: *TV Scoreboard Position*).

10.2 The question and answer screens



📸 *Real screenshots — the question on the TV (left), and after a correct answer (right).*

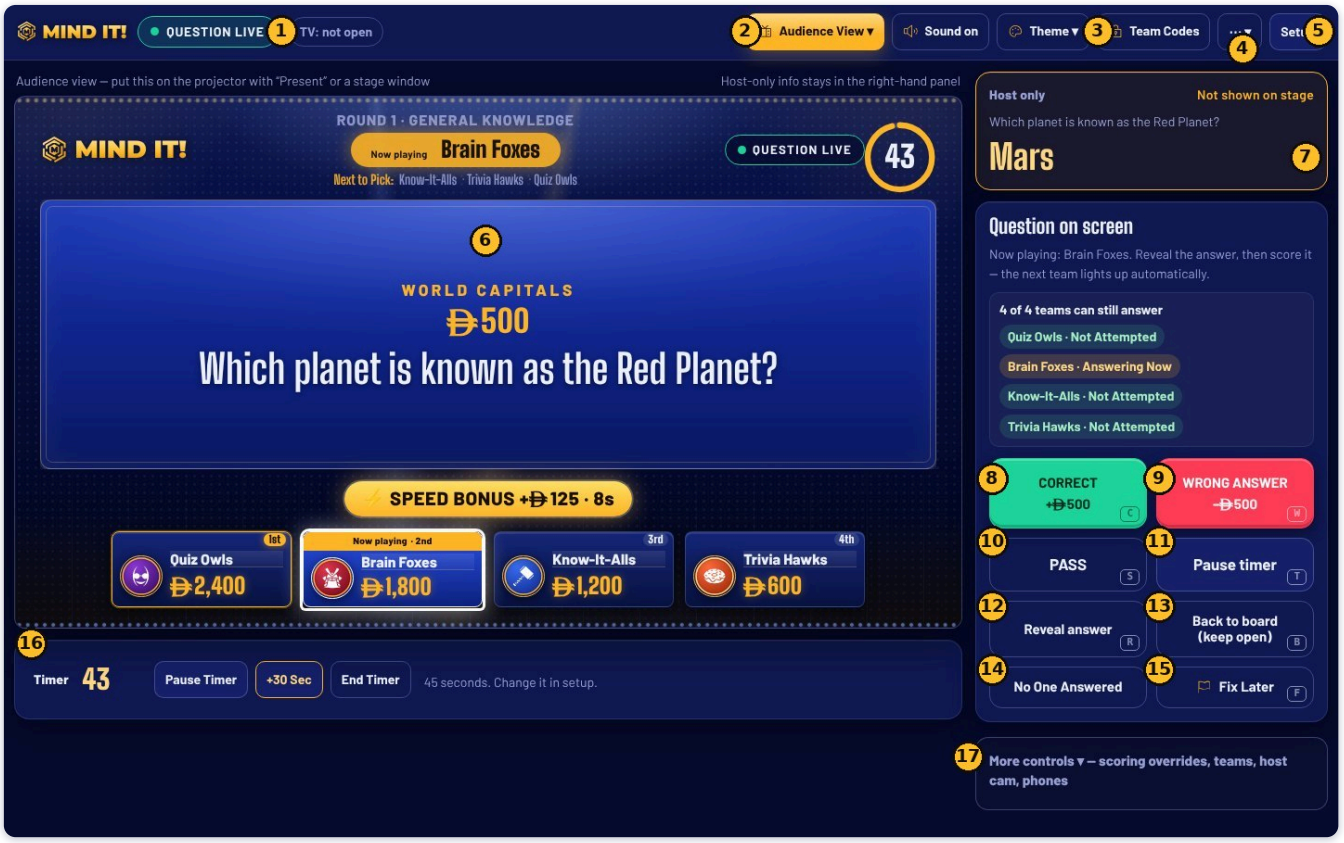
- **Category and value** above the question.
- **The ring timer** (top right) counts down from 45. A soft heartbeat plays in the last 10 seconds.
- **"Question Live"** pill while the question is open; **"Answer Revealed"** after it's answered or revealed.
- ⚡ **Speed Bonus +100 · 9s** — the speed-bonus countdown under the question (only when it can still be earned).
- **Result banner** — e.g. **"CORRECT! Crime Master Gogo +200 + ⚡ SPEED BONUS +100 — NOW 1ST"**, or **"WRONG ANSWER → HUNGOVER ACHIEVER'S TURN"**.
- **The answer** appears on the TV only after it is answered correctly or the Quizmaster presses **Reveal Answer**.

10.3 The board on the laptop (host panel)

📸 Real screenshot (build 140) — the laptop host panel with the board.

1. **Top bar** — Audience View ▾, Connect ▾, tablet status, Sound, 🎨 Theme ▾ (since build 146; 21.1), 📶 Teams, 🔐 Team Codes, ⋯ ▾, Setup (Chapter 15).
2. **Live copy of the Audience View** — exactly what the TV shows. **Click a value tile here to open that question** ("Tap a tile on the board preview to open it — the TV follows").
3. Team score cards (as on the TV).
4. Category headers.
5. Value tiles.
6. **NOW PICKING** — whose turn it is and the order after them.
7. **SCORES** — the live scoreboard.
8. **Round 1 · General Knowledge — Pick a Clue**: "30 Questions Left in This Round · Blind It! questions Hidden", **Show Standings (P)**, and (build 140) ⏱ **One More Question** and ⭐ **Go to the Final** (Chapter 15.2).
9. 🎟 **Team Chips — Use One for <team> ▾** (folded so you don't spoil anything; Chapter 12).
10. **More Controls ▾** (just below the picture — scroll down) — teams and turn order, adjust a score, Host Cam, phones, undo and resets.

10.4 The question on the laptop



📸 Real screenshot (build 152) — a question is live. The answer is only on the laptop (top right).

1. Status pills: **Question Live**, **TV ● Live** (here *TV: not open*), **Phone Connection: Active** when phones are in.
2. 📺 **Audience View ▾** (and 📲 **Connect ▾**, 📶 **Teams 2/4** — tap for Connection Health — once a tablet or phones are in).
3. 🔐 **Team Codes** (with **Sound** and 🎨 **Theme ▾** beside it).
4. ⋯ ▾ — Intermission, Backups, About and, since build 152, ⌨ **Keyboard Shortcuts** (Appendix C).
5. **Setup** (pauses the game).
6. The live TV copy (question, Now Playing, the ring timer, ⚡ Speed Bonus countdown).
7. **Host Only · Not Shown On Stage** — the question and **the answer**. Under **Question On Screen**: **4 of 4 Teams Can Still Answer** — each team's status (Answering Now, Not Attempted, Wrong, Passed).
8. **Correct +500** (key **C**) — with ⚡ **+bonus** while the speed bonus can still be earned.
9. **Wrong Answer −500** (key **W**).
10. **Pass** (key **S**).
11. **Pause Timer** (key **T**) — then **Resume Timer (T)**, which carries on from the seconds left (since build 152; before, T started the clock again from full).
12. **Reveal Answer** (key **R**).
13. **Back to Board (Keep Open)** (key **B**) — go back without scoring; the question stays open to pick again later.
14. **No One Answered** — close the question with no points.
15. ⚑ **Fix Later** (key **F**).
16. **The Timer card** — the seconds left, **Pause Timer / Resume Timer**, **+30 Sec**, **End Timer**. Since build 152 it sits **under the TV preview** on a laptop and on the tablet in landscape, so it's always in view (it used to be below the fold).
17. **More Controls ▾** — scoring overrides, teams, Host Cam, phones, and Undo & resets (15.7).

The tablet version of this screen is in Chapter 15.

---

11. Complete Scoring Rules

11.1 The big table

Situation	Score change	Example
Correct (normal question)	**+ value** (+ pass-on bonus) (+ speed bonus)	400 question → **+400**
Wrong (normal question)	**– value**; the same question goes to the next team with a **fresh full clock**	400 question → **–400**
Wrong, no penalty (key **X**)	**0**; the question goes on	—
Pass	**0**; the question goes on (timer: 30 s + time left, max 45 s)	—
Pass-on bonus	**+25% of the value per explicit pass** made earlier on this question	600 passed twice, then right → 600 + 300 = **+900**
Speed bonus	**+50% of the round's lowest value**, picking team only, within 10 s	200 right in 4 s (Round 1) → 200 + 100 = **+300**
Blind It! question	**+ wager / – wager**	wager 1,000 → **+1,000** or **–1,000**
Triple Gamble	**+3× / –3× value**; on a Blind It! question a **fixed 6×** wager	400 → **+1,200** or **–1,200**; Blind It! 1,000 → **±6,000**
Phoenix	**+ max(value, min(2 × value + 20% of the gap, gap to leader))**; wrong = **0**	1,200 question, 3,000 behind → **+3,000**
Bottoms Up, wrong	Quizmaster decides: ✓ **Finished → 0**, ✕ **Not finished → – value**	800 → **0** or **–800**
Mastermind It!	**+ wager / – wager** (wrong, no penalty → 0)	wager 1,000 → 2,400 becomes **3,400** or **1,400**
Adjust score	± any amount, with an optional reason (shown on the TV)	"+250 · Answer accepted on appeal"

Every score change is one entry in the game's **journal**, so **Undo** (key **U**) reverses exactly the last one — and, since build 112, puts back any chip that answer used (Chapter 12). Bonus amounts are rounded to the nearest point.

11.2 Correct answers ✅

The team gets the question's value, plus any bonus that applies. The TV shows "CORRECT! <team> +value", and "→ NOW 1ST ▲2" style news when their place changes.

> **Example.** Round 1, Crime Master Gogo picks Pub Grub 200 and answers in 4 seconds. 200 + speed bonus 100 = **+300**. Score: 0 → **300**.

11.3 Wrong answers and deductions ✅

The team **loses** the question's value. In normal turn order the **same question** goes to the next team (skipping teams marked Away), who gets a **fresh full clock** (45 s). A wrong answer itself never earns anyone a pass-on bonus.

> **Example.** Tequila Mockingbird gets Movie Quotes 400 wrong: **–400** (0 → –400). Hungover Achiever then answers it correctly: **+400** (0 → 400). No speed bonus for Hungover — they didn't pick it.

Each team gets one go per question (build 138): a wrong answer (with or without penalty) or a pass uses it, and the question never comes back to a team that has had its go. The Scoring card shows each team's status (Answering Now · Passed · Wrong Answer · Not Attempted), and so does the tablet remote. When every team has had its go, **the question ends by itself**: the answer shows on the TV with **NO ONE ANSWERED** below it, and **3 seconds** later (7 before build 146) the board comes back with the next team in the turn order. No points; points already taken off stay. **Undo** within those 3 seconds gives the last team its go back.

11.4 Passing and "automatic passing" ✅

- **Pass** costs nothing. The question moves to the next team that hasn't had its go (not Away).
- **The passed-to team's timer = 30 seconds + whatever was left, but never more than the question time (45 s).** Examples: 20 s left → 45 s (50 capped to 45). 8 s left → 38 s. After Time's Up (0 left) → 30 s.
- **"Automatic passing"** — Mind It! never passes on its own. When time runs out, the Quizmaster gets a ⏰ **Time's up for <team>** card with **WRONG ANSWER (–value)**, **PASS** or **Dismiss**. You decide.
- **Can't be passed:** Blind It! questions, Triple Gamble questions (including a Triple Gamble on a Blind It! question). The Pass button disappears.
- Passing a **Phoenix** or **Bottoms Up** question uses up that chip with no chip bonus.

11.5 Pass-on bonus ✅

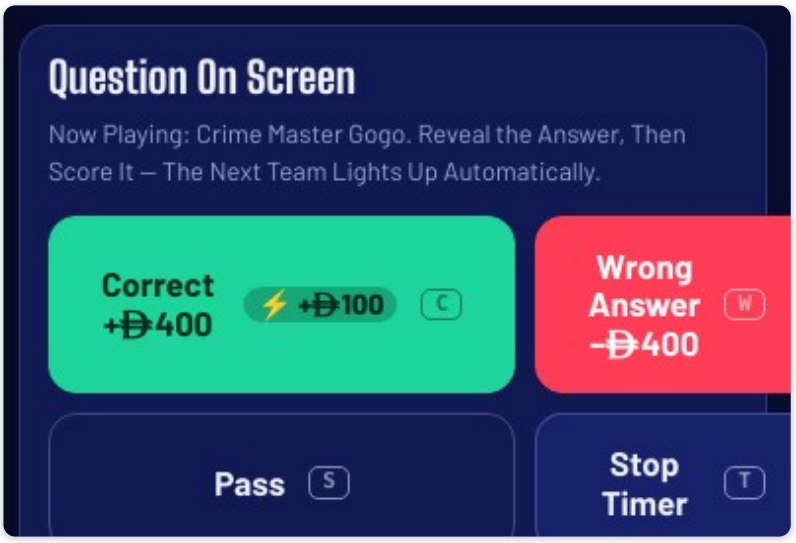
- **On by default** (Full Show, Online Mode; off in Classic). **25% of the question's value for every explicit pass** made on that question before the correct answer. Two passes = 50%.
- Only **explicit Pass** presses count — a wrong answer never adds a bonus (but passes made earlier on the same question still count).
- Alternative setting: a **fixed number of points per pass** (default 100), or off.

What happened on a 500 question	Who scores	Bonus	Total
A passes, B right	B	1 pass × 25% = 125	**+625**
A passes, B passes, C right	C	2 × 25% = 250	**+750**
A passes, B wrong (–500), C right	C	1 pass (the wrong answer adds nothing) = 125	**+625**
A wrong (–500), B right	B	none	**+500**
Fixed 100 per pass: A passes, B passes, C right	C	2 × 100	**+700**

11.6 Speed bonus ✅

- **On** in Full Show and Online Mode (off in Classic).
- **Amount: 50% of the lowest question value in the current round** — worked out live from the real values. THE BIG FAT QUIZ: Round 1 → **100**, Round 2 → **200**. (4-round quizzes: 125 / 250 / 375 / 500.)
- **Who:** only the team **whose turn it was** when the question opened (the "owner"), answering correctly **within 10 seconds** (15 in Online Mode since build 137; setting *Answer Within*, 1–60 s) — measured from when the question first appeared to when Correct is pressed.
- **Never:** after a pass or a wrong answer; on Blind It! questions; on Triple Gambles.
- **It *is* added on top of a Phoenix answer, after the Phoenix cap** — so a fast Phoenix answer can finish slightly *ahead* of the leader. This is deliberate: the owner decided to keep it (October 2026).
- On the TV: "⚡ SPEED BONUS +100 · 7s" counts down under the question (only when it can still be earned — never on a Triple Gamble or a Blind It! question); the result banner adds "+ ⚡ SPEED BONUS +100".

- On the laptop: while it can still be earned, the Correct button shows it — **Correct +200 ⚡ +100** — so you know what pressing it gives (build 113). The ⚡ part disappears by itself when the window ends (10 seconds; 15 in Online Mode).



📸 Real screenshot (build 114) — the laptop's Correct button while the speed bonus can still be earned.

11.7 Blind It! scoring ✅ — see Chapter 12.1 for the full rules

Right **+wager**, wrong **–wager**. No pass, no pass-on bonus, no speed bonus.

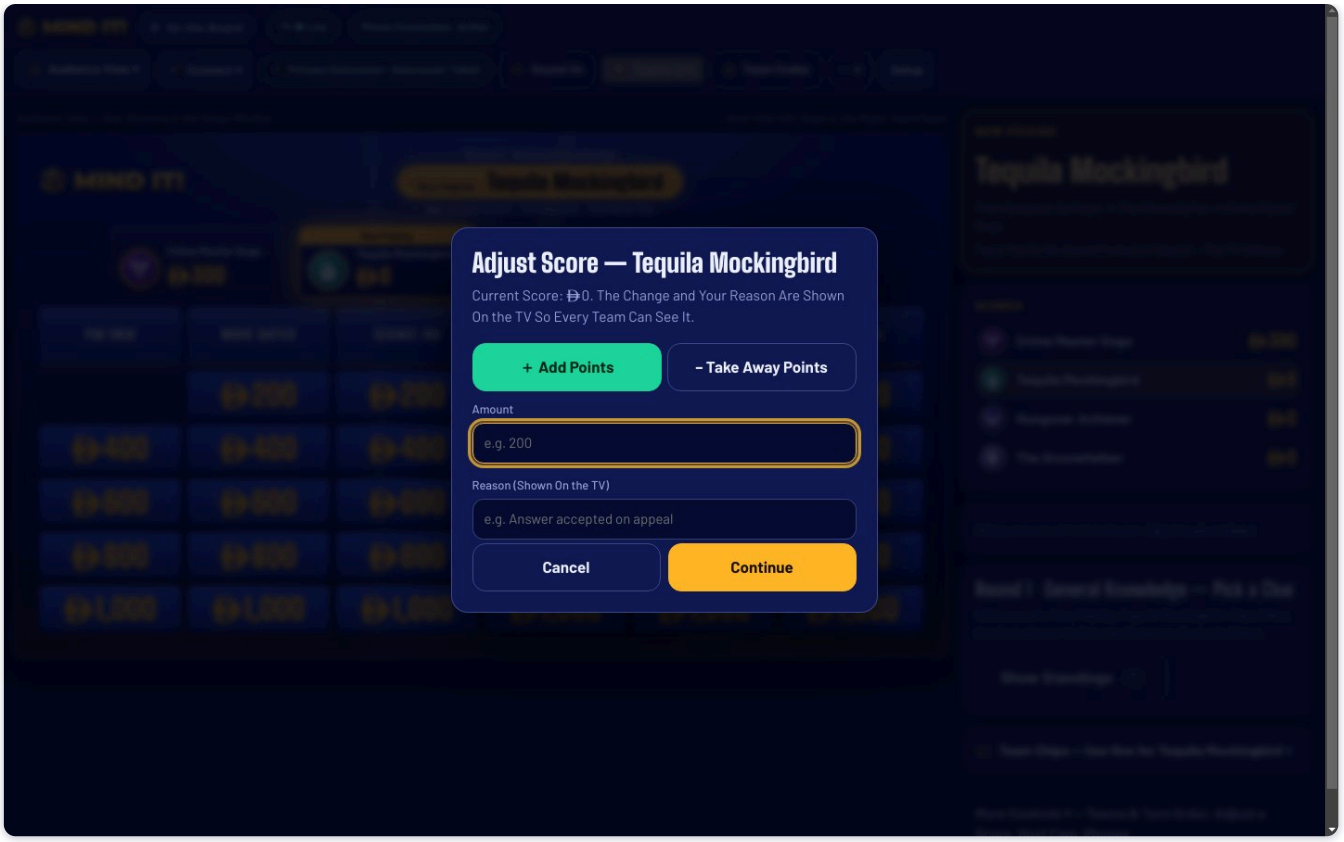
11.8 Negative scores ✅

Scores can go below zero. A team below zero:

- can still pick, answer and win points;
- on a Blind It! question may still wager from the question's value up to 1,000 (the low-score cap) — see 12.1;
- **sits out Mastermind It!** (you need 0 or more to play Mastermind It!; a team on exactly 0 can play but can only wager 0).

11.9 Manual score adjustments ✅

More Controls ▾ → Adjust Score next to a team, or — since build 152 — **click the team's row in the Scores card** (or press Enter on it) (or **± Adjust Score** on the tablet). On the tablet, what you type stays put even if the laptop changes the scores while you're typing (since build 125).



📸 *Real screenshot — Adjust Score.*

Choose **+ Add Points** or **– Take Away Points**, type the **Amount** (any whole number above 0, up to 9 digits) and an optional **Reason (shown on the TV)** (up to 80 characters), then **Continue**. The TV shows a banner for about 7 seconds, e.g. "SCORE ADJUSTMENT · Tequila Mockingbird +250 · Answer accepted on appeal · New score 250". Adjustments are journal entries — **Undo** reverses them — and they never trigger achievements.

11.10 How bonuses and powers combine

Combination	Allowed?	What happens
Pass-on bonus + speed bonus	Can't happen	Speed bonus is for the picking team only, and never after a pass.
Speed bonus on a Blind It! question	No	—
Pass-on bonus on a Blind It! question	No	Blind It! questions can't be passed.
Triple Gamble + speed / pass-on bonus	No	Neither applies.
Triple Gamble on a Blind It! question	**Yes**	Becomes a fixed **6×** wager, starts straight away.
Phoenix on a Blind It! pick	No	The chip **isn't used** — it stays ready for the team's next pick.
Bottoms Up on a Blind It! pick	No	The chip **isn't used** — it stays ready.
Phoenix + speed bonus	**Yes**	Speed bonus added after the cap (kept on purpose).
Two chips on one question	**No**	While any chip is on, the other chips' **Use** buttons are hidden.
Chips in Phone Buzzer Mode	No	Chips need Standard Mode. The Phoenix isn't even handed out in Buzzer Mode.

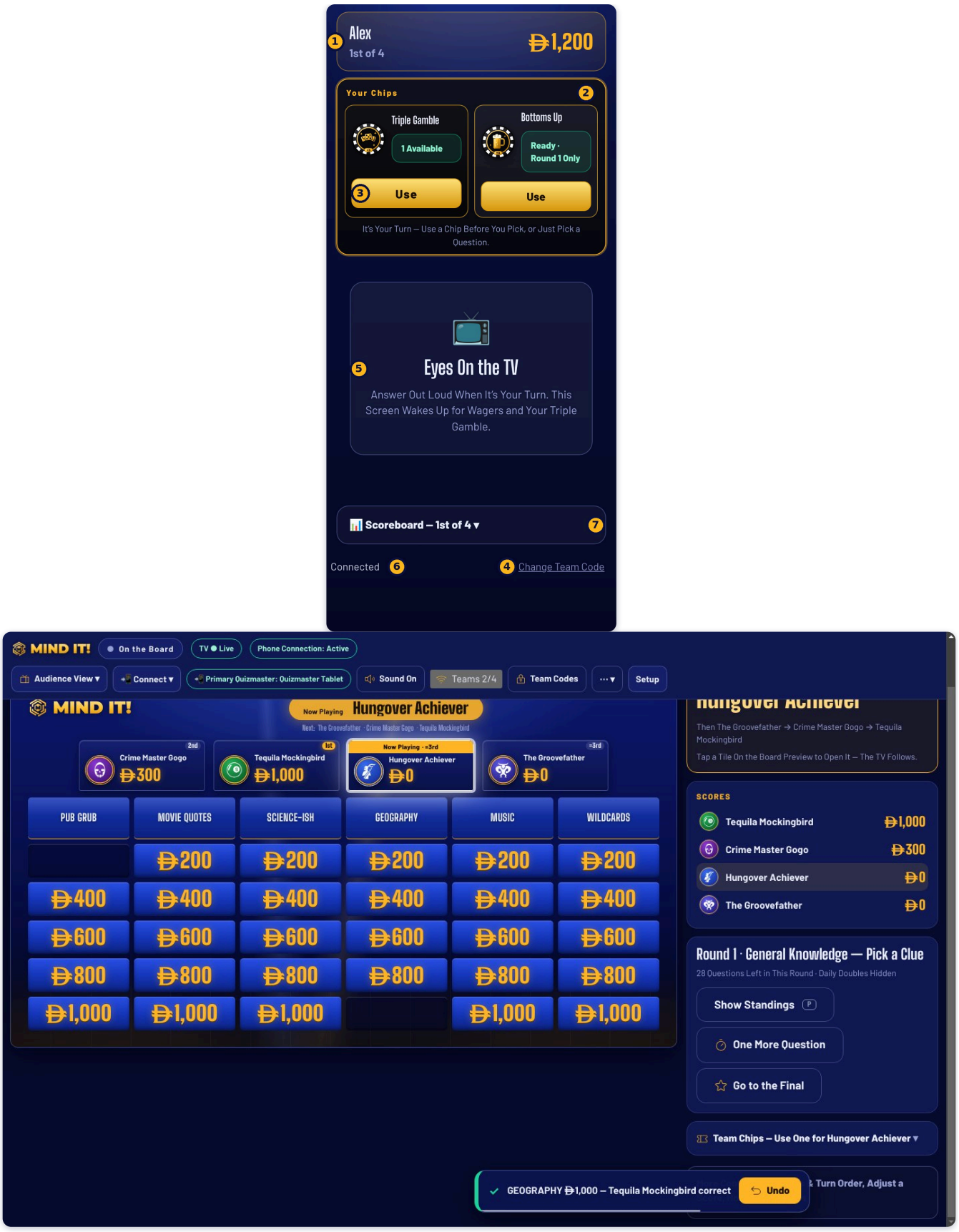
Combination	Allowed?	What happens
Chips in Mastermind It!	No	All chips are hidden in Mastermind It!

12. Every Special Ability — Complete Guide

Mind It! 1.69 has exactly **one board surprise** (the **Blind It! question**) and **three chips** (**Triple Gamble**, **Phoenix**, **Bottoms Up**), plus three **bonuses** (speed, pass-on, and the **Never Mind It!** moment). There are no other powers — ideas like Steal, Shield or Double Down chips were never built (Appendix A).

Shared chip rules ✅

- Chips need **Standard Mode**, the **laptop app** (its local server) and normally **team phones**. They are never available during Setup, in Phone Buzzer Mode, or in Mastermind It! In Phone Buzzer Mode the Phoenix isn't handed out or announced at all (an unused one is put away if you switch to Buzzer Mode mid-game).
- **One chip per question.** While a chip is switched on, the other chips can't be used.
- **Teams use chips on their phone, on their own turn, before picking.**
- **Quizmaster override:** on the laptop's folded 🎟 **Team Chips** card (and on the tablet), the Quizmaster can **Use for <team>** (e.g. a team's phone is flat) or **Switch off** a chip before the pick — the team keeps it.
- On phones, a used chip shows **Used** for the rest of that round, then disappears.
- **Undo gives the chip back** ✅ (build 112). Undoing a chip question's score puts every chip back exactly as it was before that answer: mark the question again and the chip still applies (Triple Gamble still ×3, Phoenix still capped at the leader, Bottoms Up back to before the wrong answer). If you undo every score of a chip question, the chip is back with the team, switched on for its pick. This works within the current round.



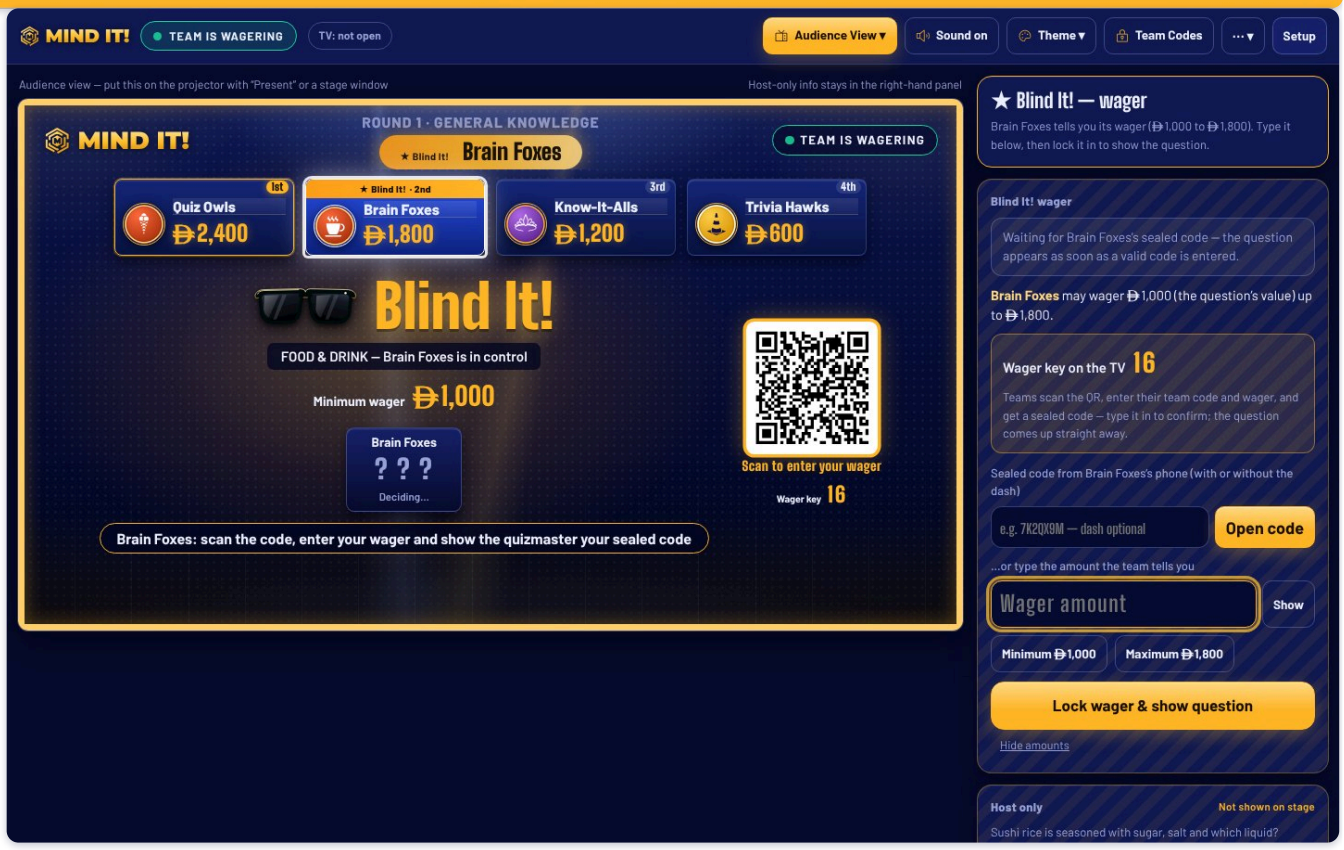
Real screenshots — the phone chips (left) and the laptop's Team Chips card unfolded (right: "Triple Gamble · Ready · Use for Hungover Achiever", "Bottoms Up · Ready · Use for Hungover Achiever").

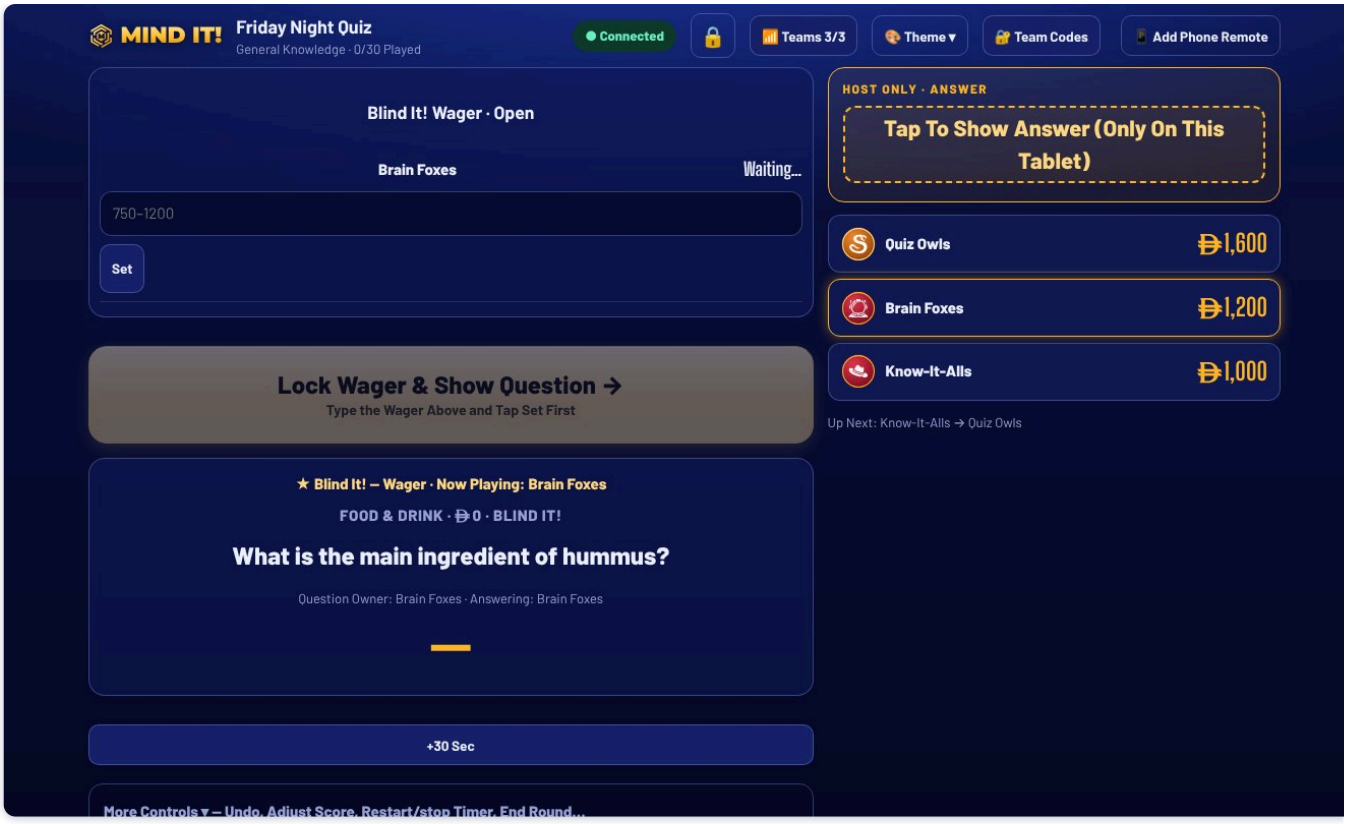
12.1 💰 Blind It!

Purpose	A hidden tile where the picking team bets on itself.

Who activates	Nobody — it's found by picking the tile.
When	Any time its tile is picked.
How many	Per round: **1 · 2 · 2 · 3** (Rounds 1–4); none in Mastermind It! Change the count in 4 · Rounds & Questions (0 = none).
Placement	**At random on the top two values of a category** (spread one per category before any category gets two), fixed for the whole round (reset round, undo and reload don't move them). Or "I'll pick them before the round", or "Use the clues marked DD".
Confirmation	The wager must be locked: by the team's phone (starts the question automatically) or by the Quizmaster (**Lock Wager & Show Question**, greyed until a wager is set).
Cancel?	No. The Quizmaster can **change** the wager until the question is scored (laptop or tablet); the phone shows "Changed by host".
Wager	**Minimum = the question's value. Maximum = the biggest of: the team's score, 1,000 (the low-score cap), the question's value.** Quick picks: **All in / Half / Minimum**.
Correct	**+ wager**
Wrong	**– wager**, and the question ends (nobody else answers).
Passing	Not allowed. "🔒 BLIND IT! — only <team> can answer".
Other abilities	Triple Gamble turns it into a 6× wager; Phoenix and Bottoms Up stay unused. No speed or pass-on bonus.
Phone	"Blind It! — Category: Geography. Enter your wager for <team>. Nobody else can see it." with the allowed range, a keypad and **Lock in**.
Quizmaster	"★ Blind It! — Wager" panel with the range, a wager box and **Lock Wager & Show Question**, plus the answer.
Audience View	A "Blind It!" splash with black sunglasses (since build 148), the category and "<team> plays alone · no passing", a QR code to enter the wager, then "<team> has locked in a wager". The amount stays **sealed** until the answer is scored (Online Mode shows it; setting *Blind It! Wager On Screen*). (**Online Mode:** no QR code — the team tells the Quizmaster their wager, who types it in.)

MIND IT!
ROUND 1 · GENERAL KNOWLEDGE
★ Blind It! Brain Foxes
TEAM IS WAGERING
1st
Quiz Owls
Ð2,400
★ Blind It! · 2nd
Brain Foxes
Ð1,800
3rd
Know-It-Alls
Ð1,200
4th
Trivia Hawks
Ð600
Blind It!
FOOD & DRINK — Brain Foxes is in control
Minimum wager Ð1,000
Brain Foxes
? ? ?
Deciding...
Scan to enter your wager
Wager key 61
Brain Foxes: scan the code, enter your wager and show the quizmaster your sealed code


MIND IT!
TEAM IS WAGERING
TV: not open
Audience View
Sound on
Theme
Team Codes
Setup
Audience view — put this on the projector with "Present" or a stage window
Host-only info stays in the right-hand panel
ROUND 1 · GENERAL KNOWLEDGE
★ Blind It! Brain Foxes
Blind It!
FOOD & DRINK — Brain Foxes is in control
Minimum wager Ð1,000
Scan to enter your wager
Wager key 16
Brain Foxes: scan the code, enter your wager and show the quizmaster your sealed code
★ Blind It! — wager
Brain Foxes tells you its wager (Ð1,000 to Ð1,800). Type it below, then lock it in to show the question.
Blind It! wager
Waiting for Brain Foxes's sealed code — the question appears as soon as a valid code is entered.
Brain Foxes may wager Ð1,000 (the question's value) up to Ð1,800.
Wager key on the TV 16
Teams scan the QR, enter their team code and wager, and get a sealed code — type it in to confirm; the question comes up straight away.
Sealed code from Brain Foxes's phone (with or without the dash)
e.g. 7K2QX9M — dash optional
Open code
...or type the amount the team tells you
Wager amount
Show
Minimum Ð1,000
Maximum Ð1,800
Lock wager & show question
Hide amounts
Host only
Not shown on stage
Sushi rice is seasoned with sugar, salt and which liquid?



📸 *Real screenshots — Blind It! on the TV (the wager screen) and the laptop (build 150), and the tablet (build 151).*

Numbers:

Team score	Tile	Allowed wager
0	1,000	1,000 – 1,000 (the Groovefather in Chapter 17)
0	400	400 – 1,000
3,000	800	800 – 3,000
–600	600	600 – 1,000

Never Mind It! ✅: if a team with a score above 0 wagers **its whole score or more**, the TV plays a special "NEVER MIND IT!" moment (rule switch, on in every preset). The scoring is unchanged: right doubles their score, wrong drops it to zero (or below if they bet more than their score). Achievement 🔥 Never Mind It! Hero.

Tips: behind? Bet big. Ahead with little to gain? Bet the minimum. **Common mistake:** the Quizmaster forgetting to lock the wager — the question won't show until it's locked.

*Before build 148 Blind It! was called the **Daily Double**, Never Mind It! the **True Daily Double**, and Mastermind It! the **Final Round**. Older games in Historic Games show the new names; nothing saved is changed.*

12.1b 🤠 Rewind It! — instead of Blind It! (since build 148)

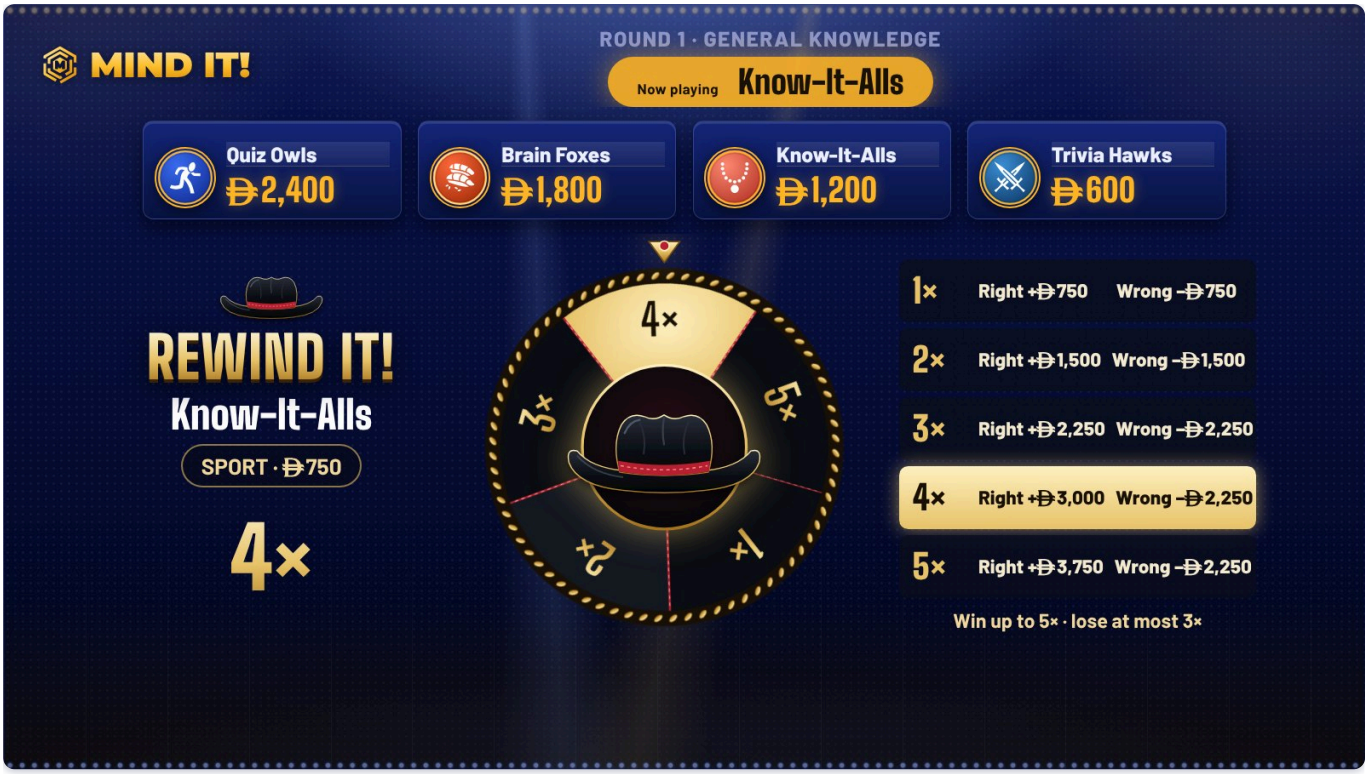
Setup → 4 · Rounds & Questions → Special Question: Blind It! (the default) or **Rewind It!**. It's one choice for the whole game and can't be changed once the game is under way (after **END GAME** you can choose again — build 149). The squares are the same ones — how many and where stay as set for Blind It! — only what happens on them changes, and the TV and phones say **Rewind It!** in that game.

Purpose	The picking team plays for a multiplier instead of a wager.
When	Its square is picked: the TV shows the cowboy hat and **REWIND IT!**, then the wheel.

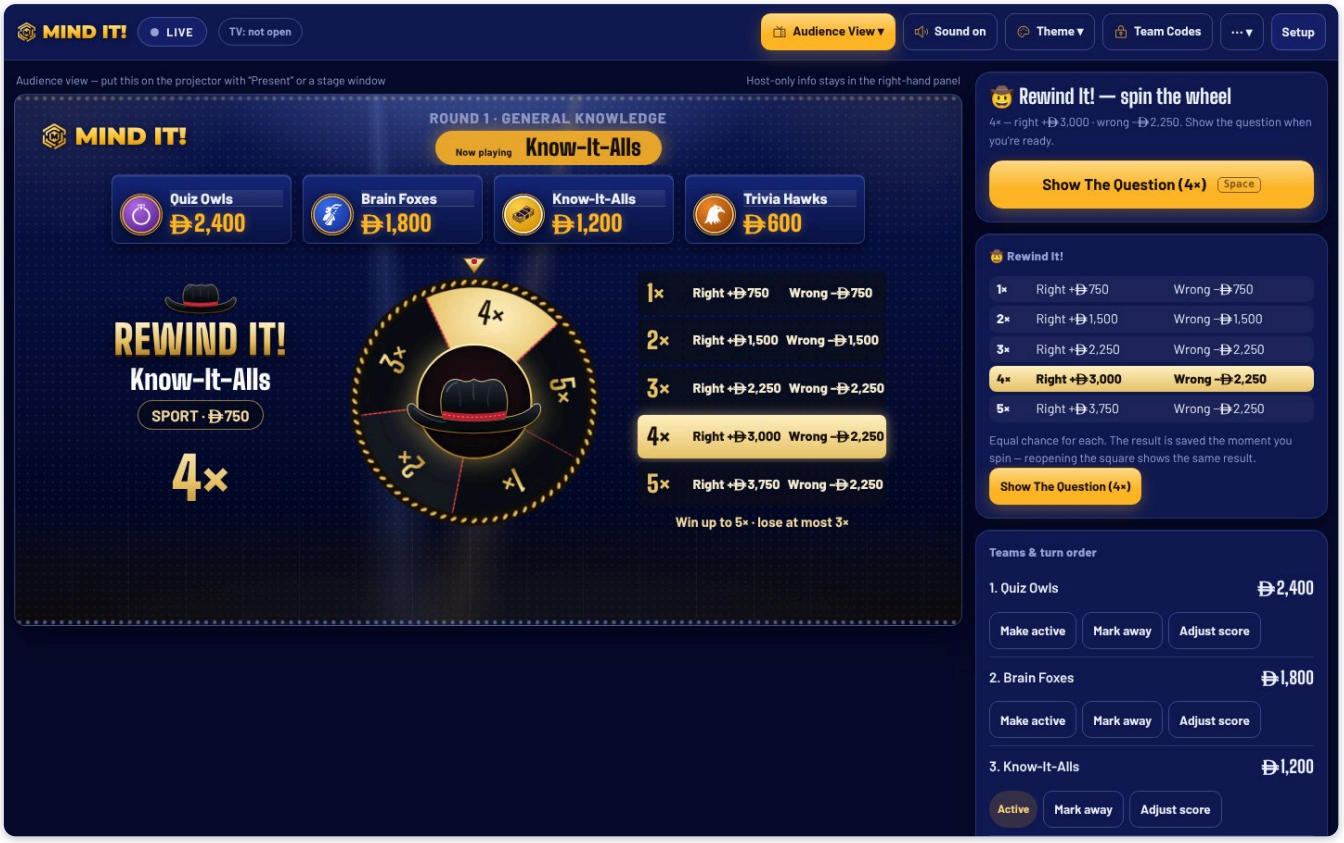
The wheel	The Quizmaster taps 🤠 **Spin The Wheel** (laptop or tablet) — in every answering mode except Phone Buzzer Mode with team phones (next row). The hat wheel turns and lands on **1×, 2×, 3×, 4× or 5×** — each equally likely. The result is decided and saved the moment you spin: opening the square again, a reload or a reconnect shows the same result, never a second spin. **Skip The Spin** jumps to the result; then **Show The Question (N×)**.
Phone Buzzer Mode (build 151)	With team phones, the **picking team spins it on its own phone**: the phone shows **REWIND IT!** and 🤠 **SPIN THE WHEEL**; the hat then turns freely on the TV ("<team>: tap STOP!") and the phone shows a big red ✋ **STOP!**. The result is drawn **the moment they stop** — each of 1×–5× still equally likely — and the wheel slows down from where it is and lands on it; the phone then shows the multiplier and what it's worth. Only that team's phone gets the wheel, and a tap shows **Spinning… / Stopping…** until the laptop has it (a second or two). The laptop and the tablet keep small **Spin For Them / Stop For Them** buttons in case the team's phone is away, and **Skip The Spin** while it lands.
Correct	**+ value × N**
Wrong	**– value × N, but never more than 3×** (a 4× or 5× loses 3×), and the question ends. Since build 149 the laptop's **WRONG ANSWER** button shows that real loss.
Passing	Not allowed; only the picking team answers. Time's up works as on a Blind It! question.
Chips	**Every chip is off for the whole game** — no Triple Gamble, Phoenix or Bottoms Up on the phones, the laptop or the tablet. No speed or pass-on bonus on the square.
Laptop	A 🤠 **Rewind It!** card with the payout table (1× to 5×: Right +… · Wrong –…) and the buttons; the question card then shows "N× · Right +… · Wrong –…".
Tablet	The same buttons (in Phone Buzzer Mode: Spin For Them / Stop For Them). While the wheel turns the tablet hides ✓ / ✕ (build 149).
Achievements	There is no wager, so Never Mind It! Hero and Gambler's Ruin aren't given in a Rewind It! game.

Numbers (a 600 square):

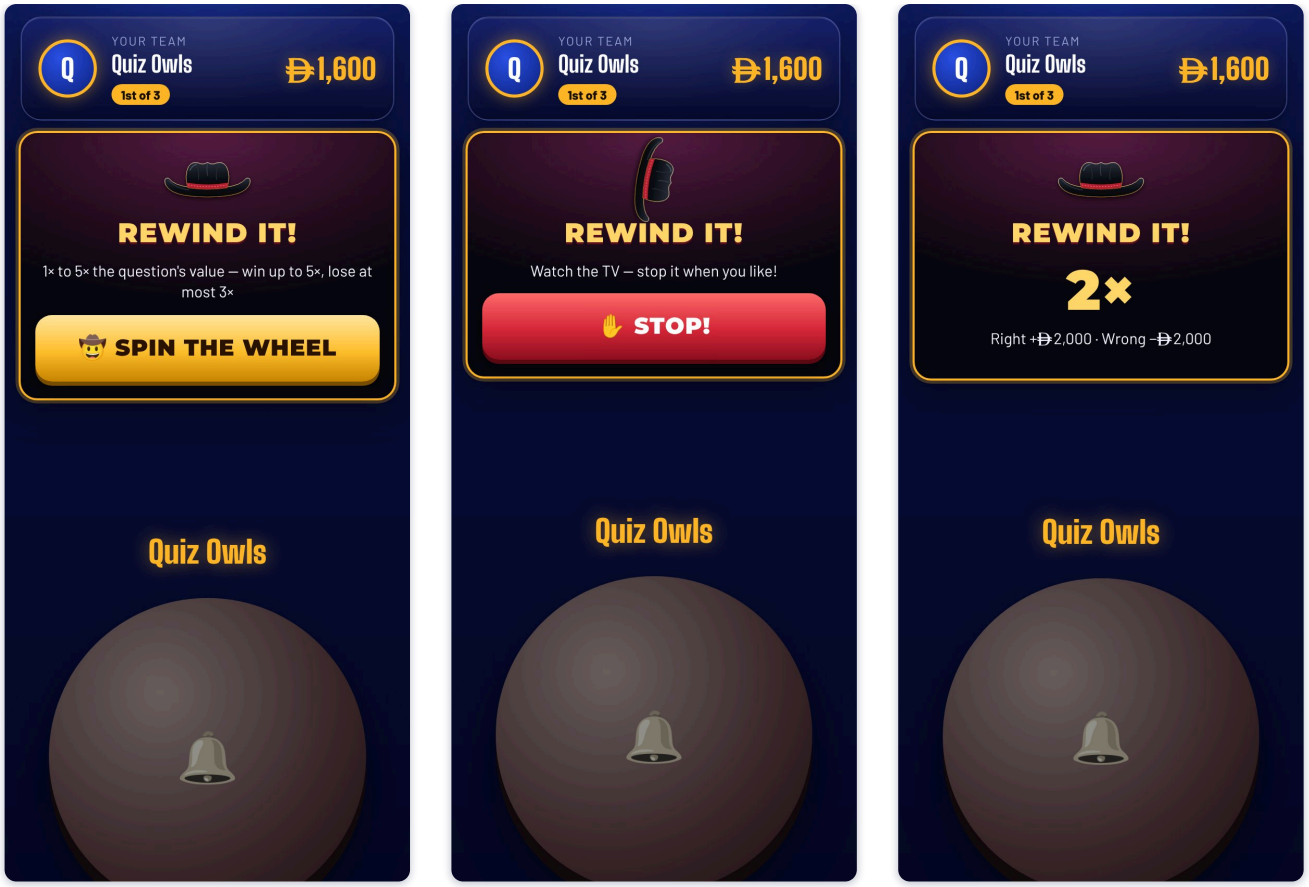
Wheel	Right	Wrong
1×	+600	–600
2×	+1,200	–1,200
3×	+1,800	–1,800
4×	+2,400	–1,800
5×	+3,000	–1,800



📸 Real screenshot (build 150) — the Rewind It! wheel on the TV, landed on its number.



*📸 Real screenshot (build 150) — the laptop after the spin: the 🤠 Rewind It! card with the payout table, and **Show The Question (4×)**.*



📸 Real screenshots (build 151) — Phone Buzzer Mode: the picking team's phone with SPIN THE WHEEL, then STOP! while the hat turns, then the result (here 2×).

Tip: Rewind It! suits a group that likes luck more than betting — nobody has to decide a wager, and a wrong answer on a big multiplier hurts less than it pays.

12.2 🎲 Triple Gamble (chip)

Purpose	Triple the stakes on one question.
Rule switch	On in Full Show; off in Classic and Online Mode.
Who activates	The team, on its phone (**Use** → confirm). The Quizmaster can **Use for <team>** or **Switch off**.
When	On the team's own turn, **before picking**. Standard Mode only. Not in Rehearsal.
How many	**Once per team per game.** Every new game gives it back.
Confirmation	Yes — a phone screen "Triple Gamble?" lists the rules; **Confirm Triple Gamble** or **Cancel**. Then "Triple Gamble Active — now pick your question".
Cancel	**Cancel** on the confirm screen; after that only the Quizmaster can **Switch off** (before the pick) — the team keeps the chip.
Correct	**+3 × value** (on a Blind It! question: **+6 × value**).
Wrong	**−3 × value** (Blind It!: **−6 ×**). The question **ends** — it is never passed on. The next pick goes to the team after the gambler.
Passing	Not allowed. No pass-on bonus, no speed bonus. Time's up is handled like a Blind It! question (no Time's-up card).

Wagering	On a Blind It! question the chip **replaces** the normal wager with a fixed 6× value, and the question starts straight away.
Compatibility	Not with another chip. Works on Blind It! questions (6×).
Phone	Chip card "Triple Gamble · 1 Available · Use", then the confirm screen, then "Triple Gamble Active".
Quizmaster	The 🎟️ Team Chips card ("Use for…", "Switch off"); the score buttons show the tripled amount.
Audience View	Nothing until the question is picked (no spoilers), then a ~3-second **dice moment**: "Triple Gamble! <team> plays for 3× — no passing", and a "🎲 Triple Gamble · 3× Value" label on the question.
After the game	A "🎲 Triple Gamble Chips" summary (who gambled, who saved their chip). Achievements 🎲 Triple Threat, 💎 High Roller (6× Blind It! right), ♠️ All In (used on the highest value available). Milestone 🎰 Gamble Master.

📸 *Real screenshots — the phone confirm screen and the TV dice moment.*

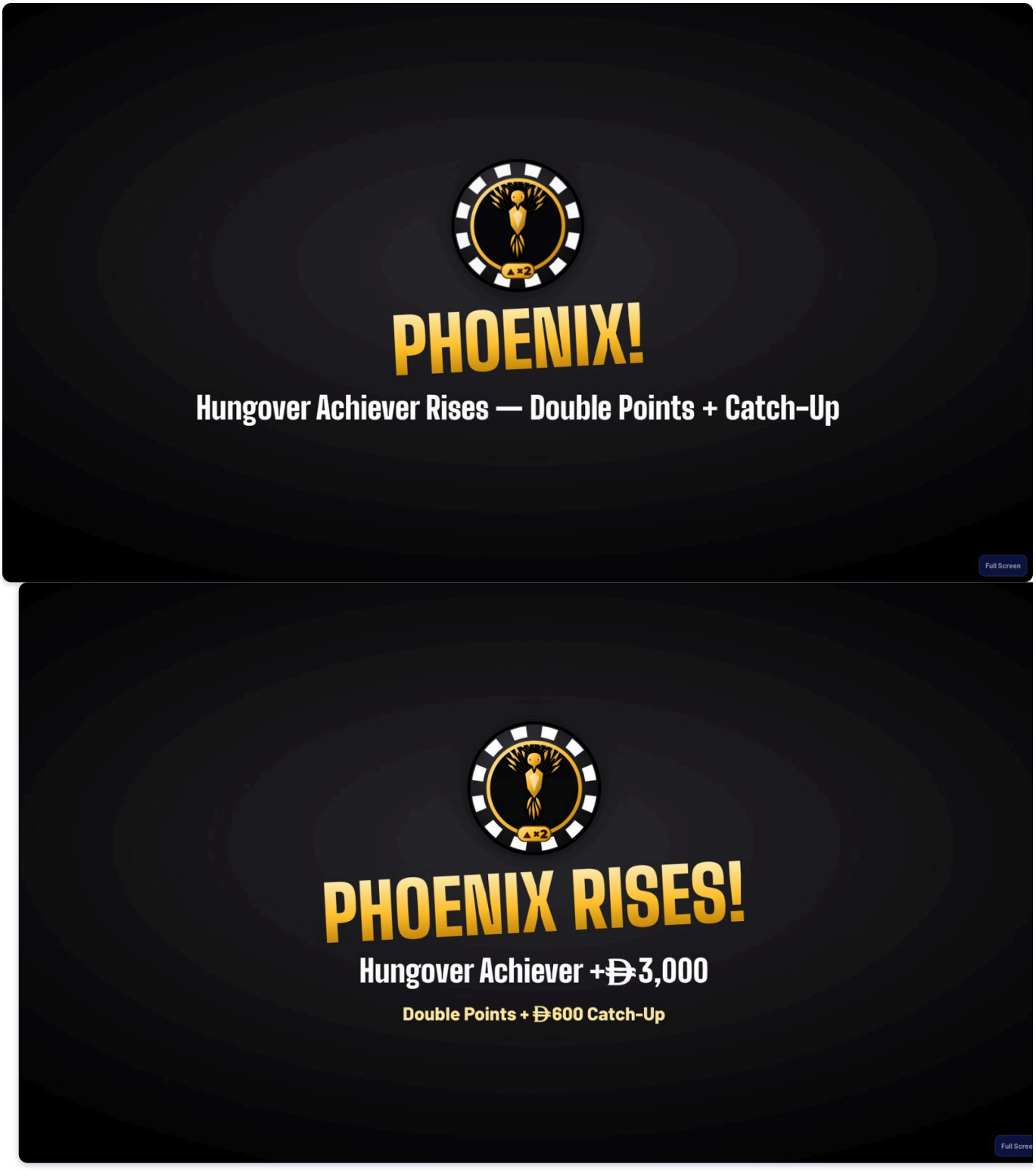
Numbers: Tequila Mockingbird (400 points) plays Triple Gamble on Wildcards 400: right → 400 × 3 = **+1,200** → **1,600**. Wrong would have been **–1,200** → **–800**. On a 1,000 Blind It! question: **±6,000**.

Tips: use it on a category you own, on a mid-value question; a Triple Gamble on a Blind It! question is the biggest swing in the game. **Common mistakes:** pressing Use *after* picking (too late — it's for the next pick); forgetting that a wrong answer can't be rescued by passing.

✅ Fixed in build 112: the "⚡ Speed Bonus" countdown is no longer shown under a Triple Gamble question (on the TV, the laptop and the tablet), because a Triple Gamble can never earn one. *(The screenshot above is from build 111 and still shows it.)*

12.3 🔥 Phoenix (chip)

Purpose	A catch-up power for a team that's far behind.
Rule switch	On in Full Show; off in Classic and Online Mode (hidden there).
Who gets it	Handed out at the **start of Rounds 2, 3 and 4** (never Round 1, never Mastermind It!) to **each team tied for last place** that hasn't used one — **only if it is more than 2,000 points behind the leader** (exactly 2,000 doesn't count). If every last-place team has already used theirs, the second-lowest team(s) get it (if more than 2,000 behind). If the last-place team is too close, **nobody** gets it. Nobody gets it if all teams are level.
Who activates	The holder, on its phone, on its own turn, before picking; or the Quizmaster ("Use for…").
How many	**Once per team per game** ("used" means played on a question — right, wrong or passed). Unused chips **expire** when the next round starts (and at Mastermind It!). A team never holds two.
Correct	**+ max(value , min(2 × value + catch-up , gap to the leader))**, where **catch-up = 20% of the gap to the leader** (measured when answering, rounded to the nearest 5). It draws level with the leader but **never passes them**, and it's **never less than the normal value**. Booked as one score entry.
Wrong	**Nothing lost** — and the question still passes on as normal.
Passing	Passing uses up the chip with no bonus.
Blind It! question	Not used on a Blind It! question — "The Phoenix chip doesn't work on a Blind It! question — it stays ready".
Compatibility	Never with another chip. Not in Phone Buzzer Mode — there it isn't handed out or announced at all.
Phone	A Phoenix chip card with **Use** ("A boost for the team that needs it most… If you're wrong you lose nothing. Each team can use the Phoenix once per game, and never in Mastermind It!.")
Quizmaster	The Team Chips card; the Correct button shows the real (capped) amount.
Audience View	"THE PHOENIX IS LIVE — <team> holds the Phoenix chip this round" after the round's board animation; a flickering 🔥 ember on the holder's score card (Phoenix holders are **public** by design); "PHOENIX! <team> rises — double points + catch-up" when used; "PHOENIX RISES! +3,000 · Double points + 600 catch-up" (or "… level with the leader — the Phoenix can't take you past").
Achievements	🔥 Rise From The Ashes (used it and won), 🚀 Phoenix Climber (climbed 2+ places in that round; called "Comeback Kid" before build 113).



📸 *Real screenshots — "PHOENIX!" and "PHOENIX RISES! Hungover Achiever +3,000 · Double Points + 600 Catch-Up".*

Numbers (all recalculated):

Holder	Leader	Gap	Tile	2 × tile + 20% gap	Capped at gap	Result
–600	2,400	3,000	1,200	2,400 + 600 = 3,000	3,000	**+3,000** → 2,400 (level) — *Chapter 17*
2,000	9,000	7,000	3,750	7,500 + 1,400 = 8,900	7,000	**+7,000** → 9,000 (level)
500	3,000	2,500	400	800 + 500 = 1,300	1,300	**+1,300** → 1,800
1,700	2,000	300*	2,000	4,000 + 60 = 4,060	300	max(2,000, 300) = **+2,000** → 3,700

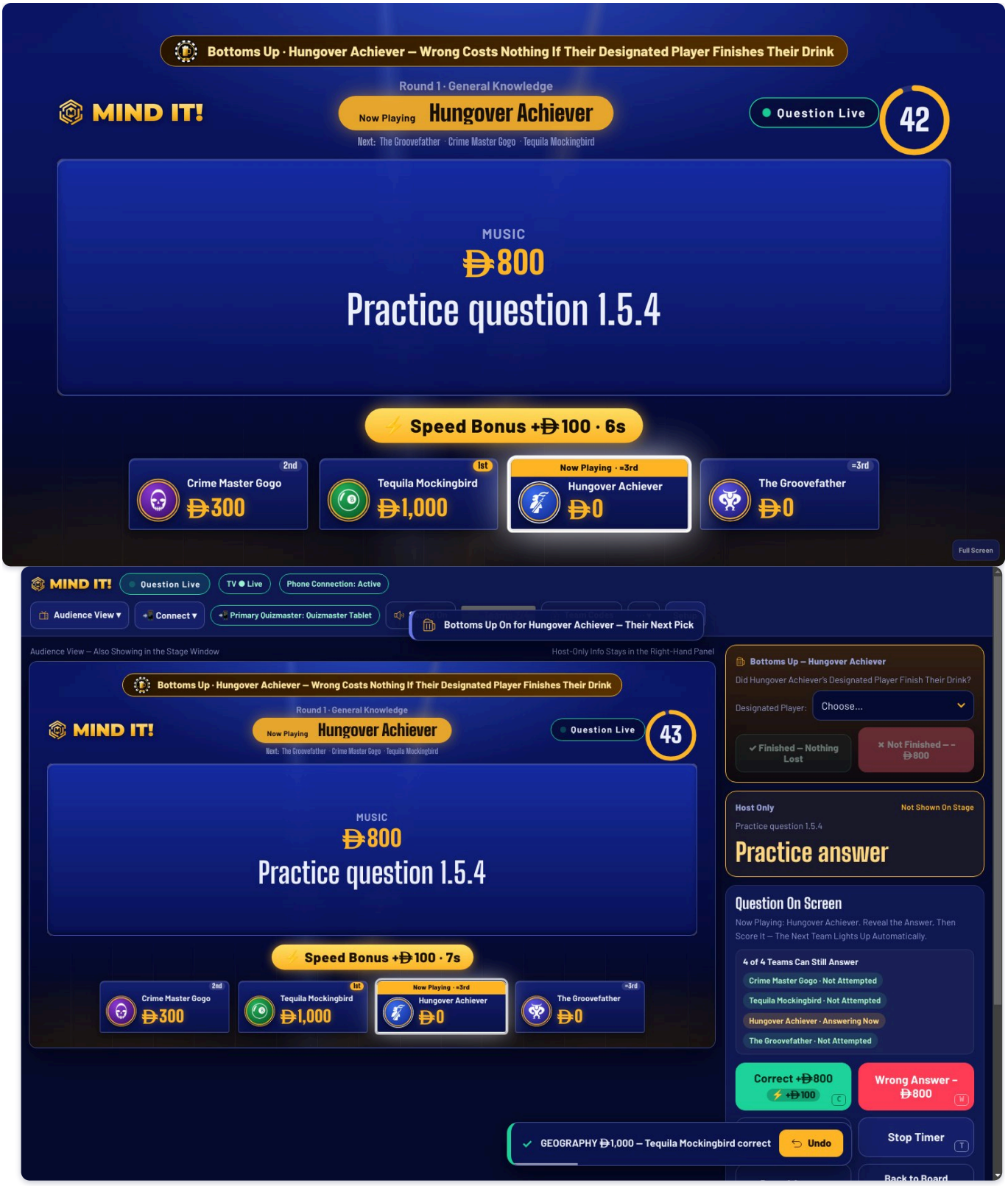
*The gap is measured when answering — it can shrink during the round after the chip was handed out.

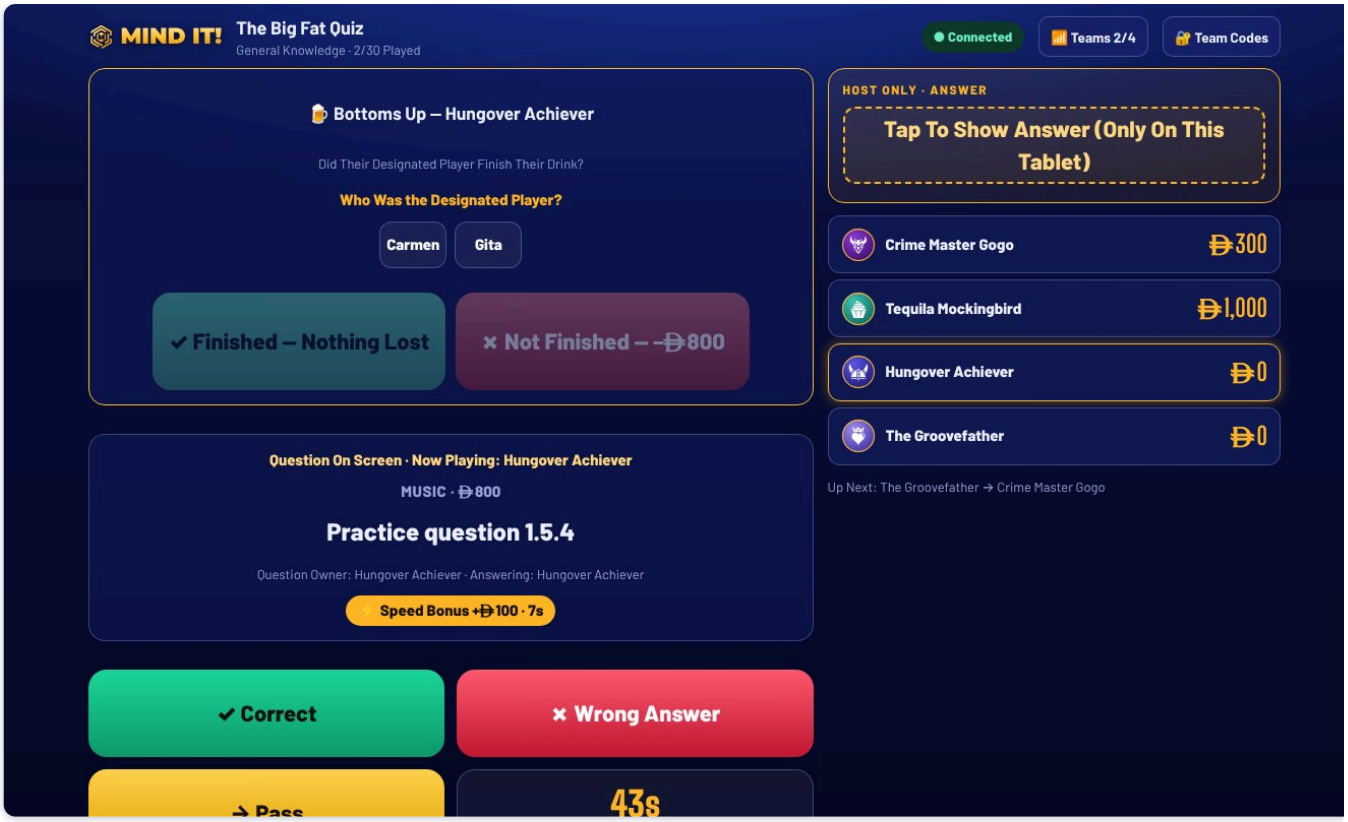
A fast Phoenix answer also gets the speed bonus *after* the cap, so it can end slightly above the leader — kept on purpose.

Tips: save it for a high-value question you're confident on — a wrong answer costs nothing anyway. **Common mistake:** waiting too long — it expires at the end of the round.

12.4 🍺 Bottoms Up (chip)

Purpose	A drinking-game safety net for Round 1.
Rule switch	On by default and in Full Show; off in Classic and Online Mode.
Who / when	Every team gets one, **Round 1 only**. The team switches it on, on its phone, on its own turn, before picking (or the Quizmaster: "Use Bottoms Up for <team>?" → **Use it**).
How many	**Once per team per game.** It expires when Round 2 (or Mastermind It!) starts.
Confirmation	The phone asks **"Who's your designated player?"** and lists only that team's players; **Confirm** waits for a choice. The Quizmaster can set or change the player on the laptop or tablet.
Correct	Normal points.
Wrong	Scoring pauses and the timer stops. The TV shows **"BOTTOMS UP!" — the team's designated player must finish their drink to lose nothing**. The Quizmaster taps **✓ Finished — Nothing Lost** (**0**) or **× Not Finished — −value** (normal loss). Then the question passes on as usual.
Passing	Passing uses up the chip.
Blind It! question	Not used on a Blind It! question — it stays ready.
Compatibility	Never with another chip. Not in Phone Buzzer Mode.
Audience View	A banner "Bottoms Up · <team> — Wrong costs nothing if their designated player finishes their drink" while the question is live.
Achievements	Go to the **designated player only**: 🍺 Bottoms Up! (finished) or 🥂 Glass Half Full (didn't). The app stores nothing about why anyone does or doesn't drink.


Bottoms Up · Hungover Achiever — Wrong Costs Nothing If Their Designated Player Finishes Their Drink
MIND IT!
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Now Playing Hungover Achiever
Next: The Groovefather · Crime Master Gogo · Tequila Mockingbird
Question Live
42
MUSIC
Ð800
Practice question 1.5.4
Speed Bonus +Ð100 · 6s
2nd
Crime Master Gogo
Ð300
1st
Tequila Mockingbird
Ð1,000
Now Playing · =3rd
Hungover Achiever
Ð0
=3rd
The Groovefather
Ð0
Full Screen
MIND IT!
Question Live
TV Live
Phone Connection: Active
Audience View
Connect
Primary Quizmaster: Quizmaster Tablet
Bottoms Up On for Hungover Achiever — Their Next Pick
Audience View — Also Showing in the Stage Window
Host-Only Info Stays in the Right-Hand Panel
Bottoms Up · Hungover Achiever — Wrong Costs Nothing If Their Designated Player Finishes Their Drink
Round 1 · General Knowledge
MIND IT!
Now Playing Hungover Achiever
Next: The Groovefather · Crime Master Gogo · Tequila Mockingbird
Question Live
43
MUSIC
Ð800
Practice question 1.5.4
Speed Bonus +Ð100 · 7s
2nd
Crime Master Gogo
Ð300
1st
Tequila Mockingbird
Ð1,000
Now Playing · =3rd
Hungover Achiever
Ð0
=3rd
The Groovefather
Ð0
Bottoms Up — Hungover Achiever
Did Hungover Achiever's Designated Player Finish Their Drink?
Designated Player:
Choose...
✓ Finished — Nothing Lost
× Not Finished — -Ð800
Host Only
Not Shown On Stage
Practice question 1.5.4
Practice answer
Question On Screen
Now Playing: Hungover Achiever. Reveal the Answer, Then Score It — The Next Team Lights Up Automatically.
4 of 4 Teams Can Still Answer
Crime Master Gogo · Not Attempted
Tequila Mockingbird · Not Attempted
Hungover Achiever · Answering Now
The Groovefather · Not Attempted
Correct +Ð800
+Ð100
C
Wrong Answer -Ð800
W
GEOGRAPHY Ð1,000 — Tequila Mockingbird correct
Undo
Stop Timer
T
Back to Board



📸 *Real screenshots — the TV while a Bottoms Up question is live, and the Quizmaster's decision on the laptop and tablet.*

Numbers: Crime Master Gogo (1,200) uses Bottoms Up on Music 800 and answers wrong. Designated player Asha finishes her drink → **0** (stays 1,200); the question passes to Tequila Mockingbird, who answers right: **+800**. If Asha hadn't finished: **−800** → 400.

Tips: any drink counts as long as it's the designated player's — keep it friendly and never pressure anyone; switch the rule off for family games (Online Mode and Classic do). **Common mistake:** forgetting to choose the designated player — the Quizmaster can set it on the laptop card.

12.5 The bonuses (recap)

- ⚡ **Speed Bonus** — 11.6. 🎁 **Pass-On Bonus** — 11.5. 🔥 **Never Mind It!** — 12.1.
- 🔥 **Streak Flames** (visual only): a team's score card catches fire at **3 correct in a row** ("🔥 3 IN A ROW"), "ON FIRE" at 5+. A pass doesn't break a streak; a wrong answer does. No points.
- 👑 **Returning Champion** (no points): last game's winners are introduced last in *Tonight's Teams*, wearing "👑 Champion ×N". **How the app decides (since build 122):** it looks at the most recent finished game with two or more teams and its winning team. A team tonight is the champion **only if every player of that winning team is on it** (extra players are fine). If the winner was a one-player team, the new team that player is on is the champion. If the winners are split across teams, or one of them isn't playing, there is no champion that night. Players deleted from Player Profiles aren't counted; teams without players are matched by team name. If last game ended in a tie, each winning team counts on its own and only one team wears the crown — the first in team order. **"N wins in a row"** counts back through the games whose whole winning team is on tonight's team.

12.6 Special abilities — comparison table

	💰 Blind It! question	🎲 Triple Gamble	🔥 Phoenix	🍺 Bottoms Up
Type	Hidden tile	Chip	Chip	Chip

	💰 Blind It! question	🎲 Triple Gamble	🔥 Phoenix	🍺 Bottoms Up
Who triggers	Whoever picks it	Team (phone) / QM	Team (phone) / QM	Team (phone) / QM
When	Any round except Mastermind It!	Own turn, before pick	Own turn, before pick, Rounds 2–4	Own turn, before pick, Round 1 only
Limit	1/2/2/3 per round	Once per game	Once per game (if eligible)	Once per game
Right	+ wager	+ 3× (Blind It!: 6×)	+ double + 20% of gap (capped at the leader)	+ value
Wrong	– wager	– 3× (Blind It!: 6×)	0	0 if drink finished, else – value
Pass allowed	No	No	Yes (uses the chip)	Yes (uses the chip)
Speed bonus	No	No	Yes (after the cap)	Yes (normal question)
On a Blind It!	—	6× fixed wager	Stays unused	Stays unused
Presets	All	Full Show	Full Show	Full Show

13. Game Modes

13.1 Standard Mode (default) — best for beginners ✅

Teams take turns in order; the team **says** its answer; the Quizmaster marks it. Everything in Chapters 10–12 applies. Chips work only in this mode.

Turn order (6 · Advanced → Advanced Game Rules → Turn Order):

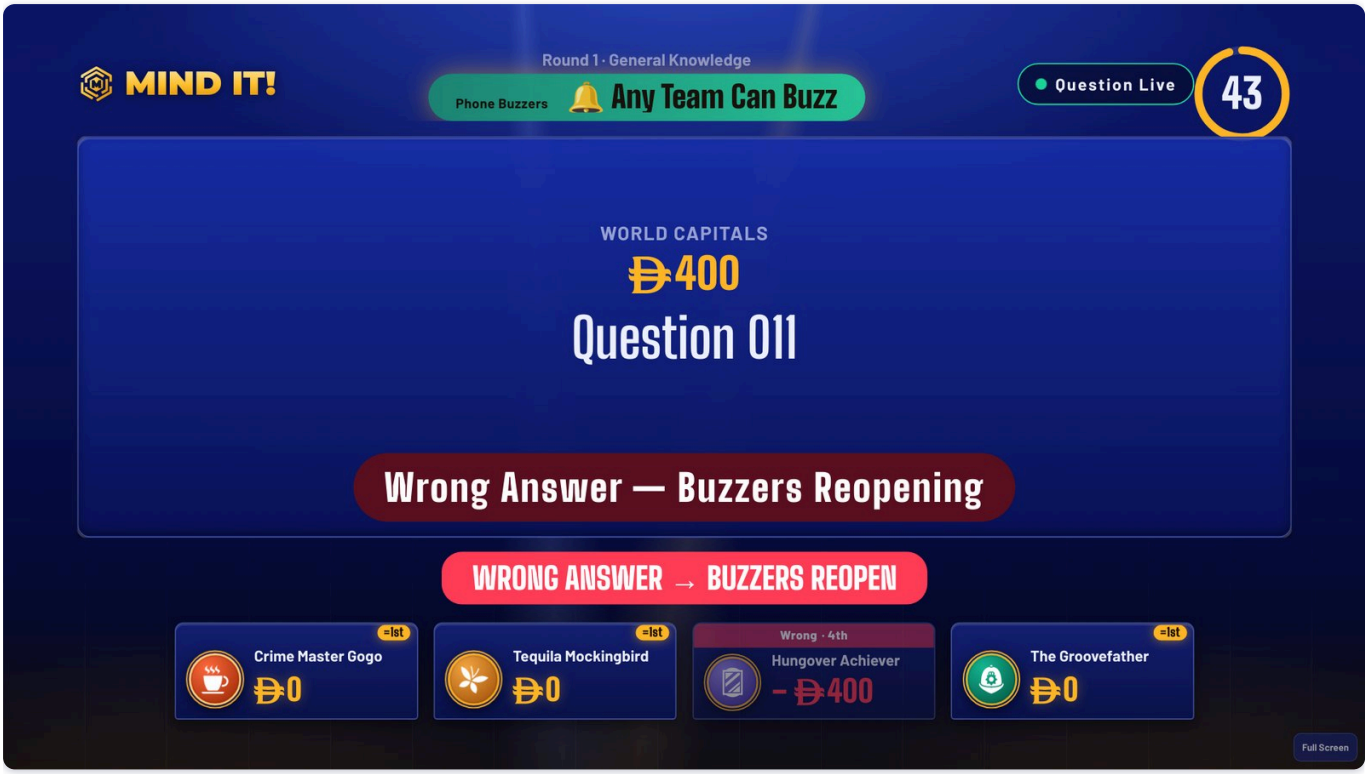
- **Teams take turns in order (1 → 2 → 3 → 1)** — default. The team whose turn it is when a question opens "owns" it. Wrong answers and passes move **the same question** to the next team. **The next question always goes to the team after the owner** — e.g. A passes, B answers → the next question is B's.
- **Classic — whoever answers correctly picks next**; a wrong answer doesn't move control.
- Host overrides: **Make Active** (More controls → Teams & Turn Order) and **A different team answered? (host override)** on the question.
- **Mark Away / Back in:** an Away team is skipped for turns, buzzers and Mastermind It! (at least one team must stay in).

13.2 Phone Buzzer Mode ✅ (🟡 not tested with real phones)

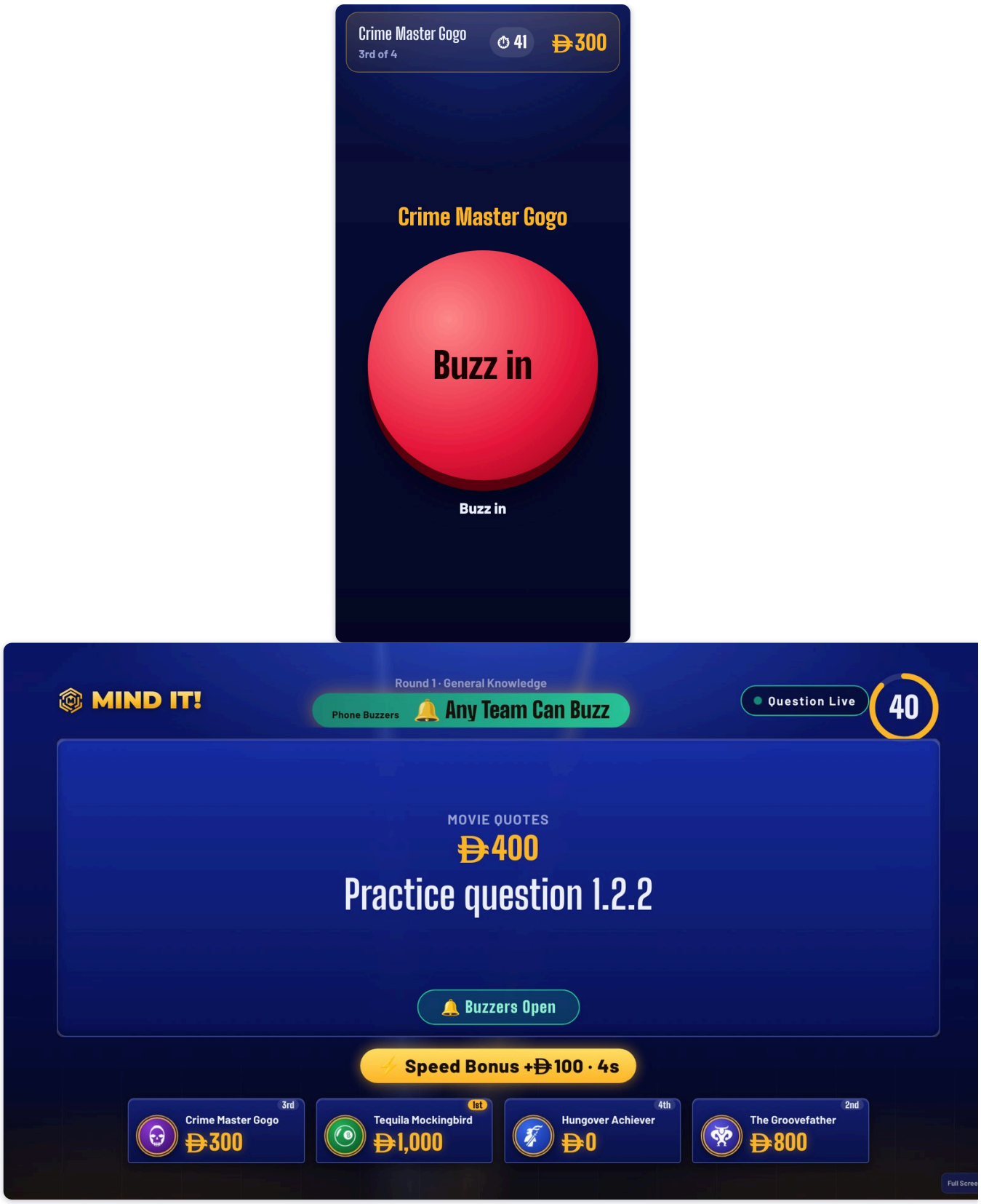
Switch it on: 3 · Gameplay & Rules → Answering Mode → **Phone Buzzer Mode** (needs the laptop app). It can be changed mid-game (it asks, and applies from the next question). Try 📳 **Buzzer Test** first (⋯ / 📶 Devices or 6 · Advanced → Help & Tests).

- **Buzzers open on normal questions.** Blind It! questions and Mastermind It! keep their wager flows (no buzzers).
- **Early-Buzz Lockout** (on except Online Mode): buzzers arm after a reading time (about 45 ms per character of the question, between 1.2 and 6 seconds). Phones say "Wait for the light..."; the TV shows "👂 LISTEN..." then **"🔔 BUZZERS OPEN"**. An early tap locks that team out for **½ second**. **Open Buzzers Now** skips the wait.
- **The first valid buzz wins — by arrival at the laptop**, never by phone clocks. Repeated or late taps are rejected.
- **Wrong:** that team is out for this question and buzzers reopen for the others (or close if nobody is left). **Correct:** buzzers close. **Time's up:** buzzers close.
- **Quizmaster tools: Cancel Buzz**, **Reopen Buzzers**. On the tablet, Correct/Wrong apply to whoever buzzed; until someone buzzes, the tablet shows 🔔 **Waiting For A Buzz...** instead (build 116).
- **On the TV** (build 114): while any team can buzz, the top bar says **Phone Buzzers · 🔔 Any Team Can Buzz** (no "Now Playing" team and no turn-order line); the team that buzzes becomes **Now Playing / Answering**; after a wrong answer the banner says **WRONG ANSWER → BUZZERS REOPEN** (or *No Teams Left To Buzz*). The ⚡ speed-bonus countdown disappears once a team other than the picker has buzzed — only the picking team can earn it.
- **Scoring** is exactly as in Standard Mode. Buzzing alone earns nothing. **Chips are not available** — the Phoenix isn't handed out in this mode (nor without the laptop app, e.g. on the browser-only web link — build 115) (the round log says "not given — Phone Buzzer Mode").
- **Phone states:** Wait for the light · BUZZ IN · Buzzed ("You're answering") · Too early · LOCKED ("Team X buzzed first") · Wrong — wait for a reopen · Waiting.
- Extras: "FIRST BUZZ: Team 2 · 0.13 s", buzzer Fun Stats (Fastest Buzzer, Quickest On Average, Jumped The Gun) and the ⚡ Lightning Reflexes achievement.

📸 *Real screenshot (build 114) — the TV while any team can buzz.*



📸 *Real screenshot (build 114) — after a wrong answer: "WRONG ANSWER → BUZZERS REOPEN".*



📸 *Real screenshots — the phone buzzer, and the TV with buzzers open as it looked in build 111 (before the build 114 changes shown above).*

Which mode? Beginners and mixed groups: **Standard**. Quick-fire regulars who love a race: **Buzzer**. Standard is also the only mode with chips.

13.3 Other ways to play

- **Rules presets:** Classic (pure quiz), Full Show (everything), Online Mode (for Teams calls: Speed Bonus on with a 15-second window, no Phoenix, 2 rounds + Mastermind It!, wagers and Mastermind It! answers by private chat, Teams

Presentation Mode) — 5.Step 7.

- 🎭 **Rehearsal** ✅ — "Play through the game to test the TV, sound, timers and phones. Nothing counts: no history, player stats, achievements, leaderboard or 'questions used'. When you finish, everything goes back exactly as it is now." Start it from Setup; finish with **End Rehearsal**. Every team doesn't need a player in a rehearsal; Triple Gamble is off.
- **Tablet-only game** 🟡 — **Start New Game** on the tablet runs the whole quiz on the tablet (no laptop). Without the laptop app there is no local server, so phones and chips aren't available; wagers are entered by the Quizmaster.
- 📱 **Phone Remote** 🟡 — a simple Quizmaster remote on any phone browser (Correct, Wrong, Pass, Reveal, Next, timer and Undo, with the answer only on the remote). Turn it on in 6 · Advanced → **Turn On Phone Remote**; it shows a QR code and a PIN.

---

14. Timers

14.1 The defaults ✅

Timer	Default	Range
Normal question	**45 s**	5–600 s
Mastermind It!	**45 s** (with thinking music; 60 s before build 139)	10–600 s
Passed question	**30 s + time left, max 45 s**	—
After a wrong answer	**a fresh 45 s** for the next team	—
Speed bonus window	**10 s** (Online Mode: **15 s**)	1–60 s
Extend	**+30 s per press**	as many presses as you like

14.2 Starting, pausing, resuming

- **Start:** questions start their timer automatically **0.7 s** after appearing (setting *Start the Question Timer Automatically*, on by default). If it's off, start it yourself (key **T** or the timer button).
- **Pause / resume: Pause Timer** on the laptop, or key **T** (the timer button on the tablet: "⏸ Pause"). Press again — **Resume Timer**, **T**, or ▶ **Resume** on the tablet — and the clock carries on **from the seconds left**, and the ring carries on from where it paused (since build 152; before, T and the tablet's ▶ started again from full). With no time left, after TIME'S UP, or on a new question, **T** starts a full clock.
- **One set of words (since build 152): Pause · Resume · End**. **End Timer** ends it now (time's up). The tablet's ↻ **Restart Timer** (More Controls) still starts the clock again from full.

14.3 Extending (+30 Sec) ✅

- Adds **exactly 30 seconds** per press, never resets the clock, can be pressed again and again.
- Works on normal, passed, Blind It! question and Mastermind It! questions. When paused, it adds to the paused time.
- **Not after TIME'S UP.** The tablet has its own **+30 Sec** button.
- The TV shows "⏱ TIMER EXTENDED +30 SEC". Every extension is logged.
- Mind It! never extends automatically.

> **Example (Chapter 17):** Hungover Achiever is struggling with Music 1,000. The Quizmaster presses +30 Sec: the clock goes from 45 to **75** seconds. (The *Overtime Hero* achievement is for a correct answer after an extension.)

14.4 When time runs out

- **Normal question, other teams still to try (turn order):** a host card ⏰ **Time's up for <team>** offers **WRONG ANSWER** (–value), **PASS** or **Dismiss**. Nothing happens automatically. Common practice: if they gave no answer, PASS; if they said something wrong, WRONG.
- **Blind It! question and Triple Gamble:** no card — mark it Correct or Wrong yourself.
- **Mastermind It!:** nothing is locked when the 45 seconds end. Phones can still submit; you decide when to move on.
- **Passed after time's up:** the next team gets 30 s.
- **Sounds:** a soft **heartbeat in the last 10 seconds** (one beat per second, two per second in the last 5, louder towards the end; setting in 5 · Audio & Presentation), and beeps near the end. Phones show a header countdown that turns gold in the last 10 seconds.

14.5 Timer synchronisation and connection hiccups

The **laptop owns the clock**. The TV window, the tablet and the phones all show the laptop's timer. If the tablet or a phone drops out for a moment, the laptop's clock keeps running and the device catches up when it reconnects. (Build 110 stopped Windows from slowing down the host window when it's in the background, which was the cause of earlier TV "Reconnecting" messages and stuttering timers.)

If the **laptop** itself closes, the timer stops with it. Reopen Mind It! and **Resume saved game** — you're back on the same question; restart or extend the timer as fair (Chapter 22).

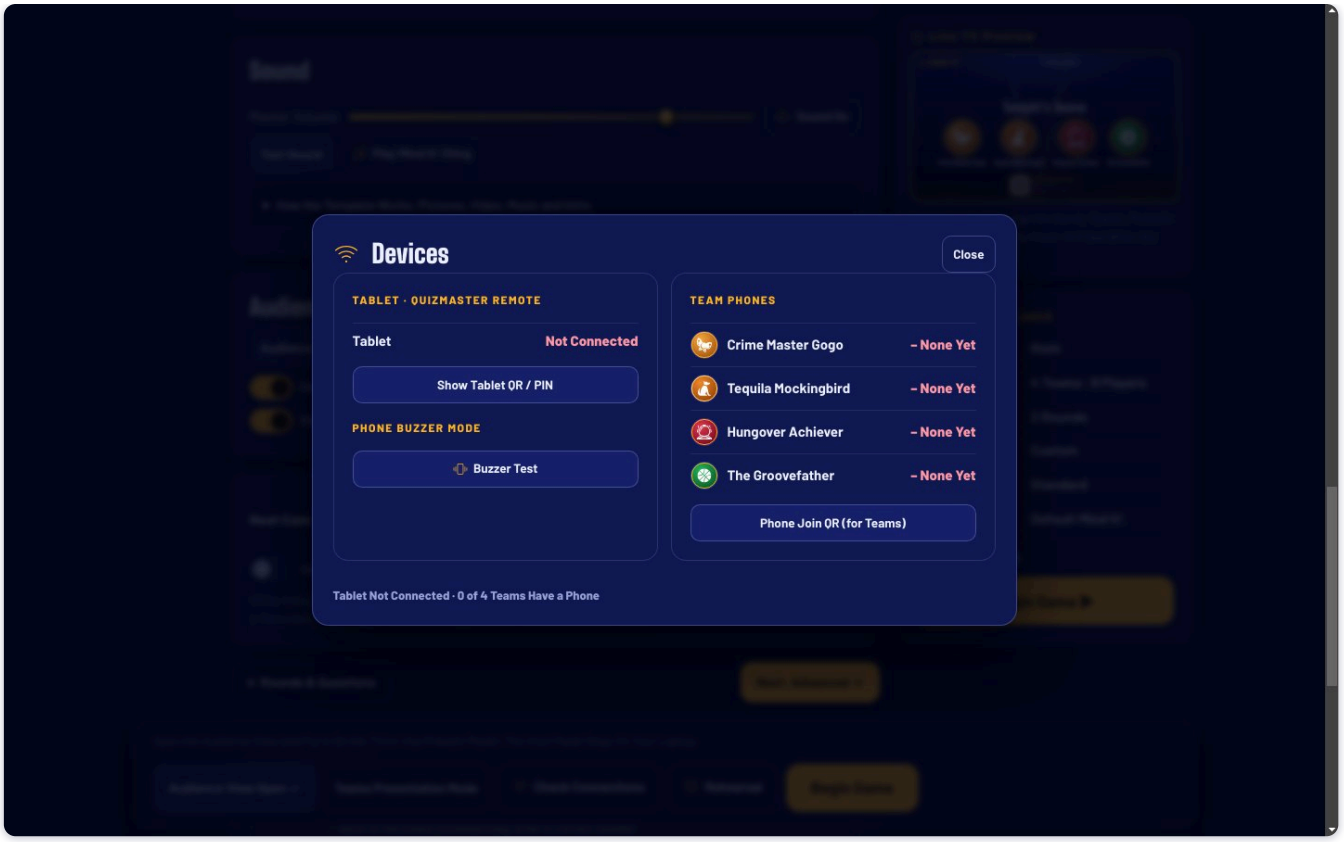
PART FIVE — HOSTING THE GAME

15. Every Quizmaster Button Explained

Most buttons exist on **both** the laptop and the tablet. Keyboard shortcuts work on the laptop (Appendix C).

15.1 The laptop's top bar (always there)

Button	What it does	When to use it
Status pills (**On the Board / Question Live / Answer Revealed / Standings…**, **TV ● Live**, **Phone Connection: Active**)	Show what's happening right now.	Glance at them.
📺 **Audience View ▾**	**Open Audience Window** (put it on the TV), **Present On This Screen** (full-screen here; Esc to exit), **Teams Presentation Mode** (for sharing in a Teams call), **TV Display Settings** (screen size, safe margins, check the TV).	Before the game; if the TV window was closed.
📲 **Connect ▾**	📶 **Devices** (tablet, team phones and buzzers at a glance, with **Phone Join QR (for Teams)** — the players' join code), **Connect Device** (QR + PIN), **Phone Remote** (the Quizmaster's simple remote on any phone browser — never show its code to players).	Before the game.
Tablet status (e.g. **Primary Quizmaster: Quizmaster Tablet**)	Which device is in control.	—
🔊 **Sound On / Off**	Mute or unmute.	Speeches, announcements.
📶 **Teams x/y**	Connected team phones. **Tap for Connection Health.**	Whenever a team says "my phone isn't working".
🔐 **Team Codes**	Every team's code (host only) and whether a phone is connected.	When a team needs its code.
⋯ ▾	⌨ **Keyboard Shortcuts** (since build 152 — every key on one sheet; or press **?**), ☕ **Intermission** ("Back in 5 minutes" on the TV, with a countdown, the standings and, since build 134, quiet theme music), 🎵 **Play the Mind It! Sting**, ★ **About & Credits** (version and build, the intro theme's ElevenLabs credit, open-source thanks and, since build 114, a **Licences** section), 💾 **Backups & Restore**.	Breaks; backups.
Setup	Opens Setup and **pauses** the game (Return to game / Start a new game).	Fixing a question or setting mid-game.



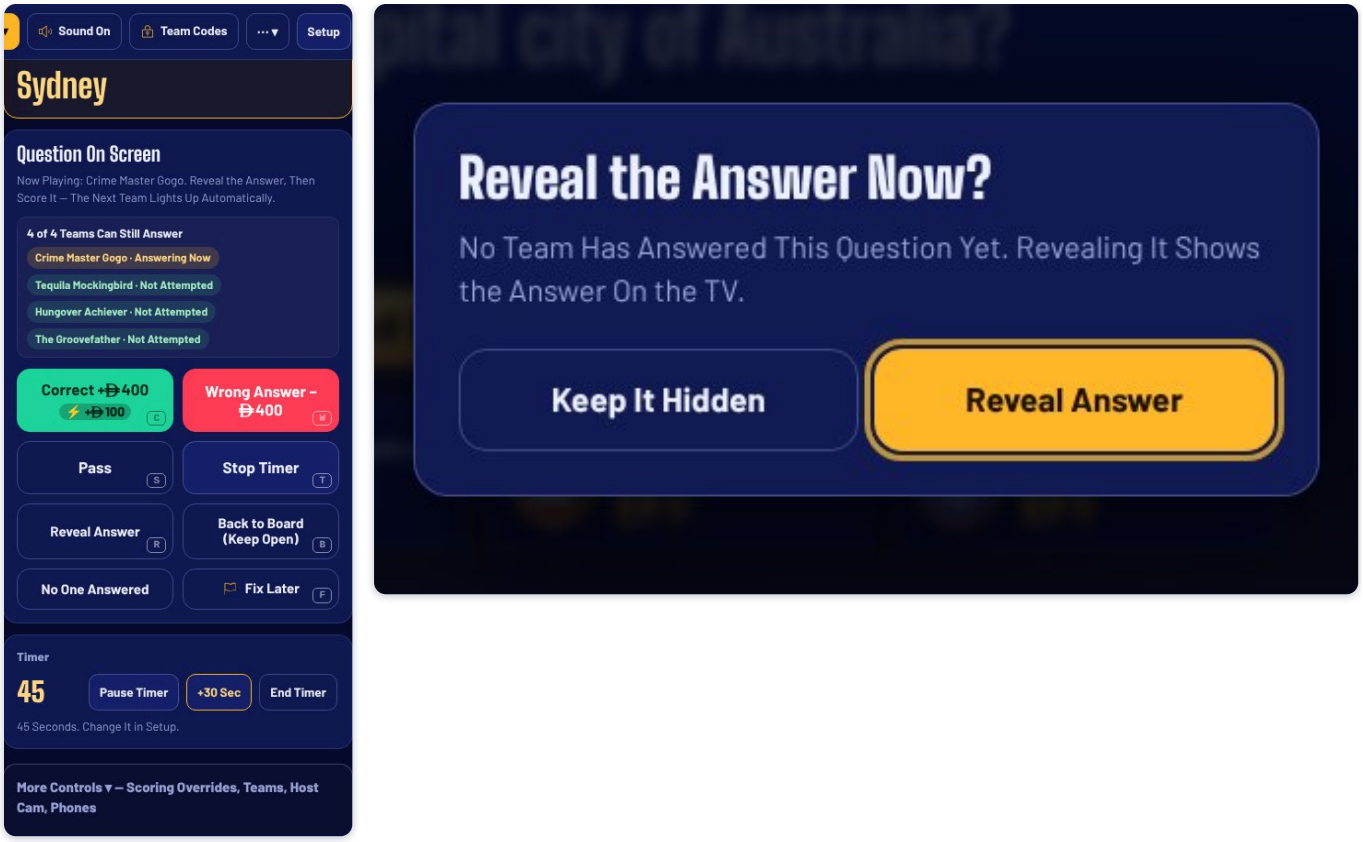
📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — Connect ▾ → 📶 Devices: the tablet, buzzer test and team phones at a glance. "Phone Join QR (for Teams)" opens the players' join code (Chapter 8).*

15.2 While picking (the board)

Button	What it does
Click a value tile on the board preview (or tap it on the tablet)	Opens that question for the team whose turn it is.
Show Standings (P)	Shows the standings on the TV for a moment (press again or continue to go back).
🎟️ **Team Chips ▾**	Use a chip for the picking team, or switch one off (Chapter 12).
⏱ **One More Question** (build 140)	Time's nearly up: the **next question is the last of the round**. The TV shows **"⏱ LAST QUESTION OF THE ROUND"** under the team in play; after that question (scored, or No One Answered) the **round summary comes up by itself** ("That was the last question"). The button turns into **✕ Cancel Last Question** until then. **Back to Board (keep open)** doesn't count — the next question you open is the last one. Not offered when only one question is left.
⭐ **Go to the Final** (build 140)	Short of time: ends this round now (like **End Round Early**), **skips the rounds still to come**, shows the round summary (**"Straight to Mastermind It!"**, up next: Mastermind It!) and then starts Mastermind It! Scores are kept. **Asks first** and names the rounds it skips; the tablet asks on the tablet. Mastermind It! is numbered after the last round played (after Round 2 it is **"Round 3 · Mastermind It!"**). Only when the game has Mastermind It! and there are rounds still to come; **Resume** on the round summary cancels it.
More Controls ▾ → Teams & Turn Order	**Make Active** (it's this team's turn), **Mark Away / Back in**, **Adjust Score**.

15.3 While a question is live

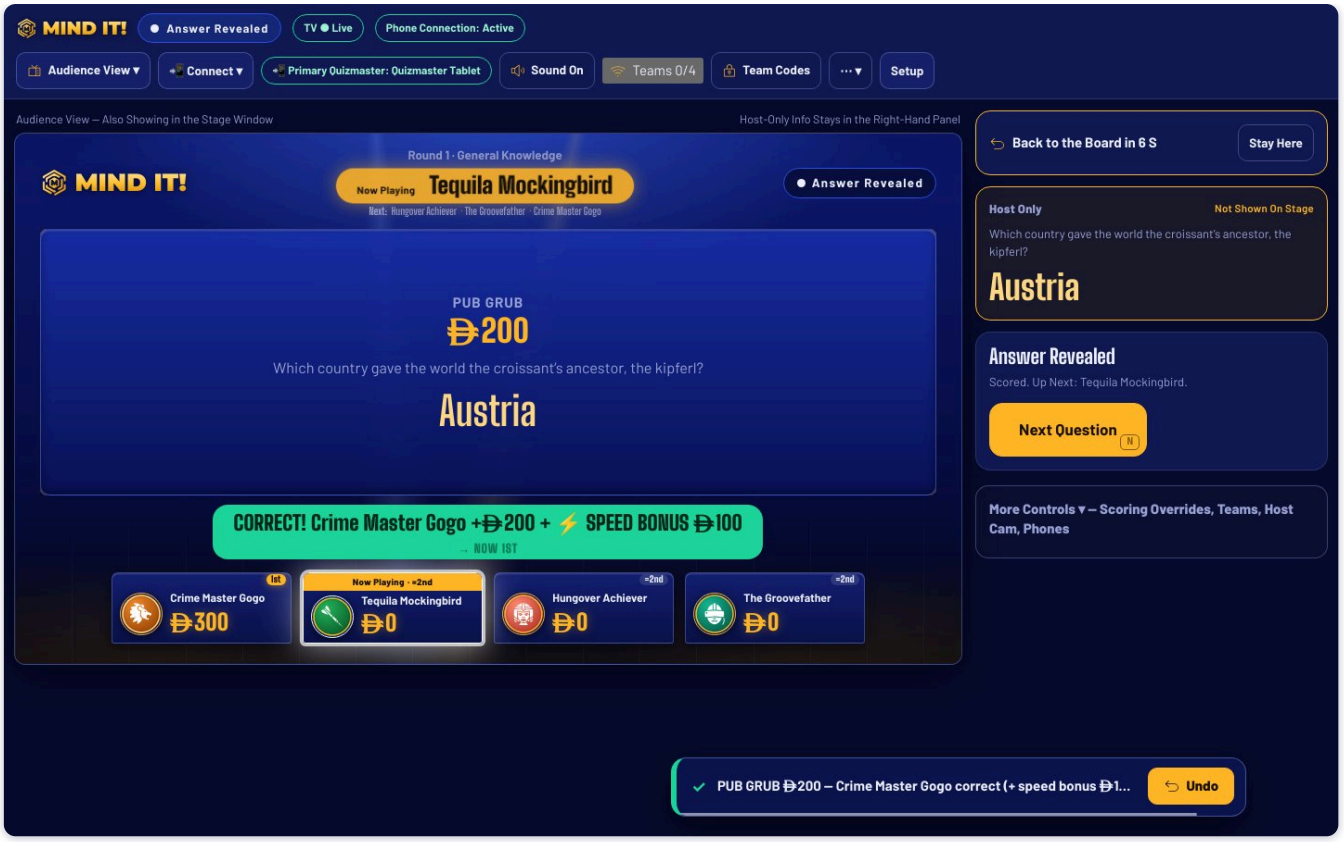
Button	Key	What it does	When
Correct +value	C	Award the points (+ bonuses). The TV shows the answer. While the speed bonus can be earned the button adds it: **Correct +200 ⚡ +100** (build 113).	The answering team said the right answer.
Wrong Answer –value	W	Deduct the points; pass the question to the next team with a fresh clock.	Wrong answer.
Wrong, no penalty	X	No deduction; the question moves on.	A fair "near miss" you don't want to punish, e.g. a technical problem.
Pass	S	No change; next team, timer = 30 s + time left (max 45).	The team says "pass".
Pause Timer / Resume Timer	T	Pause the clock; **Resume** carries on from the seconds left (since build 152).	Discussion, interruptions.
Timer card: Pause / Resume · +30 Sec · End Timer	—	The same, plus add 30 seconds or end the time now. Since build 152 the card sits under the TV preview.	Fairness calls.
Reveal Answer	R	Show the answer on the TV without scoring. **Since build 141**, if no team has answered yet (taking turns, or a Blind It! question) it asks first: **Keep It Hidden** or **Reveal Answer** — so a mis-tap can't spoil the question. In Classic turns it never asks.	Nobody got it, or you want to show it after a ruling.
⚑ Fix Later	F	Flag the question to fix after the game (wrong answer, typo, unclear wording). Tap again (**⚑ Flagged — Remove Flag**) to take the flag off. Also in Mastermind It!, and on the tablet.	You notice a problem but don't want to stop the game.
Back to Board (Keep Open)	B	Go back to the board without scoring; the question stays open to pick later.	You opened the wrong tile.
No One Answered	—	Close the question before every team has had a go: it asks first, shows the answer with "No One Answered" for 3 s (7 s before build 146), then the board.	You decide to stop early. (When every team has had its go, it happens by itself.)
A different team answered? (host override)	—	Score a different team than the one whose turn it is.	Someone shouted out of turn and you allow it.
⏰ Time's up for <team>: WRONG ANSWER / PASS / Dismiss	—	Appears when time runs out.	Decide what the silence meant.



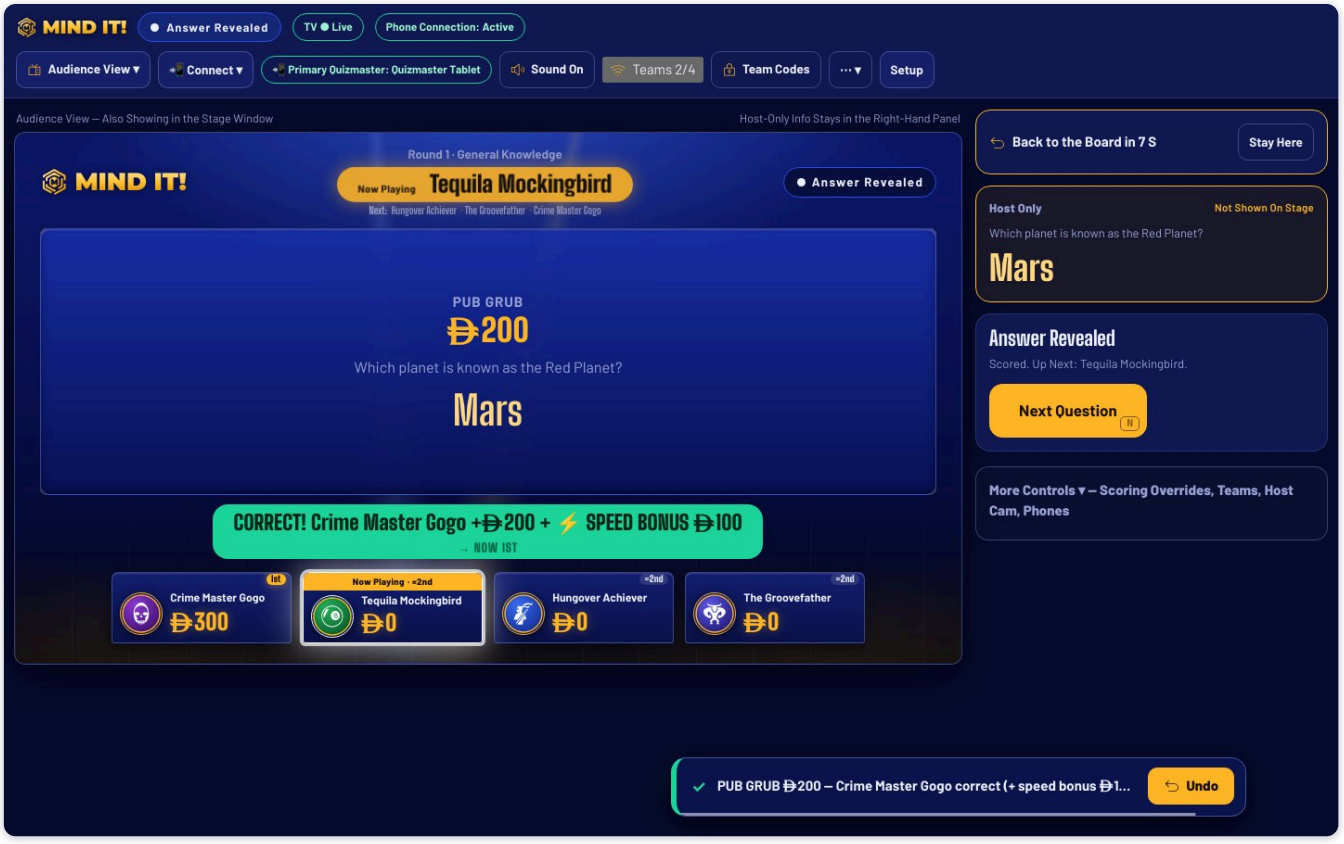
📸 *Real screenshots (build 141) — ⚑ Fix Later on the question screen (left), and the question an early Reveal asks (right).*

15.4 After an answer

Button	Key	What it does
Next Question	N	Back to the board for the next team. (Mind It! also returns automatically 3 s — since build 146; it was 7 s — after a correct answer, a Blind It! question or a Triple Gamble — tap **Stay Here** to stop that. After No One Answered it always returns.)
Stay Here	—	Keep the answer on screen (for a story or an argument).
Undo Last Score	U	Reverse the last score entry (asks first).
↩ **Undo** on the pop-up (build 140)	—	After **every** score the laptop shows what was scored at the bottom of the screen with an ↩ **Undo** button, for **8 seconds**. One tap undoes it at once — no question asked. The next score replaces it; it is never on the TV and is hidden in Present mode.



📸 *Real screenshot (build 140) — Crime Master Gogo scored; the pop-up at the bottom offers ↩ Undo for 8 seconds.*



📸 *Real screenshot — after a correct answer: the TV copy shows the banner; the right panel offers Stay Here and Next Question.*

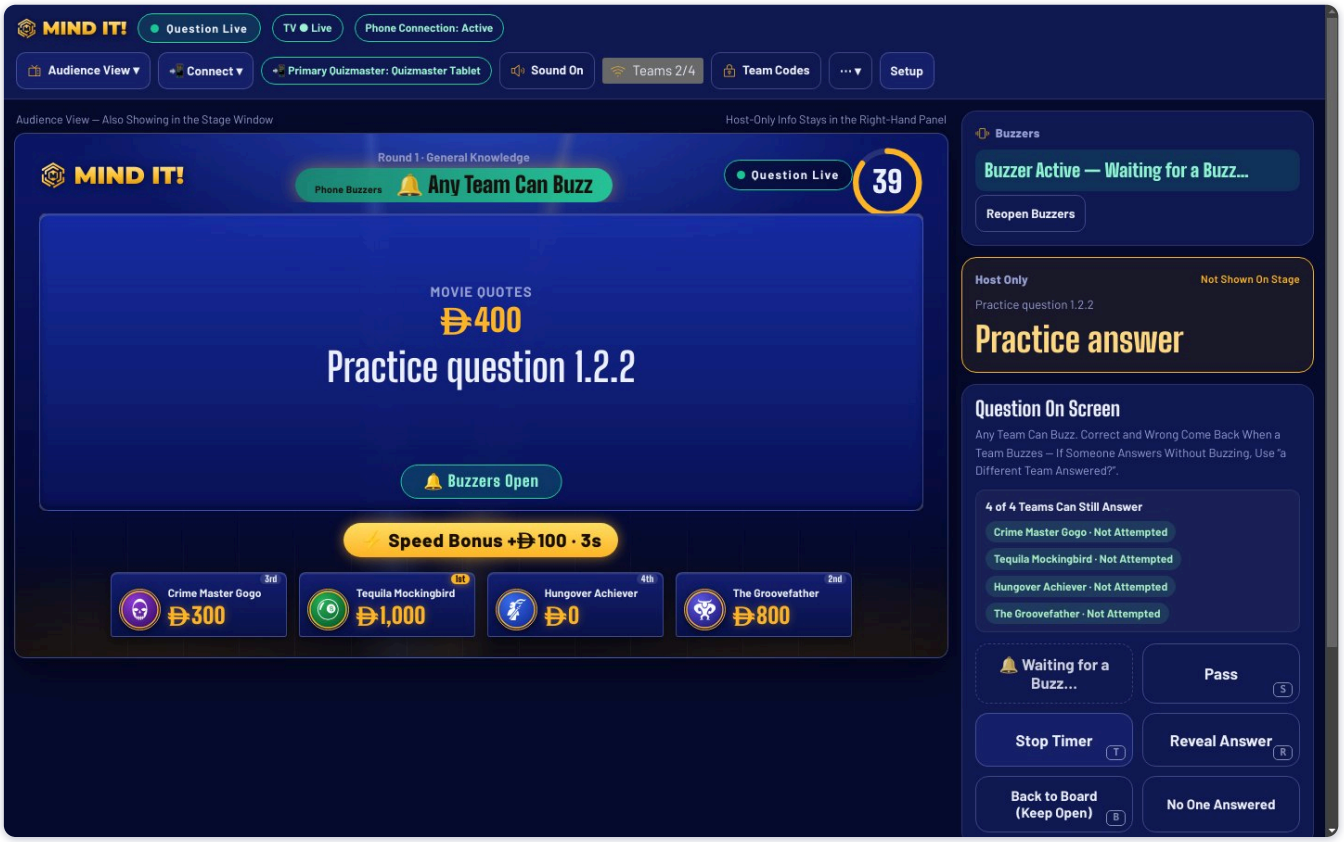
15.5 Blind It!, Rewind It!, wager and chip controls

- **Lock Wager & Show Question** — after typing a team's Blind It! wager (or the phone does it automatically). Quick picks **All in / Half / Minimum**.

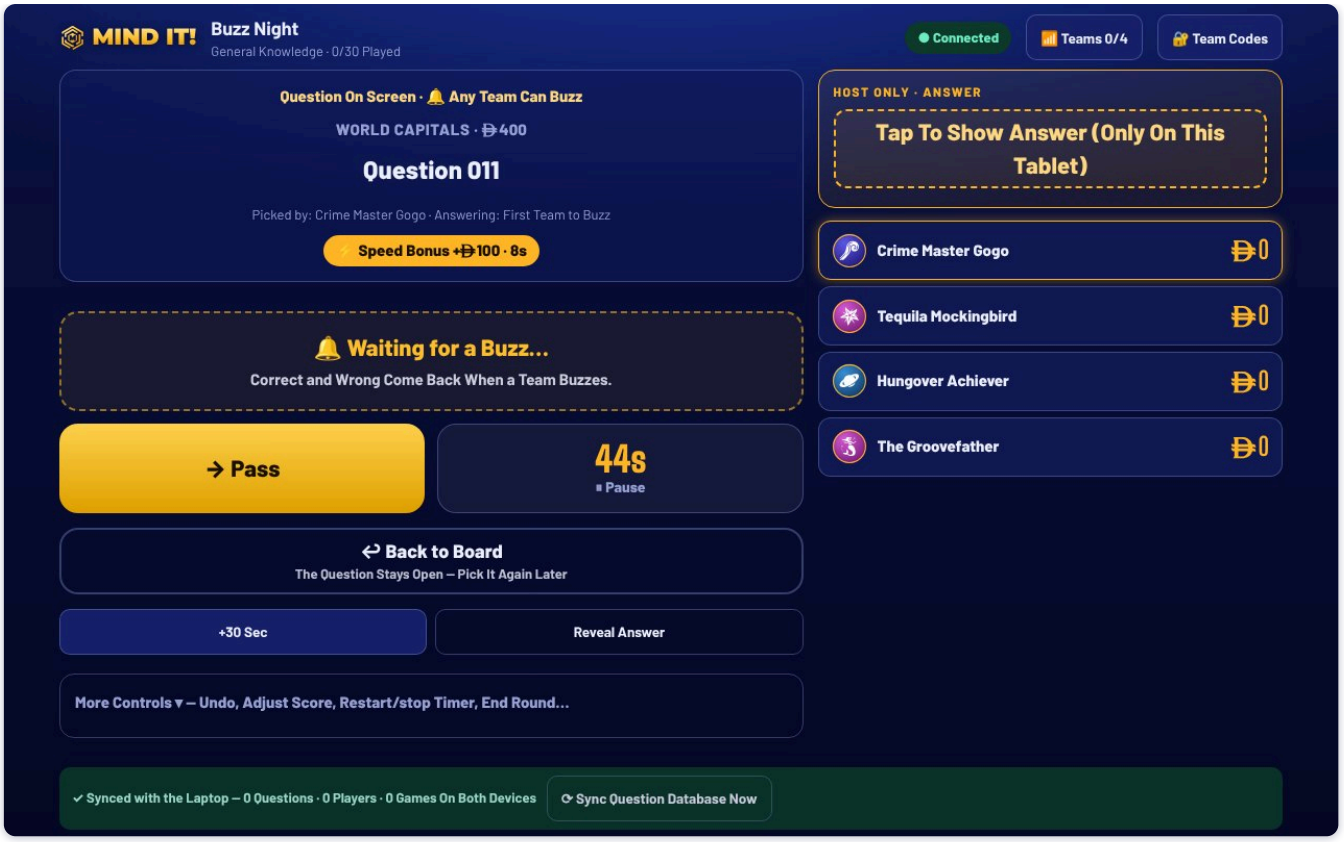
- ✏️ **Change a Wager** — change a Blind It! wager until it's scored, or a Mastermind It! wager until that team is revealed. The TV keeps amounts hidden.
- **Bottoms Up decision** — **✓ Finished — Nothing Lost** / **× Not Finished — −value**, and the designated-player picker.
- 🎟️ **Team Chips** — **Use for <team>** / **Switch off**.

15.6 Buzzer controls (Phone Buzzer Mode)

Open Buzzers Now (skip the reading time), **Cancel Buzz** (ignore this buzz), **Reopen Buzzers**. Correct / Wrong act on the team that buzzed. **Until a team buzzes** (build 115) the laptop shows 🔔 **Waiting For A Buzz...** instead of Correct / Wrong, the C / W / X keys do nothing, and the tablet shows the same 🔔 **Waiting For A Buzz...** panel in place of its Correct / Wrong, with **Any Team Can Buzz** on its top line (build 116) — so no team can be scored by accident. Once a team buzzes, the laptop's hint says who buzzed first and that a wrong answer reopens the buzzers; after scoring it says who **picks next** (build 117). If a team answers without buzzing, use **A different team answered? (host override)**.



💣 Real screenshot (build 116) — the laptop in Phone Buzzer Mode before anyone buzzes ("Buzzer Active — Waiting for a Buzz..."): Correct / Wrong come back when a team buzzes.

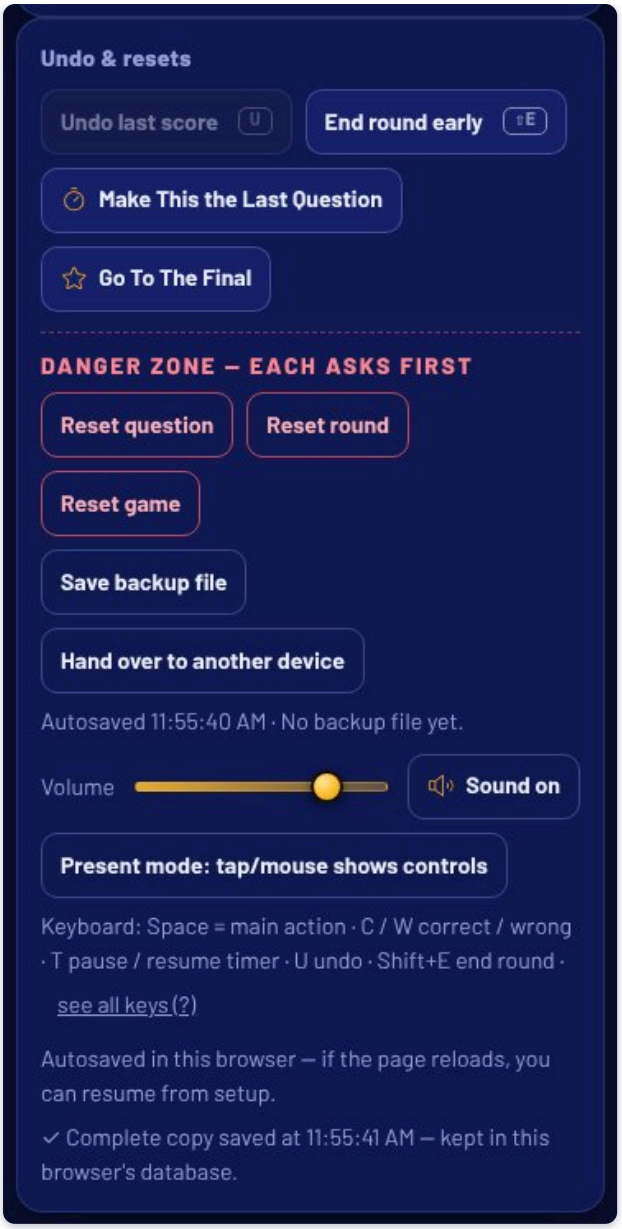


📸 *Real screenshot (build 117) — the tablet in Phone Buzzer Mode before anyone buzzes: Pass and the timer stay, Correct / Wrong come back when a team buzzes.*

15.7 Round and game navigation (More Controls ▾ → Undo & Resets)

📸 *Real screenshot (build 152) — Undo & Resets in More Controls: Undo first, then the **Danger zone**, volume, Present Mode and the keyboard note with **see all keys (?)**.*

Since build 152: Undo last score (U) comes first; **Reset Question**, **Reset Round** and **Reset Game** sit in their own outlined **Danger zone — each asks first** row, away from Undo and ⭐ Go to the Final. Every "are you sure?" box for End Round, the resets, Undo and End Game opens with **Cancel** selected, so pressing Space or Enter by mistake cancels it. On wide screens the card moves up under the TV preview on the Blind It!, Rewind It! and Mastermind It! screens.

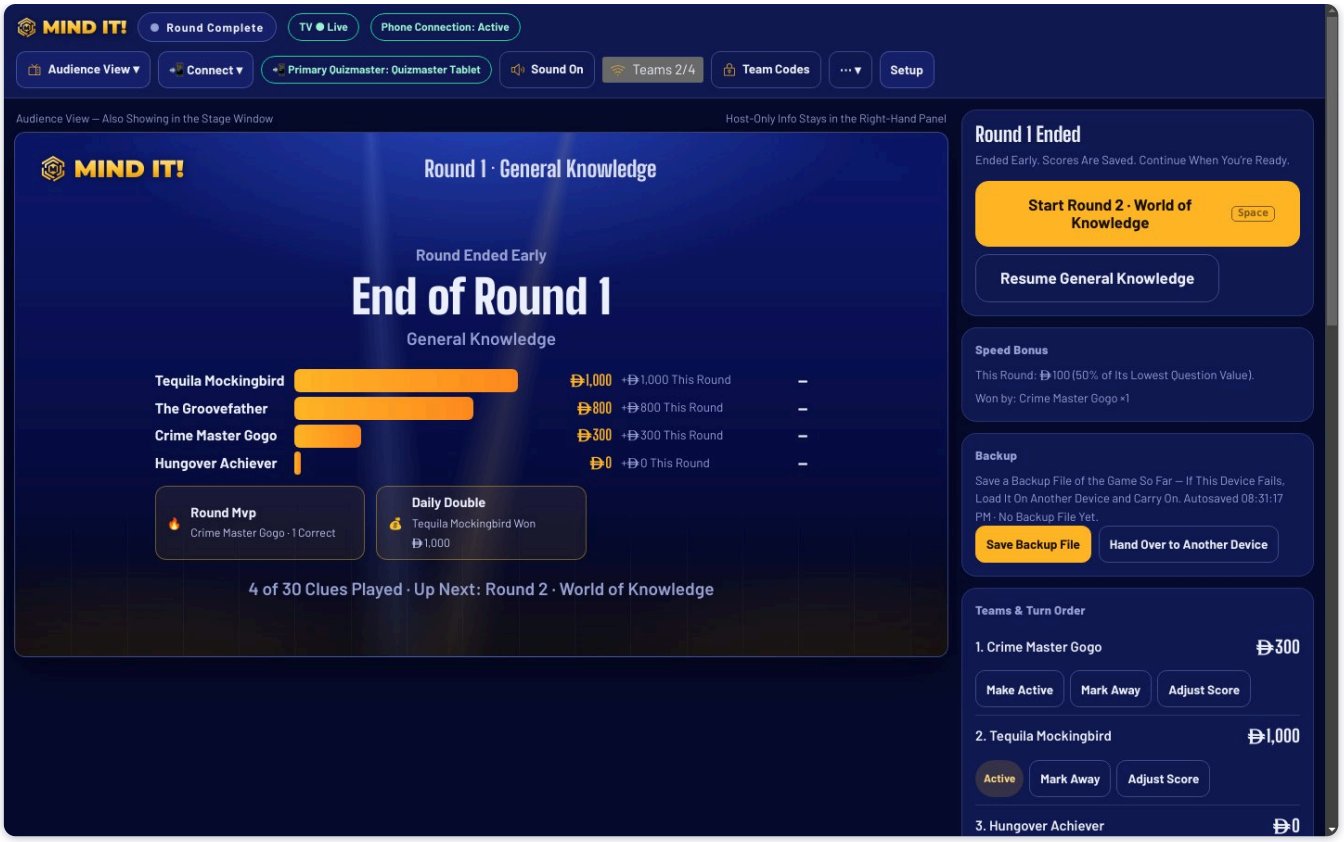


Button	Key	What it does	Safety
Undo Last Score	U	Reverses the last score entry; the question reopens. Since build 149 the answer also leaves the night's statistics (so an undone wrong answer can't make a team The Rascala!).	Asks first. Puts back any chip that answer used (build 112).
End Round Early	**Shift+E** (since build 152; E alone does nothing)	Ends the round now: stops the timer, closes any open question **unscored**, cancels an open wager, keeps scores → round summary.	Asks first.
⏱ **One More Question / ⏱ Make This the Last Question** (build 140)	—	The next question — or the one on screen — is the last of the round; then the round summary comes up by itself. ✕ **Cancel Last Question** undoes it.	—
⭐ **Go to the Final** (build 140)	—	End Round Early **and** skip the rounds still to come: round summary, then Mastermind It!	Asks first.
Reset Question	—	Puts the current question back as if never opened.	Asks first.

Button	Key	What it does	Safety
Reset Round	—	Restarts the round (same Blind It! spots).	Asks first.
Reset Game (red)	—	Back to zero.	Asks first. **Save a backup first.**
Save Backup File	—	Downloads the full game as a file.	Always safe.
Hand Over to Another Device	—	Move the running game to another computer (Chapter 22).	—
Volume / Sound On	—	Master volume.	—
Present Mode: Tap/mouse shows controls	—	Or "keyboard only" in Present Mode.	—
Phones → Show Codes / Join Link & QR Code	—	Team phone status and the join QR.	Host only.
Host Cam	—	Off by default. A small live picture of you on the TV — video only, no sound, nothing recorded or uploaded. Corner (**Automatic (Safest)** / Top-Left / Top-Right / Bottom-Left / Bottom-Right) and size (Small / Medium / Large). 🟡 Not tested with a real camera.	—

15.8 Round summary

After a round: **Start Round 2 · <name> ▶** (or **Go to the Final Round** after ⭐ Go to the Final — the TV says **"Straight to Mastermind It!"**; after ⏱ One More Question it says **"That was the last question"**), **Resume <round>** (if you ended early by mistake; it also cancels Go to the Final), a host-only **Speed Bonus** card, **Save Backup File / Hand Over to Another Device**, and Teams & Turn Order.



📸 *Real screenshot — the laptop after Round 1.*

15.9 Mastermind It! controls (Chapter 18 in detail)

Close Wagers (missing wagers count as 0 and stay editable) / **Reopen Wagers**, **Reveal Answer**, then — since build 152 at the top of the panel — **Mark each team**: per team **Accept / Reject** (or **Accept Anyway / Mark Incorrect** when the checker disagrees), **Wrong, No Penalty**, ✎ **Edit Answer**, **Reveal <team> (V)**, **Show Final Standings** — or, when teams are level on points for 1st, ⚡ **Play Tiebreaker** (build 140, Chapter 18.3).

15.10 End of the game

On the standings: 🏅 **Achievements & Fun Stats (Space)**, **Winner Screen**, **Save Picture** (💾 Save Standings Picture — PNG), **Play Again** (new questions), **Play Again (Same Questions)**, **Back to Setup**. On the tablet: the big 🏁 **END GAME** button (Chapter 19).

🏆 **Champions card (since build 146):** on the winner screen, the **Champions Card** tile (beside Save Picture and Play Again) shows a card on the TV with the winning team, its players' pictures and its stats — final score, correct answers and, when there are any, its hot streak and biggest win (joint champions side by side). Tap it again to hide it; it goes away by itself when you leave the winner screen. 💾 **Save Champions Picture** saves the card as a 1920×1080 picture to share. Space and the other end-of-game buttons are unchanged.

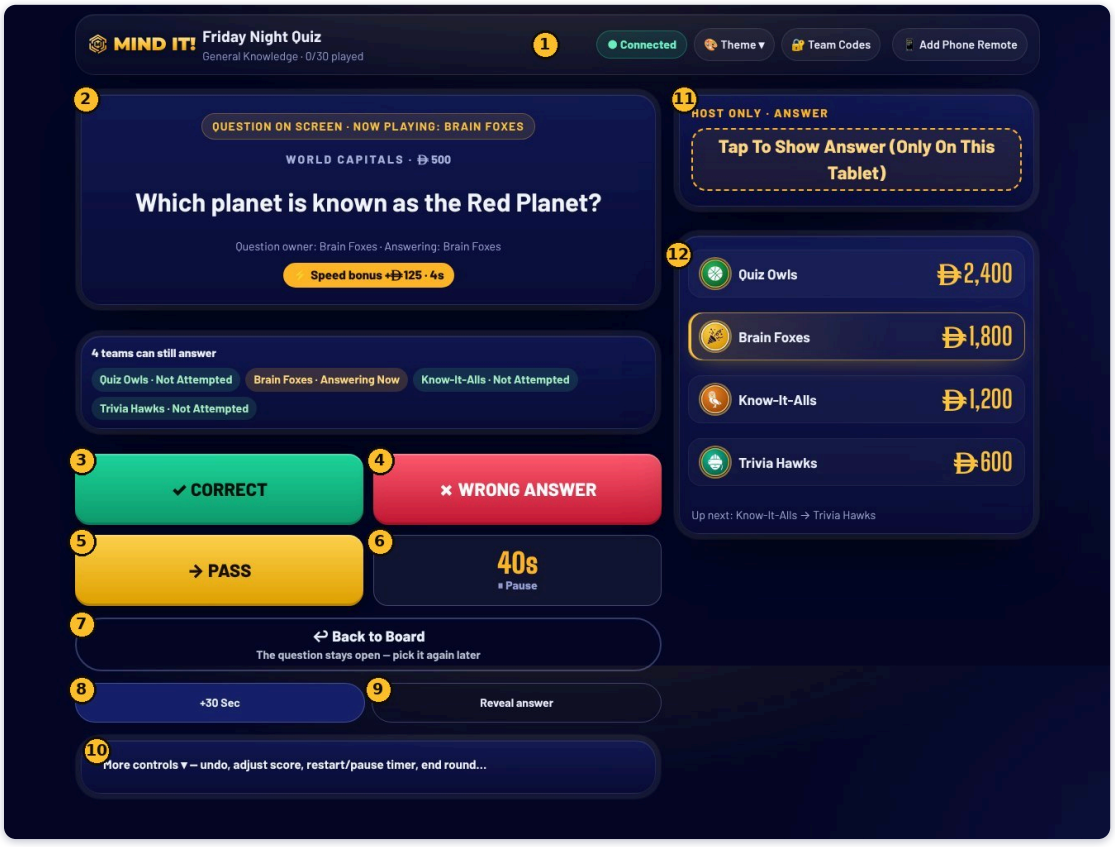
📊 **Night Recap** (since build 141) — on the standings, Achievements & Fun Stats and the winner screen: the whole night on one TV slide — the champion and its players, the final table, the night's numbers (questions, Blind It! questions, biggest swing, game time) and up to four highlights (a tiebreaker, Triple Gambles, the Phoenix, achievements). It fits landscape and portrait TVs; on an upright screen with many teams the whole table always shows, and a highlight that doesn't fit whole is left out. 🏆 **Winner Screen** and **Back to Standings** go back. If you flagged questions with ⚑ during the game, a card on the right reminds you, with ⚑ **Open Fix Later List**.

📸 *Real screenshot (build 141) — the Night Recap on the TV.*

15.11 Connection Health

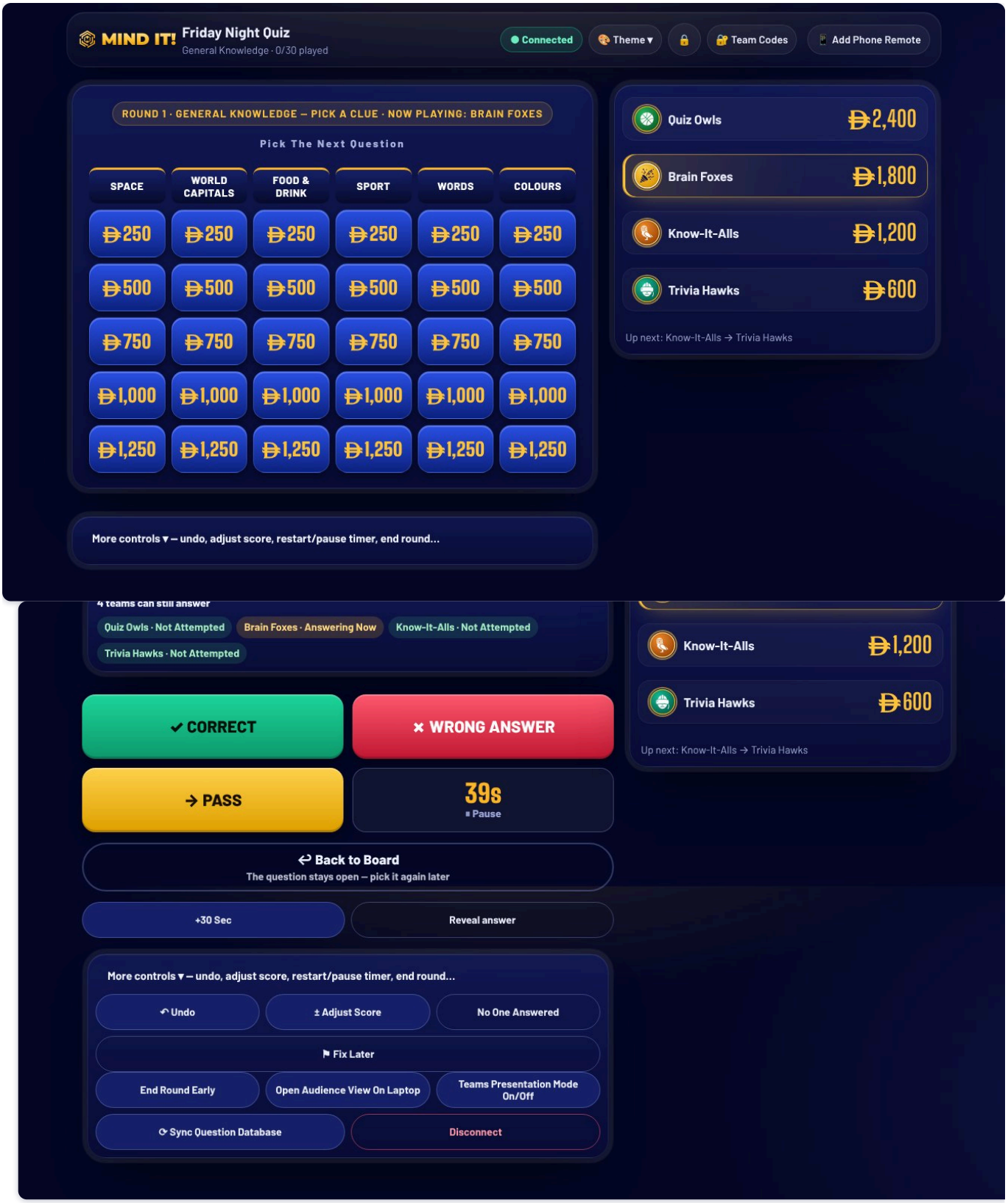
📶 **Check Connections** (Setup) / 📶 **Teams x/y** (in game) → **TEST ALL CONNECTIONS** → **RETEST** (Chapter 9).

15.12 The tablet remote



📸 *Real screenshot (build 152) — the tablet remote during a question.*

1. **Connected** status, 📶 **Teams 2/4** once the laptop reports the phones (tap for the tablet's connection sheet), 🎨 **Theme** (since build 146: the same 12 themes as the laptop's 🎨 Theme menu, the one on the TV ticked — a pick changes the laptop, the TV window and the Wi-Fi TVs at once; only on the tablet in control), 🔐 **Team Codes**.
2. The question on the TV, its owner and who is answering, and the ⚡ **Speed Bonus** countdown. Under it, which teams can still answer.
3. ✓ **Correct**.
4. ✕ **Wrong Answer**.
5. → **Pass**.
6. The timer — tap ∎ **Pause**, then ▶ **Resume** (from the seconds left, since build 152).
7. ↩ **Back to Board** — "the question stays open — pick it again later".
8. **+30 Sec**.
9. **Reveal Answer** (on the TV). Since build 141 the tablet asks "Reveal the answer now?" when no team has answered yet. ⚑ **Fix Later** sits with these buttons too.
10. **More Controls ▾** — ↶ **Undo**, ± **Adjust Score**, **No One Answered**, ⚑ **Fix Later**, **End Round Early**, **Open Audience View On Laptop**, **Teams Presentation Mode On/off**, ⟳ **Sync Question Database**, **Disconnect**.
11. **HOST ONLY · ANSWER — Tap To Show Answer (Only On This Tablet)**. Tap to peek; nobody else sees it.
12. Scores and **Up Next** (the turn order; not shown in Phone Buzzer Mode, where the order depends on who buzzes — build 117).
13. ✓ **Synced with the Laptop** (below, when connected to a laptop; not in the picture) — questions, players and games are on both devices; ⟳ **Sync Question Database Now**.



📸 *Real screenshots — the tablet's board (left) and More Controls opened (right).*

On the tablet's board, tap a value to open it. The **chips row** above the board shows each chip with **Use for <team>** (Quizmaster override).

📸 *Real screenshot — tablet chip override row.*

---

16. Audience View

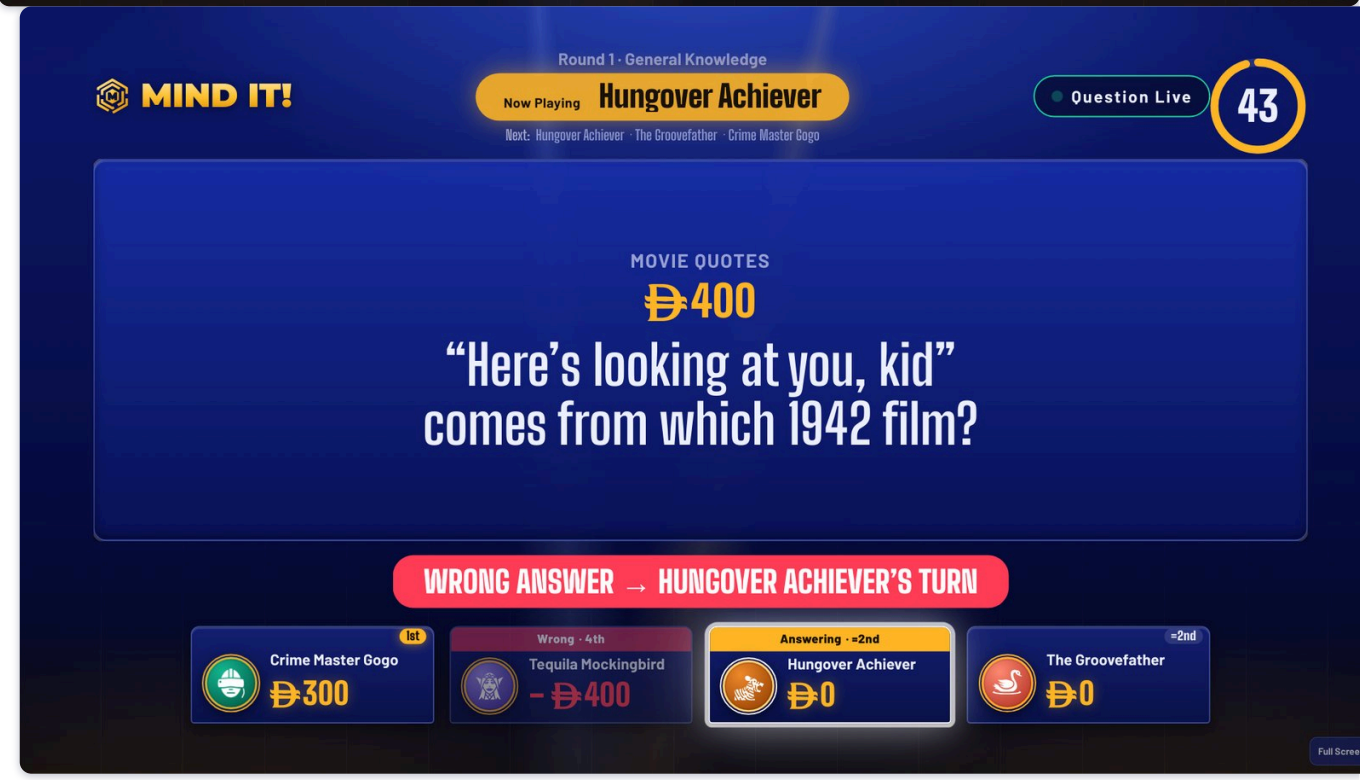
The Audience View is what the room sees. Open it from **Open Audience View (TV)** (Setup) or 📺 **Audience View ▾ → Open Audience Window**, move it to the TV, press its **Full Screen** button.

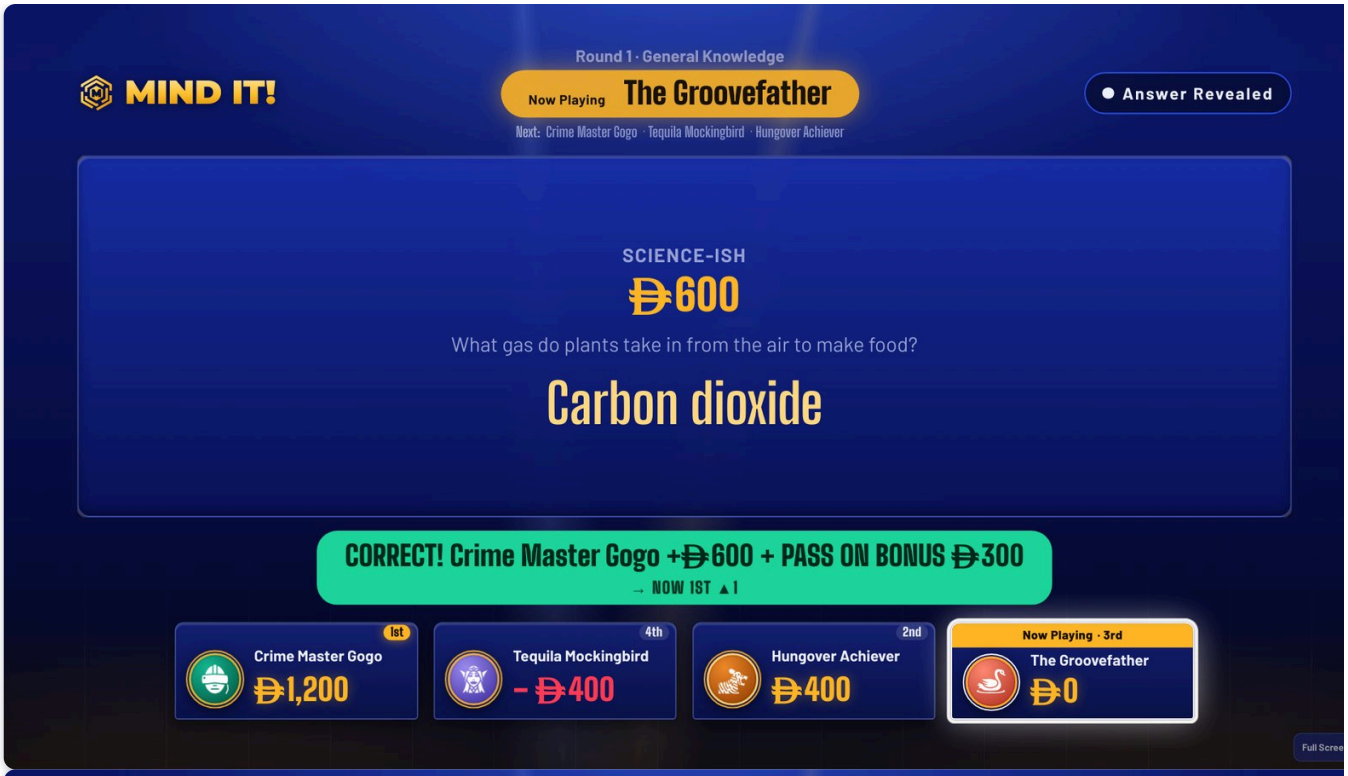
16.1 What it shows, screen by screen ✅

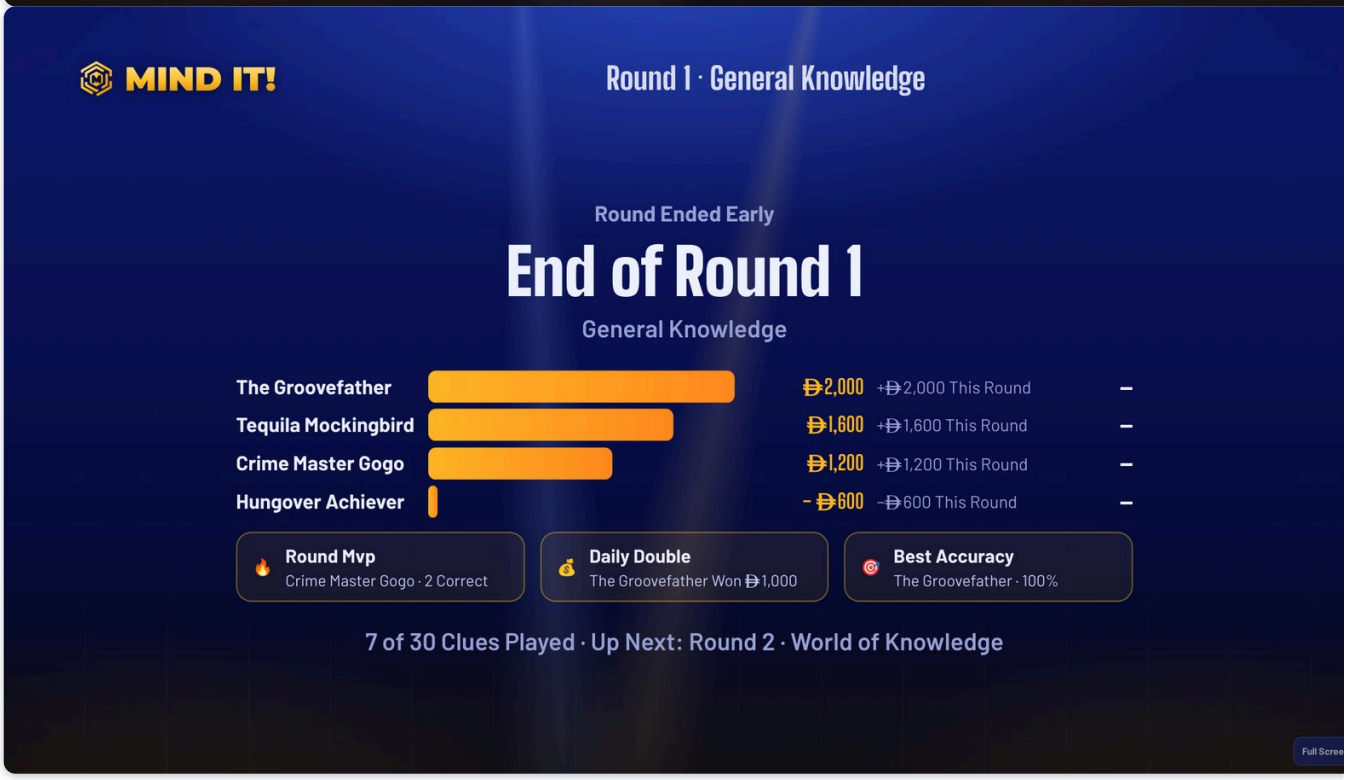
Moment	What the TV shows
Before the start	The Mind It! welcome screen (under the big MIND IT! logo, the tagline "Enna Rascala….Mind It!" — since build 149), then *Tonight's Teams* — every team's picture and name (the champion walks on last, wearing the crown). Both show the **"Scan to Join Your Team"** phone QR code (bottom centre, or top right on *Tonight's Teams*) until Round 1 starts — unless it's switched off in 5 · Audio & Presentation.
Round start	The category reveal ("Round 1 · Category 2 of 6"), then the board fills (animation, skippable). "THE PHOENIX IS LIVE" if someone holds the Phoenix.
Board	Categories, values, score cards with each team's **place** (1st in gold; shown once the scores differ — build 113), **Now Playing** and **Next**. A long team name shrinks to fit the Now Playing bar.
Question	Category, value, the question, the ring timer, "⚡ Speed Bonus" countdown, chip banners. Pictures and media if the question has them.
Correct / wrong	Banners: "CORRECT! … + ⚡ SPEED BONUS … NOW 1ST", "WRONG ANSWER → <team>'S TURN", "+ PASS ON BONUS".
Blind It! question	"Blind It!" splash, "<team> plays alone · no passing", a QR code to wager, "locked in".
Rewind It! (when chosen, 12.1b)	The cowboy hat and REWIND IT!, the wheel turning and landing on 1×–5×, then the question with its multiplier. In Phone Buzzer Mode with team phones (build 151) it says "<team>: spin it on your phone", then "<team>: tap STOP!" while the hat turns freely.
Special events	Triple Gamble dice, PHOENIX!, PHOENIX RISES!, BOTTOMS UP!, NEVER MIND IT!, "⏱ TIMER EXTENDED +30 SEC", streak flames, score adjustment banners.
Buzzers	"👂 LISTEN…", "🔔 BUZZERS OPEN", "FIRST BUZZ: <team> · 0.13 s". The top bar says **Phone Buzzers · Any Team Can Buzz** until someone buzzes (build 114).
Round end	"End of Round 1" with score-race bars, places moved ▲▼ (from Round 2) and awards (Round MVP, Blind It!, Best Accuracy).
Intermission	"Back in 4:59" countdown and the standings. Since build 134 the theme's background loop plays quietly (where the quiz's sounds play) until you resume.
Mastermind It!	Category, a box per team ("? ? ?" · Waiting… / Locked in), a QR code; then the question and a 45-second timer; then the answer and the reveal, team by team, with live standings ▲▼.
Winner	Final standings podium, then "And the Winner Is… <team>" with fireworks of gold dots. Level on points? The team with **more correct answers** wins (18.3).
The Rascala!	About 9 seconds after the winner (or when you press 😺 **The Rascala!**): the cowboy cat, THE RASCALA!, the last-place team(s) and "Enna Rascala….Mind It!" (19.1b).
Awards	*Game Highlights* → *Achievements Unlocked* → *Fun Stats* → *Final Results* (pages turn by themselves; skippable).

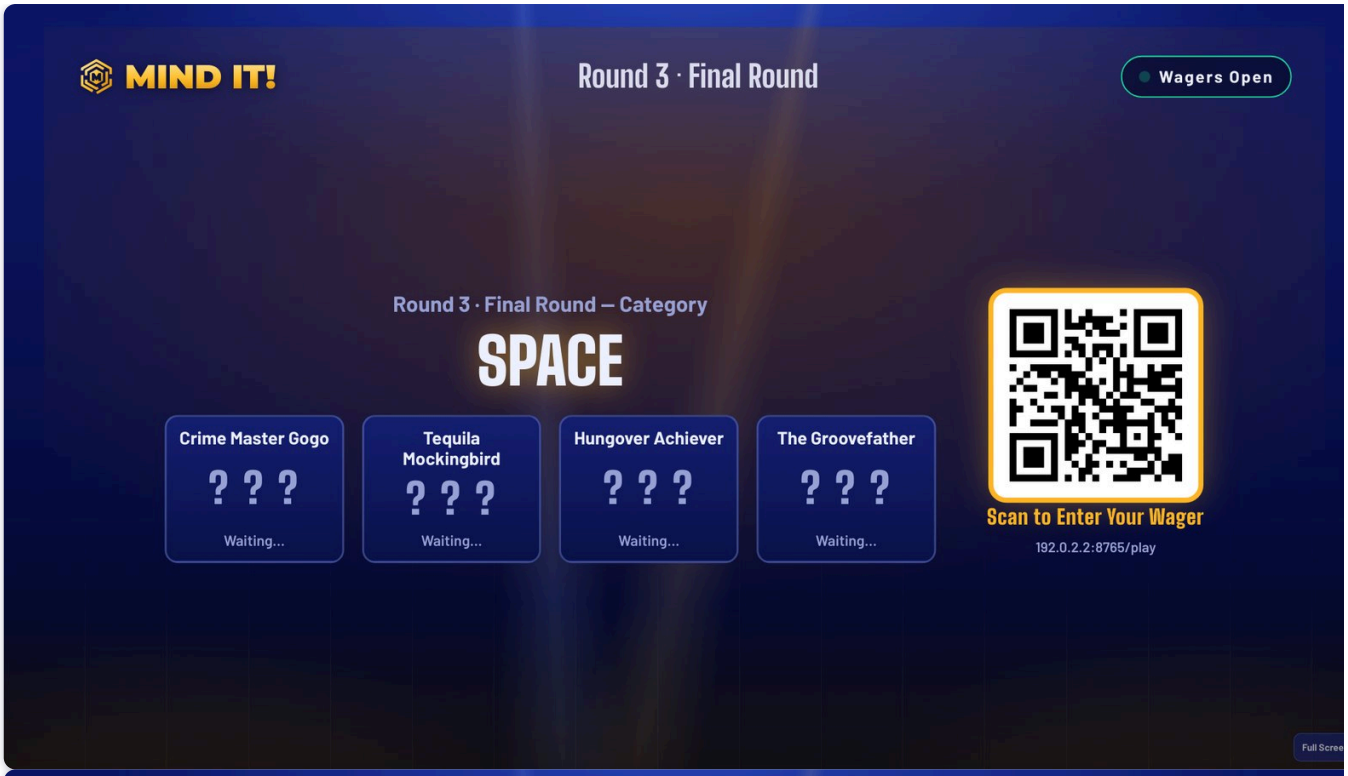
📸 *Real screenshot (build 114) — the board with places on the score cards: Tequila Mockingbird leads (gold 1st); Crime Master Gogo, playing now, is "=2nd" in its Now Playing strip.*

MIND IT!
The Big Fat Quiz
Scan to Join Your Team
192.0.2.2:8765/play
Then Type Your Team Code
Tonight's Teams
Crime Master Gogo
Tequila Mockingbird
Hungover Achiever
The Groovefather
Full Screen


MIND IT!
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Now Playing Hungover Achiever
Next: Hungover Achiever · The Groovefather · Crime Master Gogo
Question Live
43
MOVIE QUOTES
Ð400
"Here's looking at you, kid" comes from which 1942 film?
WRONG ANSWER → HUNGOVER ACHIEVER'S TURN
1st
Crime Master Gogo
Ð300
Wrong · 4th
Tequila Mockingbird
– Ð400
Answering · =2nd
Hungover Achiever
Ð0
=2nd
The Groovefather
Ð0

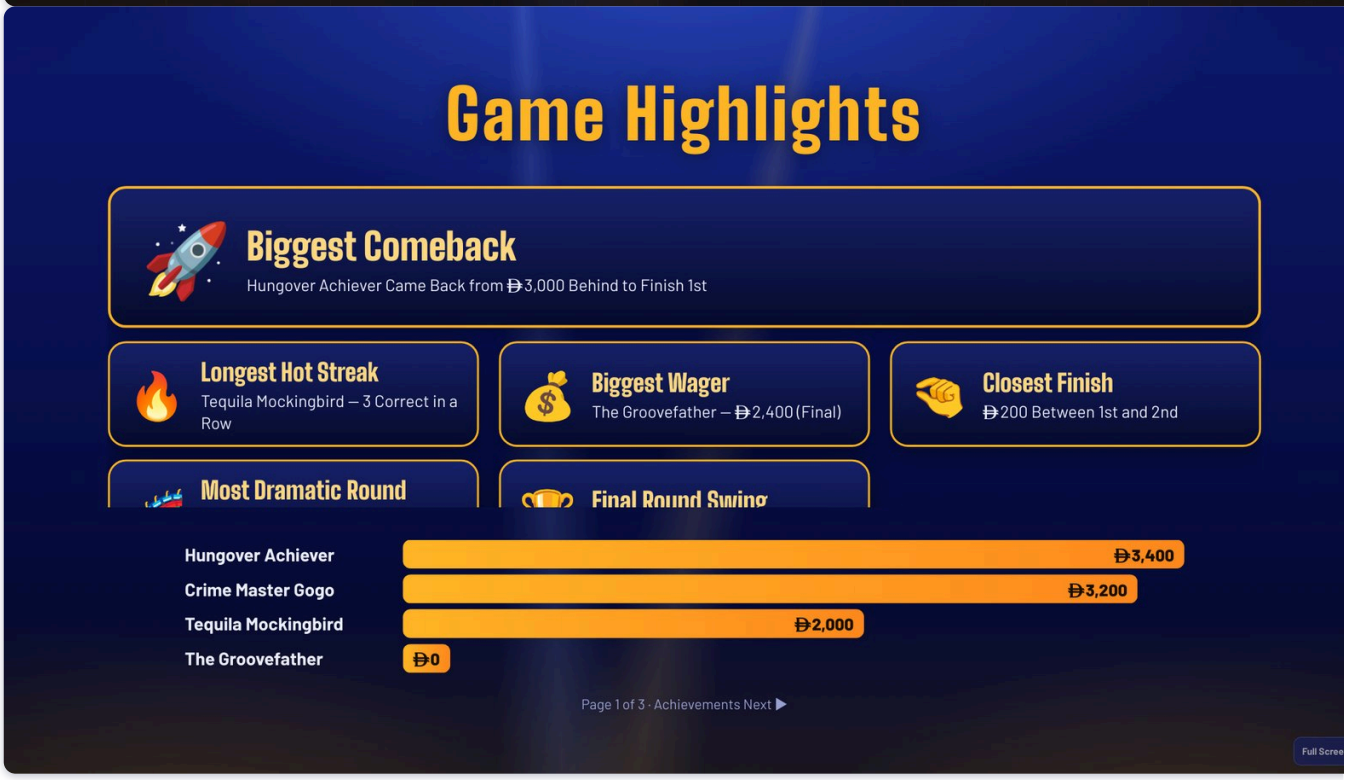

MIND IT!
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Now Playing The Groovefather
Next: Crime Master Gogo · Tequila Mockingbird · Hungover Achiever
Answer Revealed
SCIENCE-ISH
Ð600
What gas do plants take in from the air to make food?
Carbon dioxide
CORRECT! Crime Master Gogo +Ð600 + PASS ON BONUS Ð300
→ NOW 1ST ▲1
1st
Crime Master Gogo
Ð1,200
4th
Tequila Mockingbird
- Ð400
2nd
Hungover Achiever
Ð400
Now Playing · 3rd
The Groovefather
Ð0


MIND IT!
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Round Ended Early
End of Round 1
General Knowledge
The Groovefather
Ð2,000
+Ð2,000 This Round
Tequila Mockingbird
Ð1,600
+Ð1,600 This Round
Crime Master Gogo
Ð1,200
+Ð1,200 This Round
Hungover Achiever
- Ð600
-Ð600 This Round
Round Mvp
Crime Master Gogo · 2 Correct
Daily Double
The Groovefather Won Ð1,000
Best Accuracy
The Groovefather · 100%
7 of 30 Clues Played · Up Next: Round 2 · World of Knowledge


MIND IT!
Round 3 · Final Round
Wagers Open
Round 3 · Final Round — Category
SPACE
Crime Master Gogo
? ? ?
Waiting...
Tequila Mockingbird
? ? ?
Waiting...
Hungover Achiever
? ? ?
Waiting...
The Groovefather
? ? ?
Waiting...
Scan to Enter Your Wager
192.0.2.2:8765/play

MIND IT!
Round 3 · Final Round
Answer Revealed
SPACE
This planet has the most moons confirmed in our solar system as of 2025.
Saturn
Crime Master Gogo
Đ 1,600
Correct · Now Đ3,200
Tequila Mockingbird
Đ 0
Correct · Now Đ2,000
Hungover Achiever
Đ 1,000
Correct · Now Đ3,400
The Groovefather
Đ 2,400
Wrong · Now Đ0
1st Hungover Achiever Đ3,400
2nd Crime Master Gogo Đ3,200 ▲2
3rd Tequila Mockingbird Đ2,000
4th The Groovefather Đ0 ▼3

And the Winner Is...
Hungover Achiever
Ð3,400 Points
Crime Master Gogo
Ð3,200
2
Hungover Achiever
Ð3,400
1
Tequila Mockingbird
Ð2,000
3
Thanks for Playing!


Game Highlights
Biggest Comeback
Hungover Achiever Came Back from Ð3,000 Behind to Finish 1st
Longest Hot Streak
Tequila Mockingbird — 3 Correct in a Row
Biggest Wager
The Groovefather — Ð2,400 (Final)
Closest Finish
Ð200 Between 1st and 2nd
Most Dramatic Round
Final Round Swing
Hungover Achiever Ð3,400
Crime Master Gogo Ð3,200
Tequila Mockingbird Ð2,000
The Groovefather Ð0
Page 1 of 3 · Achievements Next ▶

Achievements Unlocked

Hot Streak

Tequila Mockingbird Had the Longest Hot Streak — 3 in a Row.

Hot Streak

The Groovefather Had the Longest Hot Streak — 3 in a Row.

Deadly Accuracy

Crime Master Gogo Were Right 75% of the Time (3/4).

Deadly Accuracy

Tequila Mockingbird Were Right 75% of the Time (3/4).

Speed Demon

Crime Master Gogo Got One Right in Just 0 Seconds.

Slow and Steady

Tequila Mockingbird Earned 3 Correct Answers the Patient Way — No Speed Bonus.

Slow and Steady

The Groovefather Earned 3 Correct Answers the Patient Way — No Speed Bonus.

Top of the Table

Hungover Achiever Finished Top

Climber

Hungover Achiever Climbed 3

Pass Master

Hungover Achiever Passed 1

Page 2 of 3 · Fun Stats Next ▶

Full Scree

Fun Stats

Phoenix Chips

Hungover Achiever (Round 2): Right → +Ð3,000 (Incl. Ð600 Catch-Up) (1 Paid Off)

Triple Gamble Chips

Crime Master Gogo Saved Theirs · Tequila Mockingbird Gambled 3× → +Ð1,200 · Hungover Achiever Saved Theirs · The Groovefather Saved Theirs (1 of 1 Paid Off)

Biggest Single Gain

Hungover Achiever +Ð3,000 from One Question

Biggest Comeback

Hungover Achiever Came Back from Ð3,000 Behind to Finish 1st

Longest Hot Streak

Tequila Mockingbird — 3 Correct in a Row

Biggest Wager

The Groovefather — Ð2,400 (Final)

Most Passes

Hungover Achiever Passed 1 Time

Most Pass Success

Crime Master Gogo Answered 1 Passed Question Correctly

Fastest Correct Answer

Crime Master Gogo with 44 Seconds Still On the Clock

Biggest Lead

Closest Finish

Most Dramatic Round

General Knowledge — Ð7,000 of

Page 3 of 3 · Final Results Next ▶

Full Scree

📸 *Real screenshots: Tonight's Teams (build 112, with the phone join code in the corner), then from the example game (played before build 148, so the TV still says Daily Double and Final Round where it now says Blind It! and Mastermind It!) a wrong answer, end of Round 1, the Mastermind It! wagers, the reveal, the winner and two award pages.*

16.2 Private vs public — what never goes on the TV ✅

Never on the TV	Where it lives
Answers before you reveal them	Host panel (laptop) "Host Only · Not Shown On Stage"; tablet "Tap To Show Answer"
Wager amounts before they are revealed (Blind It! sealed by default; Mastermind It! always)	Host panel / tablet
Team codes	🔐 Team Codes (host only)
Chip availability (except the public Phoenix holder)	Team phones; host Team Chips card
Mastermind It! answer checker suggestions	Host panel / tablet
Setup, notes, controls, passwords	Host panel

The **host panel's** big preview is a copy of the TV — but the right-hand column of the host panel is **host only**. When sharing your screen (e.g. a Teams call), share the **Audience View window**, never the whole screen (the TV Display Guide explains how).

16.3 Connection warnings on the TV

The TV window gets its data from the host panel on the same laptop. If it hears nothing for 5 seconds, an amber pill **"Reconnecting to Host…"** appears; after 20 seconds (or if the host window closed) a red **"Connection Lost — Retrying…"**; and a green **"Connected"** for 3 seconds when it's back. The board stays visible.

16.4 Screen size tips

- The Audience View is designed for **16:9 at 1920 × 1080** (full HD). It shrinks long questions to fit.
- **Big room / far back row:** turn on **Large Text On TV** (5 · Audio & Presentation).

- **Projector or TV cutting off the edges: Audience View ▾ → TV Display Settings** (safe margins).
- **7–8 teams:** *TV Scoreboard Position → Auto* puts scores in a side column.
- **Colour-blind players: Colour-Blind-Safe Colours** shows correct in blue and wrong in orange with ✓ and ×.
- Rough guide: at least a 50-inch TV for a living room; a projector for 30+ people. Sit the Quizmaster where they can see both the laptop and the room.

---

17. Complete Example — Host an Entire Game

This chapter follows one real game, **THE BIG FAT QUIZ**, from start to finish. *(It was played before build 148: in its pictures the TV says Daily Double and Final Round, now Blind It! and Mastermind It!; the rules and scores are the same.)* ✅ **Every score below was produced by the actual Mind It! 1.69 game engine** (the game was replayed in the real app and the scores were read back after every step), and then recalculated by hand.

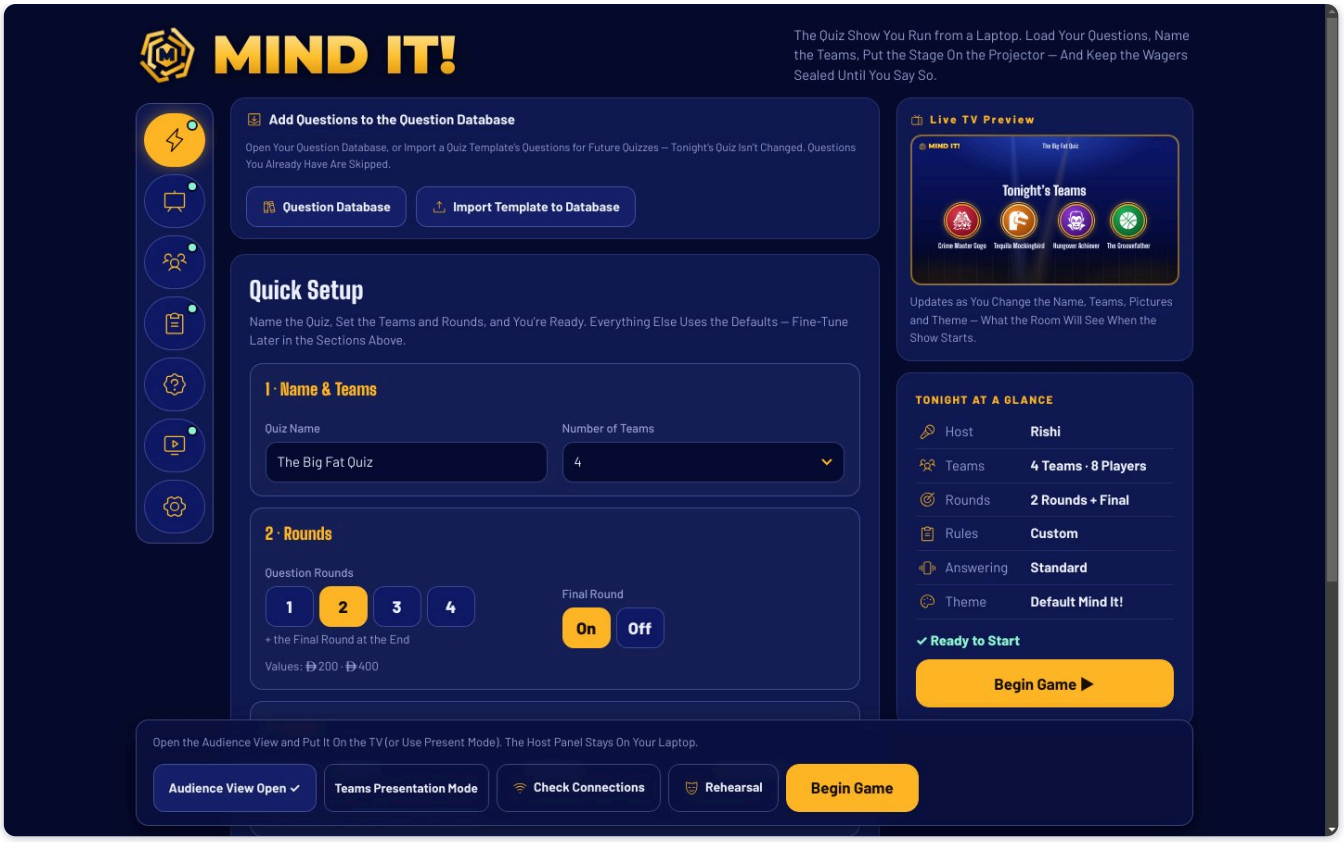
The teams (in turn order):

#	Team	Players
1	**Crime Master Gogo**	Asha, Esther
2	**Tequila Mockingbird**	Bilal, Farid
3	**Hungover Achiever**	Carmen, Gita
4	**The Groovefather**	Dev, Hamza

Quizmaster: Rishi. **Settings:** 2 question rounds + Mastermind It!; Full Show rules; Standard Mode; 45-second timer. **Values:** Round 1 = 200–1,000, Round 2 = 400–2,000. **Speed bonus:** Round 1 = 100, Round 2 = 200.

Steps 1–8: before the game

1. **Open Mind It!** on the laptop. Setup opens. Open the Audience View on the TV — it shows the phone join QR code straight away.
2. **Create the quiz:** Quick Setup → Quiz Name *The Big Fat Quiz*, Number of Teams *4*.
3. **Rounds:** Question Rounds **2**, Mastermind It! **On** (values 200 · 400).
4. **Questions:** Round 1 categories *Pub Grub, Movie Quotes, Science-ish, Geography, Music, Wildcards*; Round 2 *Sport, History, TV Shows, Food & Drink, Animals, Wordplay*; Mastermind It! *SPACE*. Check them in 4 · Rounds & Questions.
5. **Teams:** name the four teams, add two players each, Quizmaster Rishi. Tonight at a Glance: *4 Teams · 8 Players · 2 Rounds + Mastermind It!* ✓ Ready to Start.
6. **Tablet:** Connect ▾ → Connect Device; on the tablet, **Connect To Laptop → Connect**.
7. **Phones:** each team scans the join QR on the TV and types its code.
8. **Check connections:** 📶 Check Connections → TEST ALL CONNECTIONS → "All set".



📸 Real screenshot — Setup with the tablet, the TV window and four phones connected (bottom bar: "Audience View Open ✓").

Step 9: start the game

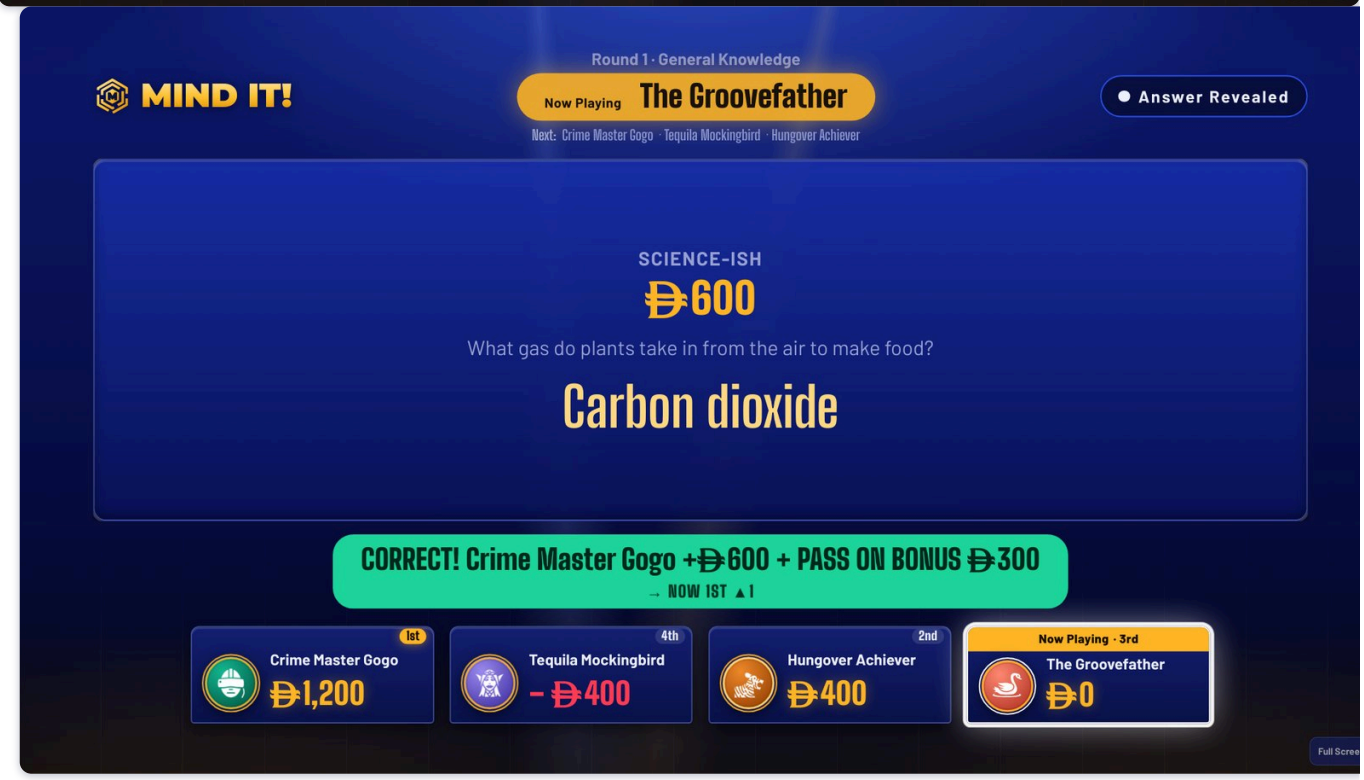
Begin Game ▶. The TV shows *Tonight's Teams*, then the Round 1 board. **Crime Master Gogo** is Now Playing.

Steps 10–17: Round 1 — the running scoreboard

#	What happens	Calculation	Gogo	Tequila	Hungover	Groove
—	Start		0	0	0	0
1	**Gogo** picks *Pub Grub 200* ("Which country gave the world the croissant's ancestor, the kipferl?"). Answer "Austria" in 4 s. Quizmaster: **Correct**.	200 + speed bonus 100	**300**	0	0	0
2a	**Tequila** picks *Movie Quotes 400* ("'Here's looking at you, kid' comes from which 1942 film?"). Wrong. **Wrong Answer**.	−400	300	**−400**	0	0
2b	The question passes to **Hungover** (fresh 45 s). "Casablanca!" **Correct**.	+400 (not their pick → no speed bonus)	300	−400	**400**	0
3a	Next turn: the team after Tequila → **Hungover** picks *Science-ish 600*. They **Pass**.	0 · timer for next: 30 + 45 left → capped 45	300	−400	400	0
3b	**Groove** also **Passes**.	0	300	−400	400	0
3c	**Gogo**: "Carbon dioxide." **Correct**.	600 + 2 passes × 25% × 600 = 600 + 300	**1,200**	−400	400	0

#	What happens	Calculation	Gogo	Tequila	Hungover	Groove
4	Next turn: the team after Hungover → **Groove** picks *Geography 1,000* — **Blind It!** Score 0, so the wager range is 1,000–1,000 (min = value; max = max(0, 1,000, 1,000)). Groove locks 1,000 on its phone. **Correct**.	+1,000	1,200	−400	400	**1,000**
5a	**Gogo** taps **Use** on **Bottoms Up** and chooses designated player **Asha**. Picks *Music 800*. Wrong! TV: "BOTTOMS UP!"	scoring pauses	1,200	−400	400	1,000
5b	Asha finishes her drink. Quizmaster: ✔ **Finished — Nothing Lost**.	0	1,200	−400	400	1,000
5c	The question passes to **Tequila**: **Correct**.	+800	1,200	**400**	400	1,000
6	Next turn: the team after Gogo → **Tequila** taps **Use** on **Triple Gamble** → Confirm. Picks *Wildcards 400*. TV: dice. **Correct**.	400 × 3 = +1,200	1,200	**1,600**	400	1,000
7a	**Hungover** picks *Music 1,000*. They're stuck — Quizmaster presses **+30 Sec** (45 → 75 s). Still wrong. **Wrong Answer**.	−1,000	1,200	1,600	**−600**	1,000
7b	Passes to **Groove**: **Correct**.	+1,000	1,200	1,600	−600	**2,000**
8	Time's getting on — Quizmaster: **More Controls → End Round Early** (asks first).		**1,200**	**1,600**	**−600**	**2,000**

MIND IT!
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Now Playing Tequila Mockingbird
Next: Hungover Achiever · The Groovefather · Crime Master Gogo
Answer Revealed
PUB GRUB
Ð200
Which country gave the world the croissant's ancestor, the kipferl?
Austria
CORRECT! Crime Master Gogo +Ð200 + ⚡ SPEED BONUS Ð100
→ NOW 1ST
1st
Crime Master Gogo
Ð300
Now Playing · =2nd
Tequila Mockingbird
Ð0
=2nd
Hungover Achiever
Ð0
=2nd
The Groovefather
Ð0
Full Screen


MIND IT!
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Now Playing The Groovefather
Next: Crime Master Gogo · Tequila Mockingbird · Hungover Achiever
Answer Revealed
SCIENCE-ISH
Ð600
What gas do plants take in from the air to make food?
Carbon dioxide
CORRECT! Crime Master Gogo +Ð600 + PASS ON BONUS Ð300
→ NOW 1ST ▲1
1st
Crime Master Gogo
Ð1,200
4th
Tequila Mockingbird
– Ð400
2nd
Hungover Achiever
Ð400
Now Playing · 3rd
The Groovefather
Ð0

Daily Double!
GEOGRAPHY
The Groovefather Plays Alone · No Passing

MIND IT!
Round 1 · General Knowledge
Now Playing Tequila Mockingbird
Next: Hungover Achiever · The Groovefather · Crime Master Gogo
Question Live
43
Triple Gamble · 3× Value
Triple Gamble!
Tequila Mockingbird Plays for 3× — No Passing
1st
Crime Master Gogo
฿1,200
Now Playing · =3rd
Tequila Mockingbird
฿400
=3rd
Hungover Achiever
฿400
2nd
The Groovefather
฿1,000

📸 *Real screenshots from this game — Step 1 (correct + speed bonus), Step 3c (pass-on bonus), Step 4 (Blind It! question), Step 6 (Triple Gamble), end of Round 1.*

The TV's *End of Round 1* shows "Round Ended Early · 7 of 30 clues played", the score race (Groove 2,000 · Tequila 1,600 · Gogo 1,200 · Hungover −600) and awards: **Round MVP** Crime Master Gogo (2 correct), **Blind It!** The Groovefather won 1,000, **Best Accuracy** The Groovefather 100%.

Round 2 — the Phoenix rises

The Quizmaster presses **Start Round 2**. Hungover Achiever is last, **2,600 behind** the leader (2,000 − (−600)) — more than 2,000 — so the TV announces **THE PHOENIX IS LIVE: Hungover Achiever holds the Phoenix chip this round.** The first pick goes to **Groove** (the team after Hungover, who owned the last question).

#	What happens	Calculation	Gogo	Tequila	Hungover	Groove
—	Start of Round 2		1,200	1,600	−600	2,000
9	**Groove**: a 400, right (after 15 s — too slow for the speed bonus).	+400	1,200	1,600	−600	**2,400**
10	**Gogo**: a 400, right (slow).	+400	**1,600**	1,600	−600	2,400
11	**Tequila**: a 400, right (slow).	+400	1,600	**2,000**	−600	2,400
12	**Hungover** taps **Use** on the **Phoenix**, picks *TV Shows 1,200*, answers right (slowly).	Gap to leader = 2,400 − (−600) = 3,000. Catch-up = 20% × 3,000 = 600. 2 × 1,200 + 600 = 3,000. Capped at the gap (3,000) → **+3,000**	1,600	2,000	**2,400**	2,400

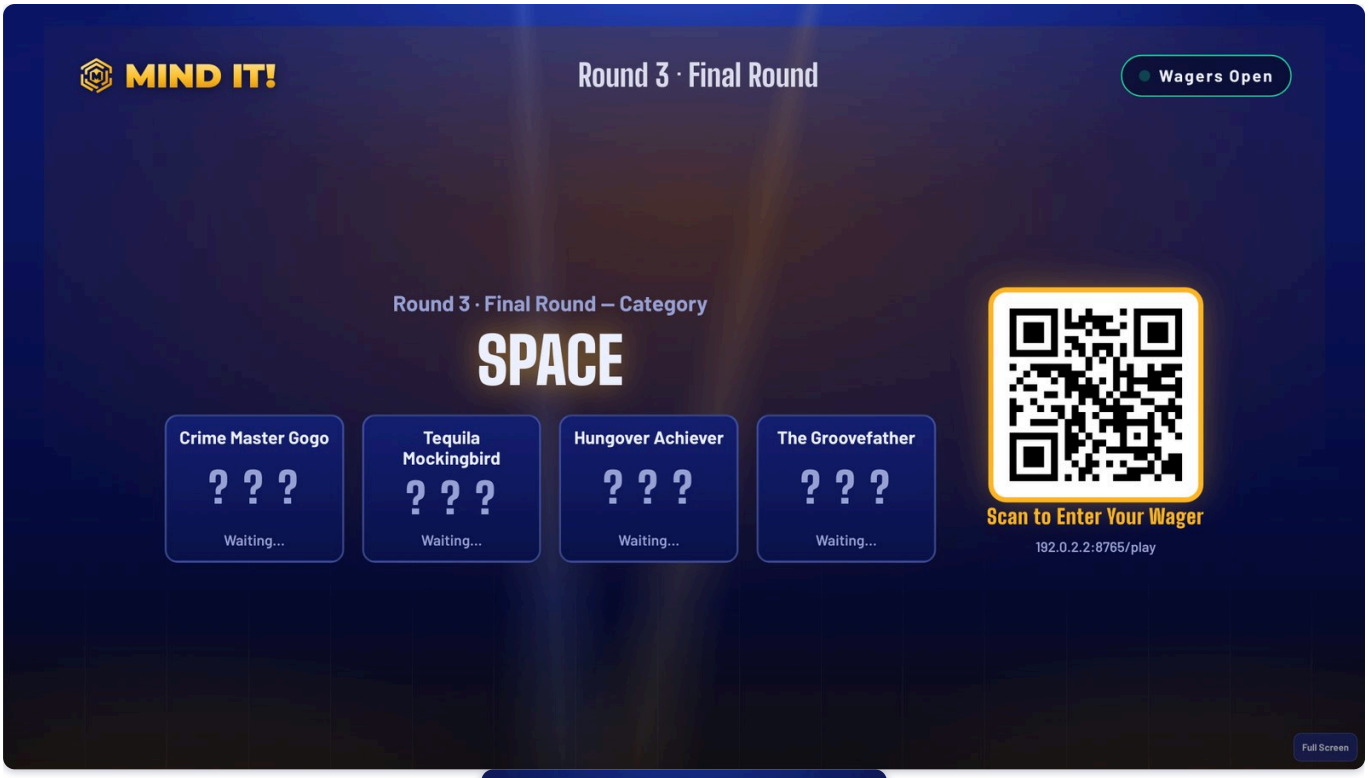
TV: **"PHOENIX RISES! Hungover Achiever +3,000 · Double Points + 600 Catch-Up"** — level with the leader, not past. The Quizmaster ends Round 2 (End Round Early) and starts Mastermind It!

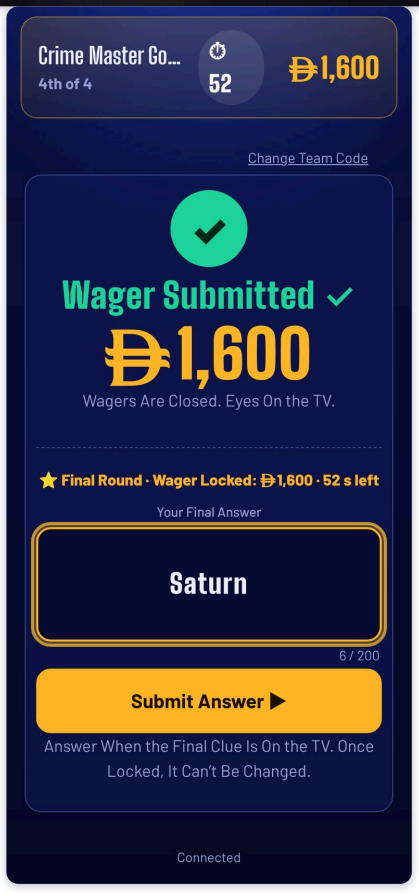
Steps 18–21: Mastermind It!

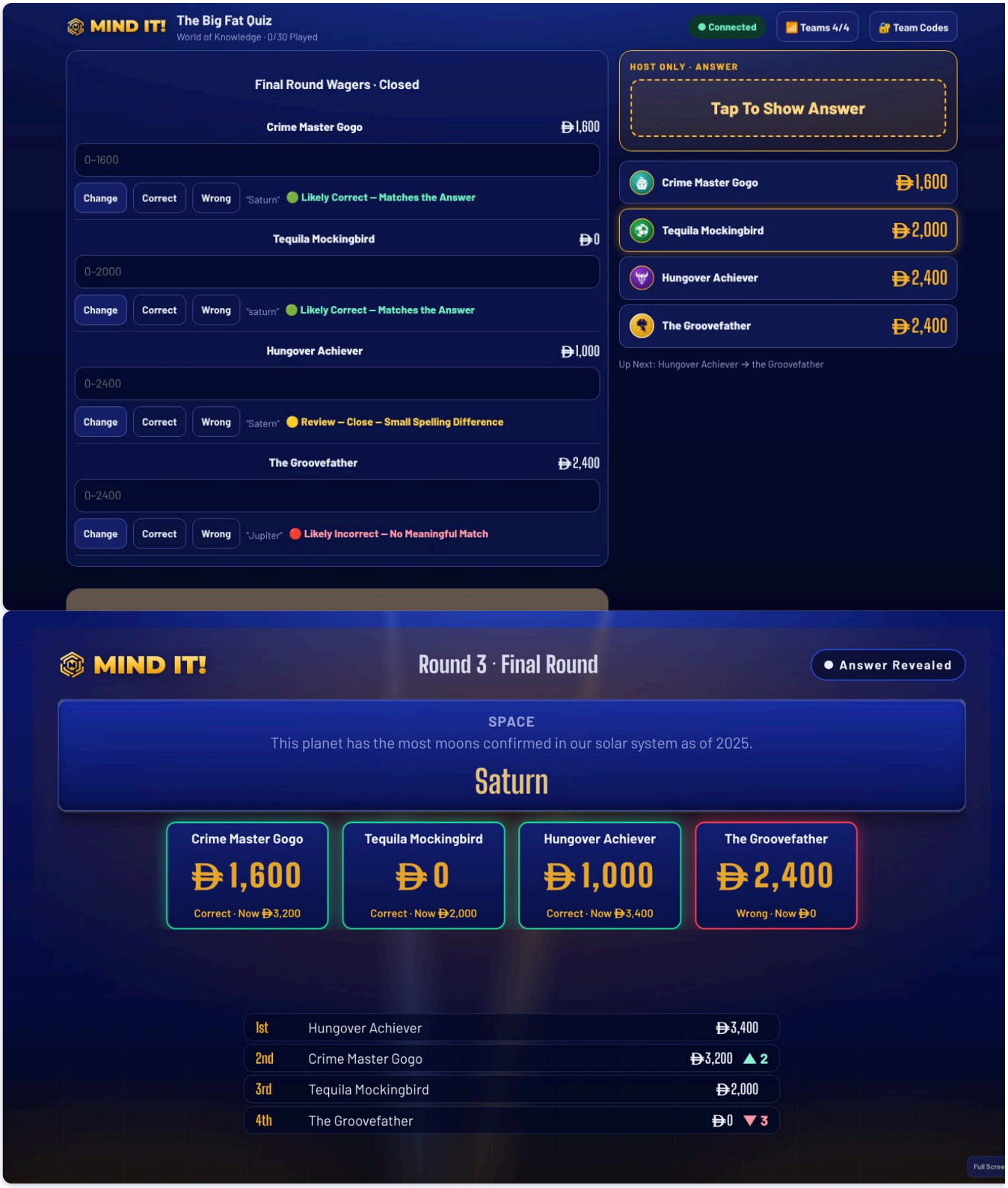
Category: SPACE. Every team has 0 or more, so all four play. Maximum wagers = their scores.

Team	Score	Allowed	Wager (on phone)	Typed answer	Checker	Quizmaster	Change	New score
Crime Master Gogo	1,600	0–1,600	**1,600** (all in)	"Saturn"	🟢 Likely Correct	Accept	+1,600	**3,200**
Tequila Mockingbird	2,000	0–2,000	**0** (nothing)	"saturn"	🟢 Likely Correct	Accept	+0	**2,000**
Hungover Achiever	2,400	0–2,400	**1,000**	"Satern"	🟡 Review — small spelling difference	Accept	+1,000	**3,400**
The Groovefather	2,400	0–2,400	**2,400** (all in)	"Jupiter"	🔴 Likely Incorrect	Reject	−2,400	**0**

The question: *"This planet has the most moons confirmed in our solar system as of 2025."* Answer: **Saturn**. *(The wagers and scores come from the replayed game; the typed answers and the checker's verdicts come from a second real run of the same Mastermind It! with the same wagers — the screenshots below are from that run.)* The reveal goes **lowest score first** (Gogo, Tequila, then the two teams on 2,400).


MIND IT!
Round 3 · Final Round
Wagers Open
Round 3 · Final Round — Category
SPACE
Crime Master Gogo
? ? ?
Waiting...
Tequila Mockingbird
? ? ?
Waiting...
Hungover Achiever
? ? ?
Waiting...
The Groovefather
? ? ?
Waiting...
Scan to Enter Your Wager
192.0.2.2:8765/play
Full Screen


Crime Master Go...
4th of 4
52
Ð1,600
Change Team Code
Wager Submitted
Ð1,600
Wagers Are Closed. Eyes On the TV.
Final Round · Wager Locked: Ð1,600 · 52 s left
Your Final Answer
Saturn
6 / 200
Submit Answer
Answer When the Final Clue Is On the TV. Once Locked, It Can't Be Changed.
Connected



📸 Real screenshots — the Mastermind It! wager screen, a phone typing its answer, the tablet with the checker's suggestions, and the TV after the last reveal.

Steps 22–25: winner, saving, End Game, main menu

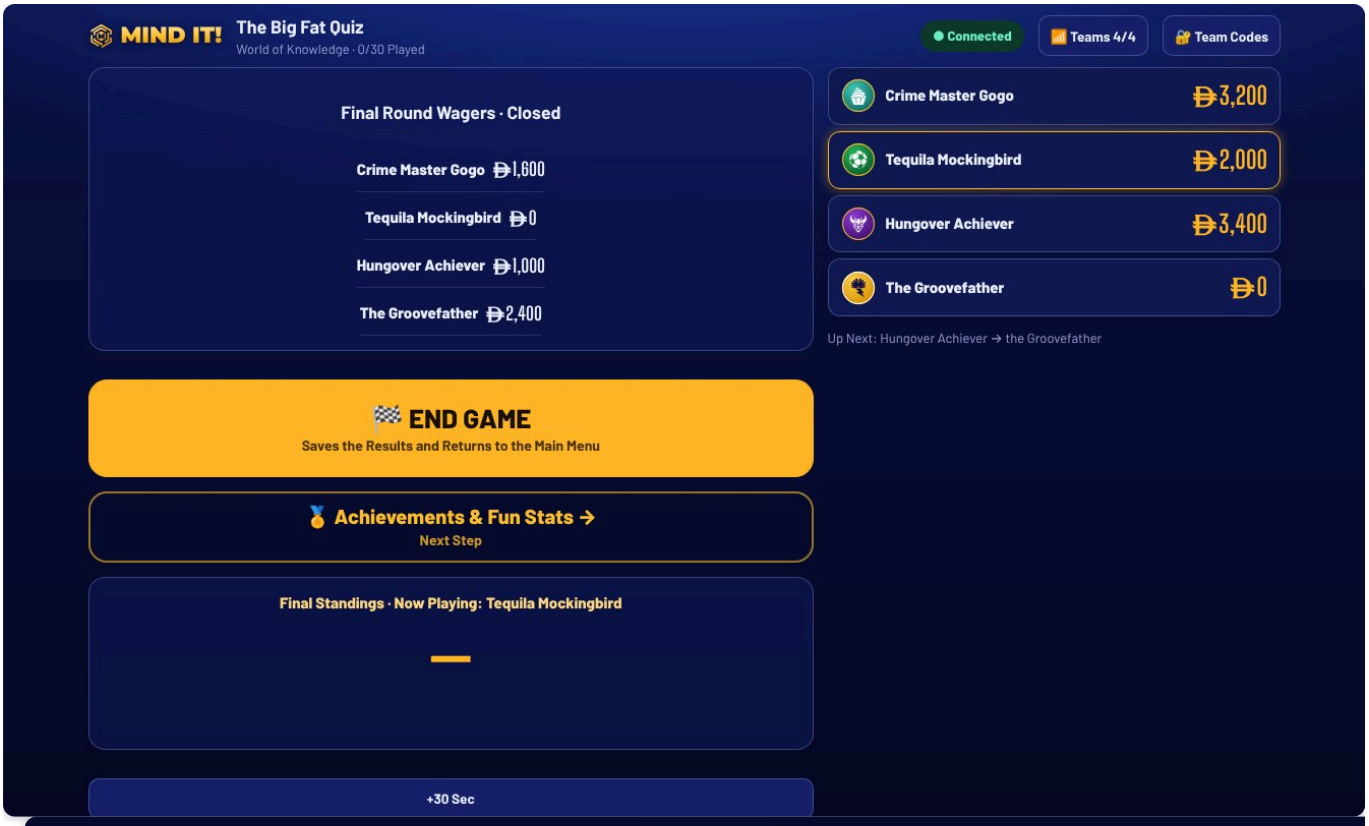
Final standings: 🥇 **Hungover Achiever 3,400** · 🥈 Crime Master Gogo 3,200 · 🥉 Tequila Mockingbird 2,000 · 4th The Groovefather 0.

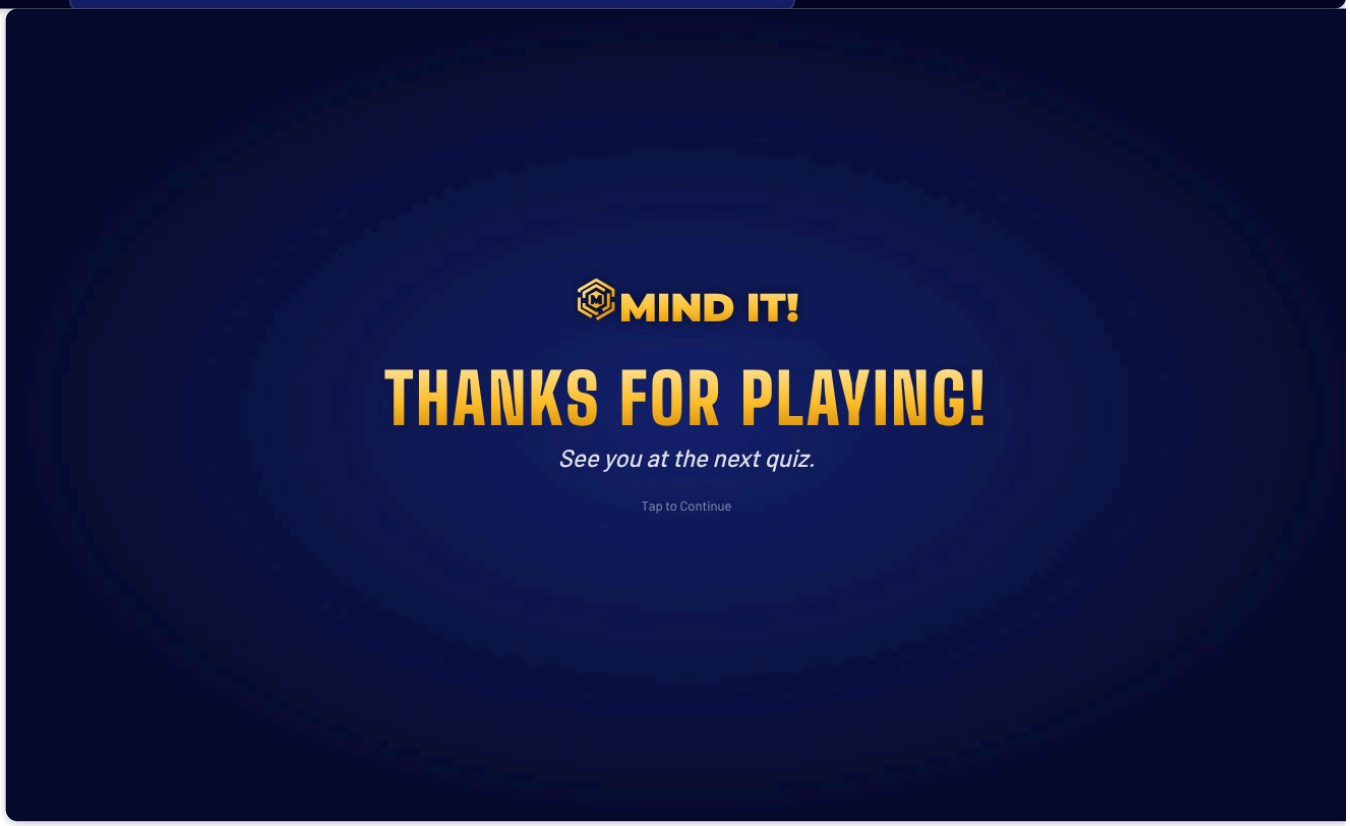
From last place at −600 to champions. 🎉

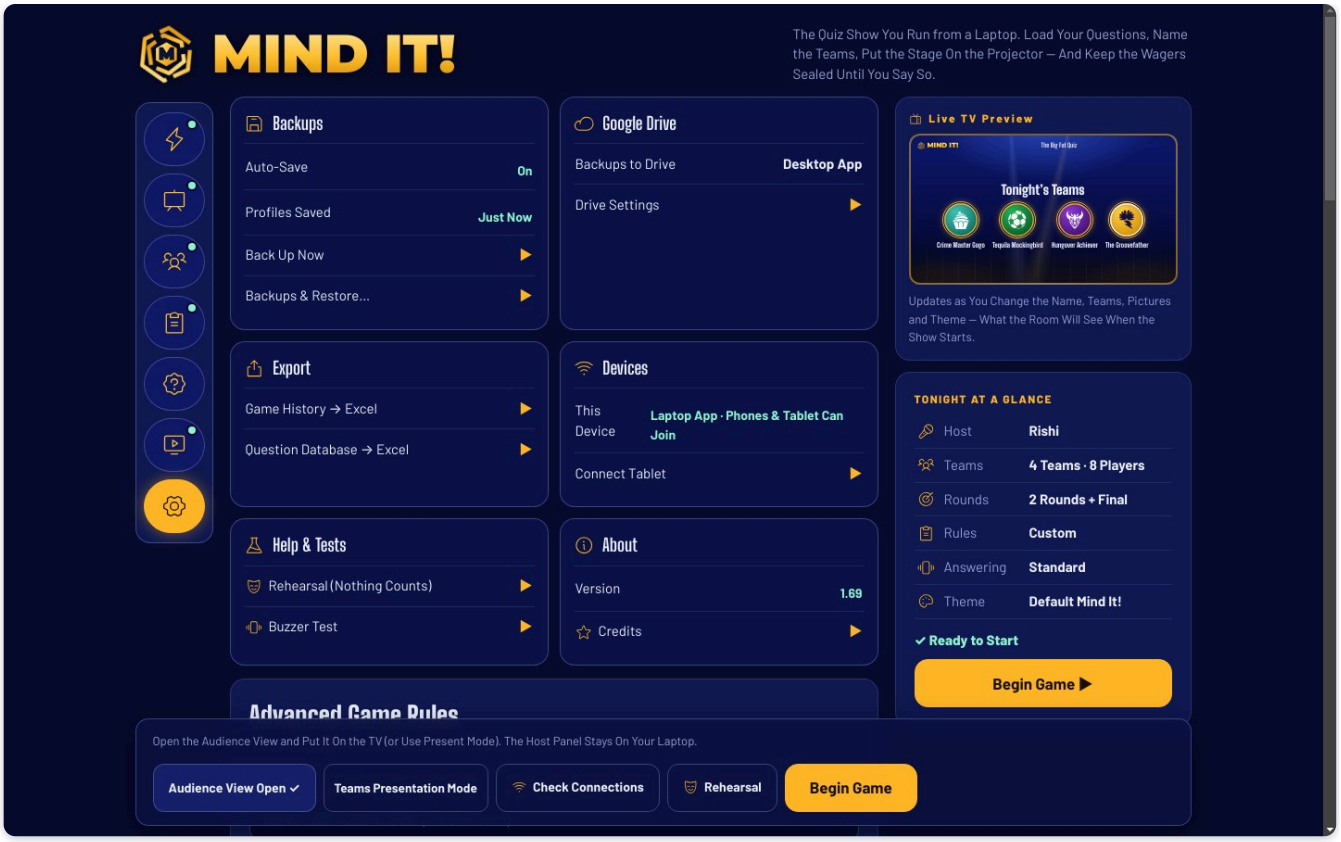
📸 *Real screenshots — the podium and the winner.*

- **22. Winner announcement:** the TV goes Final Standings → "And the Winner Is… Hungover Achiever". Press 🏅 **Achievements & Fun Stats** for the awards slideshow. This game earned, among others: Speed Demon (Crime Master Gogo), Triple Threat (Tequila Mockingbird), Bottoms Up! (Crime Master Gogo's designated player), Overtime Hero (The Groovefather), Double Down (The Groovefather), Rise From The Ashes and the Phoenix climb award (Hungover Achiever — shown as "Comeback Kid" in build 111, "Phoenix Climber" since build 113), Photo Finish (Hungover Achiever) and Gambler's Ruin (The Groovefather).
- **23. Game saving:** the game was saved to **Historic Games** automatically when the standings appeared ("✓ Game saved to history · ✓ Questions added to the Question Database · ✓ Included in backups").

- **24. End Game:** on the tablet, the big 🏁 **END GAME** button → confirm "End the game and go back to the Main Menu? The results are saved on the laptop." The tablet shows **THANKS FOR PLAYING!**; the laptop returns to Setup.
- **25. Main menu:** the tablet is back on its Main Menu, the laptop on Setup, ready for the next quiz.


MIND IT!
The Big Fat Quiz
World of Knowledge · 0/30 Played
Connected
Teams 4/4
Team Codes
Final Round Wagers · Closed
Crime Master Gogo Ð1,600
Tequila Mockingbird Ð0
Hungover Achiever Ð1,000
The Groovefather Ð2,400
Crime Master Gogo Ð3,200
Tequila Mockingbird Ð2,000
Hungover Achiever Ð3,400
The Groovefather Ð0
Up Next: Hungover Achiever → the Groovefather
END GAME
Saves the Results and Returns to the Main Menu
Achievements & Fun Stats →
Next Step
Final Standings · Now Playing: Tequila Mockingbird
+30 Sec


MIND IT!
THANKS FOR PLAYING!
See you at the next quiz.
Tap to Continue



📸 *Real screenshots — END GAME on the tablet, the thank-you splash, and the laptop back in Setup.*

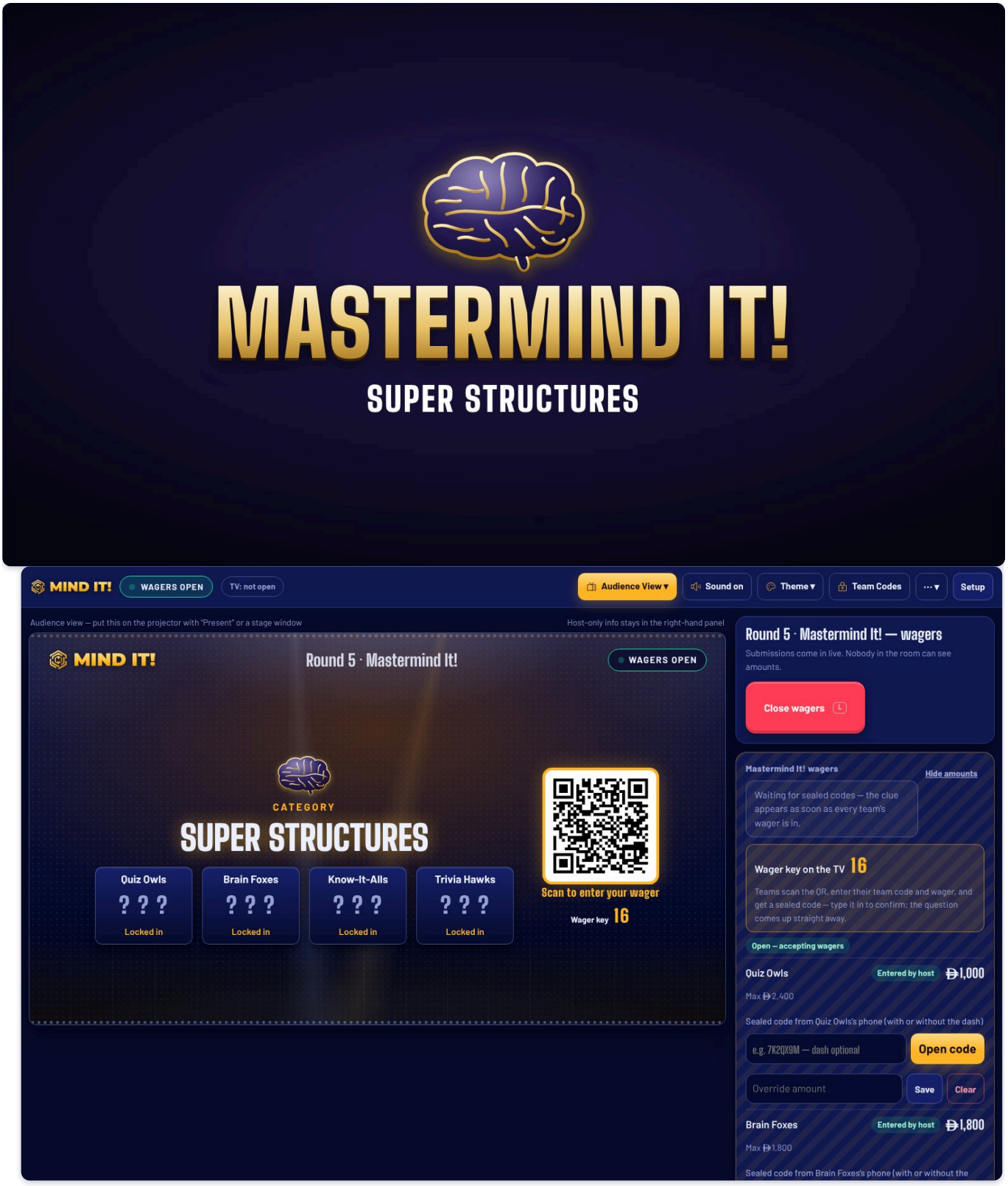
Lessons from this game: passing early cost Hungover nothing; the Blind It! minimum (1,000) gave Groove a big early jump; a 0-point Mastermind It! wager kept Tequila safe but couldn't win; Groove's all-in wager was the gamble that decided the night.

---

18. Mastermind It!

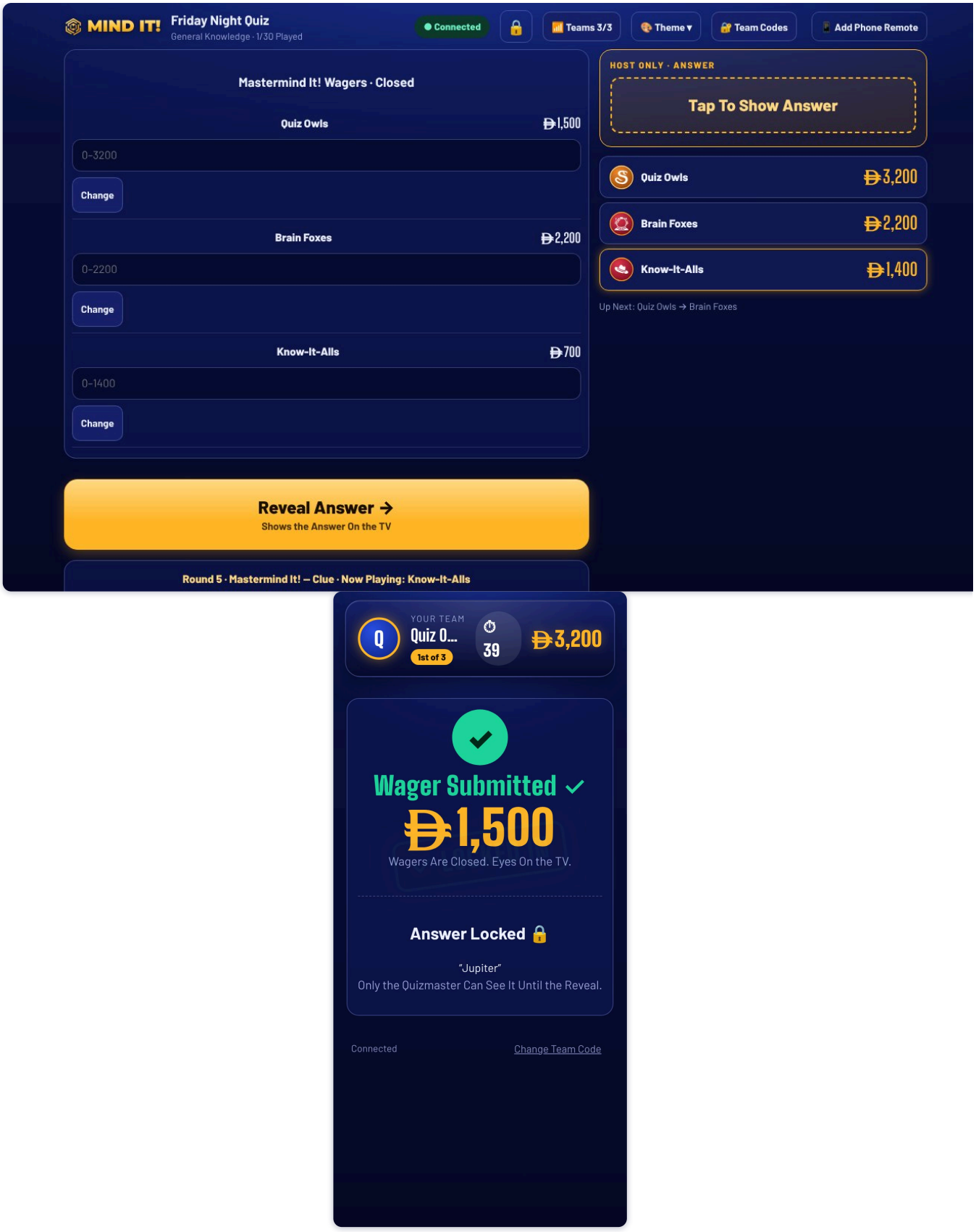
18.1 The complete process ✅

1. **Category reveal.** When the last board round ends, Mastermind It! starts: a short **Mastermind It!** moment with a gold brain (since build 148), then the TV shows **Mastermind It!**, the **category**, a box per eligible team ("? ? ? · Waiting…") and a **QR code**. The question is only in the host panel.
2. **The Mastermind It! question is now locked** (build 114) until the game ends — no switching or editing by accident while teams are wagering or answering. You can still add **accepted alternate answers** (e.g. "USA" for "United States") in the answer review (build 115).
3. **Who plays:** every team with **0 or more** points that isn't Away. Teams below zero sit out. If nobody is eligible, Mastermind It! is skipped with a notice.
4. **Wagers open immediately.** Each team wagers privately on its phone: any whole amount from **0** to its score (quick picks **All in / Half / Nothing**) → **Lock in**. The phone shows **Wager Submitted** ✓ and "Wagers are closed. Eyes on the TV." once all are in. The TV box changes to **Locked in**.
5. **Wager confirmation.** The host panel lists each team, its wager and "Submitted ✓". When **every** eligible team has a valid wager, wagers close and **the question appears automatically**. Or press **Close Wagers** (missing wagers count as **0** and stay editable) — **Reopen Wagers** is available.
6. **Minimum wager: 0.** A team on 0 can only wager 0.
7. **The question** appears on the TV with a **45-second timer** and thinking music.
8. **Answers.** Each team **types one answer** on the same phone that wagered ("Your Mastermind It! Answer" → **Submit Answer** ▶ → confirm → **Answer Locked** 🔒). Spoken answers can be marked by the Quizmaster as usual. **Typed answers close 2 seconds after time's up** (build 114): a later answer is refused and the phone shows ⏱ **Time's Up** ("If your team said its answer out loud, tell the Quizmaster"). If you add time (**+30 Sec**), answers open again.
9. **Answer checking (advisory only):** each typed answer gets 🟢 **Likely Correct**, 🟡 **Review** or 🔴 **Likely Incorrect**, with a reason ("Matches the answer", "Close — small spelling difference", "No meaningful match"). When unsure it says Review, never Correct. Accepted alternate answers count. The TV never shows these.
10. **Quizmaster overrides** (since build 152 **Mark each team** comes first on the laptop, with ✏️ **Change a wager** folded below it): **Accept / Reject** (or **Accept Anyway / Mark Incorrect** if you disagree with the checker), **Wrong, No Penalty**, and ✎ **Edit Answer** — type the correction in the box and press **Enter**; it stays even while team phones are connected (build 138), and the original typing is kept in the record. Every decision is audited in the game record.
11. **Reveal**, one team at a time, **lowest score first**, in an order fixed when Mastermind It! started: **Reveal <team> (V)**. Each team must be marked before it can be revealed. The TV shows the wager, "Correct · now 3,200" / "Wrong · now 0", and the live standings with ▲▼.
12. **Scoring:** right **+wager**, wrong **–wager**, wrong-no-penalty **0**.
13. **Final standings**, then the **winner**.


MASTERMIND IT!
SUPER STRUCTURES
MIND IT!
WAGERS OPEN
TV: not open
Audience View
Sound on
Theme
Team Codes
Setup
Audience view — put this on the projector with "Present" or a stage window
Host-only info stays in the right-hand panel
MIND IT!
Round 5 · Mastermind It!
WAGERS OPEN
CATEGORY
SUPER STRUCTURES
Quiz Owls
? ? ?
Locked in
Brain Foxes
? ? ?
Locked in
Know-It-Alls
? ? ?
Locked in
Trivia Hawks
? ? ?
Locked in
Scan to enter your wager
Wager key 16
Round 5 · Mastermind It! — wagers
Submissions come in live. Nobody in the room can see amounts.
Close wagers
Mastermind It! wagers
Hide amounts
Waiting for sealed codes — the clue appears as soon as every team's wager is in.
Wager key on the TV 16
Teams scan the QR, enter their team code and wager, and get a sealed code — type it in to confirm: the question comes up straight away.
Open — accepting wagers
Quiz Owls
Entered by host
฿1,000
Max ฿2,400
Sealed code from Quiz Owls's phone (with or without the dash)
e.g. 7K2QX9M — dash optional
Open code
Override amount
Save
Clear
Brain Foxes
Entered by host
฿1,800
Max ฿1,800
Sealed code from Brain Foxes's phone (with or without the

MIND IT!
Round 5 · Mastermind It!
QUESTION LIVE
43
Quiz Owls
Ð2,400
Brain Foxes
Ð1,800
Know-It-Alls
Ð1,200
Trivia Hawks
Ð600
SUPER STRUCTURES
Opened in 2010 and standing 828 metres tall, this building has been the world's tallest ever since. Name it.

MIND IT!
Round 5 · Mastermind It!
REVEALING WAGERS
SUPER STRUCTURES
Opened in 2010 and standing 828 metres tall, this building has been the world's tallest ever since. Name it.
Burj Khalifa
Trivia Hawks
Ð0
Wrong · now Ð600
Know-It-Alls
Ð600
Correct · now Ð1,800
Brain Foxes
Ð1,800
Wrong · now Ð0
Quiz Owls
? ? ?
Locked in
1st Quiz Owls Ð2,400
2nd Know-It-Alls Ð1,800 ▲1
3rd Trivia Hawks Ð600 ▲1
4th Brain Foxes Ð0 ▼2



📸 Real screenshots — the Mastermind It! moment that opens it, the laptop while the wagers come in, and the question on the TV (build 150); the tablet with the wagers in and a phone after locking its answer (build 151).

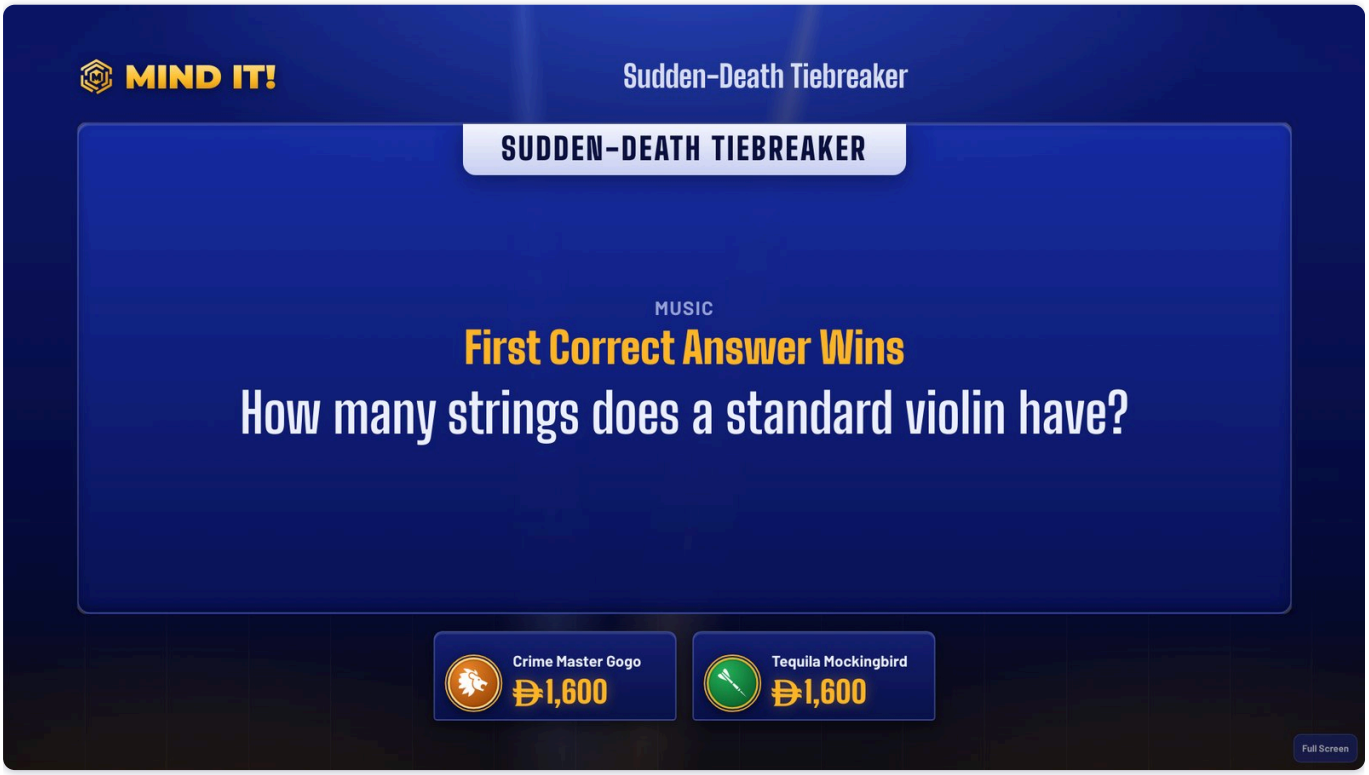
18.2 Changing a wager ✅

Teams **can't** change their own wager after Lock in (a different amount is blocked and shown to the host as a blocked attempt). The **Quizmaster** can: ✏️ **Change a Wager** on the laptop, or **Change** on the tablet (with confirmation) — until that team is revealed. The team's phone shows the new amount.

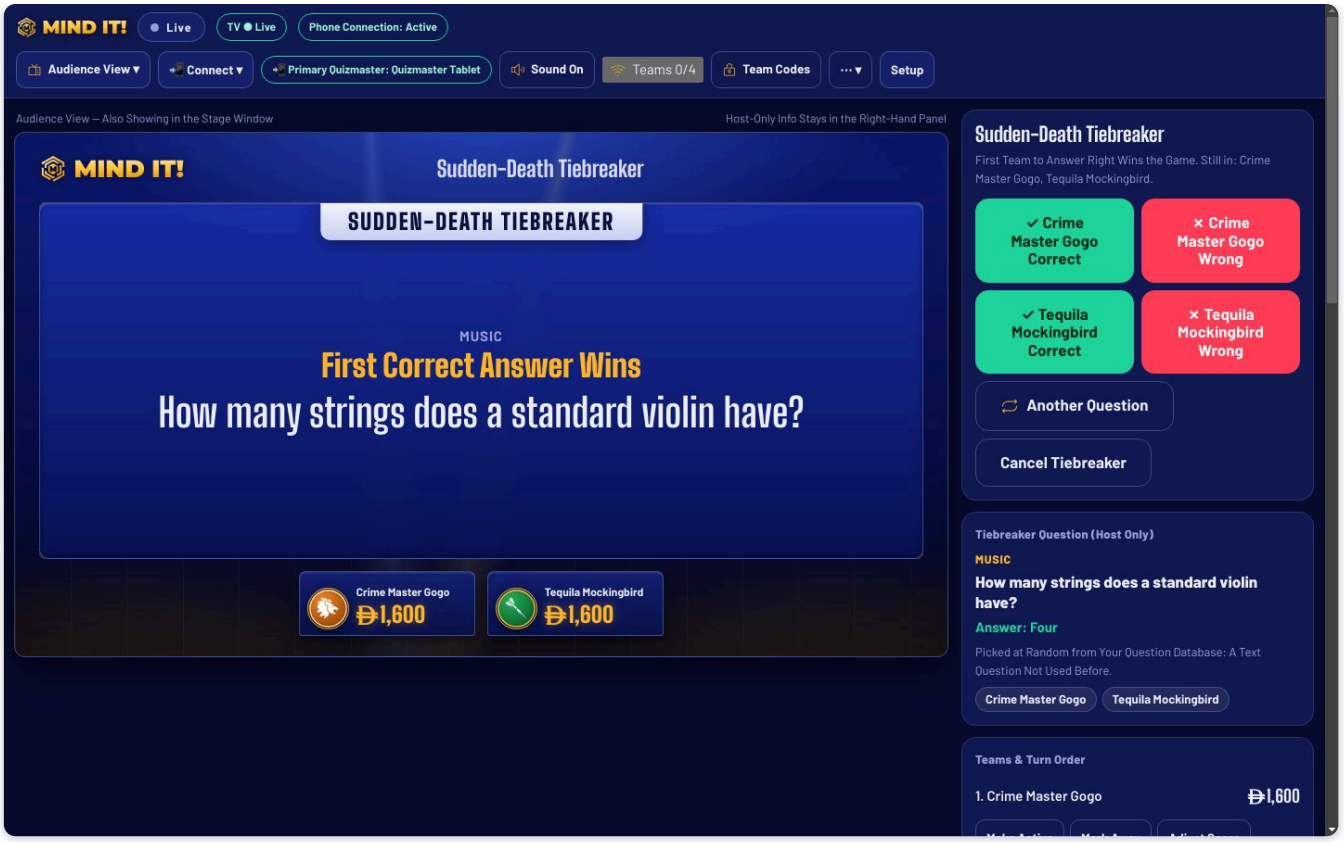
18.3 Ties

✅ **New in build 140 — a sudden-death tiebreaker, if you want one.** When teams finish **level on points for first place** (the Mastermind It! reveal is done — or the last round summary, when there is no Mastermind It!), the laptop offers ⚡ **Play Tiebreaker** next to **Show Final Standings**. Your choice: **Show Final Standings** skips it and most correct answers decides, exactly as below.

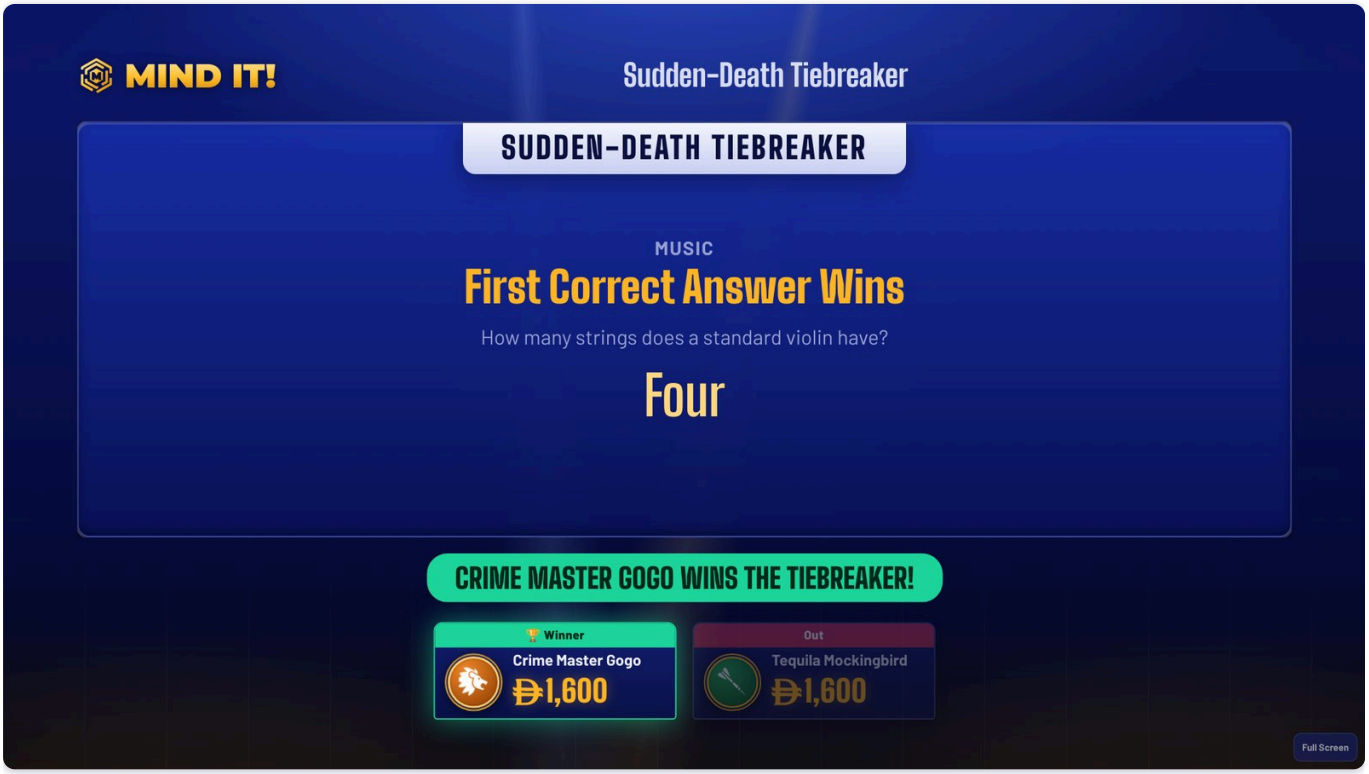
1. ⚡ **Play Tiebreaker** — the TV shows **"Sudden-Death Tiebreaker"**, the tied teams (only their scores) and the rule. Mind It! picks **one text question at random from your Question Database**: never one used in this game, and one never used before while there are any. **Only your screen** shows the question and the answer (and the tablet, behind **Tap To Show Answer**). Not right for tonight? 🔁 **Another Question**.
2. **Show the Question** — it goes up on the TV; read it out. Teams answer **out loud**.
3. Mark the **first team to answer**: ✓ **<team> Correct** wins the game. ✕ **<team> Wrong** puts that team **out** ("WRONG — <TEAM> IS OUT"); the others can still answer.
4. **Every team wrong?** The TV shows the answer and "NOBODY GOT IT — A NEW QUESTION IS COMING": tap **New Question** and every team is back in.
5. **Correct:** "<TEAM> WINS THE TIEBREAKER!" — then **Show Final Standings**. Points don't change: the winner simply ranks first among the teams level with it. The standings, the winner screen, the 💾 standings picture and Historic Games all say **"won the sudden-death tiebreaker"**, and the questions shown count as used. - **Mistake? ↩ Undo Last Mark** takes back the last Correct or Wrong. **Cancel Tiebreaker** (asks first) goes back to where you were — most correct answers decides; you can start it again. - **No question left** in the Database (text questions not in this game)? You get **Start — I'll Ask a Question**: ask one of your own, then mark the teams the same way. - A team marked **away** isn't in the tiebreaker.



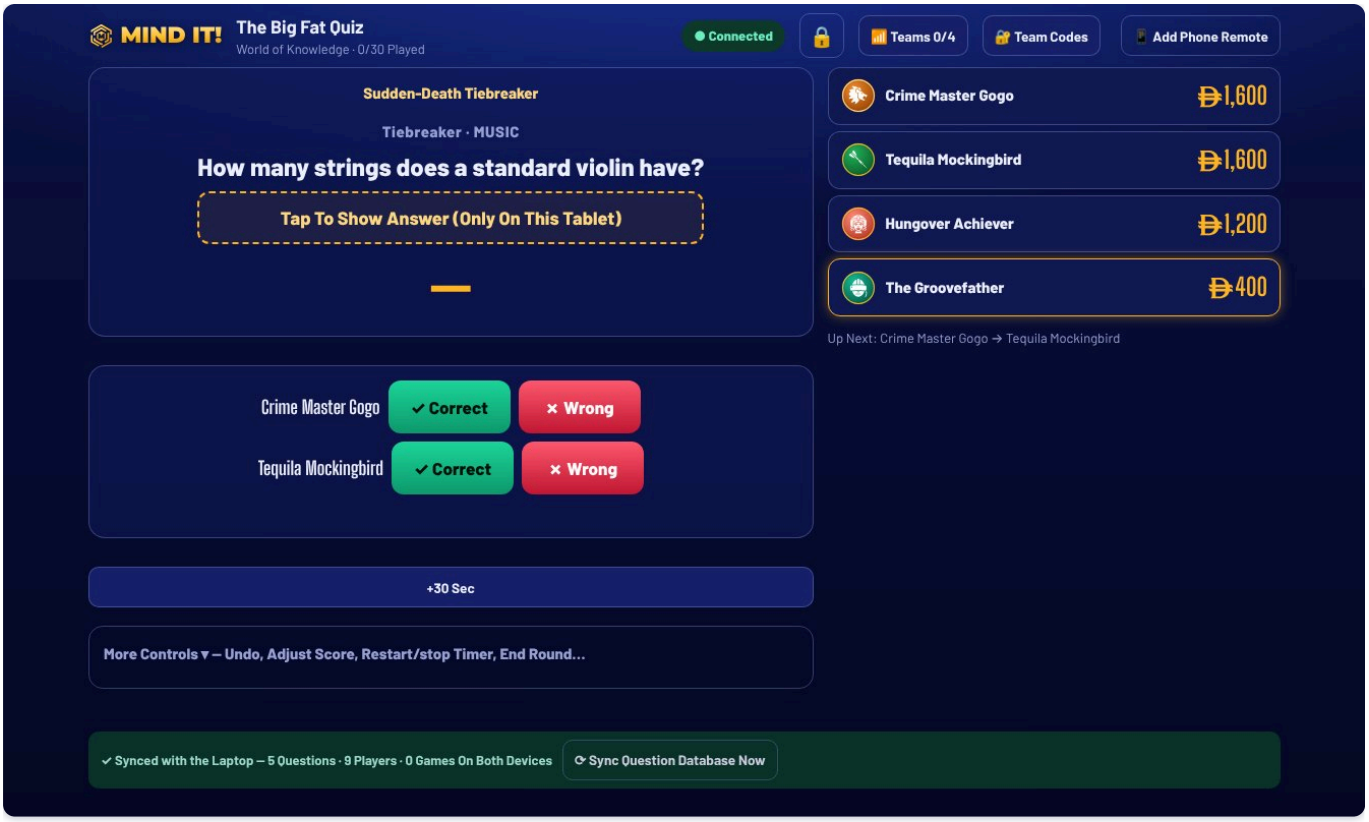
📸 *Real screenshot (build 140) — Crime Master Gogo and Tequila Mockingbird finish level on 1,600: the tiebreaker question on the TV.*



📸 *Real screenshot (build 140) — the laptop: Correct / Wrong for each tied team, and the question and answer for your eyes only.*



📸 *Real screenshot (build 140) — Tequila Mockingbird answered wrong and is out; Crime Master Gogo answered right.*



📸 *Real screenshot (build 140) — the tablet remote: the question, the answer behind a tap, and Correct / Wrong for each team.*

Without the tiebreaker — level on points? The team with the most correct answers wins. (Changed in build 112 — the owner's decision. Before, only the records used this rule and the TV showed a tie.)

- **The TV and the records now agree.** The final standings, the Mastermind It! reveal list and the winner screen place level teams by **most correct answers**. The standings say **"TIED ON POINTS — <TEAM> WINS ON MOST CORRECT ANSWERS"**, and the winner screen says **"And the Winner Is... <team>"** with "**Won on most correct answers (3 vs 2)**" under the score.
- **Level on points *and* correct answers?** Then it really is a tie: the TV shows **"IT'S A TIE!"** (or "IT'S A TIE AT THE TOP — A & B") and the teams share the win in the records.
- During the game (board, round summaries) level teams still simply share a place — the tie-break only decides the final result.
- **The counts are on screen** (build 113): the final standings and the winner podium show ✓ **3 Correct** under each score (and "· ✓ N" for 4th place and below), and the phones' scoreboard shows each team's ✓ count all game.

📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — Crime Master Gogo and Hungover Achiever both finish on 1,200; Hungover answered 3 questions correctly, Gogo 2, so Hungover takes 1st place.*

📸 *Real screenshot (build 112) — the winner screen names Hungover Achiever: "1,200 Points · Won On Most Correct Answers (3 vs 2)".*

📸 Real screenshot (build 114) — the final standings with each team's correct answers.

18.4 A worked example with numbers

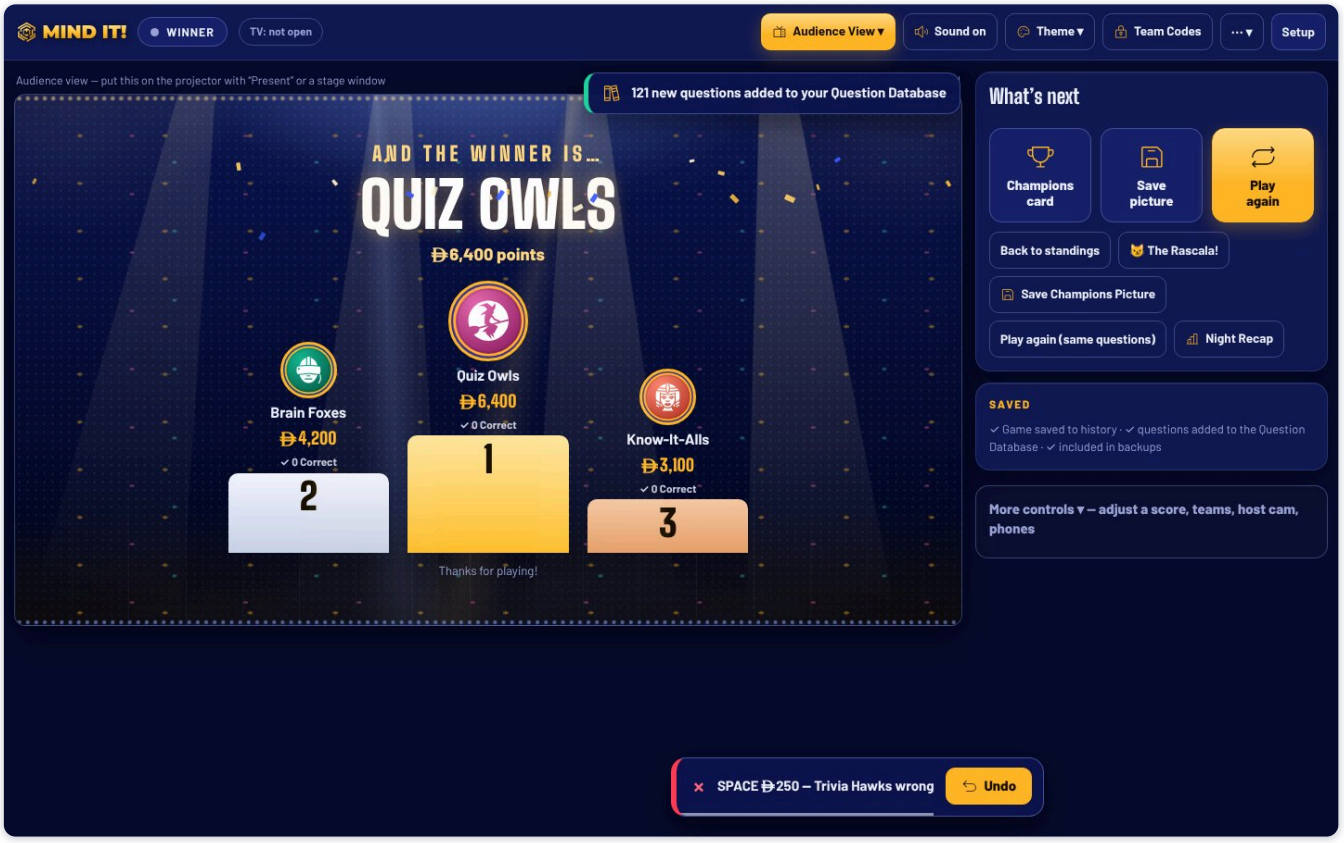
Team	Score before	Wager	Right / wrong	Calculation	After
A	5,000	2,001	Wrong	5,000 − 2,001	2,999
B	3,000	3,000	Right	3,000 + 3,000	6,000
C	0	0	Right	0 + 0	0
D	−400	—	(sits out)	—	−400

Strategy note: A bet 2,001 to make sure that, if right, it would end on 7,001 — more than B's maximum (6,000). Wrong, though…

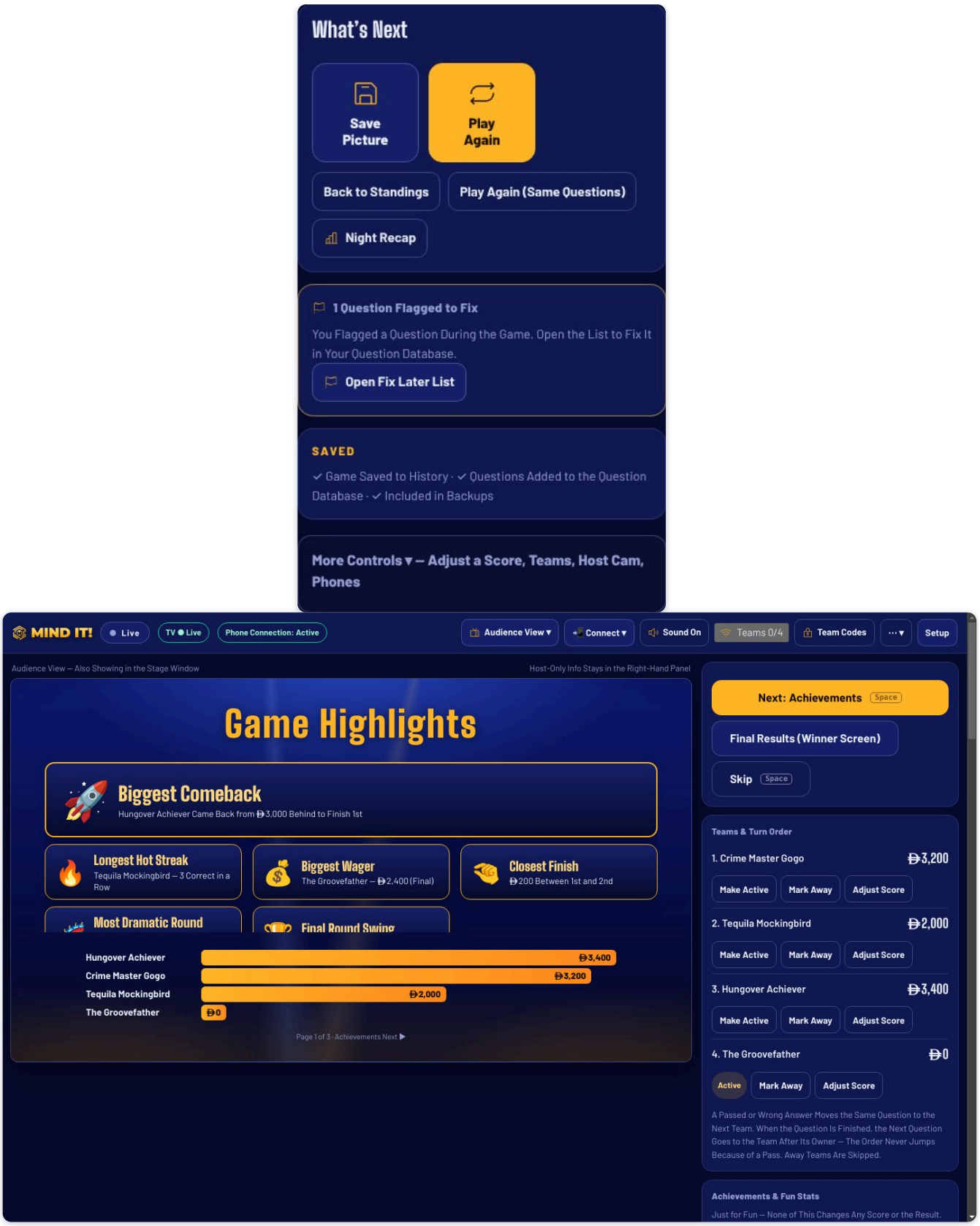
19. Ending a Game

19.1 What happens, in order

1. **Final standings** appear (laptop and TV). **At this moment the game is saved to Historic Games** — exactly once per game (never for a Rehearsal). Player statistics, achievements, the leaderboard and "used" question marks are updated, and all the quiz's questions are added to the Question Database.
2. **Results review:** 🏅 **Achievements & Fun Stats** (Game Highlights → Achievements Unlocked → Fun Stats → Final Results), **Winner Screen**, **Save Picture** (a PNG of the standings), 📊 **Night Recap** (the night on one TV slide — see 15.10). If you flagged questions with ⚑ Fix Later, a card offers ⚑ **Open Fix Later List** (see 6.4).
3. **End the night:** press 🏁 **END GAME** on the tablet, or **Back to Setup** on the laptop.



📸 *Real screenshots — the laptop's winner screen (build 150, with 😺 **The Rascala!** among the What's Next buttons) and the awards ("Game Highlights") with the host controls.*



📸 Real screenshot (build 141) — the laptop's "What's Next" card on the winner screen, with 📊 Night Recap and the card for questions flagged to fix.

19.1b 😾 The Rascala! — last place, with style (since build 148)

- **Who:** the team with the **lowest final score**. Level on score? The one with the **most wrong answers**; still level, the **fewest right answers**; still level, they **share** it. The tie-break always decides — also when every team finishes level on score (build 149). An answer taken back with Undo, Reset Question or Reset Round doesn't count. The Rascala! never changes the standings, the winner or a tiebreaker.

- **The reveal:** about **9 seconds** after the winner screen appears, the TV shows The Rascala!: Mind It!'s cowboy cat, "And in last place…", **THE RASCALA!**, the team card(s) with the score, and the line “Enna Rascala….Mind It!”. Or press 😺 **The Rascala!** on the laptop or tablet at any time on the winner screen. **Continue ▶** goes back to the winner screen (it goes back by itself after 14 seconds), without playing the fanfare again. Once per game; never in a Rehearsal; while the 🏆 Champions Card is up, the automatic reveal waits.
- **The achievement:** 😺 **The Rascala!** goes to that team's players for the night (never the Quizmaster) and is saved with the game; Career Achievements count it.
- **Historic Games:** each game shows a 😺 badge with its Rascala. Games played before build 148 are worked out from what they saved. When that can't prove it (two teams level and nothing saved tells them apart), the game's page says **Needs review** and offers a button per team or **All of them** — **Undo Pick** changes it.

📸 *Real screenshot (build 150) — The Rascala! on the TV.*

19.2 What END GAME does exactly ✅

- It appears on the tablet **after the final standings** (and on a tablet-only game too). Tapping it asks: *"End the game and go back to the Main Menu? The results are saved on the laptop."*
- The tablet sends **one** End Game command. The laptop **finishes the game record once** — it's the same record the standings already made, never a second Historic Game — and goes back to Setup, exactly like "Back to Setup".
- If the connection drops right after the tap, the tablet **re-sends it automatically** when it reconnects; the laptop recognises the repeat and doesn't save twice. A stray End Game for an old game is refused.
- The tablet shows **THANKS FOR PLAYING!** ("See you at the next quiz." — tap to skip) and returns to its Main Menu.
- **In a Rehearsal**, END GAME ends the rehearsal and records nothing.
- **Team phones** say **"🏁 Thanks For Playing!"** — also after Mastermind It! played with phone wagers (fixed in build 112), and also when the laptop's **Back to Setup** ends the game.
- It changes no scores and no rules.

19.3 How the laptop and tablet stay in step

The laptop is the single source of truth. Every tablet button is a command the laptop confirms; the tablet then shows the laptop's new state. The tablet locks the END GAME button while it waits (no double taps), and if no confirmation arrives it retries. Questions, players and games are synced in both directions (✓ **Synced with the Laptop**).

19.4 Reopening results later

- **Player Profiles → Historic Games** lists every saved game; open one to see its teams, scores, questions (exactly as asked), achievements and Mastermind It! answers.
- **Save Standings Picture** works from the standings/winner screens.
- **Export History to Excel** for spreadsheets.
- The **Leaderboard** tab ranks players across games.

PART SIX — ADDITIONAL FEATURES

20. Achievements, Statistics and Historic Games

20.1 How per-game achievements work ✅

- They are worked out **from real game data** at the end of a game and **never change scores, places, wagers, turns or the winner**.
- They go to **teams**; tied teams all get it; each achievement goes to a team at most once per game; nothing is given just for taking part.
- **Career totals credit every player on the team.** A few awards are for **one-player teams only** (🦸 Comeback Kid — "biggest comeback by a solo player"). The **Bottoms Up** awards go to the **designated player only**.
- They appear in the 🏅 **Achievements & Fun Stats** TV pages and are frozen into the Historic Game.

20.2 Every per-game achievement (60 definitions)

The "v" column is the version that introduced it. All are implemented ✅; achievements were verified by the app's test suites (the worked game in Chapter 17 earned 53 awards).

Icon	Name	Condition	Notes
🔥	On Fire	5 or more correct answers in a row	
♨️	Hot Streak	Longest run of correct answers	2+
🎯	Deadly Accuracy	Best correct-answer percentage	4+ attempts
💣	Knowledge Bomb	10 or more correct answers	
⚡	Speed Demon	Fastest correct answer	
🐢	Slow And Steady	Most correct answers without a speed bonus	3+
👑	Top Of The Table	Finished with the highest score	
📈	Climber	Gained the most places during the game	
🏃	Pass Master	Passed the most questions	
↩️	Wrong Turn	Most wrong answers	
🎲	Professional Guesser	5 or more wrong answers	
🧊	Ice Cold	Longest run of wrong answers	2+
😵	What Was That?	Most wrong answers on high-value questions	top two values
💀	So Close	Smallest losing margin	
🎰	Risk Taker	Highest total wagered	
💰	Big Spender	Largest single wager	
🎲	Double Down	Most Blind It! questions won	

Icon	Name	Condition	Notes
🫠	Double Trouble	Biggest Blind It! loss	
🧨	All Or Nothing	Biggest wager compared with the score at the time	
🏆	Final Boss	Biggest Mastermind It! gain	
🏁	Finisher	Moved up the most places in Mastermind It!	
🚀	Comeback Kings	Biggest recovery from their lowest score	
🦸	Comeback Kid	Biggest comeback by a solo player	one-player teams
🪀	Score Yo-Yo	Most total score movement	
🎭	Drama Queen	Biggest single-question swing	
🕵️	Last-Minute Hero	Correct answer with the least time left	
🐦	Early Bird	Biggest lead in the early rounds	
🧠	Perfect Start	First 3+ answers all correct	
✨	Clean Sweep	Every answer correct	5+ answers
🏃	Ran The Category	Answered every question in one category correctly	3+ questions
🥇	Wire To Wire	Led from the first scoring question to the end	
🧗	Bottom To Top	Was in last place at some point and still won	
🌱	Late Bloomer	Last after Round 1, finished in the top two	
💔	Heartbreaker	Led going into Mastermind It! but didn't win	
📸	Photo Finish	Took the lead in Mastermind It!	
🟢	Back From The Red	Dropped below zero but finished positive	
📊	Consistent Performer	Scored points in every round played	2+ rounds
🏀	Rebound King	Most correct answers on questions another team missed or passed	
💎	High Roller Row	Most correct answers on the top-value questions	2+
🛒	Bargain Hunter	Most correct answers on the lowest-value questions	2+
🔬	Specialist	Most correct answers in a single category	3+
🌍	All-Rounder	Correct answers in the most different categories	3+
🤠	Quick Draw	3+ correct answers within 5 seconds	
⚡	Speed Collector	Earned the most speed bonuses	
🚫	No Pass Zone	Never passed a question	5+ attempts
⏱️	Overtime Hero	Answered correctly after the host added +30 seconds	
🔥	Never Mind It! Hero	Answered a Never Mind It! (bet everything on Blind It!) correctly	
💸	Gambler's Ruin	Lost everything on a single wager	

Icon	Name	Condition	Notes
🧾	Mastermind It! Answer Ace	Mastermind It! answer right first time — the checker agreed, no override	
⚡	Lightning Reflexes	Fastest buzz of the game	Phone Buzzer Mode
🛡️	Title Defence	Returning champion who won again	Returning Champion rule
⚔️	Dethroned The Champ	Beat the returning champion to win	Returning Champion rule
🎲	Triple Threat	Answered a Triple Gamble question correctly	
💎	High Roller	Answered a Triple Gamble Blind It! question correctly (6×)	
♠️	All In	Used the Triple Gamble on the highest-value question available	
🔥	Rise From The Ashes	Used the Phoenix chip and went on to win the game	
🚀	Phoenix Climber	Climbed two or more places in the round after using the Phoenix chip (called "Comeback Kid" before build 113)	
🍺	Bottoms Up!	The designated player who finished their drink on a Bottoms Up and saved the team's points	designated player only
🥛	Glass Half Full	The designated player on a Bottoms Up who couldn't finish their drink	designated player only
😺	The Rascala!	Finished last: the lowest score (then the most wrong answers, then the fewest right answers; still level → shared) — 19.1b	build 148

✅ *Until build 112 the 🚀 Phoenix award was also called "Comeback Kid" and shared the 🦸 solo award's internal id, so one could hide the other. Since build 113 it is "Phoenix Climber" and all 59 achievements are separate. Games saved before keep the name they were saved with.*

20.3 Career badges (11) — on player profiles

🏆 **First Win** · 🎩 **Hat-Trick** (3 wins in a row) · 🔥 **Unstoppable** (5 in a row) · 👑 **Serial Winner** (10 wins) · 🚀 **Comeback King** (won after being last) · 🎯 **Blind It! Specialist** (3+ Blind It! questions right) · 🧠 **Big Brain** (15+ right in a game) · 💰 **High Roller** (10,000+ in a game) · ⚖️ **Tiebreak Hero** · 🎖️ **Veteran** (10 games) · 🌟 **Quiz Legend** (25 games).

20.4 Career milestones (6)

📅 **Regular** (5 quiz nights in a row) · 💯 **Century** (100 correct) · 🏅 **Collector** (10 different achievements) · 🥈 **Always The Bridesmaid** (2nd three times) · 🗡️ **Giant Killer** (beat the leaderboard leader) · 🎰 **Gamble Master** (won a Triple Gamble in 2+ games).

20.5 Host achievements (10) — for the Quizmaster

🎤 **The Host** · 🎙️ **Master Of Ceremonies** (10 games) · 🎩 **Seasoned Host** (25) · 🏛️ **Quiz Veteran** (50) · 🎟️ **Full House** (12+ players) · 📳 **Buzzmaster** · 🔔 **Buzzer Boss** (10 buzzer games) · 🎭 **The Showman** (5 themes) · 🏆 **Final Boss Host** (25 Mastermind It! games) · ❓ **Question Master** (1,000 questions).

20.6 Fun Stats ✅

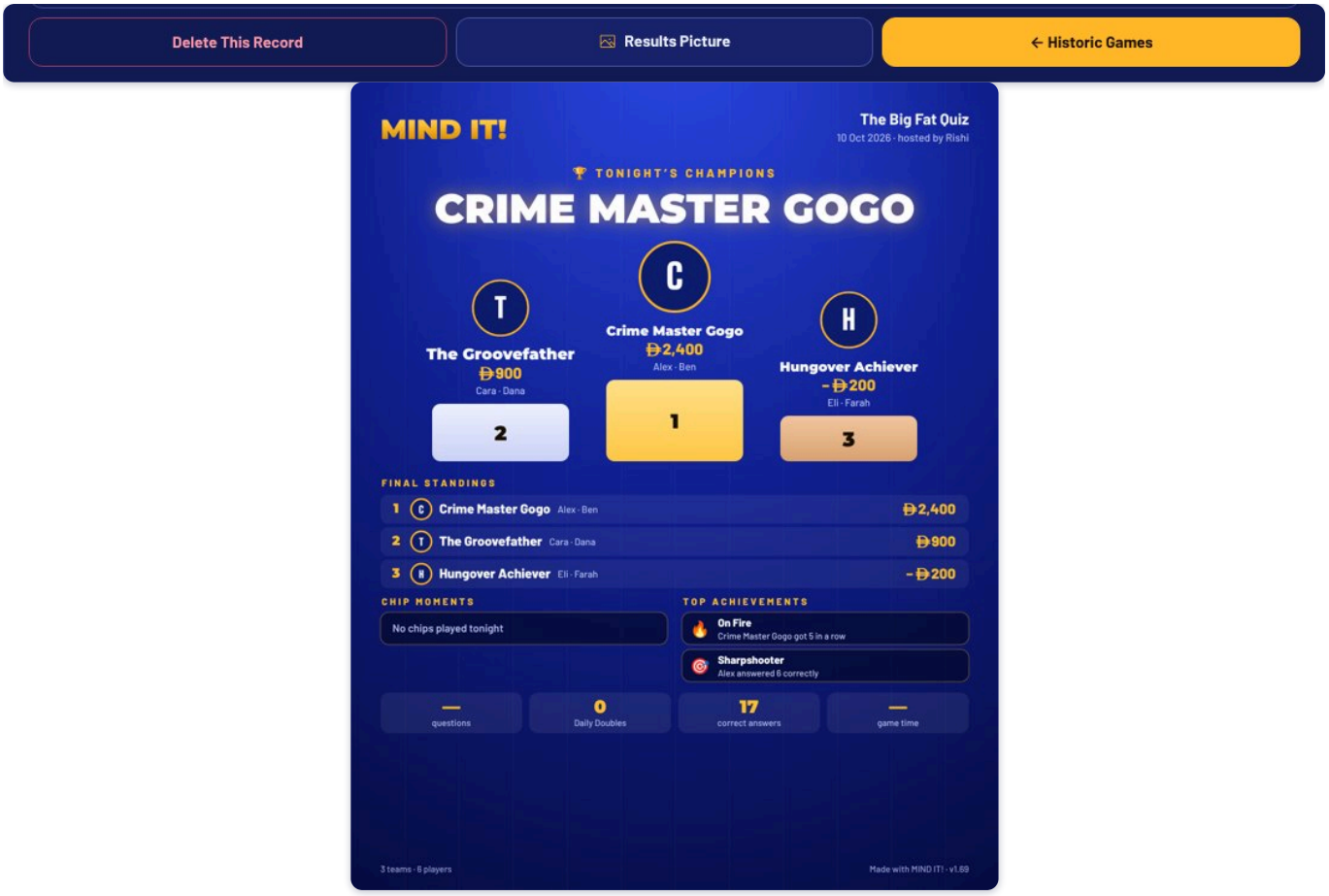
After every game, the **Fun Stats** pages show team and solo-player records such as: Biggest Single Gain, Biggest Comeback, Biggest Lead, Biggest Wager, Closest Finish, Blind It! Hero, Fastest Correct Answer, Mastermind It! Swing, Longest Hot Streak, Most Active Team, Most Dramatic Round, Most Passes, Most Pass Success, Score Yo-Yo, plus the 🎲 **Triple Gamble Chips** and 🔥 **Phoenix Chips** summaries — and in Buzzer Mode: Fastest Buzzer, Quickest On Average and Jumped The Gun.

20.7 Statistics and the leaderboard ✅

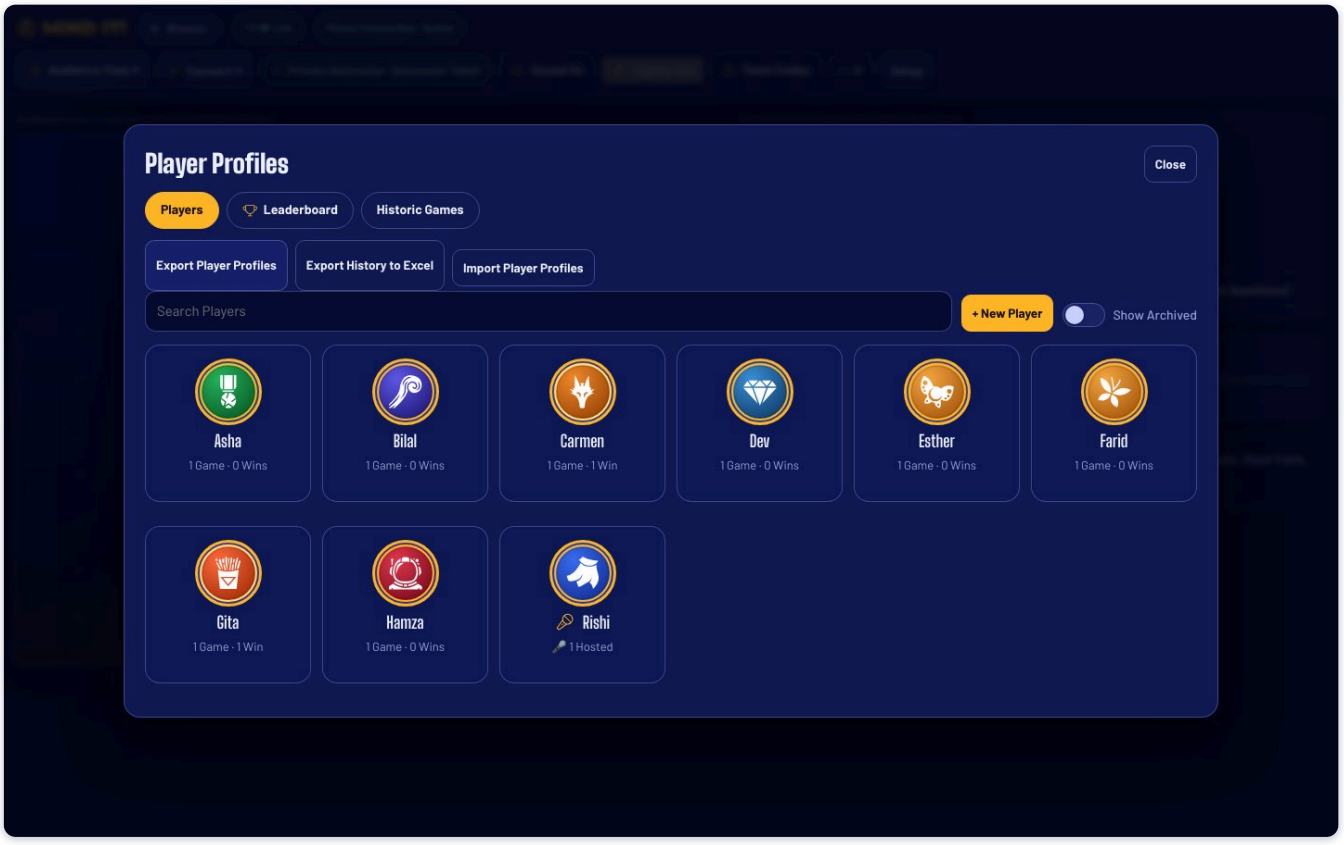
- **Player page:** Overview (games, wins, win %, best score and more) · Achievements · Games · Head-to-Head · Host stats.
- **Leaderboard** (Player Profiles → 🏆 Leaderboard, or 6 · Advanced → 🏆 Season Leaderboard): 🥇🥈🥉, periods **All Time / This Season / This Month**, ranked by **Wins / Win % / Points**, with ▲▼ and 🔥 streaks.
- **Longest Game** (host stats) starts from a 2-hour record and counts real playing time only.
- Corrections (on a player's games): **Edit Score**, **Add Past Game**, **Delete This Record**. Possible duplicate players: **Review & Merge**.

20.8 Historic Games ✅

- **Saved once per game** when the final Standings (or Winner) screen is reached. **Never for a Rehearsal.**
- **Stored:** per team — name, score, position, players, picture, correct answers, Blind It! questions, comeback; per game — quiz title, theme, tie-break, achievements and Fun Stats, host and mode, timer and buzz events, Triple Gamble and Phoenix records, champion, the Mastermind It! answer audit and the playing time.
- **Frozen:** every question played (and Mastermind It!) is copied **exactly as it was asked**. Editing the Question Database later never changes a Historic Game.
- **Damaged records** are repaired when loaded if possible; unreadable ones are **set aside, never deleted** (they stay in backups) and show "This record couldn't be displayed".
- Build 111 also repairs an impossible playing time (e.g. "15 seconds" for a two-hour game) by using the game's real start and end, marked as estimated.
- 🖼 **Results Picture** (since build 125): open any game in Historic Games and press 🖼 **Results Picture** to save the same recap card as the night's 💾 **Save picture** — podium, final standings, chip moments, top achievements — for a game you played weeks ago.



📸 *Real screenshot — a Historic Game's bottom row, and the picture it saves.*



📸 *Real screenshot — Player Profiles after one game (each card now shows games and wins).*

21. Themes, Audio and Personalisation

21.1 The 12 themes ✅

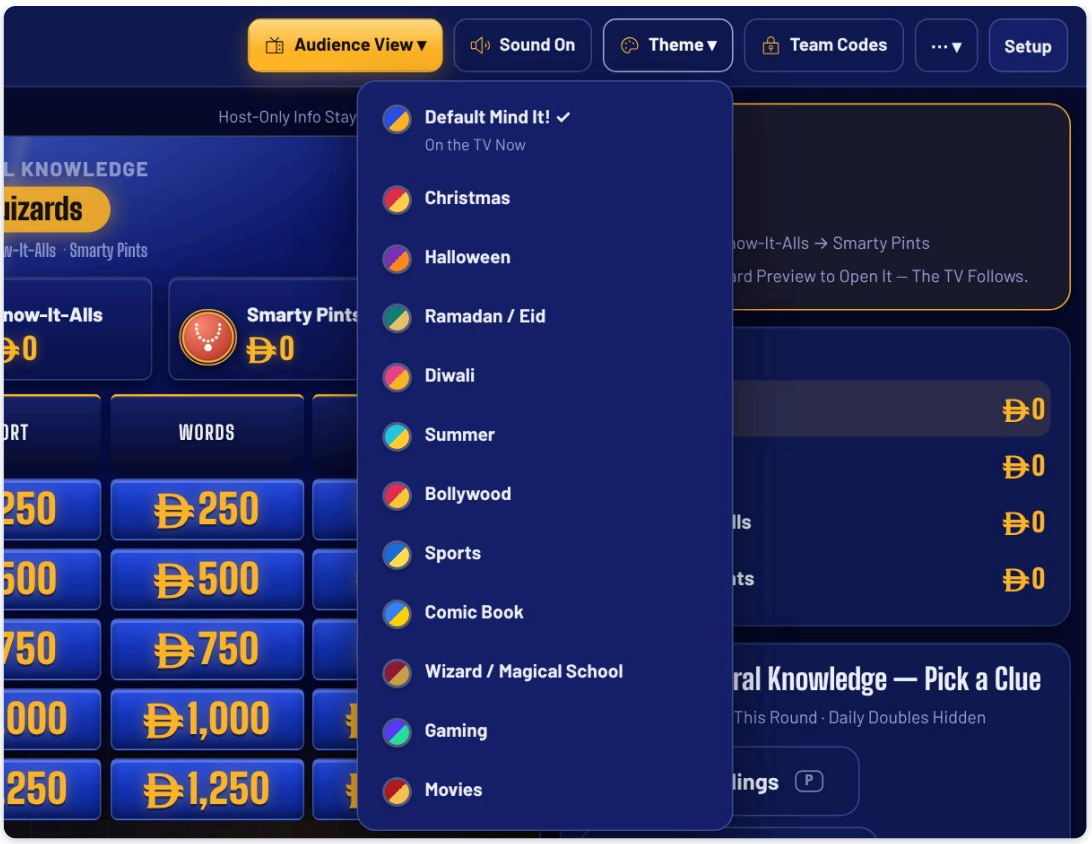
5 · Audio & Presentation → Theme. Each theme is a card with a preview of the TV in that theme (since build 146: a larger, cleaner preview in the premium look), its name, **In Use** on the current one and **▶ Sounds**. Tap a card to see it big and **Apply Theme**:

1. **Default Mind It!** 2. **Christmas** 3. **Halloween** 4. **Ramadan / Eid** 5. **Diwali** 6. **Summer** 7. **Bollywood** 8. **Sports** 9. **Comic Book** 10. **Wizard / Magical School** 11. **Gaming** 12. **Movies**

📸 *Real screenshot (build 146) — the Theme cards (the first six of twelve).*

- **Themes change the look (and optionally the sounds) of the whole game. Gameplay and your data never change.**
- **🎨 Theme ▾ in the top bar (since build 146):** during the game, tap **🎨 Theme** next to Sound on your top bar and pick a theme from the list (each shows its colours; the current one is ticked). It changes at once on the laptop, the TV window and the Wi-Fi TVs — the question, scores, turn and timer carry on. The theme cards here (with their previews) still work as before; from here a change during a game asks *Change Theme During the Game?* first.
- **The premium look (since build 146):** every theme gets glossy tiles, headers rimmed in its accent colour, deeper score cards and a soft glow on the question and the answer, in its own colours. Comic Book keeps its flat ink style, Gaming its square neon edges and Wizard its parchment card.
- **Premium theme moments (since build 147):** each theme plays its own short moment on the TV when a game starts or returns to the title, on each category card of a round intro, as a question opens, on a correct answer (on the team's score card) and a wrong one (on the question card), when a team takes first place, for the Blind It! question, back to the board, Mastermind It!, the final answer, the standings and the winner. The frequent ones take about a second and never hold up the game; the Blind It! question, round intros, Mastermind It! and the winner are the big ones. For example:
- **Default Mind It!:** a navy studio with gold light and an LED wall; spotlight beams, a gold line traced round each new question, gold light when a team takes the lead.

- **Comic Book** (redesigned: ink black, crimson, hero gold, paper cream, steel blue): an ink panel reveals the question, **POW!** on the team that scores, **MISS!** on a wrong answer, page-turn category cards, a **KA-POW** Blind It! question and hero rays for the winner.
- **Christmas:** snow, frosted glass and gold stars. **Halloween:** candle light and fog, the ghost, lightning for the Blind It! question, bats and the moon for the winner. **Ramadan / Eid:** eight-point stars drawn in gold and lantern light. **Diwali:** rangoli drawn in light, diyas and gentle fireworks.
- **Summer:** waves, bubbles and a sunset winner. **Bollywood:** theatre spotlights, marquee lights and camera flashes. **Sports:** floodlights, broadcast wipes and gold confetti. **Wizard:** the rune frame, wand-light, the wax seal with a portal of runes, the phoenix. **Gaming:** a clean scan, hologram rings and pixels, no flashing. **Movies:** curtains, film strips and spotlights. With 🎬 **Motion → Subtle** each moment is a gentle glow; with **Off**, or a device set to reduce motion, none. A slow Wi-Fi TV that lightened itself skips them.
- **Theme Intensity:** Subtle · Standard · **Full** — decorations and animations only, never the layout.
- **Drawn TV backdrops (since build 135):** every holiday and party theme now has its own picture behind the quiz, with a few things moving in it — original drawings, never covering the questions or scores:
- **Christmas:** a snowy village at night with lit cottages, a decorated tree and a sleigh crossing the moon.
- **Halloween:** a haunted house on a hill, a graveyard, glowing pumpkins, bats and a witch passing the moon.
- **Ramadan / Eid:** a skyline of domes and minarets under the crescent, with lanterns swaying from the top.
- **Diwali:** a festive street with fairy lights, marigold garlands, diyas, sky lanterns and fireworks.
- **Summer:** a beach with palm trees, a sailboat, seagulls, an umbrella and a sandcastle.
- **Comic Book:** an ink-outlined city under a sunburst, action bursts and two made-up flying heroes — since build 147 in ink black, crimson, hero gold, paper cream and steel blue.
- **Gaming:** a neon pixel city and sunset on a grid, with coins, gems and a little spaceship.
- **Movies:** red curtains, sweeping searchlights, a marquee, a film reel and a clapperboard. With **Subtle** intensity, or a device set to reduce motion, everything stays still. Bollywood and Sports keep their own designs.
- **Wizard / Magical School (since build 134):** the TV shows a castle at night on a cliff above a lake, with lit windows and a moon. Owls, a dragon, a phoenix and bats fly past behind the quiz. With **Subtle**, or a device set to reduce motion, they stay still.
- **Theme Sounds:** On, or *Off — Standard Mind It! Sounds*. The loading music, the intro theme ("MIND IT!" and the explosion) and the 🎵 Mind It! sting always stay the same.
- 🟡 Sounds can't be checked by eye; the owner approves them by ear.
- Themes that were removed in the past (e.g. "Fantasy", "Music") are not available.



📸 Real screenshot (build 146) — 🎨 Theme ▾ in the Quizmaster's top bar, during a game.

21.2 Audio ✅ (🟡 by ear)

- **Master Volume** slider, 🔊 **Sound On/Off** (top bar too), **Test Sound**, 🎵 **Play Mind It! Sting**.
- 💓 **Heartbeat in the last 10 seconds** (on by default; follows the volume and mute).
- Thinking music during Mastermind It!
- **The Mind It! sound pack** (build 149): recorded sounds in the style of the Mind It! trailer — the right-answer ding, the wrong-answer "eh-ehh", the question sparkle, the lock-in buzz, the pass whoosh, the Blind It! and Mastermind It! impact, the score tally, the time's-up horn, the Triple Gamble dice, the Phoenix rise, Bottoms Up's cheers, the Rewind It! whip-crack and the wheel's bell, The Rascala!'s "wah-wah-waaah", and a studio cheer under the winner fanfare. A theme with its own sounds keeps them (**Theme Sounds On**); with Theme Sounds Off you hear the pack.
- **Like the trailer** (build 150): each moment uses the trailer's sound at the trailer's balance — a right answer is the ding and then the score "pop"; a phone's **BUZZ IN** is the buzz; a new board, the round summary, the standings, the recap, the awards and the match-up arrive with a soft whoosh (never into or out of a question); the standings add the leaderboard tally; the winner gets the impact before the crowd; changing the theme sparkles. The laptop plays them (and through it the Audience window and the Wi-Fi Audience Screens); phones and the tablet remote stay quiet. **Sound Off** silences all of them.
- The intro keeps its music, the voice "Enna Rascala....Mind It!" and the explosion, exactly as before.

21.3 Presentation options

- **Large Text On TV** — bigger scores, names, categories and status text.
- **Colour-Blind-Safe Colours** — correct in blue, wrong in orange, with ✓ and ×.
- **Show a "How to Play" slide before Round 1.**
- **Host Cam** — Off by default; a small live picture of you on the TV (video only, nothing recorded or uploaded).
- **Board & Flow** (remembered on this device): ↩️ **Back to the board automatically after each answer** (ON; **3 s** since build 146 — it was 7 s from build 138; build 146 switches it on once on every device; "Stay Here" stops it; No One Answered also closes after 3 s since build 146) · 😐 **Hide a category once all its questions are played** (Off) · 💓 **Heartbeat** (ON) · 📊 **TV Scoreboard Position** (Auto / Always at the side / Always along the top/bottom).

- 🎬 **Motion** (in the Board & Flow card, remembered on this laptop; since build 145): **Full** (default) plays every effect — the question growing out of its square, screen fades, the TIME'S UP stamp, the shake on a wrong answer, sparks on a correct one, the gliding spotlight, standings 3rd → 2nd → 1st, the winner's spotlight and the rest. **Subtle** keeps only gentle fades. **Off** stills everything on the TV, the laptop and the tablet remote. A device set to Reduce Motion (Windows: Settings → Accessibility → Visual effects → Animation effects off) always shows none. Since build 146 the **team phones follow this setting too** (a phone set to Reduce Motion still shows none), and **Wi-Fi Audience Screens play the motion** themselves. Build 146 also added the answer rising with a line sweeping under it, the **Your Turn to Pick!** banner on phones and a picture rising into its frame.
- **A slow Wi-Fi TV lightens itself (since build 146):** a Wi-Fi Audience Screen that can't keep up (under 24 frames a second for 8 seconds, after its first 10 seconds) switches to lighter motion by itself — gentle fades instead of the zoom and slides, and no heavy glows or shadows; the picture and the Now Playing ring stay. The laptop shows a note naming that TV once, and 📺 **Connect Audience Screen** marks it 🪶 **Lighter motion**. Reloading the TV's page tries full motion again. The TV window over HDMI is never changed.

21.4 Pictures

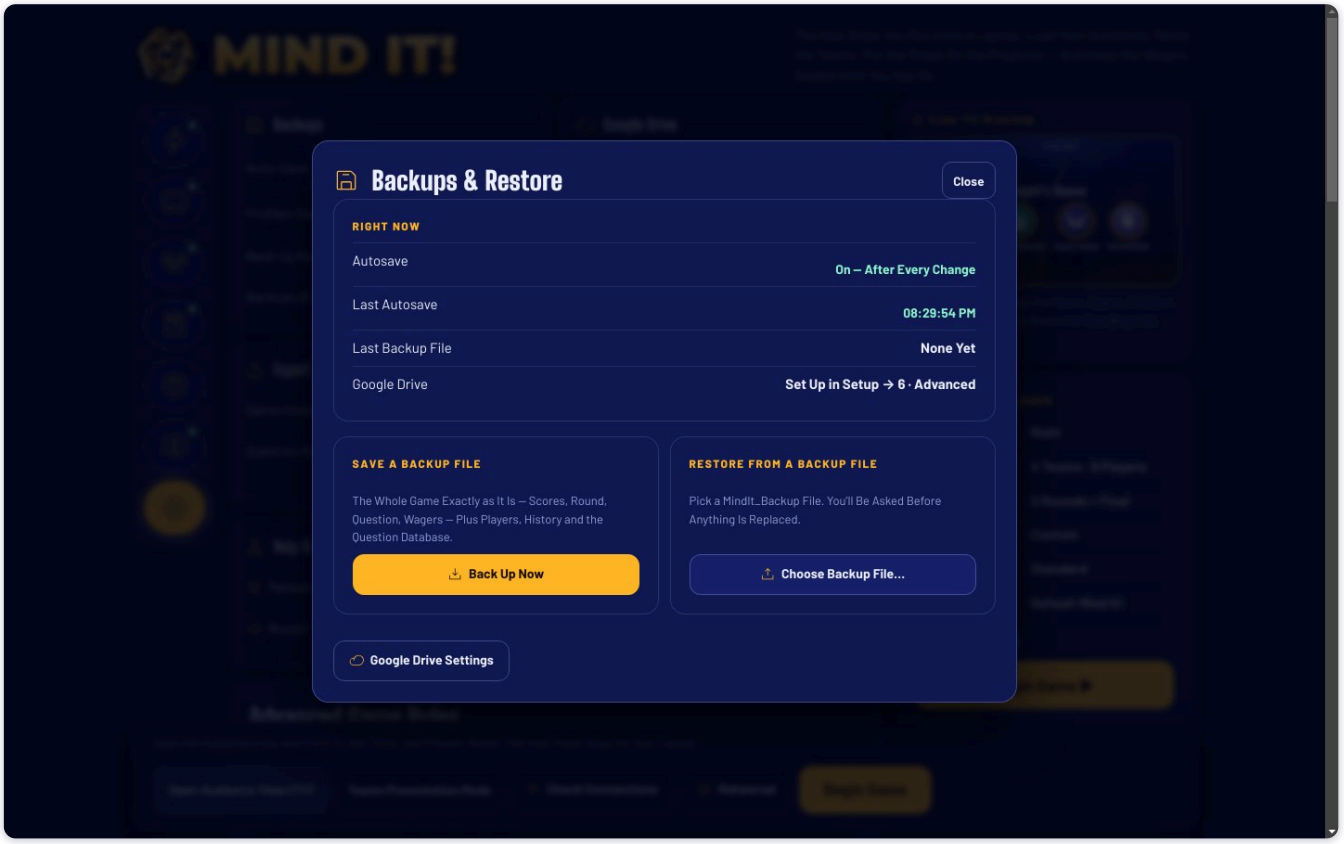
- **Player pictures:** a photo (iPhone HEIC works) cropped in the editor, or a built-in icon.
- **Team pictures:** ✎ on the team card; one-player teams use the player's picture automatically.
- **Question pictures:** Question Picture and Answer Picture on each question (and media links).
- Build 111 stores new photos at up to 800 pixels, which keeps saves small and fast.

---

22. Backups and Game Recovery

22.1 What is saved, where, and when ✅

What	Saved automatically?	Where
The current game (scores, round, question, wagers…)	**Yes — after every change** ("Autosave: On — After Every Change")	Inside the Mind It! app on that device
The current game's pictures, videos, music, intro video and team photos (since build 140)	**Yes — a complete copy, after every change**	Laptop app: the Mind It! data folder · Galaxy Tab: the app's own storage · browser: its own database
Players, pictures, Historic Games	Yes	Inside the app, and (laptop) a profiles file in your Windows user folder
Question Database	Yes	Inside the app
Backup file (`MindIt_Backup_….json`, named with the date and time)	**No — you make it**	Wherever you save it
Google Drive backup (optional, needs internet)	When set up	Your own Google Drive

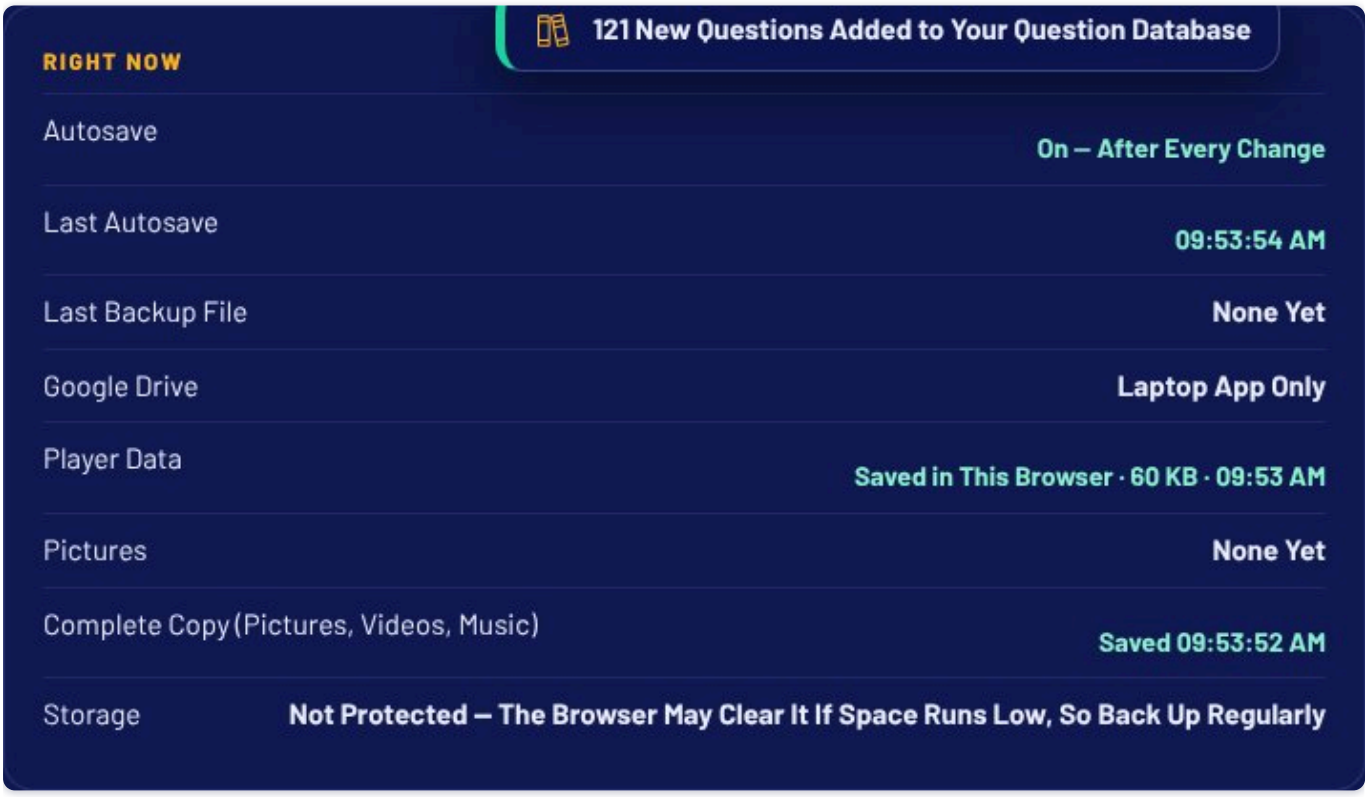


📸 *Real screenshot — ⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore.*

Pictures, videos and music after a crash (build 140). The everyday autosave has only a little room. A quiz with many pictures, videos, music, an intro video or team photos doesn't fit in it, so it used to come back after a crash **without** them (scores and questions were always kept). Now Mind It! also keeps a **complete copy**, and **Resume saved game** brings everything back. **⋯ ▾ → Undo & resets** shows when the last complete copy was saved and where:

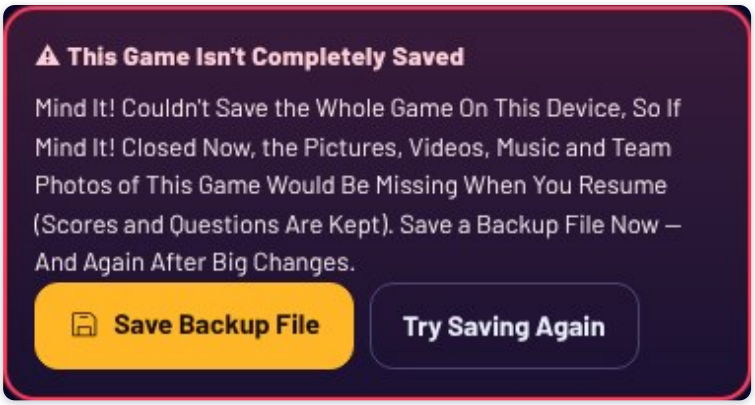
📸 *Real screenshot — the line at the bottom of Undo & resets.*

Storage the browser keeps (since build 141): Mind It! asks the browser, once, to keep its data for good — players, history, the Question Database and the complete copy — so it isn't cleared when the device runs low on space. **⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore** shows the answer in the **Storage** line: *Protected* (most browsers agree for a site you use often, or one on your Home Screen), or *Not protected — back up regularly*. The laptop app and the tablet keep their data in their own files, and say so.



📸 *Real screenshot (build 141) — Backups & Restore: the Complete copy and Storage lines (this test browser said no).*

If there is ever **no room anywhere** for the complete copy, a **red card** appears under Now Picking (and a message, once per game). Tap 💾 **Save Backup File** now, and again after big changes. **Try Saving Again** retries after you've freed some space. The card goes away by itself once a complete copy is saved.



📸 *Real screenshot — only when the complete copy can't be saved.*

22.2 Making a backup

⋯ ▾ → 💾 Backups & Restore → ⬇ Back Up Now (also **Save Backup File** in More Controls and on the round summary). The file contains **the whole game exactly as it is now — scores, round, question, wagers — plus players, history and the Question Database**, with all pictures included. Since build 136 each question picture is in the file **once** (it was also stored a second time inside the quiz), so backups are about a third smaller; builds 132 and later restore them.

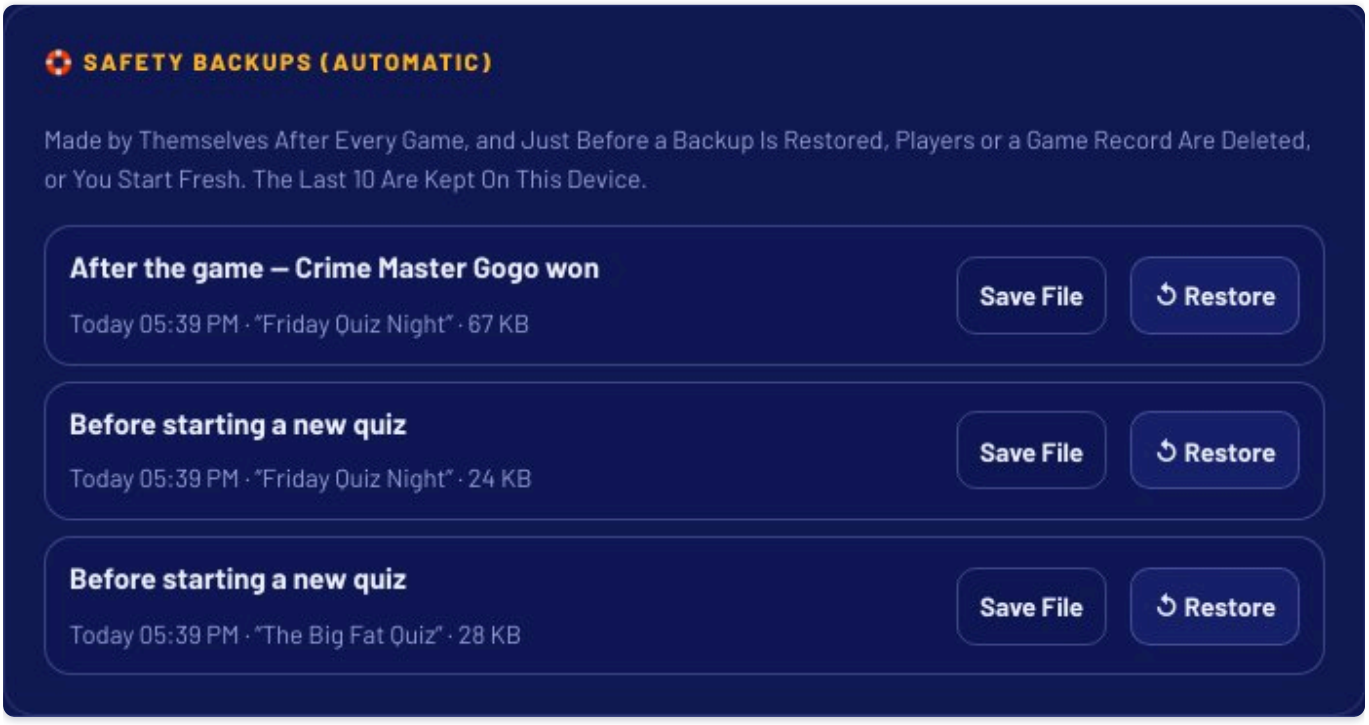
Good habit: back up before the game, at the end of each round, and after the game.

22.3 Restoring a backup

⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore → ⏏ Choose Backup File... and pick a `MindIt_Backup` file. **You're always asked first** (since build 123 — before, it only asked when a game was in progress): **Restore Backup** or **Cancel**. The players, pictures and Historic Games in the backup are **merged** with what is already there (nothing is deleted); the quiz in the backup **replaces** the one that is open, so make a backup of anything you are still preparing first. Then **Return to game** to carry on exactly where it was. (You can also drop the file on **Upload Your Question Template** in 4 · Rounds & Questions.) ✅ Restoring a real backup was checked in the sandbox during build 111 work; 🟡 not end-to-end on a real Windows PC.

22.3b Safety backups (automatic, since build 125)

Just **before** Mind It! replaces or removes anything — restoring a backup, loading a game file, deleting players or a game record, **Start fresh** or **New quiz** — it keeps a safety backup of how things were, by itself. **Since build 142** it also keeps one **after every game**, as soon as the game is in Historic Games ("After the game — Falcons won"; never for a Rehearsal). The **last 10** are kept on this device: **⋯ ▾ → 💾 Backups & Restore → 🛟 Safety backups**. Each one says what it was made before and when; **⟲ Restore** puts it back (asking first — and making a safety backup of *that* moment too), **Save File** turns it into a normal backup file.



📸 Real screenshot (build 142) — 🛟 Safety backups in Backups & Restore, with the one made after a game at the top.

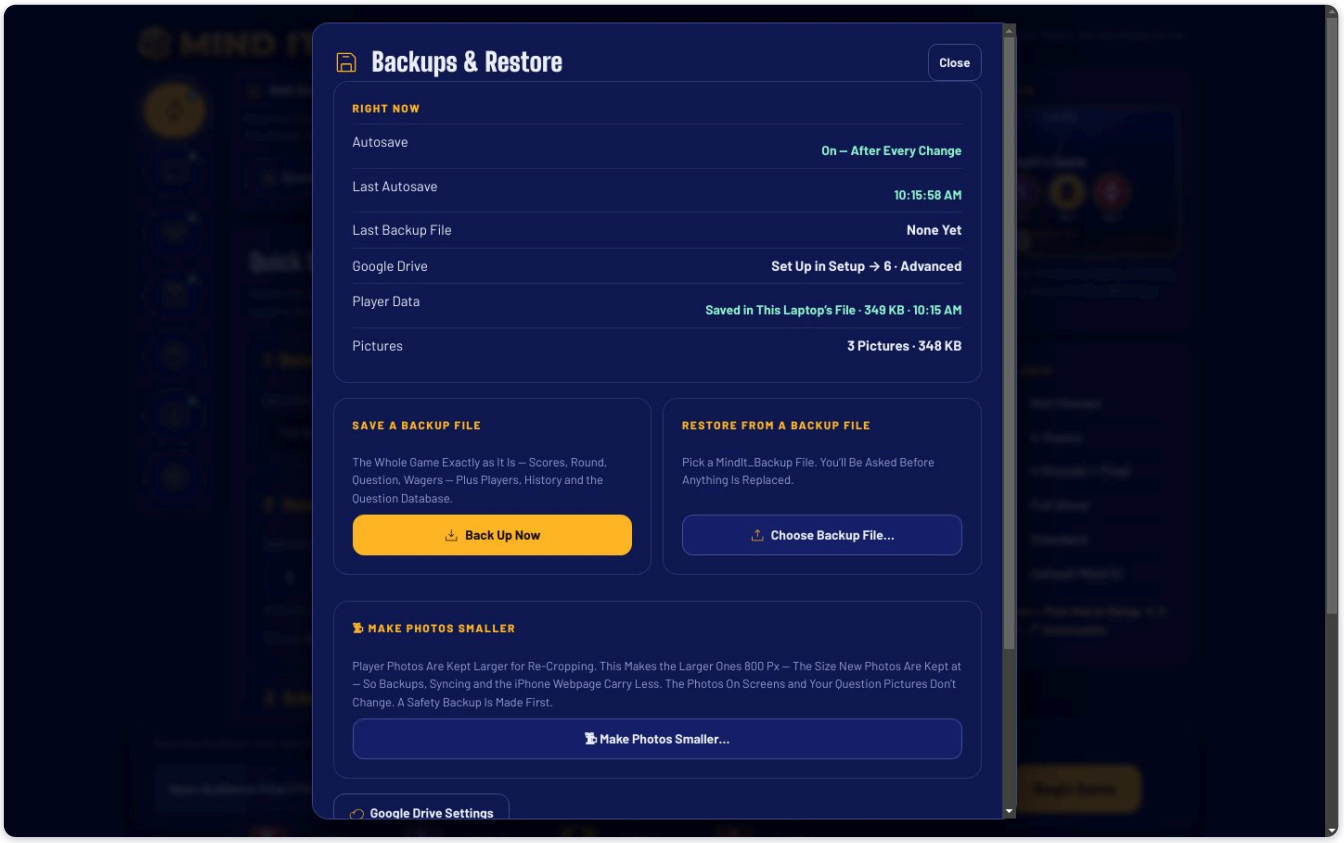
They live inside the app on this device (the laptop, or the tablet when it runs a game on its own) — they are not a replacement for **Back Up Now** files kept somewhere else.

22.3c Where your data is, and 🗜 Make photos smaller (since build 136)

Right now at the top of Backups & Restore shows two more lines: - **Player Data** — where the players, pictures, history and Question Database are saved: *this laptop's file*, *the tablet's file*, *this browser's database* (a big collection on the webpage) or

this browser; how big they are; and when they were last saved. If a save is waiting, it says so — use **Try Again** in the bar at the bottom. - **Pictures** — how many pictures are kept, and how big they are together.

🗜️ **Make photos smaller** (only when you tap it): every player photo also keeps a larger *original* so it can be re-cropped later. Since build 111 new originals are kept at 800 px; older ones can be up to 1,600 px. 🗜️ **Make Photos Smaller...** checks your photos first and tells you how many and how much smaller before anything changes. **Make Them Smaller** makes a safety backup first, then makes the larger originals 800 px. Every player keeps their picture (same picture IDs); the photos shown on screens, your question pictures (they fill the TV), animated GIFs and see-through pictures don't change. Backups, syncing and the iPhone webpage then have less to carry. If you change your mind, 🛟 **Safety backups → Before Make Photos Smaller → ↺ Restore**.



📸 *Real screenshot (build 136) — Backups & Restore with Player Data, Pictures and 🗜️ Make photos smaller.*

22.4 Preserving and moving player profiles

Player Profiles → Export Player Profiles on the old device → **Import Player Profiles** on the new one. Import merges — nothing already there is lost, and the current game isn't changed. **Export History to Excel** gives a spreadsheet copy.

22.5 Hand Over to Another Device

Move a running game to another laptop:

1. **Save Backup File** on the old device.
2. On the new device: open Mind It! as Quizmaster, go to Setup and drop the file on **Upload Your Question Template**, then press **Restore Backup**.
3. Press **Return to game** — it carries on from the exact same point.
4. Stop using the old device, so only one Quizmaster screen runs the game.

22.6 Google Drive backup 🟡

Setup → 6 · Advanced → ☁️ **Google Drive Backup**: backups go straight to *your own* Google Drive through a small web app you set up once (**How to Set It Up (5 Minutes, Once)**). Fill in **Your Backup Web App URL** and **Secret Key**, then **Save & Test**

Connection. It is the only feature that uses the internet. Office networks may block it. (Your URL and key are private — never share them.)

Since build 146 it works more lightly: the backup is made a few seconds after the round summary, standings or winner screen appears (the standings and the winner share one upload); the once-a-day backup is skipped when nothing has changed (**Back Up Now** always uploads); a big backup on a slow connection gets more time (45 seconds plus 15 per MB, up to 10 minutes); if it fails it waits 3 minutes, then 6, 12, 24 and 30, never starts while a question is on screen, and the line under the boxes says when it tries next; it also shows each backup's size and how long it took. A backup still waiting when you close Mind It! is made again a minute after the next start. Backups need nothing changed in your Google script.

☁️ **Restore from Drive (since build 146):** next to **Back Up Now**. It lists the newest backups in your Drive folder (newest first, with the date, time and size); ⭮ **Restore** downloads one and restores it exactly like *Choose Backup File* — it asks first, keeps a Safety Backup of what's open, and adds the players, pictures and Historic Games in it without deleting any. It needs the **version 2** backup script (*MindIt_GoogleDrive_Backup.gs* from build 146): open **script.google.com** → your Mind It! backup project → replace everything with the new file but keep your own `KEY` line (and `KEEP = 7`) → save → **Deploy → Manage deployments →** ✏️ **Edit → Version: New version → Deploy** (the URL stays the same). With the older script Mind It! shows these steps instead and asks it for nothing else; backups keep going up either way. The script only lists and reads the files in its own backup folder, and only with your key.

How many backups are kept in Drive: the backup script keeps the newest **7** (since build 145; it was 40) and moves older ones to the Drive Bin, which Google empties after 30 days. A script set up before build 145 keeps 40 until you change it: open **script.google.com** → your Mind It! backup project → change `const KEEP = 40;` to `const KEEP = 7;` → save → **Deploy → Manage deployments →** ✏️ **Edit → Version: New version → Deploy** (the web-app URL stays the same, so nothing changes in Mind It!).

22.7 Updating Mind It! safely

1. **Back Up Now** (and export player profiles if you're nervous).
2. Close Mind It!.
3. Windows: run the new joiner in the same folder (it replaces `Mind It!.exe`). Android: install the new APK over the old one (**Update**) — since build 149 the tablet can fetch it itself (**Settings → App Update**, 4.2); since build 142 straight from the laptop: 📲 **Connect Device →** 📲 **Update the Tablet App**, scan the code with the tablet; since build 143 the tablet offers it by itself (**Update Available → Update**). Update the laptop first, then the tablet.
4. Open Mind It! — your players, history, questions and saved game are still there.

🆘 HELP! MY GAME CLOSED IN THE MIDDLE OF A QUIZ!

Breathe. Mind It! saved the game after the last thing you did. Tell the room: *"Quick technical time-out — nobody touch your phones, your bets are safe!"*

1. **Reopen Mind It!** on the laptop (double-click `Mind It!.exe`).
2. Setup shows **Resume saved game** / **Start fresh**. Press **Resume saved game**. ❌ *Don't* press Start fresh. (Since build 121 the offer stays until you choose: if you close Mind It! again before choosing, the game is offered again next time — before, it could disappear.)
3. You are back on the same screen: same round, same scores, same question, same wagers.
4. **Re-open the Audience View** (Open Audience View (TV)) and put it back on the TV.
5. **The tablet** reconnects by itself within a few seconds (if not: Main Menu → **Connect To Laptop**).
6. **Phones** reconnect by themselves — nobody re-types a code. Check 📶 **Teams x/y**.
7. **The timer:** if a question was live, restart or extend the timer as fair (+30 Sec), or **Back to Board (Keep Open)** and reopen it.
8. **Check the scores** against what the room remembers. Fix anything with **Adjust Score** (it's shown on the TV with your reason).

No "Resume saved game"?

- Restore your latest **backup file**: ⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore → Choose Backup File… → Return to game.
- **The laptop itself died?** Use another laptop: open Mind It!, load the latest backup file (Hand Over, 22.5).
- **Lost everything and no backup?** Finish the round on paper and add the scores with Adjust Score in a new game. Then start backing up at every round break. 😉

If the tablet app closed: reopen it → **Connect To Laptop**. The laptop kept everything.

If a phone closed: reopen the link (or scan again); the team code is remembered.

PART SEVEN — TROUBLESHOOTING AND HOSTING TIPS

23. Complete Troubleshooting Guide

Format: **Problem → Why it happens → Easy fix → Advanced fix.** Before anything drastic (reset, reinstall, restore), **save a backup file** (⋯ ▾ → Backups & Restore → Back Up Now).

23.1 Starting up

The Windows EXE won't launch - **Why:** the three parts weren't joined properly; Windows SmartScreen blocked it; an old copy is still running; antivirus quarantined it. - **Easy fix:** run the joiner `.bat` again and wait for "Done". If Windows says "Windows protected your PC", click **More info → Run anyway**. - **Advanced fix:** check the joined file is exactly the size the joiner expects (it tells you if not — "badsize"); re-download any part. Close every Mind It! window (Task Manager → end "Mind It!"). Allow the file in your antivirus.

The APK won't install - **Why:** "install unknown apps" not allowed; not enough space; an app with the same name but a **different signing key** is installed (Android refuses to update it). - **Easy fix:** allow *Install unknown apps* for your file manager/browser; free some space. - **Advanced fix:** if Android says the package conflicts, the installed copy was signed differently. **Back up the tablet first** (Settings → backup), then uninstall and install the new APK, then restore. (Official builds are always signed with the same original key, so updates normally install over the old app.)

The APK won't download on the tablet (it starts but never finishes) - **Why:** the tablet's Wi-Fi or a network filter holds GitHub's file server, or Chrome is waiting for you to confirm an app file. - **Easy fix:** get it from the laptop instead (since build 142): 📲 **Connect Device** → 📲 **Update the Tablet App**, scan the code with the tablet — it comes over your Wi-Fi, not the internet. Tap **Download anyway** if Chrome asks. - **Advanced fix:** try mobile data on the tablet, or copy the APK from the laptop with a USB cable or Quick Share.

The tablet app is called "application" and closes at once (builds 129–134) - **Why:** a fault in how those app files were packaged: the tablet read every text in the app's settings one place out, so the name became "application" and the screen to open didn't exist. - **Easy fix:** install build 135 or newer over it (**Update**). Your data stays. - **Advanced fix:** none needed — don't clear the cache or data and don't uninstall. Since build 135 every APK is checked the way the tablet reads it before it can be published.

23.2 Connections

The tablet can't connect - **Why:** different Wi-Fi; guest/client isolation; Windows Firewall blocked Mind It! on the first run; wrong PIN; the laptop is asleep. - **Easy fix:** same Wi-Fi for both; on the laptop open **Connect ▾ → Connect Device**, then on the tablet **Connect To Laptop** and scan the code or type the PIN. - **Advanced fix:** allow Mind It! on **Private networks** in Windows Firewall and set the Wi-Fi to Private; use the laptop's mobile hotspot; press **New PIN (Disconnects All)** and connect again; restart Mind It! on the laptop (Resume saved game).

The Audience View keeps saying "Reconnecting to Host..." - **Why:** before build 110, Windows slowed down the host window when it was in the background. In 1.69 build 110+ that's fixed; if you still see it, the host window may have been closed or the laptop is overloaded or going to sleep. - **Easy fix:** make sure the host panel window is open (not closed); keep the laptop plugged in; it clears by itself. - **Advanced fix:** close and reopen the Audience View (**Audience View ▾ → Open Audience Window**); close other heavy programs; set Windows sleep to Never.

The question screen freezes - **Why:** the TV window lost contact, a dialog on the laptop is waiting for an answer, or the browser window was minimised. - **Easy fix:** look at the laptop — is a question ("Are you sure...?") waiting? Answer it. Don't

minimise the Audience View (it's fine for the host panel to sit on top). - **Advanced fix:** reopen the Audience View; if the laptop app itself is frozen, close and reopen it → **Resume saved game**.

Phones can't join - **Why:** different network, mobile data instead of Wi-Fi, guest isolation, VPN, firewall. - **Easy fix:** phone on the same Wi-Fi, mobile data off, scan the code on the TV again (it's there until Round 1 starts; later use 📶 **Devices → Phone Join QR (for Teams)**). - **Advanced fix:** laptop's mobile hotspot for everyone; firewall Private; check the **Join Link** address (6 · Advanced) — if the laptop has several addresses ("Other addresses on this laptop"), try another.

QR code pairing problems - **Why:** glare on the screen, the code too small or too far, an old screenshot of a code, or (tablet) the camera not allowed. - **Easy fix:** move closer, turn up the brightness, type the link (phones) or the PIN (tablet) instead. - **Advanced fix:** the tablet can also find the laptop game by itself ("LAPTOP GAME FOUND"). For phones, read the Join Link out loud.

A phone joined the wrong team - **Why:** someone typed another team's code. - **Easy fix:** on the phone, **Change Team Code** and type the right one. - **Advanced fix:** if a code leaked to the wrong team, give that team a **new code** (it asks first; the old code stops working).

A team's Mastermind It! answer was refused ("Time's Up") - **Why:** typed Mastermind It! answers close 2 seconds after the Mastermind It! timer runs out (build 114). - **Easy fix:** if the team said its answer out loud in time, mark it as usual — spoken answers still count. - **Advanced fix:** press **+30 Sec** before time runs out if the room needs longer; answers open again while the clock runs.

The Mastermind It! question can't be changed - **Why:** it locks once Mastermind It! starts (build 114), so nobody switches it by accident. - **Fix:** none needed — it unlocks when the game ends. Fix typos in the Question Database afterwards.

My saved game is gone after restarting Mind It! - **Why:** if another program was using Mind It!'s usual network port (8765), Mind It! opens on a different one, which has its own storage. - **Fix (since build 115):** Mind It! keeps a copy of the saved game and brings it over — you'll see **Saved Game Found**; choose **Resume saved game**. Since build 116 your theme, sound and house-rule settings come over too. Players, history and the Question Database are always safe in their own file.

A phone doesn't vibrate - **Why:** only Android phones can vibrate from a web page; iPhones can't. Silent/Do Not Disturb modes and battery savers can also block it. - **Fix:** nothing to do — the phone still shows everything on screen.

Wagers not registering - **Why:** the phone isn't connected (status line), the wager is outside the allowed range, wagers were already closed, or another phone on the team already locked a wager ("Your team already has a wager locked in"). - **Easy fix:** read the message on the phone; check 📶 **Teams**. The Quizmaster can always type the wager on the laptop/tablet. - **Advanced fix:** ✏️ **Change a Wager** on the host; for Mastermind It!, **Close Wagers** (missing = 0, still editable) and enter amounts by hand.

Special chips not activating - **Why:** not the team's turn; already picked the question; chip already used; another chip is on; wrong round (Bottoms Up = Round 1 only; Phoenix = Rounds 2–4 and only the eligible team); Phone Buzzer Mode (no chips at all, and no Phoenix is handed out); the rule is switched off in this preset; it's a Blind It! question (Phoenix/Bottoms Up wait for the next pick). - **Easy fix:** use the chip **before** picking, on your turn. - **Advanced fix:** the Quizmaster can **Use for <team>** in 🎟️ **Team Chips**; check 3 · Gameplay & Rules switches.

The timer isn't updating - **Why:** it's paused or stopped; auto-start is off; time's up already; a device lost contact. - **Easy fix:** press **Resume Timer** or **T** (it carries on from the seconds left); check the ⏰ Time's up card. - **Advanced fix:** check the TV pill; on the tablet look at the status line; the laptop's clock is the real one.

Buzzer problems - **Why:** not in Phone Buzzer Mode; reading time not over ("Wait for the light..."); early tap lockout (½ s); a team already tried and was wrong; phone disconnected. - **Easy fix:** 📳 **Buzzer Test** before the game; **Open Buzzers Now** to skip the wait. - **Advanced fix: Cancel Buzz** / **Reopen Buzzers**; switch the Early-Buzz Lockout off for children.

23.3 Game content and scores

The scoreboard looks wrong - **Why:** a wrong button press, a bonus you forgot (speed, pass-on), a Phoenix cap, a chip. - **Easy fix: Undo Last Score (U)** straight away — it reverses exactly the last entry. - **Advanced fix: Adjust Score** with a reason (it's on the TV, so everyone sees it's fair). Undo also gives back a chip the undone answer used (build 112), so prefer Undo for a chip question.

Missing questions / empty tiles - **Why:** a round isn't full (e.g. "28/30"); questions were deleted; a category had fewer than 5. - **Easy fix:** 4 · Rounds & Questions → **Rounds at a Glance** → top up empty slots from the database, or 🔄 **Replace** the category. - **Advanced fix:** the **Template Check** lists problems; re-import your template.

Missing images - **Why:** the picture was removed from the database; the backup came from an older build; a media link points to the internet (offline). - **Easy fix:** re-add the picture to the question (✎ Edit). - **Advanced fix:** restore the latest backup file (backups always include full pictures). Since build 111 a picture that's truly gone shows "no picture" — never a broken image — and is noted in the error list.

Audio problems - **Why:** muted; volume low; Windows output on the wrong device (e.g. laptop speakers instead of the TV). - **Easy fix:** 🔊 **Sound On**, raise **Master Volume**, press **Test Sound**. - **Advanced fix:** Windows sound settings → choose the TV/HDMI output; in a Teams call turn on **Include computer sound**.

Wi-Fi problems — see Chapter 9.4 and 9.5 (same network, guest isolation, VPN, firewall, hotspot).

The app is slow - **Why:** lots of large photos; a very old/busy laptop; many browser tabs. - **Easy fix:** close other programs; plug in the charger. - **Advanced fix:** use smaller photos (build 111 keeps new ones at up to 800 px); save a backup and restart Mind It!.

23.4 Saving and history

Lost game — see *HELP! My Game Closed...* (Chapter 22).

Historic Game errors ("This record couldn't be displayed") - **Why:** a damaged record (e.g. from a very old build or an interrupted save). - **Easy fix:** nothing to do — the record is set aside, never deleted; everything else works. - **Advanced fix:** it's kept in backups; send the backup file to whoever maintains your Mind It! for repair.

"Couldn't Save Player Profiles" (or an iPhone said "storage is full") - **Why:** before build 135, an iPhone or iPad used as the remote copied the laptop's whole player database (with all the photos) into Safari, which allows each website only about 5 MB — however much space the phone has. Since build 135 the remote doesn't copy it, the webpage keeps a large database in the browser's own database, and the message tells you which of these it is: - **"This browser's storage for Mind It! is full"** — the browser's limit for this site really is reached. - **"Can't Save On This Device"** — the browser is blocking storage (Private Browsing, or *Block All Cookies*). - **"Couldn't Open Mind It!'s Storage"** — another Mind It! tab or window has it open. - **"Couldn't Save The Player File"** — the laptop's or tablet's file couldn't be written (Mind It! keeps trying). - **Easy fix:** nothing is lost — your changes stay on screen and a bar at the bottom offers **Try Again** and ⬇ **Save Backup File**. Save a backup file, then fix the cause (turn Private Browsing off, close the other tab) and tap **Try Again**. - **Advanced fix: Backups & Restore → Right now → Player Data** shows where the data is saved and whether a save is waiting (since build 136). To make room: 🗜 **Make Photos Smaller** (22.3c), remove pictures you don't need; on the laptop, check there is free disk space.

End Game not responding - **Why:** the tablet lost the connection; the tablet is view-only ("This tablet is view-only. Tap 'Take Control' first."); the game isn't over yet (END GAME appears only after the final standings). - **Easy fix:** wait — it says "Saving the results on the laptop..." and **retries automatically** when the connection is back; or tap **Take Control**. - **Advanced fix:** on the laptop press **Back to Setup** from the standings — the result is the same (the game is saved once).

---

24. Tips for Hosting a Great Quiz

24.1 Before the night

- Do a **2-minute Rehearsal** with someone's phone. Nothing counts.
- Put the TV where everyone can see it; put yourself where you can see the TV *and* the teams.
- Print the **Player's Guide** for each table, or put a QR code to its mobile version on the tables (see `MIND_IT_QR_PLAYERS_GUIDE_PROPOSAL.md`).

24.2 Explaining the rules (script)

> *"Welcome to **The Big Fat Quiz**! Here's how it works. There are six categories on the board. When it's your turn, pick a category and a value — the bigger the number, the harder the question. Answer **out loud**. Right, and you win the points. Wrong, and you **lose** them — and the question goes to the next team. Not sure? Say **pass** — that's free. If you answer fast, there's a **speed bonus**, and if you answer a question other teams passed, you get a **pass-on bonus**. Somewhere on the board are hidden **Blind It! questions** — find one and you can bet on yourself. Your phone is for your **secret bets** and your **special chips**. And at the end, **Mastermind It!** — where anything can happen. Any questions? No? Excellent. Let's play Mind It!"*

24.3 Welcoming players (script)

> *"Grab one phone per team, scan the code on the screen, and type the four-letter code I'll give you. If your phone says 'Eyes On the TV', you're in. No app, no internet, no sign-up."*

24.4 Explaining the chips (script)

> *"Each team has a **Triple Gamble** chip: before you pick, tap **Use** on your phone, and your next question is worth **three times** the points — but you can't pass, and if you're wrong you lose three times as much. On a Blind It! question it's **six times**. In Round 1 there's also **Bottoms Up**: pick your designated drinker — if you get it wrong and they finish their drink, you lose nothing. And from Round 2, if a team falls more than 2,000 points behind, they may get the **Phoenix**: double points plus a catch-up, and a wrong answer costs nothing."*

24.5 During the game

- **Managing turns:** trust the **Now Playing** banner — the app keeps the order. If someone answers out of turn, either ignore it or use **A different team answered?**.
- **Encourage strategy:** remind teams that passing is free and that being below zero keeps them out of Mastermind It!
- **Disputes:** decide quickly, explain once, use **Adjust Score** with a reason ("Answer accepted on appeal") so it's visible and fair. Use **Undo** only for your own button mistakes — the ↩ **Undo** pop-up after each score (8 seconds) is the quickest way.
- **Pace:** 45 seconds is plenty. Use **+30 Sec** rarely, and the same way for every team. Time running short? ⏱ **One More Question** (the next question ends the round), ⭐ **Go to the Final** (skip the rounds still to come) or **End Round Early** — Mastermind It! is the best part.
- **Noisy venue:** turn on **Large Text On TV**, raise the volume, and let the TV banners do the talking. Announce the team's name before reading the question.
- **Avoid scoring mistakes:** read the answer on your screen *before* the team answers; look at the button label (it shows the amount) before pressing; press **Correct** for the team named on the banner.
- **Technical issues:** keep calm, say "technical time-out", follow Chapter 22. Phones keep their codes; scores are saved.

24.6 Building up to Mastermind It! (script)

> *"Ladies and gentlemen, it's time for **Mastermind It!**. The category is... **SPACE**. On your phones, bet anything from zero to everything you've got. Nobody can see your bet — not even me until the reveal. Bet small to stay safe... or bet big to win it all. Wagers are locked... here is the question!"*

24.7 Announcing the winner (script)

> *"In third place, with 2,000 points... **Tequila Mockingbird**! In second, so close, 3,200... **Crime Master Gogo**! And your champions tonight — from minus 600 after Round 1 — with 3,400 points... **HUNGOVER ACHIEVER**! Give it up! Stay seated for the awards — someone here is tonight's **Speed Demon**..."*

PART EIGHT — QUICK REFERENCE AND APPENDICES

25. The Printable Quick-Reference Materials

These come as separate files in the documentation pack:

File	What it is
`MIND_IT_QUICK_START.pdf`	The 10-minute beginner's quick start.
`MIND_IT_QUIZMASTER_CHEAT_SHEET.pdf`	**Exactly two A4 pages** to keep next to the laptop: controls, scoring, chips, timers (page 1); before/during/emergency/ending (page 2). Prints well in black and white.
`MIND_IT_REHEARSAL_CHECKLIST.pdf`	**Two A4 pages** to tick through once on the real laptop, tablet, phones and TV before a quiz night (about 40 minutes), from installing to Mastermind It! and the backup. Build 120.
`MIND_IT_PLAYERS_GUIDE.pdf`	**Exactly two A4 pages** for the teams: how to join, play, use the phone, and win.
`MIND_IT_PLAYERS_GUIDE_MOBILE.html`	The Player's Guide as one mobile-friendly web page (for a QR code).
`MIND_IT_QR_PLAYERS_GUIDE_PROPOSAL.md`	How players could open the guide by scanning a QR code — options available today, and a proposed (not built) in-app integration.
`MIND_IT_DOCUMENTATION_AUDIT.md`	The feature-by-feature audit behind this guide.

Appendix A — Feature status at a glance

✅ Implemented and verified

Everything in Chapters 5–22 unless marked otherwise: Quick Setup and setup sections; Question Database (add, import, edit, move, delete, preview, replace round/category with exact-5 selection, reorder, switch Mastermind It!); players, profiles, pictures, Random Teams, the Quizmaster rule; turns, correct/wrong/pass, pass-on and speed bonuses, timers and +30 s, Blind It! questions and Never Mind It!, Mastermind It! with typed answers and the checker, wager changes, undo, score adjustments; Triple Gamble, Phoenix, Bottoms Up and the Quizmaster chip override; Phone Buzzer Mode (with simulated phones); Connection Health and Test All Connections; End Game; the Audience View and the 12 themes; **new in build 112:** the phone join QR code on the TV before the game (with its on/off switch), 📶 Devices → Phone Join QR (for Teams), Undo giving chips back, ties decided by most correct answers on the TV, at least 2 teams, no Phoenix in Phone Buzzer Mode, one-player teams taking the player's name and picture, phones thanking after END GAME; achievements, Fun Stats, Historic Games, leaderboard, recap; Rehearsal; autosave, resume, backups and restore (in the test environment). **New in builds 113–114:** places on the TV score cards, Now Playing names that fit, the ⚡ hint on Correct, correct-answer counts on the podium and phones, kept hand-edited values, Phoenix Climber, the Mastermind It! question lock, Mastermind It! answers closing after time's up, 48 px tablet Setup buttons, the Replace Round duplicate warning, clearer Phone Buzzer Mode on the TV, licences in About, phones vibrating when needed.

Verified means: seen working in Mind It! 1.69 (build 111, and builds 112–114 for their changes) on a test computer (the real laptop app; tablet and phone screens opened in a browser at their real sizes), and/or covered by the app's 81 automated test suites.

🟡 Implemented, not verified on real hardware

- The EXE on a real Windows 10/11 PC (SmartScreen, firewall prompt, hotspot) and the joiner `.bat` on real Windows.
- The APK on a real Galaxy Tab (installing over an old version, finding the laptop on Wi-Fi, camera QR scanning).
- Real iPhones and Android phones; real TVs and projectors; casting (Chromecast, AirPlay, Smart View, Teams sharing).
- **All sounds and music** (they can't be checked by eye) — including the build-149 sound pack and build 150's trailer cues.
- The Galaxy Tab updating itself from the download page (build 149; tested with a stand-in, not by installing on a real tablet).
- Host Cam with a real camera; Google Drive backup to the real Google service.
- The browser-only "web link" version and its Quizmaster Mode (republished with build 114 on 11 Oct 2026; not checked on real devices).
- Phones vibrating (Android only; iPhones can't) and the 48 px Setup buttons on the real Galaxy Tab.

🔵 Approved, unfinished or undecided (open questions for the owner)

Fixed in builds 113–115: hand-edited question values are kept; no Phoenix where nobody can use it (Buzzer Mode, browser-only); in Buzzer Mode nothing can be scored before a buzz; the saved game survives a port change (another program on 8765); the 🚀 Phoenix award is now "Phoenix Climber" (no more duplicate "Comeback Kid").

Settled by the owner in October 2026 (no longer open): the Phoenix speed bonus after the cap stays; Blind It! spots stay in place when questions are reordered; ties are decided by most correct answers on the TV too (build 112); at least 2 teams everywhere (build 112); no Phoenix in Phone Buzzer Mode (build 112).

⚪ Ideas only — NOT in Mind It! 1.69

Don't look for these: Google Cast / Android TV apps; "Fast Track", True/False, Sequence, Evil Round; Lightning / Joker / Specialist / picture / Name-That-Tune rounds; lifelines (50:50, Ask a Friend), Hot Streak bonus points, Bonus Wheel, audience vote; sudden-death tiebreaker; extra chips (Steal, Shield, Insurance, Double Down, Bounty, Category Lock, Clock Stopper, Mystery Box…), Phoenix in Mastermind It! or in Buzzer Mode; an in-app pre-show checklist; a QR code for the Player's Guide on the TV (proposed in this pack only — the TV's QR code joins phones to the game, it doesn't open the

guide); a Quick Quiz Generator; league/season mode beyond the leaderboard's "This Season"; team profiles and saved line-ups; Mac version; code signing / Microsoft Store.

Appendix B — Things found while writing this guide

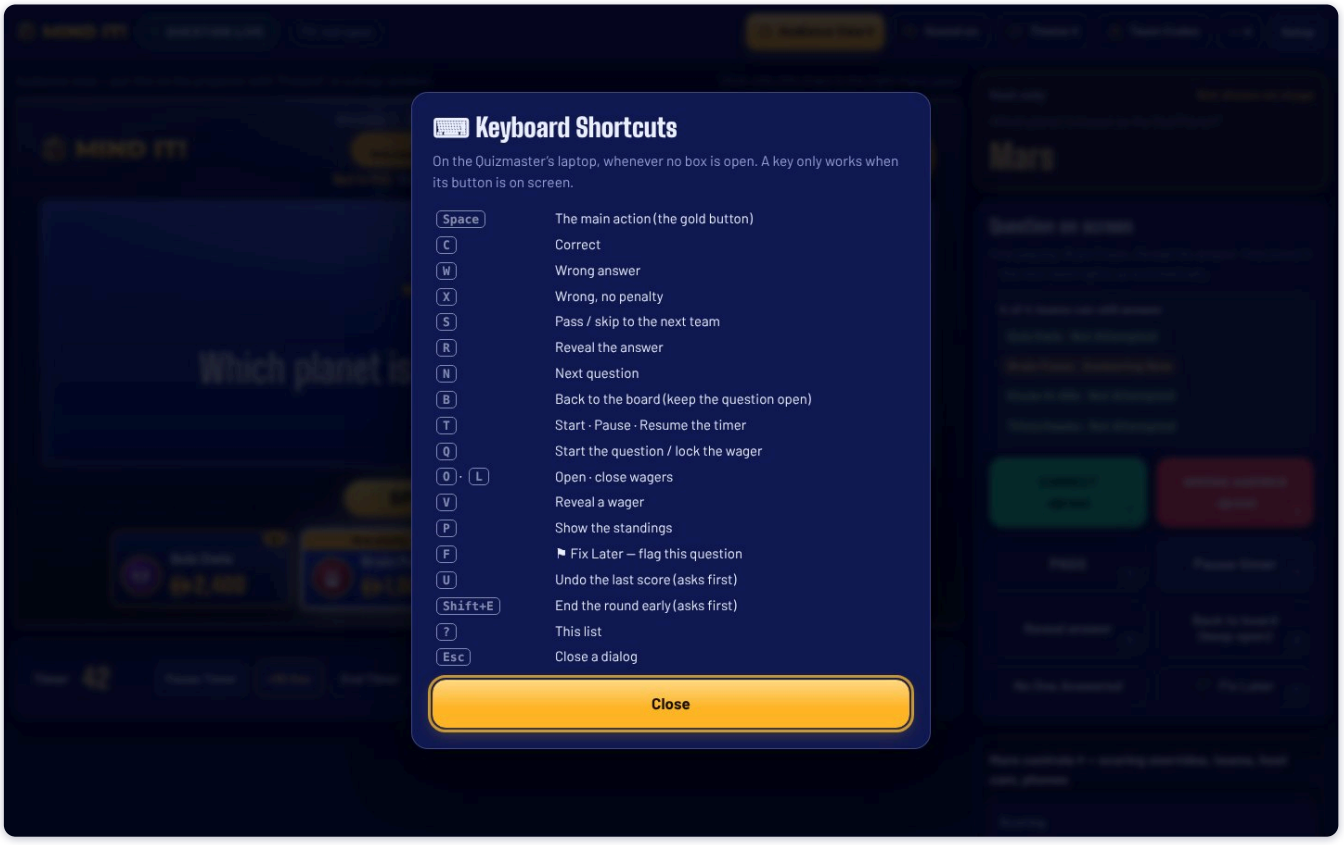
*The source code is the source of truth. These are places where the app's behaviour surprised us, or where the project documents and the code disagree. The guide itself changed nothing in the app; the owner then approved fixes for items 1–3, which are in **build 112**.*

#	What	Where	Effect	Status
1	**"Phone Join Link / QR" opened the Quizmaster Phone Remote** (build 111): the Devices button switched the Phone Remote on and showed the Quizmaster remote QR code and PIN.	Laptop, Devices window	A host could show players a code that gives host controls.	✅ **Fixed in build 112** — renamed **Phone Join QR (for Teams)**; it opens the players' join code.
2	**Phones didn't say "Thanks For Playing!" after END GAME when Mastermind It! was played with phone wagers** (build 111).	Phones after End Game	Cosmetic; results were saved correctly.	✅ **Fixed in build 112** (also after the laptop's Back to Setup).
3	**The TV showed the ⚡ Speed Bonus countdown during a Triple Gamble** (build 111), although a Triple Gamble never earns one.	Audience View, laptop, tablet	Misleading label; scoring correct.	✅ **Fixed in build 112.**
4	The setup card text said players "pick their team, enter the team code", but the phone only asks for the code (the code picks the team).	6 · Advanced → Phones & Live Wagers	Wording only.	✅ **Fixed in build 113.**
5	The project documents (GAME_RULES.md and others) were behind the app.	Documents	None.	✅ Updated to build 114.
6	The remaining open questions in Appendix A (🔵).	—	As described.	Owner to decide.

Appendix C — Keyboard shortcuts (laptop)

The same list is in the app: ⋯ → ⌨ **Keyboard Shortcuts**, or press **?** (since build 152). A key only works when its button is on screen, and never while a box is open.

Key	Action	Key	Action
Space	Main action (the highlighted button)	**N**	Next question
C	Correct	**T**	Timer start · pause · resume (resumes from the seconds left)
W	Wrong answer	**O / L**	Open / close wagers
X	Wrong, no penalty	**V**	Reveal (Mastermind It!, next team)
S	Skip team (Pass)	**Shift+E**	End round early (asks first; **E** alone does nothing since build 152)
R	Reveal answer	**U**	Undo the last score (asks first)
B	Back to board (keep open)	**P**	Show standings
Q	Start the question / lock the wager	**F**	⚑ Fix Later — flag this question
?	The shortcuts sheet	**Esc**	Close a box · leave Present mode



📸 *Real screenshot (build 152) — ⋯ → ⌨ Keyboard Shortcuts.*

Appendix D — Glossary

Word	Plain English
Audience View	The screen for the TV — what the room sees. Never shows answers early.
Host panel	The laptop window the Quizmaster uses. Shows the answers.
Quizmaster	The host. One per game; can't play in that game.
Owner (of a question)	The team whose turn it was when the question opened. The next question goes to the team after the owner.
Pass-on bonus	Extra points (25% per pass) for answering a question other teams passed.
Speed bonus	Extra points (half the round's lowest value) for the owner answering right within 10 seconds (15 in Online Mode).
Blind It!	A hidden tile; the picking team bets on itself.
Rewind It!	Chosen instead of Blind It! for a game: a cowboy-hat wheel sets 1×–5× the value; wrong loses at most 3×; no chips (12.1b).
Mastermind It!	The last question of the game, wagered by every team on 0 or more (was the Final Round).
The Rascala!	The last-place team, revealed after the winner (19.1b).
Never Mind It!	Betting your whole score (or more) on a Blind It! question.
Chip	A once-per-game special power used from the team phone: Triple Gamble, Phoenix, Bottoms Up.
Wager	A bet. Private until revealed.
Sealed	Hidden on the TV until the answer is scored.
Journal / Undo	Every score change is recorded; Undo reverses the last one (and gives back a chip it used).
Tie-break	Level on points at the end → the team with more correct answers wins; level on both → a shared win. Or, for first place, the Quizmaster plays a ⚡ **sudden-death tiebreaker** (build 140): one question, out loud, the first team marked right wins.
⏱ One More Question / ⭐ Go to the Final	Build 140: end the round after the next question / skip to Mastermind It!
Away	A team marked absent; skipped for turns, buzzers and Mastermind It!
Join QR	The code phones scan to open the game page. On the TV before the game, and in 📶 Devices → Phone Join QR (for Teams).
Team code	4 letters a team types on its phone to join. Host-only.
PIN	4 digits the tablet uses to connect to the laptop.
Local network	Devices in the room talking through the same Wi-Fi (no internet needed).
Client isolation	A Wi-Fi setting (common on guest networks) that stops devices talking to each other. Fix: the laptop's hotspot.
Latency / round trip	How long a message takes to go to a device and back (ms = thousandths of a second).
Historic Game	A finished game saved as a frozen snapshot.

Word	Plain English
Rehearsal	A practice game where nothing is recorded.
Autosave	Mind It! saves after every change, automatically.
Backup file	A file containing the game, players, history and questions — your safety copy.

Appendix E — Frequently asked questions

Do players need an app? No. They scan a QR code and use the phone's browser.

Do we need internet? No. Only the same Wi-Fi (or the laptop's hotspot). Google Drive backup is the only online feature.

Can I run Mind It! without a TV? Yes — use **Present On This Screen**, or let teams gather round the laptop. It's more fun on a big screen.

Can I run it without phones? Yes. You type wagers yourself; chips can still be switched on from the 🎟️ Team Chips card; the Mastermind It! answers are spoken.

Can I run it without the laptop? Yes, on the tablet alone (**Start New Game**) — but without team phones.

How many teams? 2–8. **How many players per team?** No limit; at least one. A one-player team takes its player's name and picture.

Two teams finish level — who wins? For first place, the Quizmaster can play a ⚡ **sudden-death tiebreaker** (build 140, Chapter 18.3). Otherwise — or if it's skipped — the team with more correct answers. Level on that too? It's a tie, and they share the win.

Can the Quizmaster play? Not in the same game. Pick another Quizmaster (Chapter 7.6).

Can a team change its wager? No. The Quizmaster can (until the Blind It! question is scored, or until that team is revealed in Mastermind It!).

Can a score go negative? Yes. Below zero you sit out Mastermind It!

What if I press the wrong button? Undo (U) — it reverses exactly the last score (and gives back a chip that answer used). Or **Adjust Score**.

Can teams answer Mastermind It! late? Typed answers close 2 seconds after time's up. Spoken answers are up to the Quizmaster.

Will my phone buzz? Android phones vibrate when it's your team's turn to pick and when your wager opens. iPhones can't.

What if the laptop crashes? Reopen → **Resume saved game** (Chapter 22).

Is anything sent to the internet? No — except Google Drive backups if you set them up. Phones and the tablet talk only to your laptop. Host Cam is never recorded or uploaded.

Where are my players and history stored? On the device (laptop/tablet) and in your backup files. Updates keep them.

Mind It! v1.69 · The Complete Idiot's Guide · documentation pack updated for build 140. Intro theme (music and voice): created in collaboration with ElevenLabs. Team icons: game-icons.net (CC BY 3.0). Fonts: Big Shoulders Display and Barlow (SIL Open Font License).